

DELORES SWALLOWS



A
Loaned Wife's
JOURNEY

The Full Story

A Loaned Wife's Journey

The Full Story – His Boss, Both Partners, and The Board

by Delores Swallows

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Content Advisory: This book is intended for mature audiences and contains explicit sexual activity.

A Loaned Wife's Journey

The full story of Nicole and Julian's adventures in the world of wife-sharing...

Entertaining His Boss – *Julian's the perfect husband—kind, loving and loyal—yet Nicole had still allowed herself to stray with a colleague. But that was in the past. She'd learned her lesson.*

At least she thought she had... until Julian invites his new boss around for dinner.

Ciaran is the exact opposite of Julian. He's probably never had a selfless moment in his life, but he's incredibly sexy, and seemingly captivated by her. After much flirting over pudding, she agrees to help him with his bookkeeping for a private business venture.

In the privacy of Ciaran's office the following week, she allows him to kiss her, and more.

She's just beginning to swim in the pool of self-loathing when something Ciaran says alerts her to the fact that her husband has a few secrets of his own. When she gets home that day, Nicole and Julian have a discussion that changes things forever...

Serving Both Partners - *Everything's changing for Nicole.*

Julian's promotion means they get to live in a fabulous home. And he's changing, too. Gone is the loveable-bumbler; in his place, a self-assured senior manager who takes control in the boardroom and the bedroom. Whether that confidence is a result of his new position at work or his decision to share his wife, Nicole isn't sure—but she's sure reaping the benefits.

Not only does her husband buy sexy lingerie and shoes for her to thrill her bull, he sometimes dictates what happens on her dates. He even encourages her to enjoy new adventures when the opportunity arises.

But life's not all plain sailing. They both learn that in an open relationship, openness is just as important as a stellar libido. Secrets have no place in wife-sharing.

When Ciaran reveals he's developing feelings for her, Nicole reminds him of the rules between hotwife and bull: they only share physical pleasure. He puts her theory to the test by inviting his business partner along to one of their dates, offering her the chance to experience twice the physical pleasure. Though annoyed by his manipulation, a phone conversation with Julian convinces her to make the most of the opportunity. Nicole follows his advice.

The perfect husband is hard to find but, for a loaned wife, there's a long list of bulls waiting for their chance...

Approved by The Board - *After Ciaran decided to share her with his business partner, Nicole knows it's time to move on. Only her husband gets to share her. Ciaran was just her bull, and the bullpen's full of alternatives for a beautiful hotwife—alternatives like the gregarious couple next door.*

Unable to accept that their kinky times are over, Ciaran persuades Nicole to accompany him to Ireland on a business trip to charm a bank manager and join his firm's get-together in Galway. Angered by his deviousness on the first day, Nicole makes him pay on the second, getting along too well with his colleagues for his liking.

Set against the backdrop of a global pandemic, Nicole finds just how good life as loaned wife can be. And her husband's suggestion means that once the travel restrictions are lifted, her adventures will get even better...

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Entertaining His Boss

Ψ



Chapter One

Nicole was just putting the finishing touches on dinner when her husband's car pulled into the drive. As she was warming the plates, Julian came through the back door with one hand held behind his back and a broad smile on his face. He kissed her cheek, whipped his hand around with a flourish, and presented her with a bunch of orange roses.

"Why, thank you." She sniffed her favourite flowers, trying to think if this was one of their anniversaries. "Did I forget something?" Unnervingly, Julian remembered the dates of every milestone in their relationship—when they'd met, when they'd first slept together, when he'd proposed. Knowing him, he probably kept a spreadsheet.

"No, but I thought they might bring a smile to that beautiful face."

"Ah, that's so nice." She stretched up and kissed his cheek. "Thanks, hon."

"There's more." Julian's smile broadened, stretching his black moustache into a horizontal line across the middle of his face. He opened his briefcase and took out a bottle of champagne.

"Oh wow, bubbles on a school night?"

"And already chilled." He slipped off his suit jacket and slung it over his arm. "I'll go and change, and then tell you my news over dinner."

By the time Nicole had placed their dinner on the dining room table, Julian was busy removing the foil and muselet from around the champagne cork. "So, what are we celebrating?"

He smiled shyly as he popped the cork, poured their drinks and passed her one. "Apparently, I'm being considered for the role of regional manager, marketing division."

"Oh wow. Congratulations." Smiling, she wondered if 'being considered for the role' was actually worthy of a celebration.

He sat down and raised his glass. "Well it's not official yet, but Ciaran seems to think the board will go along with his recommendation."

“Ciaran, the new manager?”

Julian nodded.

“He’s only been there five minutes.”

He laughed. “He was at Head Office for two years before moving to our branch, and he’s actually been with us for eight months. He started in January—it just seems a short time because of the lockdown.” An embarrassed smile crept onto his face. “To be honest, I think the lockdown’s had a big influence on my potential promotion. It appears most of my peers weren’t as productive in their working-from-home duties as I was.”

“Well, I’m proud of you for even being considered.”

He shrugged as if embarrassed by the praise, which was typical of him. While she usually considered his social awkwardness endearing, it could be maddening sometimes.

“Speaking of Ciaran,” he said, dabbing his mouth with a napkin, “I’ve invited him round for dinner on Saturday.”

“What?”

Julian frowned. “That’s alright, isn’t it?”

Not really, dear. “Do people still invite their boss round to dinner? I thought that only happened in old American sitcoms.”

He barked an exaggerated laugh. “No, I think it still happens.”

Nicole was more than a little uncomfortable. “Julian, I really don’t see myself as a corporate wife.”

After another bout of embellished guffawing, he shook his head. “It’ll be very informal, I promise. We’re not talking lobster thermidor and your finest ballgown.”

She took a bite of her glazed chicken, wondering if this would be an appropriate meal to serve. “Will his wife be coming as well?”

“Ciaran’s not married. He’s the young, ambitious, go-getter type.”

This was a surprise. Julian had never mentioned Ciaran’s age. “Well, I don’t know what I’ll cook.”

He offered an appeasing smile. “I’m sure you can rustle up something without going to too much trouble. A simple chilli or curry will be fine.”

“I think he should have offered for us all to eat out, now that the restaurants are open again.”

Julian looked uncomfortable. “I just want to show him the new way I’ve been collating the figures and suggest it as a possible strategy for the whole team to use.”

Nicole didn’t want to dampen the celebratory mood, but she was far from happy about having to entertain Julian’s boss just so he could demonstrate his data management fetish.

After finishing dinner, they took what remained of the champagne through to the living room and chatted about their respective days. Julian had returned to his usual routine of visiting customers three days a week and spending two days at the local Blackburn office, but Nicole—who worked as a part-time bookkeeper for a local electronic circuit board manufacturer—was still working from home.

“So,” she said, turning the champagne flute by the stem, “When will a decision be made about your possible promotion?”

“I’m not exactly sure. To be honest, I’m astonished I’m even being considered.”

“Nonsense. You put an awful lot into your job.”

Julian offered another self-deprecating expression. “I know most of my colleagues see me as the office nerd—”

“I’m sure they don’t.” This wasn’t entirely true. She’d seen the expressions on her own friends’ faces when she’d first introduced them to Julian. But they were only looking at the surface and not at the kind, caring person he actually was.

“Yes they do. Whenever we go on sales conferences, they think I’m boring because I don’t drink myself into a stupor and join in with their childish banter.”

“How old are they?”

“Not that young. A couple are in the mid-twenties, but some are well into their thirties. I’m only forty-one, but they make me feel like the office grandpa half the time.”

“There’s a reason I chose a more mature husband.”

As she squeezed his hand, he grinned ruefully. “To be fair, I’ve never acted like that, even when I was younger.”

Nicole tried to imagine her husband as a drunk and giggling teenager. “No, I don’t suppose you have.”

“But if the board does support Ciaran’s recommendation, it’ll mean a decent pay rise, plus a bigger car allowance.”

“Really?” She hadn’t even considered the financial benefits yet.

“And my annual bonus can be up to fifteen percent of my salary, whereas at the moment it’s capped to ten.”

She thought about replacing the horrible ‘buttercup’ bathroom tiles which had come with the house. Or replacing their old cooker with a six-ring range. “Would the new salary mean we could think about getting the bathroom or kitchen refurbished?”

Julian put his arm around her. “We could. Alternatively, we could sell up and buy one of those executive homes on Parkside Grange.”

“Really?” The houses up there were fabulous, huge, red-bricked buildings with sweeping lawns and double garages. Although she’d never been that interested in material wealth, or the men who pursued it, she loved the idea of a more elegant house with a big garden she could really invest a lot of time in.

“Let’s not count our eggs too soon, but I think a house up there would be well within our means.”

She rubbed her leg against his. “Shall we finish our bubbles in bed?”

He guffawed again, killing the mood. “I need to get a few bits of work done first, I’m afraid.”

Nicole forced a smile, waited until he’d left the room, and then watched Love Island while she drank the champagne. She’d gone to bed and fallen asleep before Julian finished whatever he’d been working on in their office.

* * * *

For Ciaran’s visit, Nicole decided to repeat a recipe she’d used before: slow-cooking a shoulder of lamb and serving it with minted new potatoes and steamed vegetables. Dessert would be just fresh berries served with a bought sorbet. If he complained, she’d be happy to point out that dinner wasn’t her idea.

Thanks to Julian obsessing over his world-beating algorithm, Nicole spent Saturday morning tidying the house and most of the afternoon prepping dinner. Just as she'd finally lowered herself into the bath for a little peace and quiet before getting dressed, Julian emerged from his office and came into the bathroom for a shave and shower. He babbled incessantly throughout, which she knew meant he was a lot more nervous than he'd let on. Determined not to let him down, she soothed herself by imagining life in one of the big houses on Parkside Grange with more than one bathroom. She might be able to bathe in peace for once.

She decided to wear her hair down and only applied a little makeup—just a touch of mascara and a subtle hint of lippy. She picked flat shoes and a pale blue, wraparound summer dress with a fitted waist.

When she walked downstairs, she found Julian looking through the bottles of red in the rack. He'd dressed in a hideous yellow V-necked sweater over a shirt and tie, and pale green chinos.

"Don't you think you're a little too... colourful?" she asked, trying to find a nice way of hinting he looked like an advert for a gay golf tournament. The sweater had been a gift from his mother, and Nicole had hidden it at the back of his wardrobe.

"I was trying to look casual. Do you think I should wear a suit?"

She laughed and shook her head. "Maybe lose the tie." As he undid the knot, she had another idea. "It's quite warm tonight, so you probably don't need the jumper, either."

"Really?"

"Just wear the shirt, maybe undo the button at your collar, and roll your cuffs back. It'll make you look relaxed."

"Right, yes. Good idea." Julian galloped upstairs and came back a minute later sans sweater, though with his hair sticking up.

Nicole smiled as she stroked it back into place. It was still completely black, though slightly thinning. "There, now you look less like a canary."

He gave an exaggerated laugh.

"Are you okay, hon?"

"Yeah, course." His flickery smile told her otherwise.

She stroked his arm. “Just be yourself. Tonight’s not an interview, so relax and enjoy it.”

He nodded repeatedly, then went back to choosing a bottle of red. “I’ve put a white in the fridge already, but I think I should open one of these now and let it breathe.”

“I think you should let yourself breathe.”

He gripped his chosen bottle. “I just want tonight to be a success. I need to show him the data output for this week’s figures so he can see how the standard deviation shifts when you take into account—”

“Stop!” Nicole laughed at his startled expression. “All I’m hearing is blah-blah-blah.”

Julian followed her into the kitchen. “You’re a bookkeeper. Surely you understand the advantages of being able to get an instant snapshot of ___”

“Blah-blah-blah. Tell Ciaran, not me. Now, let me check the lamb.”

Julian returned to the dining room with the corkscrew to open the red, and Nicole lit the gas under the pan of new potatoes.

When the doorbell rang, Julian came into the kitchen, his eyes wide. “Ciaran’s here.”

“Maybe you should let him in, then. Since it’s a nice evening, how about we have pre-dinner drinks on the patio?”

“G-good idea.”

“Take him out to the garden now, and I’ll join you as soon as I’ve got the veg in the steamer.”

“Yes. Right.”

Julian disappeared. A moment later she heard mumbled conversation as the two men headed down the hall and through the dining room to the patio doors. She gave them a couple of minutes before heading out to meet their guest.

“Ah, here she is,” Julian said as she stepped out onto the patio. “Nicole, this is Ciaran. Ciaran, this is my lovely wife, Nicole.”

She tried to hide her surprise. Ciaran was nothing like she’d expected. He was incredibly good-looking with dark hair and piercing blue eyes that sparkled. She finally found her voice. “Hi Ciaran, it’s nice to meet you.”

He flashed her a dazzling smile and held out his hand. “Nicole. Good to meet you, too.”

“Drinks,” Julian said, clapping his hands together a little too loudly. “What can I get you, Ciaran?”

“A beer would be good, if you’ve got one.”

“Beer, yes of course. Nicole?”

“I’ll have a glass of white, please hon.”

After Julian had gone inside, Ciaran nodded towards the garden. “You’ve got this nice.”

“Thanks. I know it’s only small, but I enjoy pottering around when I can.”

She let her eyes wander over his body as he walked across the lawn towards the flowerbed by the back fence. He obviously worked out; his arms and shoulders were clearly defined under his fitted t-shirt. His stomach was flat, his waist narrow. As he crouched down to look closer at the flowers, she got a good view of his faded designer jeans hugging his muscled thighs and pert backside.

He narrowed his eyes. “I’m picking up a smell. It’s familiar but I can’t place it.”

She walked over and stood next to him, conscious that her bare legs were very close to his face. “It’ll be that,” she said, pointing at a white-flowered bush. “It’s a liquorice plant.”

“Liquorice, that’s it. That’s what I can smell.” Ciaran straightened and was about to say something else when Julian returned with their drinks.

Julian passed Nicole her wine, then handed one of the bottles of Beck’s to Ciaran, raising his own bottle in toast. “Good health.”

“Yeah, cheers.” Ciaran took a swig, then pointed his bottle towards the flowers. “I was just admiring your garden.”

“Ah, this is Nicole’s domain. Though I’m tasked with cutting the grass, she’s the one who chooses the plants and tends to them.” He leaned closer to Ciaran, as if revealing a secret. “She’s the one who provides all the glamour, as it were.”

Ciaran caught Nicole’s eye and smiled. “Yeah, I can see that.”

She felt a warmth in her cheeks and between her legs, and had to look away. Her husband’s boss was really sexy. “I should go check the

dinner.”

After draining the potatoes, she added butter and mint and put them in a serving bowl. Once her cheeks had cooled down, she went back to the patio door and called them inside. Julian nodded and held out his arm to let his boss come into the room first. Nicole saw Ciaran’s eyes wander over her body. Her cheeks heating again, she returned to the kitchen.

She carried the serving bowls through to the dining room and placed them in the centre of the table. When laying the place settings on three sides of the rectangular table earlier, she’d assumed that Julian would allow their guest to sit at the head of the table. Instead he’d taken that seat, which meant she and Ciaran would be facing each other. “Careful, everything’s still quite hot.”

Ciaran smiled at her. “It smells great.”

When she’d fetched everything from the kitchen, she uncovered the serving bowls as Julian fussed over the bottle of red he’d opened earlier, pouring a glass for himself and Ciaran. Nicole stuck to white. Red wine discoloured her teeth after just a couple of glasses. She sat, passing Ciaran the large serving spoons. “Help yourself.”

He grinned at her invitation, and she felt her cheeks warming again. Ciaran made free with the lamb and vegetables but only took one small potato.

Nicole began to fret. “Don’t you like potatoes?”

He laughed. “If only. I *love* potatoes, but I try not to eat any carbs.”

Her gaze automatically dropped down to his torso, and she realised he’d seen her do it.

“It’s particularly hard for me, being Irish and all. Potatoes are in my blood, you might say.”

Nicole glanced at her husband, who looked as surprised as she was. “You don’t sound Irish.”

“I was born in Cork, but my parents moved over here with my dad’s job when I was two. We moved around this country quite a bit over the following years, so I was never anywhere long enough to pick up any accent.”

Julian joined the conversation. “Do you still have family there?”

Ciaran nodded. “Yeah. In fact, my parents moved back when my dad retired, so all my family are in Ireland. I don’t have any siblings, but I have a lot of cousins.” He smiled at Nicole. “How about you, are you from round here?”

Julian answered before she had the chance. “I grew up in Hastings, and Nicole’s from Durham.”

Ciaran nodded. “How come you moved to Lancashire?” He’d directed the question at Nicole, but once again Julian answered.

“It was when I landed the job with GLP.”

Ciaran and Nicole shared a secret smile as Julian, oblivious to their guest trying to include the hostess in the conversation, launched off into a detailed history of his various roles at the company.

Ciaran tried again. “So, where did you two meet?”

“My previous job was in Nottingham, where Nicole was studying.” Julian took a sip of his wine and smiled at her. “I went to a lively little restaurant one night and fell for the most beautiful waitress they had.”

Nicole shrugged. “Most of my student friends had part-time jobs. We needed the money to eat.”

Ciaran nodded his understanding. “Yeah, I worked through my university years, too. Bar work mainly, but also a few shifts with a local swimming club. I’m a qualified swimming teacher.”

“Really?” Nicole couldn’t prevent the image of him in a tight pair of Speedos flashing before her eyes.

“Yeah. I did a lot of swimming as a kid and got the coaching licence as a way of making extra cash. I also did a couple of summers working as a lifeguard in Spanish hotels. That was a breeze—sitting on a high chair in the sun while kids splashed around on inflatable unicorns.”

Nicole suspected he’d have been great eye candy for the kids’ mothers, too.

Ciaran picked up his glass. “So, what did you study in Nottingham?”

“She was—” Julian stopped as Nicole glared at him. “Sorry.” He gave an apologetic smile, then forked in a mouthful of lamb.

Nicole turned to Ciaran, who was smirking. “I did a BA in classics, which meant I studied Ancient Rome and Greece.”

“That sounds...” He blinked. “What sorts of things did you study?”

“The cultures. Art, literature, mythology. Even the language. I chose Latin.”

“Fascinating. So, do you work as a teacher or historian?”

Julian scoffed again and Nicole rolled her eyes. “No, I work part-time as a bookkeeper for a small local company that produces heating controllers.”

Ciaran’s eyebrows went up. “Really? Well, I guess there’s not much call for classical art and literature experts, but the bookkeeping sounds interesting.”

She laughed. “It’s not, believe me.”

“No, I meant the fact you can do it. I’m looking for a bookkeeper right now.”

Nicole glanced at Julian, then back at Ciaran. “Don’t you have an office full of qualified accountants?”

“Yeah, but I have an interest in another business with one of my cousins. I always keep that side separate from my full-time employment.” He went back to eating, and little more was said until the main course was finished.

As Nicole stood and leaned over the table to collect the plates, she caught Ciaran checking out her breasts. He offered to help clear the table, but she insisted he remain seated. On each subsequent trip with the dirty crockery, she felt his gaze following her movements. The heat between her legs confirmed she enjoyed the attention.

By the time she returned with dessert, the men were talking about Julian’s program for collating sales figures. Or rather, Julian was talking about it. While her husband waxed lyrical about self-populating projection formulae, Nicole ate her berries and sorbet and sipped her wine. She noticed Ciaran only ate the berries.

Julian had hardly touched his own dessert, now in full-on data-analyst mode. “...So, if everyone spent ten minutes a day updating their figures, we’d have an instant snapshot. It’d make the monthly updates almost redundant. Those figures would be—”

“I’m not sure I understand how you’d be able to accomplish that,” Ciaran said with a frown.

Julian stood up and smiled. "I'll just run some figures through the program and print out what I mean. It'll be easier to show you then." Without another word, he left the room.

Ciaran laughed as Julian took the stairs two at a time. "I've never known anyone so passionate about numbers."

Nicole smiled. "Hmm, me neither."

He picked up his glass and stared at her over the rim. "You're not what I expected."

"I could say the same." Her stomach tightened.

He took a sip of wine, then put his glass down on the table. "How on earth did Basil Fawlty get such a gorgeous wife?"

She smiled at the flattery, but then frowned. "Basil Fawlty? Is that what you call him in the office?"

He shook his head. "That's how some of the guys in the sales room refer to him, but it's light-hearted and mainly based on his appearance. He's a respected member of the team, hence me putting him forward for the regional manager's role."

Nicole stared into Ciaran's blue eyes, trying to work out if he was being sincere. She found it hard to believe that her husband was the type to earn respect from his peers.

"You have a fabulous body."

His words shocked her into laughing out loud. "Er... thank you. I think that your no-carb regime is working for your body, too."

He gave a confident smile. "Maybe we should let our bodies get acquainted. Allow them to enjoy each other."

Nicole stood and brushed a stray lock of hair from her face. She could feel her cheeks burning. "I'll get the coffee."

She walked to the kitchen and he followed her. When she reached the counter, he stepped close behind her and slid his arms around her waist.

Although her heart pounded in her chest, she kept her voice low and calm. "Ciaran, this isn't appropriate."

"No, I know." His mouth was close to her ear, his breath on her neck making her shudder.

—” She placed her hands on his and tried to free herself. “Please, I can’t

“I can smell your arousal.”

Her jaw dropped but she couldn’t answer, worried that it might be true. She remembered him crouching by the liquorice plant as she stood right next to him. Upstairs, the printer in Julian’s home office beeped and then whirled into action.

Ciaran released her and she turned to face him. He took out his phone and touched the screen a few times, then handed it to Nicole. “Send yourself a text. That’ll give me your number, and you mine. I really do need a bookkeeper for my side venture.”

Even though she didn’t believe him, she tapped in her number and sent a blank text. Her own phone beeped from the kitchen table and he smiled, slipping his phone back into his pocket. At the sound of Julian’s footsteps on the stairs, Ciaran made his way back to the dining room and she turned on the percolator.

Nicole stayed in the kitchen for a few minutes to allow her heartbeat to slow and her cheeks to cool. She couldn’t believe what Ciaran had just done, or that she’d been stupid enough to give him her number. Though her body still tingled, she was angry with herself.

After loading the dishwasher, she took three cups and saucers through to the dining room. Ciaran was reading the sheet of paper Julian had printed and didn’t look up. She returned to the kitchen for the percolator and cream, then sat opposite Ciaran again. “There’s cheese and biscuits if you’re allowed them on your diet?” she teased, determined not to let him see how much he’d affected her.

He looked up and gave her another mischievous smile which kicked her heart rate up again. “The cheese, yes. The crackers, no. I don’t need anything else, but please, you two go ahead.”

She looked at Julian, who shook his head. “Not for me, thank you.”

Nicole poured the coffees. “I suppose sugar is out of the question.”

His eyes seemed to twinkle again. “Definitely, but I’d love some cream.”

This surprised her. “Cream’s allowed?”

“Oh yeah. I have lots of cream.”

He'd stared directly into her eyes as he spoke, and wet heat bloomed between her legs once more. She squeezed her thighs together, worried that both men would be able to smell her arousal. "Aren't there a lot of calories in cream?"

"Yeah." He smiled again "And protein. But I'm not too worried about the calories. I just don't eat sugar, or anything that's metabolised to sugars."

"And I always thought cream was bad for me." Nicole flashed her eyes, knowing her husband wouldn't notice.

Ciaran flirted back. "No, you can have as much cream as you like. Just don't have it in a cake, because they're made with flour."

"Ah, she does like flowers," Julian said, smiling sweetly at her.

Nicole and Ciaran shared another smile.

While the men discussed the figures on the sheet, and how using this principle could work within the framework of their sales data, Nicole drank three cups of coffee and watched Ciaran. Not just his expressive face, but also how his biceps and triceps flexed when he moved his arms to point at the sheet or pick up his cup. Every so often, he'd flash her one of his smiles.

She was on dangerous ground, but it'd been a while since she'd felt so alive.

Julian offered Ciaran another glass of red.

"No thanks, I'd better not have any more."

"Are there carbs in the wine?" Nicole teased, smiling at him.

Ciaran chuckled. "I'm actually more concerned about staying under the legal limit for my drive home."

"I can make fresh coffee," she offered.

He shook his head. "Not for me. I probably won't be able to sleep after the three cups I've already had."

She bit her lip and wondered if he'd be lying awake thinking about her. She was pretty sure she'd be thinking about him...

"Well," Julian said, holding out the sheet of figures he'd been obsessing over. "You can take this with—"

"No, it's okay." Ciaran smiled. "I understand it now, and I think it's a good idea. You should implement it for a trial period as soon as your new

position's confirmed."

Nicole saw her husband's face light up with pride, his moustache curling up like a dead caterpillar.

Ciaran turned to her. "It was lovely to meet you, and thanks so much for dinner. It was delicious."

She tilted her head to one side and gave him a wide smile. "It was lovely to meet you, too. I'm sorry about teasing you with the potatoes."

"Oh I love to be teased." He shook her outstretched hand. "I was serious about the bookkeeping thing. You mentioned you work part-time—what days don't you work?"

Her heartbeat kicked up its pace again. "Usually Tuesday and Friday, but with the home-working thing at the moment, it's more flexible."

He nodded. "That's great. Maybe we could meet for an hour so I can explain what sort of thing I'd need?"

She held her breath and glanced at Julian, who seemed thrilled at the prospect of his wife doing work for his boss. She gave Ciaran a brief nod. "Sure, that'll be fine."

He gave another smile and left. After Julian had closed the door, he clasped his hands in front of his chest. "Well, I think it's safe to say that tonight was a success. Not only was your cooking delicious, but he seemed quite taken with your accountancy skills."

Nicole shrugged. What Ciaran actually wanted from her wouldn't be related to bookkeeping. The man was so bloody arrogant and seemed to have a complete disregard for others—namely the guy he was proposing to promote—and yet she'd still gone along with his actions, passing on her contact details in an instant. Her cheeks flamed.

How desperate did that make me look?

They wandered back to the dining room and collected their wine glasses, then adjourned to the living room. Julian seemed to be in a very good mood, and since Nicole had spent the previous hour or so with a wet crotch, she sat next to him on the sofa and snuggled into his side.

"Ciaran seemed to like your algorithm," she said, using the sort of language that she thought might get him in the mood to scratch her itch.

"Hmm, he did, didn't he?" His eyes shone with pride.

She rubbed her calf against his leg. "I'm glad that all your extra effort is finally being recognised." She placed her hand on his thigh. "I might even reward you myself."

Julian looked down at her hand and bit his lip. "I was just going to run some more figures through my program."

Nicole slid her hand up his thigh and over his crotch. "Do that tomorrow."

"It'd only take me five minutes." He gave another smile, and she realised he was teasing.

"If what I want from you only takes five minutes, you'll be in trouble." She felt his cock start to swell beneath her hand.

"Do we need to tidy up before we go to bed?"

She shook her head in dismay. "I'm offering you hot sex. Stop thinking about algorithms and chores."

Julian abandoned what was left of the expensive red wine in his glass and allowed her to lead him up to their bedroom. He quickly removed his shirt, revealing his tall, wiry frame and thick band of black hair running from his chest down his stomach, and Nicole undid the belt of her dress and slipped it back off her shoulders.

He removed the rest of his clothes and climbed into bed, his eyes glued on her body as she unclipped her bra and rolled her panties down her thighs.

She moved to the side of the bed and smiled at him. "Lie on your back."

He paused, a little uncertain. "I'd be happy to—"

She shook her head. "No, not tonight." Her husband was patient and generous when it came to foreplay; she sometimes struggled to get wet enough for penetration. Tonight, that wouldn't be a problem.

Julian lay flat on his back and smiled up at her as she straddled him. She leaned forward and dragged her long brown hair over his face, which she knew he liked. Then she gripped his erection, pointed it at her entrance and dropped down on his length.

He let out a groan, probably surprised by how wet she was.

Nicole rocked her hips forwards and back, grinding her clit against his pubic bone and clenching around his shaft. He slid his hands up over her

hips and around to cup her breasts. As he squeezed her nipples, she felt her orgasm begin to wind like a clock-spring. She bore down harder, mashing her clit against him. The delicious tension inside her increased as she inched closer. Bucking her hips faster, she willed him to come at the same time—to hell with her warnings about him not lasting five minutes.

She closed her eyes and remembered Ciaran's breath on her neck, his voice in her ear. *I can smell your arousal.*

Nicole's legs began to shake. She opened her eyes. Julian's jaw was clenched tight—the expression in his eyes one of turmoil. He was afraid to come.

Her wave broke and she let out a grunt. She stroked his chest. “Come now.”

His body tensed and his eyes rolled up. He was coming, and she rode her own wave as they both cried out and writhed on the bed.

Eventually they stilled, and Nicole lay down on his chest. She could feel his heart beating and presumed he'd be able to feel hers, too. It'd been a while since they'd had sex with so much passion. Or maybe it'd be more accurate to say since *she'd* felt so much passion.

He slipped his arms around her waist and squeezed. “That was a pleasant surprise.”

She smiled at his after-sex talk. “A pleasant surprise?”

“What I meant was, I wasn't expecting you to be so—”

“Maybe I'm finally coming round to the eroticism of algorithms.”

He laughed, the resulting shudder easing his now-flaccid cock out of her. “I don't think it was that.”

She tensed. Had he picked up her flirting with Ciaran? Maybe he hadn't been as oblivious to the innuendo as she'd assumed. “Oh?”

“No. I think your mind is already planning the garden in one of those big houses on Parkside Grange.”

“Yeah, maybe I am.” For once relieved by his obliviousness, she slipped out of bed and headed for the bathroom. After turning on the shower, she quickly brushed her teeth at the basin and then stepped under the jets.

By the time she returned to the bedroom, Julian's eyes were half-closed. He'd drunk more than usual, and she suspected he'd also expended

quite a bit of nervous energy in the build up to tonight's dinner. On top of that, she'd ridden him like a pogo stick.

Settling down on her own side of the bed, Nicole closed her eyes and thought about Ciaran. He was a dangerous mix, but she couldn't deny the excitement he made her feel.

It'd be risky—but then, she'd taken risks before and gotten away with them. Though in truth, the thrill she'd experienced then hadn't outweighed the self-loathing she'd felt afterwards.



$$\Psi$$


A horizontal line with a small square box in the center, containing a horizontal bar.

Chapter Two

Nicole stopped working and stretched, glad to have the sun warming her at her improvised desk at the patio table. She was more than welcome to use the office they'd created upstairs while Julian was out at work, but her sunny spot just felt more relaxed. Her phone buzzed. It was a text from Ciaran. A long one.

Hi Nicole

Re: Discussion about bookkeeping

Would it be possible for you to come into the GLP offices tomorrow lunchtime? I thought I'd have enough time in the afternoon to be able to meet in town for a coffee, but my PA has just reminded me there's a video conference I can't miss.

Would 12.30 work for you?

She replied, saying that'd be fine, but she barely got a thing done for the rest of the afternoon, or before Julian got home later that evening.

He already knew about her appointment with Ciaran. "It's a shame you're visiting on a day when I'm out of the office. I'd have liked to show you around the place."

"That would have been nice, but I think Ciaran chose the day he thought would cause least disruption to my week."

He nodded. "That smells like curry," he said, looking over her shoulder at the pan on the hob.

"It is. Go get changed, and I'll serve it up."

They ate at the dining table and chatted freely about their respective days. Julian had spent his day at the GLP office and seemed particularly pleased that she may be able to do some work for Ciaran's side project.

"Isn't he breaking your company's code of conduct by having an interest in another business?"

“How d’you mean?”

“I mean some companies don’t allow their employees to moonlight. They tend to see it as a conflict of interest.”

“Ah, right.” Julian tore off a chunk of naan bread. “I suppose it might be construed as a problem if his side interest was in the same business sector as GLP, but from what I understand, the venture with his cousin is engineering-based.”

“Is he an engineer?”

“I think his cousin is—or at least *was*—but they employ people to do the actual engineering work. From what I understand, they import individual components and then construct and sell the finished product. Some sort of filtration pump, apparently.”

Nicole chewed while she thought about what Ciaran could want her to do. “Do they sell the pumps in Ireland or in the UK?” She hoped this wouldn’t involve relearning the entire HMRC tome on import tax which had sent her to sleep during her exam period.

“I assume both, because he seems to have concerns about Brexit. His business is in the EU, so a trade deal being agreed or not could have a big impact.” Julian smiled. “I’m sure he’ll explain things when you meet up.”

“Yeah. So, where will you be tomorrow?”

“East Midlands. Leicester and Nottingham.”

“Any more news on the promotion?”

“Not as yet.” He raised his eyebrows and gave a teasing grin. “But I did notice that there are at least two houses on Parkside Grange on the market.”

She laughed and shook her head. “Let’s wait until you hear before we start making plans for spending money we don’t have.”

Julian nodded. “Fair enough.”

They finished eating, then had coffee sitting at the patio table enjoying the last of the evening sunshine.

“Is there a visitor’s carpark at GLP?” Nicole asked.

“There are a couple of areas reserved for visitors’ cars, but there’s always spaces available, even if those two are occupied.” He sipped his coffee, then looked at her. “What will you wear?”

“Wear?”

“Mmm.”

“I thought a tight lycra miniskirt, thigh-length boots and sparkly boob-tube.”

Julian guffawed. “Although Ciaran might have appreciated you wearing that on Saturday night, I think he’d prefer something more formal for the office.”

“Oh? Why d’you say that?”

“He likes the staff to look smart, says it reflects on the company’s image. We have casual dress on Fridays, but when one girl came to work in a pair of patterned running tights, Ciaran said they were a little too casual.” Julian’s moustache twitched as he smirked. “Maybe he only said that because Sharon really doesn’t have the figure to be wearing skin-tight running gear.”

Nicole had intended wearing her jeans because they were comfortable. “I’m not actually GLP staff, so his rule shouldn’t apply to me.”

“True. It’s up to you, I just thought I’d mention it.”

She was silent for a moment, then looked at him. “I didn’t know there was a casual dress day. You wear a suit every day of the week.”

“It’s not compulsory,” he said with a shrug. “Besides, I’m more comfortable in a suit.”

She smiled, rubbing his arm affectionately. “Of course you are, dear.”

After they’d loaded the dishwasher and tidied the kitchen, Julian disappeared into his office for an hour and Nicole decided to have a bath.

Lying in the hot soapy water, she closed her eyes and thought about her upcoming meeting with Ciaran. Worries about the extent of her import tax knowledge aside, she was far more concerned about being alone with him in his office.

She was still angry at herself for the way she’d behaved on Saturday night and should have told him in no uncertain terms that he was out of order for slipping his arms around her waist. For a man to behave like that with the wife of a colleague was outrageous. If another man had done that,

she'd have slapped his face, but she'd been so unnerved by his comment about being able to smell her arousal.

Who says that to a woman?

Then she'd spent the rest of the evening flirting like a tramp. Nicole supposed that Ciaran behaved that way with every woman he met. Being so good-looking, he probably got away with it more often than not. It was infuriating that she'd allowed herself to be so shallow.

Nicole sighed, held her breath and slipped below the surface. After counting to twenty, she sat up and decided to leave washing her hair until her shower tomorrow morning. Instead, and seemingly at odds with her resolve to have nothing to do with Ciaran, she started shaving her legs.

* * * *

Having allowed the usual forty-five minutes that it took Julian to get to work, it took Nicole only twenty-five minutes to drive to the GLP office outside rush hour. Far too early to walk in, she listened to music in her car for fifteen minutes before heading for the glass double doors.

She'd ended up choosing a smart pair of black trousers and black high heels with a white blouse. With her hair pinned up and wearing just a little mascara and lipstick, she was trying to convey a professional appearance.

Reception was a large space with a tiled floor, huge windows, and chrome and leather seats. A pretty blonde sat behind a raised counter. "Hi. Can I help you?"

Nicole realised she didn't actually know Ciaran's last name. "Nicole Steadman. I have a twelve-thirty appointment with—"

"Ah, yes." She put a tick on a list of names she had in front of her. "Please take a seat, and I'll let Ciaran know you're here."

Nicole moved to one of the chrome and leather seats as the receptionist picked up the phone. The tightness in her stomach reminded her of the last interview she'd attended.

A door at the end of the room opened and Ciaran, looking fabulous in a perfectly fitted charcoal grey suit, white shirt and tasteful silk tie, walked over and smiled. "Nicole, thanks so much for coming in."

Nicole stood and smiled, wondering whether to shake hands. Ciaran ran his hand down her upper arm, then looked over towards the receptionist. “Fleur, do I need a visitor’s badge for Nicole?”

“Not if you promise to keep an eye on her,” she said with a flirtatious smile.

Ciaran laughed. “Oh, I promise to do exactly that.” He smiled at Nicole. “Come on, let’s head upstairs.”

His manner and words felt too casual, and too intimate. She reminded herself to make it clear that this was going to be nothing more than a working relationship.

As they walked up the stairs, passing several other members of staff, Ciaran turned to her. “Have you eaten? I can get some sandwiches sent up if —”

“No, I’m fine, thanks.”

When they walked through an outer office, a middle-aged lady sitting at a desk looked up and smiled.

“Any chance of a couple of coffees, Bern?”

The PA smiled and looked at Nicole. “I can also offer tea, if you’d prefer.”

“Tea would be lovely. Thank you.”

Ciaran led her into his office, which was a huge square room with a view over the business park and the moors beyond. “Sorry,” he said as he slipped off his jacket and hung it on a metal stand in the corner. “I don’t drink tea, so it never occurs to me to offer it.” He pointed at a table and chairs beneath the windows. “Please, take a seat.”

Nicole sat at one side, and Ciaran took the seat adjacent so they were sitting at right-angles to each other, knees almost touching. Although it was much less intimidating than him sitting behind his huge desk and her perched on a hardbacked chair, she still felt a little uncomfortable.

“I thought today,” he said, looking into her eyes, “I could just give you a brief overview of our setup and explain what we need regarding the accounts.”

“Okay.” She tried to hold his gaze. His cologne intoxicated her, and what felt like a weak electric current tingled in her lower stomach.

“Has Julian told you about what’s involved?”

“A little. He mentioned buying parts and having a team of engineers who make up some equipment you then sell.”

“Yeah, that’s pretty much it. But we’re thinking of changing it a little. At the moment, we—”

The office door opened, and Ciaran’s PA brought in a tray bearing their drinks and a plate of biscuits.

Ciaran flashed her his gorgeous smile. “Thanks, Bernice. You can take your lunch break now, if you like. I don’t think I’ll need anything else before two.”

Bern nodded, then left.

Ciaran passed Nicole her tea. “Milk and sugar?”

“Just milk, thanks.” She picked up a shortbread finger and smiled. “Luckily, I’m not on the same diet as you.”

He let his gaze drop to her body then looked back into her eyes. “You don’t need to diet.”

She let her own gaze sweep over his chest and flat belly. “Neither do you.” So much for keeping things professional.

He smiled at her flattery. “My dad spent much of his working life travelling around the country visiting customers, and as a consequence he had an awful diet—all fast food and far too much chocolate. He piled on weight and developed type 2 diabetes in his fifties. I believe obesity is genetic. All the fat kids I knew at school had fat parents, and I have a fat parent. I’m trying to give myself the best chance of not becoming like my dad.”

Nicole nodded. “Fair enough. So, you said you were changing your business?”

“Yes. Like you said, we purchase parts—from Ireland when possible, but from elsewhere in Europe when not—and put them all together. We have a team of six engineers doing the work, three of whom are retired and work on a part-time basis. Then we sell the assembled product and also carry out service contracts for the maintenance. But what we’re hoping to do is make a change to leasing the equipment to our customers rather than selling it. Saves them the initial expense of buying and gives us guaranteed regular income. Sporadic peaks and deep troughs are hard to ride in this economy.”

“And you need me for...?”

His eyes bore into hers. She held her breath. That wasn't how she'd meant to phrase her question.

Ciaran gave her one of his knowing smiles. “What I need is for you to help implement the changes to our accounting system. The spreadsheets we use simply have sales and receipts, plus wages and overheads. When we lease the equipment we'll need to take depreciation into account, and we're not sure how that'll work.”

“Will I need to know about the import and export protocol? I'm afraid I have limited experience in that.”

“I can get you up to speed with what you'll need to know, but with the way your Prime Minister's behaving, we haven't a clue what's going to happen.”

She laughed. “*My* Prime Minister?”

“At times like this,” he said, “I wave my Irish passport in the air.”

“I don't blame you. I certainly didn't vote for him. He acts like a spoilt child backed up by his bully friends.”

“So you're not a fan?”

She shook her head. “Julian votes Tory. Always has done, always will do. I didn't mind David Cameron, but I haven't got time for Boris. He's witty and likeable as a TV gameshow host, but I don't think he's up to the job of running a country. What's more, I wouldn't trust him as far as I could throw him.”

Ciaran stared for a second, then leaned in and kissed her. Nicole was too shocked to respond. She didn't kiss him back, but she kept her lips parted and didn't snatch her head away.

After a couple of seconds, he pulled back and looked into her eyes. “I'm sorry, but I've wanted to do that since I first saw you walk out through your patio door.”

She was dumbstruck and angry. Angry with him for his arrogance, angry at herself for allowing it to happen, and even angrier at her body for tingling all over and flooding her crotch with a hot need.

“Ciaran—”

“I know it was wrong. Just as I know my behaviour on Saturday was wrong, but—”

“There are no buts. I’m a married woman. What’s more, I’m married to someone who works for you. This is totally unacceptable. For both of us.”

“I know, and I’m sorry. I shouldn’t have...” He shook his head.

“Is there actually any need for me to be here, other than for stroking your ego?”

“What?”

“The bookkeeping thing you said you—”

“Yes. Yes, of course there is.” He sighed. “I didn’t ask you here just so I could make a pass. I *do* need a bookkeeper, and I’m sorry for letting my personal feelings...” He stood up and walked to his desk to pick up a pile of printed sheets.

“I’ve made some notes for you to take away and have a look at,” he said. “I’ll also send you the spreadsheets we’ve used for the last couple of years’ accounts so you can see how we’ve done it in the past.” He handed the stack to Nicole, then sat down in the seat opposite, finally keeping the table between them.

She glanced at the papers, then back into his face. Although she was still angry, she couldn’t deny that to have a man who looked like Ciaran apparently captivated with her was flattering.

“Tell me about Julian,” he said. “How did you two end up together?”

“Why?” She couldn’t help smiling. Many of her friends had asked the same question.

Her smile seemed to relax him. “I like Julian, and I respect his capacity to manipulate figures and quickly solve problems. His ability to assimilate sales data quickly has been key in the months I’ve been here. I suspect my predecessor benefitted personally from Julian’s knowledge. I think he’d used what Julian had suggested and claimed it as his own idea, and as a result he got offered a better job with a rival company.”

“I didn’t know that.” Nicole was simultaneously proud and irritated.

“I can’t prove it, but nothing else the guy had ever done in his time here suggested he was a forward thinker. After I started here, Julian explained the details to me, and I asked if he was the one who’d thought of it. He just offered that shy smile of his, and I knew.”

“Did you tell him that his boss had pretended it’d been his idea?”

“I didn’t see the point, but that’s partly why I put Julian forward for the manager’s role.” Ciaran sat back. “I know he seems an odd fit for a manager—he’s shy, unassuming, and not the best at interacting with people—but he’s damn good at his job.” He smiled. “I’m hoping he can lead by example rather than inspiring his team with his motivational skills. We have HR for all the touchy-feely crap. I want someone to show them how it should be done, not to tell them how they’d like it done.”

Nicole had never heard anyone speak so well of her husband.
“Thank you.”

He shook his head. “I’m not flattering him to try to look better in your eyes, I’m merely stating how he fits into my plans here at GLP. But my question still stands. How did he manage to win your heart?” He flashed her another gorgeous smile. “I doubt you fell for him because of his ability to manipulate sales data.”

She bit her lip and stared into his eyes for a second, then shrugged. “You told me about your fat father and his diabetes, and how you don’t want to end up like him.”

Ciaran nodded.

“Well, my dad’s the main reason why I chose someone like Julian to spend my life with.” She swallowed, surprised she was actually revealing this to a relative stranger. “When I was a child, I thought my parents were perfect. My mum was pretty and always happy, and all my friends at primary school liked my dad because he made them laugh when they came round to our house. But by the time I reached my teens, that had all changed. Mum had stopped smiling, and my dad had stopped making anyone laugh. He was a selfish bastard who cheated on my mum time and again. He destroyed her with his lies and his false apologies. She became depressed, and her prettiness faded. By the time he eventually left her for good, she wasn’t the same person. Ten years later, she’s still bearing the emotional scars and doesn’t trust men. She lives alone and refuses to let anyone get close.”

Ciaran stared at her, grim-faced and silent.

“I hated my dad for what he’d done, and I haven’t spoken to him in ten years. I know he remarried and quickly separated after he’d cheated on his second wife, but that was ages ago. I haven’t heard anything of him

since. At university, I met a nice guy who I thought I could trust, but when I discovered he'd been seeing another girl at the same time, I dumped him. I didn't intend having a life like my mother's. Then I met Julian."

"While working as a waitress."

She laughed. "Yes. Okay, so he was a bit weird, and my friends thought he was a dork. But he was honest and caring. He was the first man I'd ever known who put my feelings before his own. He made me feel special. He *still* makes me feel special, and I probably don't deserve that." She blinked, remembering the way her body had reacted to Ciaran's advances, then forced a smile. "So that's why I'm with the man whose colleagues refer to him as Basil Fawlty."

"Don't mention the war," Ciaran laughed, reaching out to squeeze her hand. "You know that's an affectionate nickname, right? He's a good man."

She nodded.

"But that doesn't change the way I look at you. The way I feel when I'm with you." He raised his eyebrows. "Or the way you look at me."

"Ciaran!" Nicole gave a sigh. "I think of you in the same way that you think of potatoes. Tasty, but ultimately bad for my health."

He laughed and slapped the table. "That's a good analogy. I like the idea of being a new potato, hot and tempting, covered in butter."

"I was thinking of a greasy chip." She smiled at his hurt expression.

"Well, that's put me in my place." He stood and nodded at the pile of papers on the table. "Take those with you and have a read. If you let me have your email address, I'll send the spreadsheets for you to look at, too."

Nicole ripped the corner off one of the sheets, took a pen from her bag and jotted her details down. "Here you go."

"Thanks." He took the paper from her and walked over to put it on his desk. As Nicole made her way towards the door, Ciaran approached and smiled. "Maybe after you've had a chance to read the notes, we could have another chat?"

She nodded, and they stared into each other's eyes for a split second. Her stomach tightened. Ciaran reached out and gently ran his fingertips down her upper arm. Nicole held her breath, the thrill from his touch

sending a shudder to her core. He stepped close, cupped the back of her head with one hand and pulled her head toward his.

As their lips met, Nicole closed her eyes and kissed him back, tasting the coffee on his breath and sucking his tongue when he pushed it into her mouth.

He ran his other hand up her stomach and squeezed her breast, and a groan escaped from her throat. His hand slid downwards, passing over her stomach to her crotch. Her resistance now non-existent, she stood with her feet apart to give him easier access as she ran her hands over the back of his shirt. The muscles in his back flexed under her touch.

Ciaran pushed her against the wall, keeping his mouth clamped to hers, and dragged his finger back and forth over the gusset seam of her trousers. She pushed his head back and looked into his eyes. They were both breathless.

“Ciaran, please... I can’t.”

With deft efficiency, he unsnapped the fastener of her trousers and slid the zip down.

“Ciaran...”

His warm, smooth hand slipped down her tummy and inside her panties. He cupped her mons, then smiled at her. “You’re dripping wet.”

All she could do to respond was let out a stuttering breath.

Ciaran slipped two fingers inside her. She let out a whimper, her nails digging into his bicep. She stared wide-eyed into his face as he finger-fucked her against the wall of his office—an office her husband probably visited often.

Ciaran’s thumb grazed over her clit as his fingers curled up to press against the front wall of her cheating, saturated cunt, and Nicole bit into his shoulder to stifle the scream of her orgasm. The spasms shook her entire body while his thumb continued to circle the nucleus of her pleasure.

She gasped through clenched teeth, fighting to regain control of her body so she could try and salvage some of her dignity. But the slut in her wouldn’t relent, and she squeezed his arm tighter, knowing she could come again.

Ciaran got the message. He removed his thumb from her clit and added a third finger to her cunt. Then, bending his back slightly, he pumped

his arm, slamming her against the wall and almost lifting her off her feet.

Nicole dug her nails deeper into his arm and pulled his hair with her other hand as the second climax racked her body. She groaned and sobbed and clenched around his fingers, grinding herself against his hand like a bitch in heat. She knew, even as her juices were drenching his fingers, that she'd hate herself later. But it didn't stop her from kissing him, pushing her tongue into his mouth and nipping at his lips.

Ciaran eventually stilled his arm and slipped his hand out of her pants. They stood staring at each other, with him looking almost as shocked as she felt.

"I..." He shook his head. "Nicole, I didn't..."

She tucked her blouse in and fastened her trousers.

"I'm sorry if I forced myself—"

"You didn't force yourself on me." The guilt was already creeping over the pleasure like a dark shadow, covering the thrill with a bitter aftertaste of self-loathing. "I let you do it, and I rode your fingers like a slut." She blinked to clear her eyes. "I'm no better than my..."

Ciaran's brow creased, and he shook his head. "You're nothing like your father. You have your husband's blessing."

"What?" She wasn't sure she'd heard him correctly.

"Julian. He knows. He encouraged me."

"Don't be absurd." Nicole shook her head, wondering if he was trying to justify all this. "What makes you think—?"

"He told me you'd enjoy the excitement. Said he'd seen the way the two of us hit it off at your house on Saturday night."

Nicole opened her mouth to say something but was completely lost for words.

"He said you'd had a fling with a guy you worked with last year, that it'd been just a physical thing."

She went cold. *How could he know about Sam?* "He what?"

Ciaran looked puzzled. "Julian explained your relationship was strong enough to withstand your trysts with other men. He even told me on Monday that you'd admitted you were attracted to me."

Her only admission of attraction had been the fact she'd fucked her husband with abandon as soon as Ciaran had left. "I didn't tell him that."

He gave a rueful smile. "Maybe he's more perceptive than either of us give him credit for."

Nicole's mind was still playing catchup. "Ciaran, did Julian tell you that he thought you and I would become lovers?"

"I don't think 'lovers' would be the right word." For the first time since she'd met him, Ciaran looked less sure of himself. "He told me that he wouldn't be surprised, or offended, if you decided to enjoy yourself with me."

"Enjoy myself?" This conversation was becoming surreal. Between the come-down from her adrenalin rush, and a brain flooded with oxytocin and dopamine, she could barely think straight.

"I think, in layman's terms, he meant he wouldn't mind if you chose to fuck me. Julian knows you love him, and he's made it perfectly clear that he loves you. He's not worried that you'd ever leave him for somebody else, and he's happy for you to have a little fun every now and then."

"Julian would never say that. He isn't..." She shook her head. "That's not who he is."

Ciaran looked puzzled. "It's not something I'd make up. I assumed this was something you'd discussed at length."

Nicole shook her head, but nothing would clear her thoughts. "I'm sorry, I have to go."

"Right." He nodded. "Of course. Please, read the notes and check your email for the spreadsheets. And talk to your husband. I get the impression that he's perhaps opened up to me about your arrangement a bit prematurely."

Nicole bit her lip. She wasn't about to admit that there *was* no arrangement, and that what she'd done the previous year had actually been a selfish act of infidelity. Numb, she nodded and opened the door.

Bernice was behind her desk in the outer office, eating a sandwich and reading a magazine. Nicole wondered if the older woman had heard her groans and the banging of her backside against the wall while her boss had finger-fucked her to oblivion. If she had, there was no judgement in the friendly smile the PA gave her as Ciaran led Nicole past her desk and back

to reception. Nicole walked on unsteady legs to her car and had to sit for several minutes to calm her nerves before driving home.

She and her husband had a lot to discuss, and it was a conversation that she wasn't looking forward to.



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Chapter Three

As soon as Nicole arrived home, she stripped off her smart clothes and threw her drenched panties into the laundry basket. After taking a shower, she dressed in leggings and a baggy sweatshirt, then headed downstairs.

Even though she hadn't had lunch, she wasn't hungry. Her stomach was still in knots after what had happened in Ciaran's office.

With just a couple of sentences, he'd managed to blindside her. He'd also left her wondering if she actually knew her own husband at all. Why would Julian encourage another man to make a pass at her? How could he possibly benefit from that?

Nicole grabbed a wine glass and a bottle of red, then took a seat at the wrought iron patio table. She poured herself a large glass of merlot; she'd need Dutch courage to talk to Julian about what had happened last year, let alone what had happened with Ciaran. The birds sang and Nicole drank her wine. She topped up her glass and drank some more. After a while, she closed her eyes and tipped her head back, letting the sun warm her face. Meanwhile, her stomach remained tight and cold.

* * * *

"Enjoying the sunshine?"

Julian's voice made her jump. She looked around, disoriented, then checked her watch. It was only half three. She glanced at the half-full glass on the table, then peered up at Julian. "I'm sorry, I wasn't expecting—"

"My last scheduled visit was cancelled." He slipped off his jacket, hung it on the back of another patio chair, and sat down next to her. "There's been a case of Covid amongst their staff, so everyone's back to working from home while self-isolating. I decided it wasn't worth driving back to the office, so came home instead."

“That’s nice.” To her horror, she realised her speech was slightly slurred.

His eyes twinkling, Julian reached over to pick up the wine bottle. “I’m guessing this was full when you first came out here.”

She was shocked to see it empty. “I didn’t realise I’d had so much.”

“Was it your meeting with Ciaran that drove you to drink?”

“I... He said...” She frowned and shook her head. “Ciaran told me things—things I didn’t know.”

He watched her from beneath his dark brows, but didn’t interrupt.

“What’s more, he said you’d told him things I wasn’t aware you knew.”

“Ah.”

“Julian, I’m sorry.”

He shook his head. “Don’t be.”

“How can you say that? I was selfish, and I cheated. You didn’t deserve that. You’ve always been so—”

“It doesn’t matter.”

“Of course it matters! I stood next to you in church and swore to forsake all others. I gave you my word, and yet I still—”

“I knew it was just a physical attraction.”

Nicole blinked to clear her eyes. She didn’t know if the tears that spilled over and ran down her cheeks were due to her shame or self-pity.

Julian wiped them away with his thumbs, his hands gently cradling her head. “If I’d thought you’d done it because you didn’t love me, then I’d —”

“I shouldn’t have done it at all. I hated myself afterwards and ended it because I couldn’t stand the thought of hurting you. Or lying to you.” She sighed and looked up to the sky. “I couldn’t stand the thought of us having a life like that of my parents.”

“That’s not going to happen. We’re different people.”

“I’m not so sure I’m any different from my—”

“You’re *nothing* like him.” Julian lowered his hands to her shoulders and squeezed. “He didn’t care about anything but himself, and that’s not you.”

“Really? You could have fooled me. Who else was I thinking about when I allowed myself to do what I did?” A memory of having sex in Sam’s car flashed through her mind. It’d been uncomfortable and sordid, her skirt bunched around her waist, her panties pulled to one side and her legs wrapped around his as she’d writhed and moaned through their lunchtime sessions.

Julian’s hands were warm on her shoulders. His comforting patience made her feel so much worse. “How did you find out?” she asked. “And why didn’t you say anything?”

He held her gaze for a second, then sat back and picked up her wine glass. After taking a sip, he stared down into the rich depths. “I suppose I first got suspicious when you started to wear your favourite perfume for work. You used to only wear it when we went out. And then one time, I happened to notice the smell of...” He looked up, embarrassed. “After one of your nights out, you came to bed and I could smell condoms, or at least I could smell whatever it is they coat them with.”

Nicole stared open-mouthed. She’d always insisted Sam wear a condom because she’d been terrified of catching an STD. She remembered that night, when she’d got home late and thought it too risky to have a shower before getting into bed. She’d assumed Julian was asleep and had gotten up to shower before he woke next morning.

Julian bit his lip. “It got to a point where I had to know. On days I was based in the office, I’d spend lunchtimes waiting outside your factory to see if you left with anyone. One day I saw you walk out with a bearded man and get into his blue Audi. I followed you to a country park and waited in a layby farther down the road. His car came back out forty minutes later, and I followed you back to work. He dropped you off around the corner, presumably so you could walk in separately. Your hair was mussed and your skirt creased, and I knew why.”

Tears were now flowing freely. Nicole hated herself. “I’m sorry.”

“I didn’t mind.” His jaw seemed to be clenched, and he was shaking slightly. “I’d just seen my beautiful wife get out of another man’s car. I *knew* she’d had sex with him, and yet I didn’t mind.”

Cold seeped through her. He was hurt and angry, yet he was blaming himself for his own reaction to her infidelity. “Julian, I—”

“I was *glad* you were having a little fun. Happy that another man was giving you excitement.” Finally, he looked into her eyes. “The idea of you receiving pleasure was...” He swallowed, then cast his eyes down at the glass again. “A nice one.”

“Why on earth would you like the idea of me being with another man?”

Julian licked his lips and swallowed again. “I’d never had a girlfriend who looked like you. You were so far out of my league, and—”

“That’s not true.”

“Yes it is. I’m sure you’d never had a boyfriend like me before, either. I couldn’t believe you accepted my invitation to dinner.” He gave another embarrassed smile. “Even on that first date, I could feel other men in the restaurant looking at us, wondering why someone like you was having dinner with me.”

“Oh Julian, that’s simply—”

“I also saw the expressions on your friends’ faces when you first introduced me. I know they thought me a bit...” He shrugged. “Well, you know how I am.”

“You’re kind, and you’re considerate, and you’re honest.” Nicole sniffed and wiped her face with the sleeve of her sweatshirt. “You’re also a lot better than I deserve.”

Julian shook his head. “When you told them later we’d got engaged, they all thought you’d gone mad.”

“I didn’t care what they thought. But what I don’t understand,” she said, looking deep into his dark brown eyes, “is why you’d be happy about me seeing another man.”

He looked around the garden as if searching for the answer in the flowerbeds.

She took a steadying breath. “Ciaran seemed to think that you wanted there to be more than a professional arrangement between him and me.”

Julian bit his lower lip, still staring at the far end of the garden. “I knew immediately on Saturday night that the two of you were attracted to each other.”

Nicole started to deny it, and he laughed.

“Oh, come on—I saw the way you two looked at each other. And all the flirting over dinner, it got me thinking that...” He took a deep breath, then finished the remainder of the wine in the glass. “If you’d have introduced Ciaran to your friends instead of me, they’d have all been jealous as hell, rather than wondering if you’d lost your mind.”

“Julian, I don’t care what my friends think. They don’t know you like I do, and with Ciaran I wasn’t—”

He leaned forward and stared deeply into her eyes. “Please don’t deny it. I may struggle to articulate things, but I’m not so naïve that I can’t see what’s going on right in front of me.”

She remembered all the innuendo during the dinner. Holding Julian’s gaze, she nodded. “Okay. I admit I flirted, and it was selfish of—”

“I’m not complaining. I rather enjoyed it.” He gave a sudden cheeky grin. “What’s more, I benefitted from your arousal later that night.”

Her stomach twisted in turmoil. “You still haven’t explained why you liked the idea of me being with another man.”

“Like,” he corrected. “I still feel the same way. It makes me... proud, I suppose. Proud that other men covet my wife.”

“I don’t under—”

“When I was a child, I wasn’t very popular with the other children on our street. I wasn’t good at sport, and I wasn’t good at making them laugh. But I had some Star Wars toys, and they’d come and visit my house and we’d play together.”

“Please don’t liken me to your Millennium Falcon.”

“No, I wouldn’t. Not the Falcon.” His moustache twitched with the hint of a smile. “One of the Stormtrooper models, maybe.”

She slapped his arm playfully. He rarely showed his sense of humour and she appreciated him trying to lighten the mood.

Julian shrugged and gave a nostalgic smile. “Anyway, for a few hours on rainy Saturday afternoons when the weather stopped the other boys playing football in the park, I had friends playing with my Star Wars figures. I got a thrill from knowing they liked my toys, and later—after they’d gone home—the toys were still mine, and I could play with them whenever I wanted.”

“I’m not sure I like that analogy. I’m not simply a possession for you to—”

“No, of course you’re not,” he said, shaking his head. “And that’s not what I meant to convey. I was just giving it as an example. But the way I’d felt as a child sprung to mind when I saw you get out of the man’s car after you’d...”

“I’m so sorry.”

Julian sighed. “Why don’t I get changed and bring out another bottle?”

Nicole nodded, watching him take his jacket from the back of the chair. She sat in the silence of her garden, too confused to arrange her thoughts into any sort of order.

Julian returned wearing a cable-knit sweater and carrying a bottle of wine and second glass. He filled his own and replenished hers.

“The man at work,” she began, not daring to look into her husband’s eyes, “was called Sam. He was nice to me, and made me feel...” She shook her head. “I never meant it to go as far as it did. I was flattered when he paid me attention, and for a while it was just harmless teasing and fun.”

Julian watched her over the rim of his glass.

“And then one day it went a little beyond that—”

“How?” His expression suggested curiosity, not anger.

“We’d joked and teased each other for weeks. It was just light-hearted banter, and then one day we were walking to the carpark after work, and as I turned to say something, his face was close to mine and...he kissed me.” She let out a pent-up breath. “And I kissed him back.”

“And did the two of you drive somewhere private for more than kisses?”

“No. I got into my car and drove home. I was shocked that I’d kissed him, and I hated myself for doing it.”

Julian kept his face neutral, and she had no idea what was going on behind his eyes.

She took a gulp of wine, knowing she’d never be able to justify her actions. “And from that moment on, all the light-hearted banter and teasing between us had an undercurrent to it.”

“What sort of undercurrent?”

“A kind of sexual tension.”

“Did it feel good, this sexual tension?”

Nicole frowned. “Yes, but it was double-edged. Thrill and excitement versus guilt and self-loathing.”

“But it was the thrill and excitement that won the battle, obviously.” There was no malice in his voice.

“In the short-term, yes. But longer-term, guilt and self-loathing got the upper hand because I stopped seeing him.”

“And how did he take that?”

“He understood. It wasn’t a love affair, it was just a physical thing.”

“Physical?”

Nicole’s stomach knotted tighter. “Sexual.”

Julian nodded and sipped his wine. “How did things progress from the kiss to something sexual?”

“What?” It was hard enough admitting she’d been unfaithful—surely he didn’t want the sordid details?

“I’m not asking you to describe every single thing, but I’m curious about some aspects, like how it went from a kiss on the factory grounds to intercourse in another carpark.”

She closed her eyes and tried to remember. “There was another kiss the following week—in a deserted room at work—and then he asked me out to lunch. We decided that rather than go to a pub, where we might be seen, we’d go to a quiet place and have a sandwich. And we went to the country park.”

“And you had sex?”

“No, not then.” She took a steadying glug of wine. “We talked. I told him that I loved you and didn’t want to risk my marriage, but admitted that I couldn’t stop thinking about him.”

“Is Sam married?”

“He is now, but he wasn’t then.” She shrugged, embarrassed. “He married the girl he was living with while he was seeing me.”

“So that was why you needed to use his car. Neither of you had a house you could use.”

Nicole nodded, too ashamed to admit that while Julian had been on a three-day sales conference in Guildford, she'd invited Sam to her home and fucked him in the marital bed.

"And how was the sex?"

"Julian, do we have to do this?"

"Yes. I think you owe me that much." His expression wasn't one of anger, but she could see he was determined.

She sighed, knowing full well that she could hardly complain. "The sex was exciting, though that could have been down to the situation. Someone new." She shook her head slightly. "I'm sorry."

"Did you always come?"

"Oh, for God's sake!"

"I think—"

"Yes, I came." She dropped her head back and took a deep breath. "I can't confirm it was every time, but it could have been."

"What about oral sex?"

"Christ, you cannot be serious."

His expression suggested he wanted an answer.

"Yes, a few times. Maybe three or four, I honestly can't remember the exact number."

"Did you take him all the way?"

She shook her head, amazed that he felt it important to know if the other man had come in her mouth. "No, it was just foreplay. I sucked him for a short time, then fitted the condom so he could go inside me."

Julian considered this. She wondered if he was going to ask if Sam had performed oral sex on her.

"Why did he wear a condom if you're on the pill?"

His question surprised her. "I couldn't risk passing an STD on to you."

"Ah..." He nodded his understanding. "So how long did it go on for?"

"Just a few weeks. The ill feeling I got from deceiving you began to outweigh the excitement I got from..."

"The fucking?"

She blinked, surprised at his use of the f-word. Julian rarely used expletives, and never when referring to sex. “I was going to say *the trysts*, but I guess your description is more accurate. That’s all it was. Fucking.”

He took another gulp of his wine and topped up his own glass. Nicole’s was still full, but he was almost a bottle behind her. “So, how many times in all did the two of you... get together?”

“I honestly don’t know.” She tried to work it out. It’d been at least a couple of times a week for seven weeks. “Probably fifteen, something like that.”

“Have there been others?”

“No.” She shook her head vigorously. “None, I promise.”

He nodded and smiled. “I believe you.”

“I’m sorry. I wish I could take it all back.” That wasn’t completely true—she had some wonderful memories of her time with Sam.

“I don’t think you should regret it. As I said, the thought of another man giving you pleasure was nice. I found it...arousing.”

“The idea of me being with another man turned you on?” She knew men like this existed, but had no idea that Julian was one of them.

He nodded. “I was angry at myself for feeling that way, believe me.”

“But if feeling that way made you angry, why would you try and instigate...?” She couldn’t make herself use the same layman’s terms that Ciaran had, earlier. “I mean, with Ciaran.”

Another smile raised the edges of Julian’s moustache. “Because watching the two of you flirting was also arousing, but then”—he looked directly into her eyes—“In bed, after he’d left, you behaved in a way that was...”

She squeezed her eyes shut, mortified. She should have known he’d pick up on that. Only a fool would fail to see how she’d acted, how wet she’d been, how quickly she’d climaxed.

“I got the impression you were using me to satiate the desire that Ciaran had generated.”

She started to shake her head but decided against it. She gave a weak smile as she conceded the point. “I can see I’ve underestimated your insight.”

He took another drink. “Did flirting with Ciaran feel the same as with Sam?”

Nicole picked up her own glass and took a sip, watching his face while deciding how to answer. After putting the glass down, she nodded. “Yes, a little.”

“And what about in his office today? Did you feel the same excitement then?”

Nicole’s jaw dropped. Did he know what happened?

He saw her expression and chuckled. “I’ll take that as a yes.”

She wondered if Ciaran had already phoned him to reveal how easily his slutty wife had been seduced. Rather than offering her confession, she decided to turn the tables. “Did you want me to feel the same excitement today?”

He averted his eyes. “Yes.”

At least he was being honest. “And have you spoken to Ciaran since?”

“No. I thought I’d mentioned that I didn’t bother going into the office.”

“Oh yes. Sorry, I’d forgotten that.”

“So, today?”

“Today, I felt even more excitement than I did on Saturday.” She held his gaze, trying to see if her words were pushing his buttons. “Because we were alone in his office.”

He swallowed, licked his lips and then took a sip of his drink.

“Is that what you wanted to hear?” Nicole realised the wine had loosened her tongue.

Julian clenched his jaw and nodded once.

“Are you hoping that I’ll use you again, to satiate the desire that Ciaran generated?”

He shrugged. “I thought that as the two of you were alone in his office, maybe he’d already satiated those desires himself.”

“Is that what you expected?”

“I...” He shook his head, probably too embarrassed to admit he’d been hoping his wife had let another man have sex with her.

She slid her hand across the table and gripped his. “Tell me what you wanted to happen.”

“I thought that... I imagined you two would—”

“Did you want him to fuck me?”

Julian closed his eyes and frowned. It seemed like it was his turn to gather courage. “Yes,” he said eventually. “I guess I was hoping the two of you might—”

“What if we had? How would you feel about it if I’d had sex with him?”

“I suppose I’d find it...”

Nicole stood up and walked towards the house, stopping when she reached the patio door. “Follow me,” she instructed. She was halfway up the stairs by the time he came into the house.

Once in the bedroom, she kicked off her shoes and peeled down her leggings and panties at the same time. Julian came through the door and stopped as soon as he saw her naked from the waist down.

“Lie on the bed,” she told him.

Julian complied.

She crawled onto the bed and started to undo his trousers. “Was it arousing for you, imagining me in Ciaran’s office earlier?”

His embarrassed frown gave her the answer. She tugged hard at his trousers, getting them down to mid-thigh, then released his cock from his boxers. He was already hard, and precum covered his entire cockhead.

Nicole looked into his face. She could hardly be shocked that their discussion had aroused him, because her own panties had been sodden when she’d taken them off.

Gripping his cock and still wearing her sweatshirt, Nicole crawled up the bed until she straddled him. “Sorry to disappoint, but this will be the first cock I’ve had today.” With that, she impaled herself.

Both groaned and she rocked her hips, his cock filling her.

She looked into his eyes while riding him. “But today’s meeting wasn’t completely innocent.”

He stared up at her, pushing his hips up in time with her own movements.

“Do you want to know what happened?”

“Yes. Please.” Julian raised his hands to grip her hips.

“We were sitting at the table in his office, and he leaned in and kissed me. I told him off, and he apologised. But then, as I was about to leave, he did it again.”

His eyes opened wider and his nostrils flared.

“This time, I kissed him back. It was a passionate kiss, with tongues.”

Julian opened his mouth, his breath coming in short gasps.

“Ciaran’s hands started to explore my body. He cupped a breast...” She leaned down until they were eye to eye. “Is that arousing, knowing I let him grope my tits while I sucked the saliva off his tongue?”

Julian let out a groan. His eyes fluttered as if struggling to keep his focus on her face.

“And then he ran his hand down my body to my crotch, stroking me through my trousers.”

“How did it feel when he touched you there?” he whispered.

“Dirty. Delicious. I didn’t stop him, and when he undid the button and slipped his hand down inside my panties, I encouraged him by putting my feet a step apart.”

Julian let out a grunt and arched his back, lifting her off the bed. Nicole groaned and bounced on his cock as it pulsed inside her.

Gripping the pillow on either side of his head, she bucked her hips and ground her clit against his body. “I came on his fingers, just like I’m going to come on your...”

She squeezed her eyes shut and her mouth opened in a silent scream as she came. The release of tension was intense, and she bucked like a woman possessed. Her movements were so vigorous that Julian’s flaccid cock slipped out, leaving a void inside her. Opening her eyes, she saw his shocked expression and immediately regretted her confession.

Nicole took a deep breath, then rolled off him and lay on her own side of the bed.

After a few moments’ silence, he turned onto his side and stroked the hair out of her face. “I’m glad you let him touch you.”

“Why?”

“It’s—”

“Arousing?”

He flashed his embarrassed smile. “Does it make me weird?”

Like he’d done for her earlier, she tried to lighten the mood. “You were weird before, so this just makes you weirder.”

He gave a muted chortle, which was another of his cute mannerisms.

“I felt bad immediately afterwards,” she said. “It was then, when I was regretting what’d happened, that Ciaran told me you knew about Sam, and that it’d been your encouragement that had made him...” Now that her passion had been quenched, she struggled to name what she’d allowed to happen in the office.

“Didn’t you feel the urge to touch Ciaran?”

His question took her by surprise. “That never crossed...” She hadn’t actually thought about it—then or since—but now, she wondered if Ciaran had expected her to reach for his cock. She shook her head. “No, I didn’t.”

“Oh.”

“Are you disappointed that I didn’t?”

“I should ask you the same question,” he said, grinning.

She laughed. This was a whole new world, and she wasn’t sure how to deal with it. “God, what’s happening to us?”

“Nothing need happen to us—if you don’t want it to. But if you do...” He moved his hand to stroke her shoulder through the sweatshirt. “If you wanted to have a little more excitement, then I wouldn’t object.”

She didn’t reply, but raised her eyebrows.

“Perhaps ‘not objecting’ was understating things a little. I suppose it would be more accurate to say if you took things further with Ciaran, then both of us would be experiencing the excitement.”

Going further with Ciaran was an enticing proposition. She’d ended her only previous indiscretions because she hadn’t been able to live with the guilt. Now she was actually being given carte blanche to do as she wished with another man, agreeing to take that leap with Ciaran should’ve been easy. But for some reason, that wasn’t the case.

“How would it work out between us?” she asked, sitting up in bed. “If I were to... Y’know...”

Julian pulled his trousers back up and sat alongside her. “I think you know the answer already. What happened with Sam didn’t stop me loving you, and it didn’t make me feel like you’d stopped loving me.”

“I stopped liking myself.”

He gave her his sweet smile and reached out for her hand. “When I first discovered you were seeing him, I analysed your behaviour. Everything you said, and how you acted. You didn’t give me the impression you wanted to be somewhere else. Never once were you short with me, rude, or cruel. I decided you weren’t seeing him because you’d fallen out of love with me. You were just doing it because of the physical attraction between the two of you.”

“You didn’t think me selfish?”

He shook his head and smiled.

“Well, that’s how I saw myself.” She sighed. “But Ciaran would be different. You have to see him every time you go into the office.”

He shrugged. “And?”

“Wouldn’t it be awkward?”

Julian stared at her for a second, which made her think he hadn’t actually considered this. “No, I don’t think so.”

She didn’t share his view. “I don’t like the idea of the two of you comparing notes.”

He guffawed and looked incredulous. “I certainly wouldn’t be discussing what went on with him, because that *would* be awkward.”

“You wouldn’t?”

“Of course not. What goes on between the two of you is exactly that—between the two of you. If, however, you wanted to tell me certain things, like you did just a few minutes ago, then that’s between the two of us.” He grinned. “I got the impression you’d enjoyed telling me about it, and I’m sure you saw from my reaction how much I enjoyed your... disclosure.”

“You’d want the details?”

He shrugged. “Only if you wanted to tell me.”

Nicole considered this. “And if I didn’t want to tell you?”

“Then you’d keep them to yourself.”

She frowned, wondering how Julian could possibly benefit from the arrangement he was offering her if she chose to keep things to herself. Her stomach rumbled and she realised she hadn’t eaten since breakfast. “I’m going to make myself something to eat. Are you hungry?”

“Starved.”

They headed downstairs to the kitchen.



Ψ



Chapter Four

Neither Nicole nor Julian brought up any proposed future liaisons between her and Ciaran until Sunday evening. Pretending to surf the web on her phone, she watched Julian out of the corner of her eye as he calmly flipped pages in his novel. He'd be seeing his boss tomorrow for the first time since her session with him in the office, but he was acting like it would just be another day at work. Abandoning the thrall of social media, she twisted to face him.

"So, how do you feel about seeing Ciaran tomorrow?" she asked.

He looked up from the pages and smiled. "I feel no different than I do about seeing him any other time."

"Really? Not even a tiny bit apprehensive, or curious as to what he thought about Friday?"

Julian smirked. "I'm sure I can guess what he thought about Friday, and I expect he'll be eager for another meeting with you."

Her mind tumbled in somersaults as she waited to see if he would say more. She knew he meant Ciaran would be eager to get more than his fingers inside her. Eager to have a release of his own.

“Did you arrange a second meeting?” he asked.

“No, not yet. He said he’d email some spreadsheets for me to look at, so I’ll check tomorrow to see if he’s sent them.”

Julian nodded, then went back to his novel. She surfed her phone for a few minutes but found that she’d made herself impatient to find out whether Ciaran had been in touch.

He had.

Her inbox contained three messages from him, two from Friday afternoon, and one time-stamped Sunday morning. The first two were unexciting, containing spreadsheet attachments and a covering explanation of some of the figures. The third simply read:

*I need to see you again. Are you available this
Thursday?*

Nicole smiled as she typed out a reply: *I can make myself available.*

As Julian put his book to one side, she did the same with her phone, plugging in the charger, then lay down. She lay awake in the dark for a long time, thinking about giving herself to his boss.

* * * *

On Wednesday, a text arrived from Ciaran, telling her to check her email. Nicole was working on her laptop in the dining room and clicked through to her inbox, opening his note.

Hi Nicole

*Fridays are traditionally casual dress for the
office, but for the rest of the week we insist on
formal attire.*

*So, although I loved the way your trousers hugged
your perfect backside at our last meeting, I think
it would be more appropriate for you to wear a
skirt on Thursday. You should also wear nylons
(but I’ll be disappointed if they’re tights).*

Can you make 12.30 again?

Ciaran

At first she thought it might be a joke, but then she remembered Julian mentioning that Ciaran had reprimanded one of the female staff members for wearing bright leggings. She couldn't decide whether to be amused or offended. If another man had told her how to dress for a meeting—specifically asking her to wear stockings—she would have given him a two-word answer, the second of those words being 'off'.

But Ciaran was different.

Not because he was handsome, sexy, and charming—even though he was. Ciaran was different because, thanks to her husband's encouragement, she'd already decided to have sex with him. And if her wearing stockings in the office would get him hot and horny, who was she to complain? She closed the email and tried to get back to work but struggled to concentrate for the rest of the day.

Julian arrived home at the normal time, and after dinner they took coffee out on the patio.

She crossed her legs and ran her hanging foot against his leg. "Have you remembered I'm having another meeting with Ciaran tomorrow?"

"Of course."

"Are you working in the office tomorrow?"

"Ordinarily I would be, but Ciaran's asked me to accompany a junior colleague to visit a customer."

She frowned. "Is he allowed to send you away like that?"

"He's the boss, so yes. But there's actually some justification—the customer was asking questions that my colleague hasn't really got the background knowledge to answer fully."

"Oh, okay."

"Are you looking forward to your meeting?"

She smiled and raised her eyebrows. "How do you mean?" A buzz of excitement tingled in her stomach, though she wasn't sure if that was due to her meeting with Ciaran tomorrow or the conversation she was about to have with Julian.

“I mean exactly what I asked. Are you looking forward to tomorrow?”

“I’m...” She laughed at her own reluctance to admit it. She nodded. “Yes, I’m looking forward to it.”

“Good.”

“What about you?”

“Well, I don’t really know this customer, so I—”

“Julian! You know perfectly well what I mean.”

He grinned in a way that showed he wasn’t sorry at all. “I’m experiencing some pleasant anticipation regarding your meeting.”

“You’re experiencing ‘some pleasant anticipation’?”

He laughed. “I suppose that sounds a little—”

“It sounds ridiculous. You’re not at a marketing seminar, discussing potential sales figures with shareholders. You’re at home and talking to your wife about her having sex with another man.”

“Yes, I just...” He shrugged. “You know what I’m like.”

“I know what you’re like.” She leaned closer and lowered her voice to an intimate whisper. “But it’s only recently that I’ve learned what *else* you like. So, I’ll ask again. Are you looking forward to my meeting with Ciaran tomorrow?”

Julian looked her directly in the eye. “Yes. The thought of what might happen is...”

“Arousing?”

He laughed. “Should I have used stronger language?”

“Though I’m glad you don’t walk around effing and jeffing all the time, I liked the way you talked the other day, when I was telling you about Sam.”

“Ah. Right.”

“So, when the two of us are talking about sex—or more specifically, talking about me having sex with another man—can we just use plain English?”

“Plain, as in four-letter English?”

“Mmm. I think if we’re going to be doing something dirty—and let’s face it, you encouraging me to sleep with another man is very dirty—

then we should use appropriate words to describe it.”

“Wouldn’t that make you feel...well, dirty?”

“I hope so. So, your feelings about tomorrow?”

“I’ve been thinking about it since you told me. I’m... I’ve spent all week in a state of...” Julian sighed. “It turns me on, thinking about it.”

“Me too.”

“Are you expecting that the two of you...? That you’ll...?”

“Say it.”

He frowned. “Do you think you’ll have sex?”

“I’d rather you’d said ‘fuck’.”

He sniggered. “Will you let him fuck you?”

“Possibly. Or maybe I’ll fuck him.”

His eyes widened slightly.

“Ciaran sent me an email earlier to point out that as this meeting isn’t on casual-dress day, I should dress more formally than last time.”

“What did you wear last time?”

“A smart blouse and dress trousers. I looked formal and professional.”

Julian looked puzzled. “So what was wrong with that? Many women in our office wear smart trousers all week.”

“Hmm. Well, tomorrow I’ve been asked to wear a skirt. With stockings.”

“Really?”

She nodded.

“And are you going to?”

“Yes. If it’s something that turns him on, I don’t mind.” She smiled. “Do you mind?”

“No, not at all. It’s a sexy image.” He frowned. “Do you even have any stockings?”

“I’ve got a couple of pairs of hold-ups. I also have a suspender belt, but I’ll have to nip to the shop tomorrow to buy regular black stockings if I choose to wear that.”

Julian was silent, but she could see there was a lot going on behind his eyes. She was turned on by simply watching him consider the implications of Ciaran's request. "What are you thinking?"

"Stockings give him easier access to your body than tights would."

She nodded. "True, though last time I was wearing trousers and he still got his hand up my cunt."

Julian's eyes and mouth snapped wide open, and he glanced around the garden as if worried the neighbours might have overheard.

She slapped his arm. "Stop being such a prude."

"I... I've never heard you say anything like that."

"Yeah, well, get used to it. When we're talking about this, there's no censorship."

"Right. Yes..." He glanced at her, then averted his eyes again. "I like the image of you being fucked in stockings and suspenders."

"You do?" She blinked. "How come you've never mentioned it before?"

He shrugged. "Because it's you that's important, not what you wear. Though actually, we have done it while you were wearing stockings. In Paris, remember?"

"Yes, I remember." They'd been out for dinner and held hands walking beside the Seine. She'd worn a purple sequined dress and black hold-ups, and once back in their hotel room she'd removed her dress and panties, but left on her bra, stockings and shoes.

Julian shivered again, and he looked up at the sky. The sun had dropped behind the neighbouring houses. "Shall we continue this conversation inside?"

She nodded, then carried their cups through to the kitchen. Julian closed the patio door and waited in the hall, looking embarrassed.

Nicole stopped when she saw his expression. "What's wrong?"

"Nothing, I just..." He frowned. "I just remembered I need to look up a few things before I see the customer tomorrow."

"Oh." She'd worried that he might be having second thoughts about what she could do with Ciaran. "That's fine. I'll have a bath."

After a good soak, Nicole put on her robe and wandered into the upstairs office.

Julian looked up and smiled at her. "I've almost finished."

She slipped between him and the desk, then stared into his eyes. "I think you should take a break." Before he had time to look puzzled, she undid the belt of her robe and pulled it open, revealing her nakedness.

"Ah. I, er..."

She sat on his desk, rested her hands on the desktop behind her, and leaned back. "Don't talk. If you *have* to wag your tongue, I can think of a better way for you to do it." She slowly opened her legs.

After holding her gaze for a moment, he dropped his face to her crotch and licked along the length of her sex. She let out a sigh. He was slow and gentle, teasing her outer folds with his tongue and lips before pushing deeper. She moaned every time he dipped into her channel. As her juices started to flow, he moved his attentions up to her clit.

Another groan escaped her lips, and she brought one hand forward to stroke his head. "Oh, that's nice."

"Mmm."

"If you want to finish me off with your cock, I wouldn't mind."

He looked up into her eyes but kept his mouth on her sex. After a little shake of his head, he placed his lips over her clit and sucked gently, making her writhe.

Nicole watched his face as he took her to the edge, then she could no longer do anything but squeeze her eyes shut and sob through her climax. He moved his mouth away from her sensitive clit and lavished soft kisses all over her inner thighs.

As her heart crashed in her chest, she opened her eyes and smiled at him. "Thank you, that was lovely."

He flashed her his shy smile.

"Do you want to go inside me?"

He shook his head. "No, I'm fine."

"Are you sure?" She'd expected him to be horny from the conversation they'd had, and even more so after she'd plonked herself down in his desk.

His embarrassed expression returned. "I'll wait until after..."

"After?" She gave a smile. "Okay." She slid off the desk and fastened her robe, then moved towards the door, where she turned. "But you don't need to wait until after anyone else, you know that."

He smiled and nodded.

Nicole walked into their bedroom, stripped off her robe and climbed into bed. She liked the thought of her husband joining her later, discovering her nakedness and forcing himself on her, taking her roughly.

As it was, she fell asleep before he'd finished whatever he was doing with his spreadsheet.

* * * *

The same pretty receptionist welcomed Nicole with a smile. "Hi, please take a seat. I'll tell Ciaran you've arrived."

The heels of Nicole's black patent stilettos clicked on the tiled floor as she walked over to the chrome and leather chairs. She sat down carefully, keeping her knees together. Her skirt was black and figure-hugging. When she'd checked closely in the mirror of her bedroom, the outline of her suspenders was visible through the stretchy material.

Ciaran arrived a couple of minutes later, and his eyes swept over her body. He smiled, thanked the blonde receptionist, and escorted Nicole up to his office. Bernice again offered tea or coffee, but neither wanted refreshments.

After Ciaran had suggested Bernice take her lunch break, he and Nicole entered his inner office. Without waiting, and ignoring the table they'd used on her last visit, she walked to the chair opposite his desk and sat down. Ciaran hesitated for a second, then walked around his desk and dropped into his swivel chair.

"It's good to see you again," he said.

"Thank you." Nicole slowly crossed her legs, knowing as she did so that her stocking tops would become visible. "It's nice to see you again, too."

He looked momentarily flustered, which surprised and amused her. "I, er..." He shook his head. "Did you get a chance to look at the spreadsheets I sent?"

Nicole had no intention of wasting this meeting talking about the bookkeeping façade. “No. Sorry.” She raised her upper knee slightly, flashing bare thigh and black suspender.

“Oh. Well, that’s okay, I can—”

“Do you insist that Bernice wears stockings at work from Monday to Thursday?”

“What?” He laughed and shook his head. “No, I don’t think...” He swallowed. “I don’t think even thirty years ago that Bernice would have looked anything like...” He nodded at Nicole’s legs. “Anything like that.”

She stood up, straightened her skirt, and walked slowly around his desk until she was standing next to him. He swivelled his chair through ninety degrees and looked up into her eyes.

“Do you approve of my skirt, then?” she asked.

His usual self-confident smile was nowhere in evidence. He nodded. “It’s a lovely skirt, and it fits you perfectly.”

“Hmm.” Gripping either side of the material in her fingers, she slowly inched it up. Ciaran’s gaze dropped to watch as first the lace stocking tops, then her bare thighs and suspenders came into view. Her skirt was now bunched around her waist. “What about the stockings?”

“Fabulous.” His voice cracked at the final syllable.

“You can touch them, if you like.”

He tentatively held out his hands, tracing his fingertips over the smooth flesh on either side of the black strap down the front of each thigh. Then he slid his palms over the sheer denier of the nylon on her inner legs.

“Do they turn you on, Ciaran?”

He nodded, taking deep breaths through his nose.

“Show me how much they turn you on.”

He looked up and frowned. “Sorry?”

“You’re looking at my legs and stockings because they turn you on, so I want to see that arousal. Are you hard?”

Ciaran blew out his cheeks. “This is a bit... What’s happened since —?”

“We both know why I’m here.” She smiled. “As my husband’s already told you, this is something I’m allowed to do.”

As understanding dawned, his arrogant smirk returned. "I'm glad to hear it."

"Good. So, don't you have something to show me?"

Ciaran stood up and pulled her head close, kissing her roughly on the mouth. Nicole responded by nipping at his lips, then she ran her hand over the bulge in his trousers, gripping his erection through the expensive material of his designer suit, making him gasp.

He undid the buttons of her blouse and pawed her boobs through her lacy bra. Nicole kept kissing and pushing her tongue in his mouth, her fingers already working on his belt buckle. Once it was free, she undid his trousers and slipped her hand inside, feeling the hot skin of his hard cock.

She wrapped her fingers around the shaft, impressed by the girth. Looking down, she squeezed out a pearl of clear liquid between the tip of her forefinger and thumb. She brought her hand up to her mouth and stared into his eyes, sucking the precum from her fingers.

Ciaran twisted her round until she was backed up against his desk. He kissed her passionately, his teeth occasionally clashing against hers. She wanked his cock, and he lifted her onto the desk. Standing between her open legs, he slipped his fingers past the gusset of her black silk panties to the entrance of her drenched sex.

The instant he slid his fingers inside her, they both moaned, continuing to kiss and grope each other.

Eventually, Ciaran removed his fingers, pulled his head back and looked at her. He pushed her body down until she was lying on her back across his desk. She raised her legs, resting a high-heeled shoe on each of his shoulders.

His confident smile had returned to full wattage. He tried to pull her panties down but realised he wouldn't be able to unless he undid the suspenders. To Nicole's consternation, he took a pair of scissors from a desk drawer and quickly snipped through the waistband on either side of her panties.

He chuckled at her expression. "I'll replace them." Then he slid his cock through her outer folds, coating his entire shaft with her juices.

Nicole whimpered and looked down, seeing his cock rise over her mons before it slipped back until just the tip showed. She clamped her

hands on it, holding it against her mound as he slowly thrust forward and back. His shaft slid over her clit in the most delightful way.

She looked up into Ciaran's eyes. "Get a condom."

"What?"

"Put a rubber on so you can go inside me."

"But I thought you'd..." He shook his head, looking tortured. "I don't have one here."

"Oh, fuck. I'm really hot for it, now."

"I can tell." He looked down at her body and sighed. "So am I."

She used both hands, open palmed, to hold his cock against her as she rocked her hips. The friction as his shaft slid against her clit was delicious. "But this is nice."

"Nicole, please..."

She rocked harder, enjoying his look of desperation. "Oh, yeah. I quite like this. It'd be enough to..." She fluttered her eyes and dropped her mouth open.

Ciaran increased the speed of his thrusts, and she ground her clit against the constant back and forth of his smooth shaft.

The tell-tale tingle of an orgasm developed deep inside her. "Oh yeah." She licked her lips, purposely acting like the proverbial slut. "Oh fuck, yeah."

His eyes were fixed on hers. "Nicole, I really need to go inside you now."

She shook her head just as her orgasm hit. Bucking up from the top of his desk, she clenched her teeth and rubbed herself frantically against his cock.

Ciaran gasped. An arc of cum spewed out and landed on her tummy. She cried out and lifted her head, watching his cock shoot another two spurts up to her belly and onto her bunched-up skirt. He kept thrusting his hips until the final drops of cum oozed out and soaked her fingers.

Ciaran took a deep breath and held it for a couple of seconds before letting out a long sigh. He looked down at her body, and her gaze followed his. Her stomach was splattered with cum, as were her skirt and pubic hair.

Nicole slowly rubbed it into her skin, watching his face as she did so. “You’ve made a mess.”

Without taking his gaze from her fingers, he said, “I was hoping to shoot it somewhere else.”

“Hmm, that would have been nice,” she teased, “but you cut my panties, so it would have been dripping out of me all afternoon.”

Still breathless, he stepped back and tucked his cock back inside his pants. “If you knew I needed to wear a condom, you should have brought one with you.”

“Maybe I did.” She smiled sweetly, then sat up on the desk. “Or maybe I decided having you sliding along the edge was too good to stop.” She looked down at the mess on her and her skirt. “Do you have any tissues?”

He walked over to the table by the window, grabbed a box, and carried it back to the desk. Then he flopped into his chair and watched her mop up his cum from around her bellybutton.

“You do realise,” he said with a smile, “that we’re going to have to have another meeting. Very soon.”

“Oh?” She dropped the first sodden tissue on his desk and took out a second to wipe the mess from her pubes.

“Yes. You haven’t read the spreadsheets yet, so we’ll need to go through those.”

Nicole laughed, then finished cleaning up the mess on her skirt. Thankfully it seemed that all the stains were on the inside lining.

She started buttoning up her blouse. “Do you really want me to read the spreadsheets?”

He shrugged. “I really want another meeting.”

“It’s nice to be in demand.”

“And at the next meeting, I’ll make sure I bring something that means there’ll be no mess on the outside.”

Leaning so her lips almost touched his ear, she whispered, “Next time, I might let you make a mess on the inside.”

With that, she picked up her handbag and walked to the door, turning with her hand gripping the doorknob. “I can find my own way back

to reception. You'd better dispose of those tissues before Bernice brings your afternoon tea."

* * * *

Nicole was in a much better mood driving home from her second meeting with Ciaran.

Although she felt a twinge of regret that she and Ciaran hadn't actually fucked, she was pretty happy with how things had turned out. It had felt important to not give him the upper hand. It'd been nice to see him a little disappointed, and maybe even a little desperate. What's more, the sex had been appropriately dirty, and definitely enjoyable. Losing her pair of sexiest panties and having to get her skirt dry-cleaned was a small price to pay for his look of tortured frustration.

By the time Julian returned home, she'd showered and made dinner. She could tell he was desperate for the details even as he came through the door.

"How was your day?" she asked, struggling to keep her face straight.

"It was okay." He swallowed, then stood looking at her with an expectant smile.

"And were you able to answer all the customer's questions?"

"What? Oh, yes. Yes, I think I managed to iron out any wrinkles he may have thought he had. How about your—?"

"I've bought a lasagne, is that okay? Why don't you go and get changed, and I'll dish it up."

Julian looked crestfallen, but turned and trudged upstairs.

The second their bedroom door shut, Nicole crept upstairs, stripped to her bra and panties on the landing, then followed him in. Julian stood in his shirt, socks and underpants—an almost comical sight—while putting his trousers on a hanger. His eyes popped open when he saw her.

"I thought you might like to hear about my meeting with Ciaran," she said, walking over to him. As she started to unbutton his shirt, he dropped the trousers and hanger onto the carpet. "Can you wait for your lasagne, or would you rather eat now?"

He nodded then shook his head. "Later's fine."

“Good.” She pushed his shirt open and sucked his nipple, which was right in line with her lips. As he stared down into her face, she ran her hand down his stomach to his shorts. He was fully erect. “Oh, what’s this?”

Julian’s breath caught in his throat.

“I’ve been a naughty girl.”

“Have you?”

“Mmm.” She leaned close, squeezing and relaxing her grip on his cock through the cotton of his shorts.

“How naughty?”

She pursed her lips. “Not *very* naughty... But quite naughty.”

He took several shallow breaths through his mouth. “Quite?”

She nodded. “I let Ciaran see my stockings.”

“See them?”

“Yes. And he saw my suspenders, too.”

“You wore the suspenders?”

“Mmm hmm.”

“Did he...?” He swallowed. “Did he like them?”

“Oh yes. They made him shake a little, just like you’re doing now.” She slipped her hand inside Julian’s shorts and gripped his cock, which was dripping freely. “I let him touch them, too. He stroked my legs through the stockings.”

He blinked several times in quick succession, then sighed.

“He also stroked my thighs above the stocking tops.” She tilted her head up and nibbled his chin. “And I touched him, too.”

“You touched him?”

She smiled. “I rubbed him through his trousers, and he got all hard—like this is.” She glanced down at Julian’s cock, which was so hard and red it looked almost angry.

“And did you...?”

“I took it out and played with it, just like this.” She wanked Julian slowly, then smiled. “I think he liked it.”

His eyebrows reached for his hairline. “I imagine... he would.”

“And he touched me, the same way as he did before. With his fingers, until I was all hot and wet.”

Staring into her eyes, Julian looked expectantly at her. When she didn't say more, he nodded. “And?”

“Ciaran didn't want to wear a condom.”

He frowned and looked confused. “So what happened?”

“I told him he wasn't allowed inside me without one.”

“Oh. But you're... So what happened?”

“He pushed his cock against my body, rubbing it against the outside. I was lying on his desk with my skirt pushed up and my legs on his shoulders, and we both sort of bumped together.” She pumped his cock as he evidently struggled to visualise what she described. “His cock ran over my clit, and it was nice. It was so nice that it made me come.”

His eyes seemed to smile. “You...?”

She nodded. “And then Ciaran came.”

“Ciaran came?” he asked in a whisper.

“Yeah, all over me. On my tummy and my skirt. On my suspenders, in my pubes and all over my hands.”

As Julian's eyes half-closed, she decided to forego her own pleasure and make it nice for him. “And now I want you to do the same.”

Before he could answer, Nicole dropped to her knees and pumped him fast, cupping his balls with her other hand. Julian let out a groan as a thick dollop of cum hit her on the neck. She aimed it lower and took the second spurt on her boobs, then held his cockhead against her cheek and was rewarded with a warm splash there.

Turning her head, she opened her mouth and took him into her mouth, making him whimper and shake. His final eruption oozed onto her tongue. She moaned and purred to show her appreciation, sucking and licking his cock until it softened.

Slowly releasing him from her mouth, she looked up into his face. “How was that?”

He took a shuddering breath, then blinked. “I think I need to sit down.”

She laughed, and as he stepped to the bed and sat on the edge, she crawled across the carpet and stayed on her knees by his feet.

He stared down at her with a look of wonder, then frowned. "I'm sorry, I think I've ruined your bra."

"It'll wash."

He was silent for a few seconds, then shook his head. "Was Ciaran not upset that you... That he didn't...?"

She laughed. "I think it's pretty safe to say he was disappointed, but me going bareback wasn't something we'd discussed, and I wasn't sure what you'd want." Since Julian still looked baffled, she broke it down for him. "Before, with Sam, I made him wear a condom."

"You told me. But that was before I knew." He looked thoughtful. "Technically, it was before you knew I knew."

She smiled at his pedantry. "Yes."

"But now I know, so what's the problem?"

She stared. "You wouldn't have minded if I'd let Ciaran take me bareback?"

Julian shrugged as if he found her question strange.

"I just wasn't sure how you'd feel about that level of intimacy."

"Why? He's still putting his dick inside you."

His words shocked her a little, but so did his failure to see the obvious. "Yes, but with a condom it's only his dick."

Julian's puzzled frown returned.

"Without a condom," she explained, "it's his dick *and* his cum."

He shrugged. "But you're on the pill, so there's no—"

"I'm not worried about getting pregnant!" She sat back on her haunches and sighed. "I wasn't sure how you'd feel about him coming inside me, that's all."

"Isn't his dick being inside you the important thing? I don't see any difference if there's a condom or not."

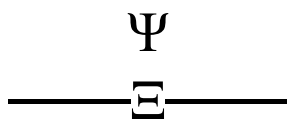
"Really?" As Julian reached out to take her hand, she didn't know whether to be disappointed or relieved. "Well, if we'd had this discussion last night, Ciaran would probably have been a lot happier about the meeting."

“I’m sure you can make it up to him.”

She was taken aback, but Julian didn’t seem to notice.

He just flashed her one of his reassuring smiles and said, “Now, how about that lasagne?”





Chapter Five

Nicole spent Friday morning weeding the flowerbeds. Then she submitted an online food order, to be delivered on Sunday. Just after she'd made herself a sandwich for lunch, her mobile rang. Seeing Julian's name on the caller ID, she instantly began to worry. He very rarely phoned from work.

She accepted his call. "Hiya."

"Hi, just a quick one. Don't make dinner tonight, I've booked us a table at The Crown."

"Oh?"

"Don't worry, the tables are all socially-distanced, and you're allowed to remove your facemask when you eat." He gave one of his chortles. "We'll need to leave as soon as I get home, so please be ready for five-thirty."

"Okay." She wanted to ask if it would be just the two of them, or if Ciaran had been invited to join them at the upmarket joint. "What should I wear?"

"It's The Crown, so probably not jeans. But wear whatever you're comfortable in, because you always look beautiful."

She smiled. "Thank you. Okay, I'll see you later."

"Bye, love."

After he'd rung off, she took her sandwich and a glass of Coke outside to the patio. As she ate her lunch, she reflected on how differently she felt compared to sitting here exactly a week ago.

* * * *

Julian ushered her into the car so briskly she barely had time to stop her dark grey dress catching in the door. He was good humoured but distracted, and she had to point out that they were in the wrong lane as they reached the main road heading into town.

He flashed her a smile. “We’re calling somewhere on the way.”

When they took a left, she knew they were heading for Parkside Grange. “I thought we’d agreed to wait until...” She gasped as she realised why he was taking her out to dinner. “Has it been confirmed?”

Julian grinned. “You are now married to the marketing division’s Regional Manager.”

She placed her hand on his arm and squeezed. “Congratulations. I’m so proud. And I’m happy for you because I know how hard you’ve worked.”

Flashing her another smile, he took another left and stopped outside a red-bricked home with a ‘For Sale’ sign on the lawn.

Nicole stared at the large house and detached double garage at the end of the block-paved driveway. “This looks fabulous.”

He nodded and checked his watch. “We have a viewing booked, so let’s have a look inside, shall we?”

She got out of the car, and together they walked to the front door. Julian handed her a face mask and, once they’d both fitted them, he rang the bell. Nicole looked down the road at the other houses. No two were built in the same design, all the gardens were well-maintained, and all the cars parked on the drives were expensive models.

The door was opened by an attractive woman carrying a toddler. “Hi, I’m Cheryl,” she said. “And this little fella is Mason.”

Julian introduced Nicole and himself, and Cheryl invited them into the large hallway, which had a wide staircase running up to a galleried landing.

She bent to put her little boy on the slate-tiled floor. “You want to go play with Tania?” she asked. He nodded and disappeared into one of the rooms off the hall.

Cheryl straightened and nodded towards another room. “Let’s start in here.”

They followed her into the huge open space that was the living room. It was at least thirty feet long. Bifold doors along the back wall overlooked a large garden.

The room was fabulous with oak flooring, leather sofas, and an open fire. Nicole walked to the glass doors and swept her eyes over the entire

garden. It was beautifully landscaped. Open fields stretched beyond the fence.

“Nicole is a keen gardener,” Julian said.

Cheryl smiled. “We have a corner plot, so our back garden is bigger than the others—though to be fair, all the gardens are a good size.”

“Why on earth would you want to move from here?” Nicole couldn’t help asking.

“I don’t, believe me. But my husband’s company has asked him to take a job in Australia.”

“Oh, wow. That sounds fantastic.”

“We hope so. It’s the only reason we’ve agreed to leave here. We’ll be living in Sydney for at least three years, then we’ll decide if we want to come back to the UK or not.” Cheryl nodded towards the hallway. “Come on, I’ll show you the rest of the house.”

The kitchen-diner was equally impressive, with immaculate fitted cupboards and a granite-topped island. All the appliances were finished in brushed steel, and a set of French doors led out to a stone-flagged patio. Next, they were shown into a smaller sitting room, where Mason and his slightly older sister were watching cartoons on a huge flat-screen TV mounted on the wall. Toys were stacked on shelving units.

“This is mainly used as the playroom,” Cheryl explained.

“It’s lovely.” Nicole was thinking it’d make a nice place for her to work in. A picture window overlooked a side garden bigger than their whole back garden at home.

“Let’s go upstairs.”

Nicole and Julian exchanged excited looks all the way around the tour, but Nicole couldn’t help assuming that the house would sell before they’d even arranged to get their own on the market.

“What stage are you at with your own sale?” Cheryl asked.

Julian frowned. “Ah, very early stages, I’m afraid.”

“Well that could be perfect. Gordon’s company has agreed that if we identify a suitable buyer, they’ll purchase your house and sell it. I assume that’ll work out cheaper for them than getting a bridging loan on this place. We’re due to leave in three weeks’ time.”

Nicole’s heart soared. “You mean...?”

Cheryl shrugged. "I mean if you like the house and are happy with the price, it's yours. Send us your solicitor's name, and Gordon's company will arrange a valuation of your place. You won't even need an estate agent."

Temporarily speechless, Nicole glanced around the hall again, trying to imagine living here.

"Do you have any other viewings booked?" Julian asked.

"Not at the moment."

Julian glanced at Nicole, then looked back at Cheryl with a beaming smile. "We'll take it."

Once back in the car, Nicole stared at the house as if in a dream. "Are we really going to be able to live there?"

"We certainly are. I phoned the bank earlier to check what mortgage I'd be able to get with my new salary. We can more than afford this one."

"Wow. I can't believe it."

He started the car. "Right, dinner."

The Crown was a beautiful black and white half-timbered building set back from the road. The carpark, which was usually crammed, had only four other cars in it. Once inside, they were escorted to an isolated table by a waitress in a clear visor and disposable gloves. She was back within two minutes with their drinks order, placing them on a side table.

Nicole took a sip of her gin and tonic. "I can't believe we could be living in that house in a month's time."

Julian reached across the table and took her hand. "It might take longer for the legal side of things to be completed, but I'm happy to be patient."

She nodded. "Me too."

He pushed his leg against hers under the table. "I think our life is turning out to be perfect."

She looked into his eyes, knowing he was talking about more than his promotion and their potential new home. "Is it really better for you?"

"Yes."

"But it seems like you're doing all the hard work and making the sacrifices, while I'm the one who's getting most of the benefits."

“And that’s as it should be. You deserve to be the centre of attention.”

She stared into his eyes, feeling guilty and excited and spoiled all at the same time. “Thank you, but are you sure you want us to go down this...?” She shrugged, wondering exactly how to phrase the fact she’d be having sex with another man. “This sharing route?”

“Yes, but rather than sharing, I prefer to think of it as a loan.”

“A loan?” Nicole wasn’t sure she liked that term. “Doesn’t a loan usually involve some sort of interest payment?”

He guffawed. “My only interest is knowing that you’re enjoying yourself, and knowing how it will make things more exciting between us.”

“You really like the idea of it?”

He nodded.

“What if I hadn’t...? I mean, last year. What if I hadn’t been so selfish? Would you have felt like you were missing out?”

“I don’t know. This wasn’t something I’d thought about or longed for. I don’t think I knew I had these feelings until I had to confront them.”

“I’m still sorry for what I did.”

“As I said, it’s opened up something for us that could be... Well, we’ve already had a lot of fun, and it’s only just started.”

She nodded, thinking how passionate things had become between them since she’d first met his boss. A thought occurred. “Was it Ciaran who told you about the promotion?”

“No. I got a phone call from the Marketing Director, but Ciaran had been informed because he came to congratulate me, and then sent out a memo to all the others in the team.”

“And how did your peers take the news?”

“They seemed pleased for me.”

The waitress approached, left two menus on the neighbouring table, then retreated. They silently studied the choices for a few minutes. Julian opted for pâté followed by bream, while Nicole went for scallops followed by a vegetable bake.

After they’d placed their order, Nicole asked the question that’d been on her mind all day. “Did Ciaran make any comment about our

meeting yesterday?”

“Only that you hadn’t had time to look at the spreadsheets yet.”

“I’m not convinced he actually needs a bookkeeper.”

“I think he does, but maybe he allows himself to get distracted.”

“Is that what he thinks I am, a distraction?”

“I think the distraction is the chemistry between the two of you.”

Julian grinned. “I imagine he finds it hard to concentrate on business when you’re with him.”

That’s because he thinks with his dick. “And what about you? Do you find it hard to concentrate on business when I’m with him?”

He chuckled quietly. “It’s fair to say I’m more than a little distracted when I know the two of you are in a meeting.”

“But distracted in a good way?”

“Yes.”

“Good. But now...” She raised her glass. “No more talk about anyone else. This is your night. We’re celebrating your promotion, which is a fitting reward for all the extra work you’ve put in over the years. And when we get home, I’ll be rewarding you for being such a kind and loving husband.”

His eyes sparkled with excitement. Just then, the waitress delivered their first course.

Over dinner they chatted about their potential new home, Nicole worrying they wouldn’t be able to afford to furnish every room for a while. Julian suggested Cheryl and her husband might consider selling some of their furniture since it’d probably cost more to ship to Australia than to replace it once they’d arrived. They both agreed that moving to Parkside Grange would certainly make up for not being allowed to go on holiday as a result of the pandemic.

It was a warm evening and only nine-thirty when they arrived home, so they drank brandy out on their patio. When their glasses were empty, Julian asked if she wanted another.

Nicole leaned close and nuzzled his neck. “No. I want you to take me to bed.”

He smiled. “Is this going to be another case of you using me to satisfy desires a certain other person has generated?”

“No, this has nothing to do with him. We’re not going to mention anyone else.”

“Ah. That sounds—”

Nicole kissed him on the mouth, then pulled him to his feet. Sliding her arms under his jacket and around his waist, she hugged him as they kissed. Then she led him inside and upstairs. Once in their bedroom, they slowly undressed each other, kissing flesh as it became exposed. They climbed naked into bed and lay side by side, stroking each other while kissing.

He ran his fingers over her sex and smiled at the wetness. She eased him onto his back and climbed on top, lying full length with her boobs crushed against his chest and her legs either side of his. Julian reached down and fed his cock into her. She writhed and undulated on him as he stroked her back and bum. Their love-making was slow and tender.

Getting close, she opened her eyes and stared into his. Julian gazed up at her, then as her muscles clenched around him, he leaned up and kissed her face. Nicole cried out as the orgasm surged through her.

Finally, with the spasms ebbing to a warm throb of contentment, she stilled and smiled down at him. “Mmm. Now it’s your turn.”

Julian rolled them both over without letting his cock slip out. Once he was lying on top, he held himself up on straight arms and pumped his hips. He started slow, gradually increasing the speed and force of his thrusts as she watched his face. When his breathing became ragged, she rocked her hips, clenching and relaxing her muscles around his cock.

His mouth dropped open and he held still. She could feel his cock twitching as it unloaded deep inside her. Bucking herself against him, she came again. Julian resumed his thrusts. The two of them groaned and clung to each other as they rode out the final ripples of pleasure.

Breathless, Julian rolled off. He turned his head and smiled at her.

She snuggled up to him and kissed his cheek. “Thank you.”

He was silent for a moment, then took a breath. “It’s been a long time since we’ve made love like that.”

“Hmm.”

“I mean the last couple of times, after talking about...” He nodded, as if in agreement that Ciaran wouldn’t be mentioned. “They were

wonderful. And intense, but—”

“They were us fucking. This was us making love.”

“Right, yes. But what I’m saying is, do you think what we just did was because of the recent developments?”

“Tonight was about us, not Ciaran. What we just shared proves we don’t need anybody else to make our sex life satisfying.”

His mouth opened, and he looked slightly concerned.

Nicole giggled. “I’m not saying we won’t use him for our kinky fulfilment, but we don’t *need* him.”

“So you’re still...?” He gave another embarrassed shrug.

“I’ll do it if you tell me it’s what you want.”

His jaw clenched and he breathed through his nose. Then he closed his eyes and nodded. “It’s what I want.”

She smiled. “That’s what I thought.” She laid her head on his chest. “In that case, I guess I should read his spreadsheets and suggest we have another meeting.”

She felt Julian’s heart beat faster as they lay in silence.

* * * *

Nicole finally got around to looking at Ciaran’s spreadsheets late on Sunday afternoon. They seemed pretty straightforward. She had no doubt that she’d be able to fulfil his bookkeeping needs as well as his carnal ones.

She typed out a text:

Hi Ciaran

I’ve now had time to look at the spreadsheets. I’m sure I’ll be able to do whatever it is you need. Let me know when you want me to come into the office.

Maybe I could visit at the end of a day, after Bernice has gone home. That way I won’t need to worry about being quiet :-)

Nicole

As she hit ‘Send’, a tingle developed deep inside her.

Ciaran's reply arrived within a minute:

*Tomorrow at 6pm.
Dress appropriately.*

The tingle intensified to a deep, yearning need. In twenty-four hours' time, she was going to have another man's dick inside her.

* * * *

Nicole stopped at a security gate that had been open during her day-time visits. The guard raised the barrier as soon as she gave her name.

Reception was completely empty except for Ciaran, who stood by the inner door minus his jacket, his tie loosened, and cuffs turned back. He smiled and ran his eyes hungrily over her body, taking in the red silk blouse, black pencil skirt, nylons and high heels. They walked in silence up the stairs, along the corridor and past Bernice's desk.

As soon as they were inside Ciaran's office, he closed the door and nodded toward a cardboard box on the table under the window. "That's for you. It's all the paperwork for this financial year. Receipts and invoices. Have a look through and let me know if you need anything else."

Nicole glanced at the box, then looked back at Ciaran. "Okay. Does that mean the bookkeeping discussion's over now?"

He smiled, his blue eyes twinkling. "It depends if you have any questions."

She bit her lip and looked to the ceiling as she pretended to think, then shook her head. "No, I don't think so."

"Good." He slipped his arms around her waist and pulled her close, looking into her eyes. "So, are you going to play hard to get again?"

"Did I do that the last time?"

"You know you did." He reached into his back pocket and took out a pack of condoms. "But today, I've come prepared."

"I actually had some in my handbag at the last meeting but thought what we did instead was quite sexy."

He looked angry for a moment, then chuckled and shook his head. "You fucking tease."

“I suppose I was.” She ran her hands over his shoulders and down his arms, reminding herself how good his body felt. She leaned close and inhaled, savouring his cologne and musk. “But I’m not going to tease you tonight.” She took the condoms from his hand and held them up in front of his face. “And you’re not going to be wearing one of these, either.” She dropped them to the floor, then stepped away from him and started to unbutton her blouse.

Ciaran’s eyes widened as she opened the blouse and slipped it off. Her erect nipples were clearly visible through the black lace cups of her bra. She undid the catch and zip of her skirt and, with a wiggle of her hips, let it slip down her legs to the floor. Stepping out of it, she stood in front of him wearing only her bra, suspender belt, stockings and shoes.

He stared wide-eyed at her fully exposed sex.

“I didn’t want you cutting up another pair of my panties.”

He took a deep breath, then finally tore his eyes away and looked up into her face. “Fucking hell.”

She strutted over to the table under the window, grabbed the box and put it down by the door. “So I don’t forget it,” she said, suppressing a grin at his perplexed expression. “I’m hoping you’ll take my mind off the accounts for a little while.”

Nicole walked to his desk and leaned her bum against the top. Ciaran stepped close. Watching his face, she unfastened the knot of his tie, then began on his shirt buttons. “I still remember what you said the first time I met you.”

“Oh?” He traced his fingers around her nipples, setting her nerve-endings ablaze.

“We were talking about healthy food, and you said I could have as much cream as I liked...” She pushed his shirt open and bent to suck his nipple, then straightened and kissed his jaw. “Remember?”

He nodded.

“Good.” She raised herself up onto his desk and parted her legs. Reaching down, she stroked the bulge in his trousers. “Because tonight, I’m going to put your theory to the test.”

Her fingers made short work of his belt and zipper. Once she’d released his cock, she stroked it with both hands. It was just as thick, long

and straight as she remembered.

“Are you saying you want my cream?”

She smiled and pointed his cock between her legs. “Yes. But you have some work to do first.”

“I do?”

She nodded. “You’ve got to fuck me.” She bit his ear lobe. “And you’ve got to please me.”

Ciaran stepped to the desk and slid his cock inside her. Nicole cried out, surprised by the girth. He was thicker than Julian, and it felt delicious. She gripped his head and wrapped her legs around his waist.

“Fuck, you’re so tight,” he whispered. “So fucking hot and tight.”

She looked into his eyes and breathed through clenched teeth, unwilling to admit to him how big he felt.

After easing her back until she lay on his desk, he gripped her hips and fucked her with slow, deep thrusts. Nicole reached between the cups of her bra and undid the clasp, freeing her boobs. Ciaran’s hands immediately seized them, caressing and squeezing gently while pulling at the nipples.

Nicole began to rock her hips, writhing on his desk as he fucked her. She arched her back, which allowed his cock to slide in deeper. “Ahh... Ow!”

He smiled down at her. “You like that?” He pushed in again, the tip of his unsheathed cock hitting places that hadn’t been reached before. “Does it feel good?”

She nodded.

“Are you going to come for me, Nicole?” He pushed in again.

“Yeah, I’m going to come for you.”

He pinched her nipples harder while continuing to push deep with each slow thrust. “So come.”

Her eyelids fluttered and her breathing became ragged. “I’m...”

He pushed deep again, his cock stretching and filling her.

“I’m...” Her legs trembled and her heart raced in her chest. “Oh!”

Nicole gripped the edge of the desk on either side of her legs as she came. Ciaran fucked her harder, ploughing in and out through her spasms as they gripped his cock. He pinched her nipples harder, making her cry out

again. She bucked and twisted, willing him to come, but he just fucked her harder.

When her orgasm had passed, he slowed his thrusts and smiled down at her. “Ready for a change of position?”

She blinked, amazed that he still hadn’t come. “Okay.”

He eased back and out of her, then helped her off the desk to the floor. “Take a step away, turn and bend over.”

She did as told, the front of her bra hanging down. Gripping the edge of the desk, she placed her feet wide apart and kept her legs straight.

Nicole looked over her shoulder at Ciaran and wiggled. “Come and get it.”

He bent his knees slightly and entered her with force, making her grunt. Now he fucked her hard, his hands gripping her hips and pulling her back to meet each thrust.

With her eyes closed and her hair hanging down on either side of her face, Nicole’s focus was on the fat cock reaming her from behind. She was being used. She was being used and it felt amazing. She began to push back to meet his thrusts, rendering his hands on her hips redundant.

“Fuck me,” she growled.

Ciaran complied.

Glancing over her shoulder, she saw his brow beaded with sweat. “Where’s the cream you promised me?”

He pounded her, then pushed in all the way and held still.

Nicole moaned as she felt his cock pulse. She used her fingers to rub her clit while his cock continued to pump its load inside her. She came a second time, grunting in a most unladylike manner.

Ciaran resumed his thrusts, and she lowered her head onto the desk as he kept fucking her. His cock was still hard, and she was happy for him to continue. She closed her eyes and revelled in the sensation of being used in this way. He was relentless, banging into her over and over for a long time before letting out a long sigh and holding still.

He’d come twice—something she’d never experienced before.

When he eventually pulled out and stepped back, she stood up. Her hair clung to the perspiration on her face, and her entire lower body ached.

She looked over at Ciaran, who stared at her with wide eyes while taking huge gulps of air.

“I told you there’d be no teasing tonight,” she said.

He dropped down onto his office chair without bothering to cover his cock. “God, that was...” He shook his head, then let out another long exhale. “Jesus.”

Nicole fastened her bra, then stepped back into her skirt.

“Do you want a drink or anything?” he asked.

“No thanks.” She had no intention of sitting here in the afterglow. She picked up her blouse and slipped it on, fastened the buttons and smoothed down her skirt. Combing her hair with her fingers, she flashed him a smile and walked over to pick up the box of receipts. Holding it against her hip, she opened the door.

“Is that it?” he asked. “You’re just going to leave now?”

“We both know I only came here to fuck. Now we have, I’m going home.”

“But we’ll do this again, right?”

She smiled. “Oh yes, we’ll do it again.”

With that, Nicole left his office and let the door swing shut behind her. She walked along the deserted corridor, down the stairs and through the empty reception. Once in her car, she glanced inside the box. On top of the pile of receipts and invoices, she found a small, wrapped parcel. Picking it up, she knew immediately what it was. Inside, she found a black silk thong identical to the one Ciaran had cut from her during her last visit. She laughed, dropped it back into the box and drove to the security gate. Waving to the guard, she settled back for the drive home.

Julian was pacing when she walked in through the back door, his eyes full of questions.

“Go to the bedroom,” she ordered. “Take your clothes off.”

He practically ran out of the room and up the stairs.

Nicole followed at her own pace. By the time she’d reached their bedroom, he was sitting on the bed in just his underpants.

Holding his gaze, she slowly removed her blouse and then stepped out of her skirt, exactly as she’d done for Ciaran earlier.

Julian's face was a picture. "Did you...? Is that how you dressed for your meeting?"

She nodded.

"And did...? What did he say?"

"He liked it." She took a breath. "Listen, shall I go for a quick shower?"

"No."

She stepped closer to the bed and frowned. "I could be a bit messy down there."

He reached out and ran his fingers through the matted hair around her sex. As he pushed his fingers inside, she heard the squelch and felt Ciaran's cum ooze out. Julian pulled out his fingers and rubbed the mess all around her sex.

"You don't mind?" she asked.

He kept his gaze fixed on the gooey mess. "No, I don't mind."

"I thought maybe you wouldn't like it."

He slipped his fingers back inside her. "It turns me on."

"I thought his dick being in me was the important thing. You said it made no difference if he came in there or in a condom."

He wouldn't meet her eyes. "I may have... That wasn't completely true."

Nicole stared down at him, then placed her feet a little wider to give him easier access. "You liked the idea of him coming inside me?"

He swallowed, then nodded.

"Do you want to go inside me now, feel all that sticky wetness on your dick?"

He looked up at her. Swallowed hard. "I may not last very long."

"I don't care, just put it in and do whatever you want."

She crawled onto the bed, lay on her back and spread her legs. Julian removed his shorts, clambered between her thighs, and pushed into her.

Letting out a sigh, Nicole wrapped her arms around his waist.

He held himself still and looked down at her. "Tell me."

“I went into his office and removed my blouse and skirt like I did for you. Then I sat on his desk and told him what I wanted.”

His breathing was shallow. “Which was?”

“That I wanted to be fucked. He lay me down on his desk and did exactly that. After I’d come, he made me stand up and bend over his desk, and he fucked that way until he came.”

Julian began to tremble slightly, but seemed reluctant to move his cock in and out.

“I came again when Ciaran did, and after he’d come, he stayed hard. He kept fucking me until he came again.”

“Really?” Julian closed his eyes and frowned. He was on the brink.

She kissed his cheek. “Don’t fight it. We can talk more later. Just relax and give me a third shot.”

His eyes clicked open as soon as she’d said it, his hips snapping forward. Nicole wriggled beneath him and he cried out, his legs locked straight and his body shaking.

Nicole rubbed his back and whispered encouragement. “Yeah, that’s it.” She kissed his face.

Eventually, they both stilled. Julian took a deep breath and rolled off her, then stared up at the ceiling.

“Are you okay?”

He shook his head. “I’m sorry I was so...*brief*.”

“Don’t be. It’s flattering that you can get so turned on by the thought of me... y’know. With someone else.”

He shrugged in his typical way.

Stroking his arm, she looked into Julian’s eyes. “And there was no reason to lie to me before—about wanting to hear about him coming inside me.”

“I didn’t want you to think me a complete pervert.” He smiled again. “Sorry.”

“It’s okay. But if we’re both going to get as much out of this as we can, then we need to talk about all the things we want.”

He leaned up on one elbow. “You’d do that? I mean, if there was something I wanted?”

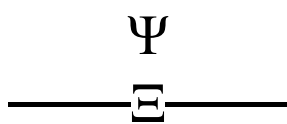
She smiled. “Maybe. But now, I really *do* need a shower. How about you phone for a pizza, and I’ll get cleaned up. Then after we’ve eaten, you can bring me back to bed and tell me all the things you want me to do with Ciaran.”

Nicole walked through to the bathroom, a little tender but very content. As the hot water cascaded down over her body, she allowed herself to reflect on how their lives had changed over these last few weeks. Julian’s promotion, the new house, and the desires her husband had kept hidden.

The prospect of being a loaned wife was exciting. Especially when her husband was going to come up with a list of dirty things he wanted her to do with another man.



Serving Both Partners



Chapter One

Nicole was pleasantly surprised at the valuation of their house. Not as thrilled or shocked as she'd been when her husband admitted he wanted her to sleep with other men, but the surveyor's report still made her smile.

"It's quite a bit more than we'd thought," she said, passing the report back to Julian.

He nodded. "Perhaps we'll be able to afford to furnish the new place after all."

The solicitor's letter also confirmed their new mortgage application had been approved and that the funds would be made available in time for them to move into their new home at the end of the month.

Turning to her husband, Nicole ran her hand down his arm. "I thought we could go to The Trafford Centre today."

"Oh?" His expression suggested spending Saturday in a shopping centre didn't appeal. "Will it even be open, with the pandemic restrictions?"

"Yes, I've checked. And stop pouting. I want to get you some new clothes. Maybe a couple of shirts and ties more fitting for your new regional manager status, but also some nice casual clothes for you to wear when we're mingling with all our new neighbours in Parkside Grange."

"Hmm."

She laughed. "Come on, I'll even buy you breakfast when we get there."

He trudged to the bathroom to shave. Twenty minutes later, they were heading towards the motorway.

As Julian steered into the carpark of the sprawling complex, he let out a sigh at the number of cars there.

She giggled. "Stop sulking. We'll have a nice time, I promise. I may even let you choose a new pair of shoes for me."

Finally, as he reversed into a space, a smile curled the edges of his moustache upwards. “What about lingerie instead?”

She loved the hopeful gleam in his eyes. “Would you like to choose me some new lingerie?”

He nodded.

“And will this lingerie be for your eyes only?”

Her favourite Bond enthusiast grinned broadly. “Not necessarily.” He killed the engine and turned to look into her eyes. “You told me that Ciaran likes you in stockings, so maybe I’ll give you a licence to *thrill*.”

“Now you’ve made me go all tingly.”

“Hmm.” He reached for the door handle. “I suppose we’d better have some breakfast first then, so you don’t soil any of the garments you try on.”

“Julian!” She slapped his arm. “I don’t know what’s gotten into you lately.”

He laughed. “Yes, you do. And we both know it’s because of what’s been getting into you.”

Her jaw dropped, but he’d already climbed out of the car.

They donned their facemasks and headed inside the huge shopping centre. Though not as crammed as usual, there were still hundreds of people inside. They headed straight to the food outlet they preferred and found a free table nicely spaced away from all the other customers. A waitress came over and they each ordered a drink and pastry.

Nicole removed her facemask. “I still can’t believe what we’re doing.”

“It was your idea. I wouldn’t have suggested—”

“I don’t mean *shopping*. I mean I can’t believe I’m in a situation where you’re going to choose lingerie for me to wear for another man.”

“Ah. I guess that is a bit of a change from the norm.” He glanced around at the other patrons. “Do you ever wonder if we’re the only ones who have secrets?”

Surprised, she shrugged. “I think I’m still too amazed at our secrets to have considered other people’s.”

“Well, I don’t care about other people’s secrets. I’m too busy enjoying our own.”

Nicole stared at him for a second, a warmth spreading through her. “Me too.”

After breakfast, Nicole managed to persuade Julian to liven up his work wardrobe with a pale blue shirt, and another with a subtle grey check. She chose four ties which went nicely with both new additions and his standard stock of boring whites. In the next shop he actually chose some decent casual trousers for himself along with the jeans she picked up. He didn’t even wince when she put the checked shirts and three polo shirts in pastel colours onto the counter.

Once back on the main thoroughfare, Nicole handed all the bags to Julian. “That’s you sorted. Take these back to the car, then meet me in there,” she said, pointing to a large shoe store.

By the time Julian arrived, Nicole had narrowed her choices down to three pairs, all black with a stiletto heel.

“These are my favourite,” she said, holding up a strappy sandal in patent leather. “They’d look great with fine-meshed fishnets and my toenails painted red.” The next one she showed him was in black suede with a peep toe. “I think these are classy.” She smiled as she put it down and picked up the final shoe, which was made from a soft black leather, had a pointed toe and a bright red sole. She slipped it on and stood up, needing to go on tiptoes with her bare foot for balance. “Do you think this heel might be a little too high?”

He stared wide-eyed at the shoe, and at the way it made her calf muscle stand out. He swallowed. “Not at all.”

She laughed, enjoying the effect the shoes were having on him. “So, which do you think I should take?”

“All of them.”

“Don’t be silly. Just tell me which pair you’d—”

“I’m serious. Let’s take them all.”

“They’re too expensive.” She picked up the sandal and dangled it from her finger. “These alone are eighty-five quid.”

“Have you tried them all on?”

She nodded. “And I think these are my fav—”

He signalled to the assistant. “Hi, can we take all three pairs, please?”

Nicole stared open-mouthed at Julian as he took out his bank card and paid.

Once back on the thoroughfare, he scanned the shop signs. “Do you know where the lingerie shop is?”

Still stunned, she nodded to the upper level.

“Come on, then.” He led the way, bounding along with the bag of shoes.

As they wandered around the lingerie store, Nicole ran her eyes and fingers over the racks of sexy garments. The thought of strutting around the office under Ciaran’s gaze made her shiver.

She looked up into her husband’s eyes and caught him watching her closely. “What?”

“I get the impression you’re trying to decide which you think he might like the most.” He smiled as she put her hands to her flaming cheeks. “It’s fine. Even I’m trying to imagine which ones he’d like.”

“Which ones do *you* like?”

He nodded at a mannequin they’d just passed. The headless white figure was dressed in stockings and suspenders with black silk panties and matching bustier that buttoned up the front.

It *was* sexy. “That’s really nice. Want me to try on the top?”

He nodded.

She rooted through the hangers until she found her size, then nodded toward the changing room. “I’ll just go in there.”

“Should I come too?”

She leaned close to whisper in his ear. “Yes, but maybe later.” She laughed at his startled expression, then headed toward the changing room, grabbing a pair of corsets from another rack along the way.

The little silk bustier Julian had picked fit perfectly, pushing her smallish breasts together to give her an impressive cleavage. She checked her reflection in the full-length mirror and then took a selfie, not bothering to remove her facemask. The corsets also fitted nicely, making her legs look long and slim. Again, she took selfies and sent them to Julian.

Once dressed, she stepped out into the shop, seeing Julian staring wide-eyed at his phone. While he was busy, she rounded up matching panties for both corsets, panties, stockings and suspenders to go with the bustier, then headed back to Julian, who was exactly where she’d left him.

He nodded at his phone. “Take all three of these, too. I’ll pay.”

She laughed. “I’ll buy them. You’ve spoiled me already with my shoes. Now put your phone away, we can’t have you getting an erection in here.”

He guffawed, then glanced around to make sure nobody else had heard her. “I’ll go and wait...” He nodded toward the shop exit.

Five minutes later, she couldn’t see Julian anywhere outside the shop, not even on the benches a little farther along. She was just reaching for her phone when she saw him coming out of Clinton’s, clutching a small paper bag.

“I’ve bought you something else to wear.”

Puzzled, she looked inside and saw a black facemask with shiny red lips printed over the mouth. She giggled and looked up at him. “Er... Thank you.”

“I think you should wear it the next time you see Ciaran.”

“Oh?”

He nodded. “The photos of you in the underwear and facemask were sexy, and it got me thinking.”

“I see.” She slid the mask back into its bag and put it in with her lingerie.

“I think you should keep the mask on while you tease him, but then you’ll have to remove it for the finale.” His eyes bore into hers. “Or at least pull it down.”

Her insides were tingling in anticipation. Julian intended telling her what to do with Ciaran. The hordes of people pushing past them seemed to fade into the background. Her entire focus was on his eyes, because that was the only part of Julian’s expression she could see. “And what’s the finale?”

“Oral sex.”

Suddenly the hordes of people around them came sharply back into focus. “Right...”

“You can remove your clothes to let him admire your underwear, but he’s not allowed to touch you.”

“You want me to suck his dick,” she concluded.

He nodded.

“For how long?”

He looked puzzled. “For as long as it takes.”

“So... you want him to come in my mouth?”

“Yes.”

Her pelvic muscles clenched involuntarily. She became aware that her panties were damp. “It doesn’t sound like I’d be getting a whole lot of fun out of that meeting.”

“I disagree. I get the impression you like to take charge during your encounters.” His eyebrows bobbed. “But if you like, you can pleasure yourself while you suck him.”

She nodded, on autopilot, barely able to recognise the man she thought she knew. She’d be lying if she said the idea of sucking Ciaran off didn’t arouse her, though. “And that’s definitely what you want?”

“It’s one thing.”

“There are others?”

“Oh yes. But let’s take it one step at a time, eh?”

As they headed back to the car, Nicole replayed what he'd just said about her giving the impression she liked to take charge during her meetings with Ciaran. Had she told him that? She couldn't remember if she'd mentioned enjoying seeing Ciaran's arrogance and confidence waver—particularly during the meeting where she'd pretended he needed a condom. The niggling suspicion that Julian and Ciaran were discussing her trips to the office resurfaced. Or maybe Julian assumed she was bossy everywhere else as well as at home.

Shoving the matter to one side, she slid into the front seat of the car and wondered how she'd encourage Julian to tell her why he was happy for her to do something as intimate as swallowing Ciaran's cum.

* * * *

"I thought I could start sorting through the stuff in the loft," Julian said as he chewed the remains of his lunch. "It's mostly in boxes anyway. We need to decide what we'll be taking when we move, and what we throw away. I can stack the ones we're keeping in the garage for the removal company."

She nodded. "I can help, if you like."

"You hate the loft. The only time you went up there, you complained it was too dirty."

"Hmm. Well, it seems that nowadays, that's exactly how you like me."

He blinked. "Is that a bad thing?"

"No. I like it. And what's more..." She leaned close and kissed his cheek. "I like that it's you who's telling me to be dirty."

Julian looked embarrassed, which made her laugh.

"Come on," she said. "Maybe after we've finished in the loft, we'll need to share a bath."

He grinned. "I'd like that."

It wasn't actually that dirty, with the floor boarded and the roof felted. Three bright, bare bulbs hung in a line from the central roof beam,

and in typical Julian-fashion, all the boxes had been arranged into neat piles. It took them less than half an hour to move everything to the garage and then make some progress on sorting out what they wanted to keep.

Nicole put a small silver Christmas tree on the trash pile. “That’d look lost in our new living room. This year we’ll need a bigger tree.”

“Agreed.”

She bent over a box full of old paperbacks. “These could go to the charity shop. Maybe we should make a third pile of stuff to donate. I’ve got quite a few clothes I’ll never wear again.”

“Okay.”

She grinned. “Now that you have some nicer casual clothes, maybe we could donate that old yellow sweater your mother bought you.”

“I was going to suggest you wear that for Ciaran one day.”

Her laugh echoed in the garage, but she found herself glad of the opportunity to steer the conversation back to more important matters.

“Would you like to suggest what I wear, as well as what I do?”

He nodded.

“Why?”

“It turns me on.”

She took his hand and pulled him away from the boxes. “We can finish this tomorrow. Let’s take this conversation to the bath.”

She was already in the scented water when Julian walked into the bathroom, naked, a bottle of wine in one hand and two glasses in the other. She sat up and took the glasses from him to pour the wine as he stepped into the bath, wincing at the high temperature.

He sat on the side, only his feet in the water. “I may need you to add a bit more cold before I can get in.”

She giggled, and then had a thought. Reaching out, she wrapped her fingers around his cock. “Maybe I could practise what you want me to do to Ciaran...”

Julian stared in silence.

She adjusted her position so she was kneeling, then leaned in and planted a soft kiss on the tip of his cock. It soon grew hard. “Would you like me to suck your dick?”

His only reply was a slight nod of his head.

Keeping her eyes on his face, she parted her lips and took him into her mouth. She bobbed her head slowly, sliding her lips up and down his shaft for a few seconds before pulling back and releasing him. He groaned with disappointment.

“Okay, so I understand why you like me sucking *your* dick. But what I don’t understand is why you like the idea of me sucking Ciaran’s.” He gave another tiny nod, his expression suggesting that he was still embarrassed about discussing his desires. She stroked his leg, trying to be patient. “I get that you like to share, and that you like the idea of him fucking me. But... I thought, maybe naively, that it was because you got a thrill out of imagining my pleasure. Because the thought of me getting off on someone else’s dick turned you on.”

“It does.” He frowned. “Immensely.”

“But I wouldn’t be getting off by sucking Ciaran’s dick. *He* would. Does Ciaran getting off turn you on?”

He laughed, finally seeing her point. “It’s not the thought of Ciaran’s pleasure that’s arousing, but the fact that it’d be *you* performing the act. The thought of Ciaran receiving a blowjob from anyone else does nothing for me.” He blinked, looking uncomfortable. “Returning to my favourite Star Wars toys analogy, I didn’t care about the kids playing with other toys. I just liked the idea of them liking my toys and being a little jealous that I could play with them whenever I wanted to.”

Nicole let go of his cock, sat back down in the water and turned on the cold tap. “Get in the bath.”

His disappointment was palpable.

“We’re going to talk for a while. But don’t worry, you’ll get your blowjob later.”

“I... You don’t have—”

She touched her finger to his lips and smiled. “Ignoring the fact that I’m not a toy that can be passed around—”

“No, I wasn’t saying—”

“It’s okay, I know you weren’t. So, what part of me giving him a blowjob makes your motor run?”

He took a breath, then picked up his glass. After taking a sip, he exhaled slowly. “I suppose I want him to be captivated by you. By your beauty, your poise, your elegance. But more than that, I want him to be enthralled by your sexuality. I want him to see that you have everything a man could ever wish for in a woman.”

Nicole was flabbergasted, not to mention extremely flattered. That wasn’t the answer she’d expected. “Why?”

“I suppose to make him envious. Or to put it more selfishly, because if someone with all your attributes chose to marry me, it makes me look better.” He looked away, as if ashamed. “Better than I actually am.”

“Julian, that’s not true. You’re a wonderful man, and you deserve someone better than me. What I did last year—”

“No. Let’s not keep harking back to how this started and instead enjoy the fact that it has.”

“Okay.” She picked up her glass. “So it’s started, for better or w—”

“It’s better. Much better.”

She bit her lip, still amazed at how unselfish he was, for all his talk about liking the way she made him look better. Sometimes their arrangement seemed too good to be true. “And now, we’re living the lifestyle where I have sex with your boss.”

He swallowed, then took another sip of his wine.

“But I don’t do it to make you look good.”

He shook his head.

“What Ciaran thinks about you isn’t my concern.” She leaned closer and dipped her hand through the bubbles, gripping his cock beneath the surface. He was still semi-hard. “I do it because it turns me on, and because

I know it turns you on. It's all about the sex. Me having sex with him, and me having sex with you."

Julian sat in silence, his cock growing hard in her hand.

"I don't think Ciaran's opinion of you will be affected by who you're married to. You impress him at work. Me fucking Ciaran had nothing to do with your promotion. Me fucking Ciaran has no bearing on your standing within the company. Me fucking Ciaran is only happening because it's what *we* want. Not just me, and not just you."

"I understand that."

She put her glass down, then took his from his fingers and put it aside, too. "I know I promised you a blowjob..." She shuffled forward in the water. "And if you can hold back from coming, I'll do it here in the bath. But I really need you inside me now."

Julian moved forward and Nicole straddled him, her legs either side of his hips, her feet behind him. She fed his cock inside her and he let out a sigh. She slid up and down slowly, inching herself toward the release she'd craved since they'd been at the shopping centre.

He gripped her waist and began moving her on him, lifting her up and pushing her down on his cock.

She held his gaze. "You're supposed to be saving yourself."

He bounced her faster.

"Oh God..."

He leaned close and bit her earlobe.

"Oh, Julian... Come with me. Come... I'm going to—"

Julian grunted and arched his back, sending water splashing over the rim of the bath. Nicole's orgasm ripped through her, the intensity of the spasms making her scream. They gazed at each other, bouncing and splashing until the feelings faded.

Eventually, she slid off him, picked up her glass and moved back to her end of the bath. "Thank you."

"Anytime."

Nicole added more hot water and they lay in silence for a while.

He cleared his throat. "About the blowjob..."

She raised her foot and placed it on his chest. "Don't worry, you'll still get it."

"No, I mean the one I suggested you give Ciaran. If you don't want to do it, that's fine."

"But what if I *want* to do it?"

He looked puzzled. "I thought you'd said you wouldn't get off on it."

She shook her head. "No, I just didn't understand what you would get out of it. Now I do."

"So you like the idea?"

"Hmm." She smiled. "And the more I think about it, the more I like it. Not just the act, but the fact that I'll be in charge, and all he'll be able to do is sit there and enjoy it."

"You'll make him sit down? In his office chair?"

"Isn't that how you visualised it?"

He shook his head. "No, I imagined him standing up and you on your knees."

"I don't like that idea as much. I was thinking I'll make him sit on the edge of his desk with his pants round his ankles. Then, wearing the facemask you bought earlier, I'll strip down to my sexy lingerie—"

"Without panties?"

"Yes, without panties. I'll sit in his office chair and tease him—stroke his dick, wipe it across my face, blow on it through the facemask, and pretend that's all he's getting." She smiled. "And that's when I'll start touching myself."

"So you'll be in charge?"

"Oh, I'll definitely be in charge."

"But you'll give him release...? Eventually?"

"Yes." She stared into his eyes. "When the time's right, I'll pull my mask down and take him into my mouth. I'll suck his dick. I'll suck him so

well that he won't be able to contain himself, and I'll do exactly what you asked me to do."

"Which is?"

"I'll let him fill my mouth and hold it there, swilling it around the head of his cock with my tongue."

Julian's eyes were like saucers.

"And while I'm doing that, I'll rub my clit to bring myself off. Then I'll swallow his cum. That's what you want, right?"

He nodded.

"Good."

Julian got out of the bath and dressed. Nicole added more hot water and stayed to finish the rest of the wine. By the time she wandered downstairs, Julian had started going through the contents of the bookshelf in the living room.

He nodded towards a pile of loose books. "They're all yours, so let me know which ones you want to take with us." He smiled. "It's not as if we'll be struggling for space."

Nicole quickly skimmed through the pile. "I'd like to keep them all."

He packed them into a box. "How about we get a takeaway tonight? Thai?"

"Ooh, good idea. I'll have the duck and noodle thing I like."

After skimming through the menu, Julian phoned in their order. He put his phone away and smiled. "About an hour."

"Great. Shall we watch a film?"

"It'll have to be something on Netflix, because I've boxed up all our DVDs."

After eating their takeaway, they had a pleasant evening cuddling on the couch watching TV, though Nicole's mind wasn't really on the film. She was thinking about giving Ciaran a blowjob. Having seen his cock up close, she knew how well he measured up. But what about her? Though she was

hardly a novice, she suspected Ciaran would've been with a lot of women who'd been only too happy to impress him with their oral technique.

The credits of the film rolled up. As Julian turned off the TV and lights, she threw out the takeaway cartons and loaded their plates into the dishwasher. They headed upstairs and climbed into bed. The way he grabbed for his novel suggested that what they'd done in the bath had satisfied his carnal desires. Grinning, Nicole reached for her phone and opened a browser, taking advantage of her 'quiet time'.

She typed in 'How to give the perfect blowjob' and hit search.



$$\Psi$$


A horizontal line with a small square box in the center, containing a horizontal bar.

Chapter Two

On Sunday morning they agreed to do some work-related tasks before continuing with packing for their imminent move. Julian worked in the upstairs office preparing slides for a team presentation he was giving tomorrow, and Nicole went through the box of receipts and invoices Ciaran had given her at their previous meeting. She spent a couple of hours sorting the paperwork into relevant piles, putting them in chronological order and filing each in a ringed binder. Then she entered their details—date, supplier or customer, amount—into a spreadsheet on her laptop.

Once her task was completed, she went to the kitchen to start lunch. She put the chicken in the oven and was peeling potatoes when her husband slipped his arms around her waist from behind.

“Need me to do anything?” he asked.

“No, I’m fine. I just need to boil these for a few minutes before I put them in to roast, then we can start packing boxes. Have you finished your slides?”

“Yep.” He squeezed her waist. “Finished going through the receipts?”

He meant, was she ready to go and see Ciaran again? A tingle of excitement and anticipation swept through her. She turned and held his gaze. “Yes, I’m ready.”

His Adam’s apple bobbed as he swallowed. “So you’ll set up a meeting for this week?”

“Yes, if he’s available.”

“Oh, I have no doubt he’ll make himself available.”

“I expect he will.” She took a breath, then looked towards the pile of collapsed cartons they’d bought. She didn’t quite have the energy for packing just yet. Not with the sun shining so brightly outside. “How about eating out on the patio? We may not get another chance before we move. Want a beer?”

“Yes please.”

Over lunch, they excitedly discussed the size of the garden they’d soon be able to sit in. Julian pointed out that they should take any flowers and bushes Nicole was particularly fond of to their new house, even though that garden was already fully stocked. Afterwards, they headed into the kitchen and began packing their stuff into boxes, reminiscing about their lives in the house. Even though their new home was more than Nicole ever imagined they’d have, she had many fond memories of their first home together.

After a couple of hours, she’d had enough of filling, taping and labelling boxes. “I think I might have a bath.”

“I suppose I should start packing away the office.”

She nodded. “I’m going to have another beer. Do you want one?”

“Yes please. I’ll put these boxes in the garage, if we can actually fit anything else in there.”

Nicole opened two beers and carried them upstairs. As her bath was filling, she took one of the beers to the office and left it on the desk, then went into the bedroom to undress. She heard Julian’s shouted thanks just as she slipped into the hot water.

Lying in the peaceful silence, she imagined teasing Ciaran while wearing only her facemask, lingerie and shoes. Having studied blowjob technique online, she felt more confident she could give him something to remember. She’d even used the biggest and straightest under-ripe bananas she could find to practice deep-throating.

Maybe she should invite Julian to join her in the bath so she could practice her newly-acquired skills on warm flesh...

On impulse, she got out of the bath and headed for the office. The door was slightly ajar. As she stepped closer, she saw that one of the fitted wardrobe doors was open. Although they’d installed shelves so that the space could be used for keeping books and stationery, the inside of the wardrobe door still had a full-length mirror attached.

The reflected image stopped her in her tracks.

Julian was sitting in his office chair, his trousers undone and an erection protruding. He was watching something on his phone while masturbating. Nicole stared, open-mouthed. The reflected view was in

profile, so she had no idea what was on his screen, and there was no audio. She held her breath as he pumped his hand faster.

He set the phone on the desk, grabbed a tissue and draped it over the end of his cock. With a final pump of his hand, he closed his eyes, dropped his head back and let out a sigh. Nicole backed away.

Stepping into the bath again, she added more hot water and lay back to consider what she'd just witnessed. A few weeks ago, she'd probably have found his behaviour upsetting, but things had changed. Considering what she'd done with Ciaran, Julian jerking off while watching porn was hardly anything for her to get upset about—though she was upset that he obviously didn't feel able to share it with her.

She was curious about what he'd been watching, though. Since he'd first admitted getting turned on by the thought of her with another man, she'd done quite a bit of reading up on the wife-sharing fetish.

She didn't think of Julian as a traditional cuckold; he showed no interest in being humiliated, nor did he want to be denied physical contact with her. He simply got sexual titillation from knowing she had sex with other men. Her research had told her lots of men had the same feelings. It looked like Julian might be doing some research of his own, which was fine, but she couldn't deny that catching him enjoying those fantasies alone had deflated her. She'd been fully open with him about everything since they'd started with Ciaran, after all. Made a point of it, actually.

She eventually got out of the bath, slipped into her robe and made enough noise on the landing to let him know she was heading to the office. She opened the door to find Julian kneeling on the floor, piles of books and files on either side of him.

He smiled up at her. "How was the bath?"

"Fine. Are you hungry yet?"

"Not particularly. Maybe I'll have something later."

"Okay. I'll see you downstairs."

Nicole drank a pint of water as she channel-hopped in the living room. Julian joined her about twenty minutes later, announcing he'd finish sorting his office the following night. They had a light supper while watching TV and headed off to bed around ten-thirty. Nicole slept fitfully

and found herself wide awake in the middle of the night. She checked the time on her phone.

03:44

She was just about to put her phone down when she saw Julian's mobile on the other bedside cupboard, on charge. Would she be able to go through his search history and find the video he'd been watching? Maybe it'd give her a better insight into which aspects really turned him on.

As gently as she could, Nicole tiptoed around to Julian's side of the bed. Watching his face to make sure he was still asleep, she silently unplugged the charger and took his phone into the bathroom. Bolting the door, she sat on the edge of the bath and tried to unlock the phone. It usually needed a fingerprint, but she knew the backup code on the touch-sensitive screen.

Incorrect pattern.

Frowning, she tried again and got the same result. *What are you hiding?*

Doubt began to work its way into her head. Why would he want to keep secrets when she was so open with him about her meetings with Ciaran? Now more determined than ever to see what he'd been watching, Nicole crept back into the bedroom. She ran her hand down her husband's left arm. He didn't stir, so she gently moved his hand until his palm was up, then held the back of the phone against the pad of his forefinger. Immediately, his phone unlocked and lit up.

Nicole returned to the bathroom, locked the door, and searched his browsing history. There was nothing there that suggested porn, just regular sites she knew he read. She checked the videoclips in his gallery. Nothing of note. The last clip was from weeks ago, when they'd gone for a walk and spotted a family of swans on a lake.

Next she opened his files and found a videoclip stored in the Documents subfolder. After checking that the phone was muted, she opened the clip. As it played, she got a sinking feeling in the pit of her stomach.

It was a scene of Ciaran's office, shot from somewhere high and to the left of his desk. The picture quality was poor, but she and Ciaran were both easily recognisable. She was bent over his desk, and he was fucking her from behind. She had her eyes closed and mouth open, and her tits jiggled from the force of Ciaran's thrusts.

She swallowed and closed her eyes, blood raging in her ears.

After sending the clip to her own phone, she deleted the message from his Sent box, closed down the phone and crept back to their bedroom. She silently reconnected the charger, slipped back into bed and lay awake for a long time. Julian had said Ciaran never discussed what she did with him. Was that a lie? Were the two of them in this together, with Ciaran agreeing to film what happened for Julian's benefit?

She was hurt, but couldn't decide if she was angry or not. What was worse, she wasn't even sure if she had the right to be angry.

Is he cheating by watching me cheat?

Nicole would have to think about how she really felt before mentioning it to either of the men she was fucking.

* * * *

After Julian had left for work on Monday morning, Nicole opened her phone and watched the clip she'd sent herself just hours earlier. It didn't have audio, so her muting his phone had been pointless.

She watched with a weird sense of detachment. It showed only a short excerpt of what had taken place, starting mid-fuck with her bent over the desk, and ending just after Ciaran came inside her for the first time. She wondered if it had been edited down to make the file small enough to send by email to Julian's phone. There were probably more clips from the same meeting: the earlier part, where Ciaran had fucked her lying on the desk, and the latter part when he'd come a second time.

Perhaps there were clips from every time she'd visited the office. Had Julian also jerked off to her getting finger-fucked against the wall? When Ciaran had cut off her panties before their 'outercourse'? Had he seen Ciaran come over her tummy?

Nicole closed the app and sighed, unable to decide how she felt about being secretly filmed. She knew how she *should* feel but couldn't justify any real sense of hurt or anger. Determined not to let it spoil her fun, she wandered through to the dining room, booted up her laptop and started working on her official job.

She worked for an hour or so, then headed into the kitchen to make herself a cup of tea. While waiting for the kettle to boil, she picked up her

phone and tapped out a text to Ciaran to tell him she'd sorted his paperwork and was ready to meet—ideally after hours.

She wasn't expecting an answer any time soon because she knew he'd be sitting in on Julian's presentation, but her phone beeped almost immediately. His reply was short and direct: *Tonight at 6.*

The situation still freaked her out. While listening to a talk about how the team should start collating sales data, Ciaran had accepted an invitation to have sex with the presenter's wife.

Though he didn't yet know what sort of sex he'd be getting.

She sent a thumbs up in reply, then tried unsuccessfully to concentrate on her own job. She decided to have an early lunch and sat outside in her garden, enjoying the warm sun.

The time of the meeting meant she wouldn't see Julian beforehand; they'd probably pass each other on their journeys to and from the office. Rather than forewarn him by text, she decided to leave him a note. She liked the idea of her husband reading it and getting all hot and bothered. Maybe he'd jerk himself off waiting for her to come home.

A thought struck her. Would they be filming tonight's session as well?

Well, if that's what he wants...

* * * *

Nicole left home a little after five. The sun had disappeared behind dark clouds, giving the September evening an odd, almost ethereal light. It looked like a storm was brewing. She kept her eye out for Julian's car heading in the opposite direction but didn't see it.

When she arrived at the GLP office, the security barrier was still raised. There were a few cars scattered around. Maybe Friday was the only day when everyone left on time. Thankfully, Julian's car wasn't there.

Just as she was about to get out, she noticed her phone holder. It was a six-inch flexible rod with adjustable jaws on one end and a large sucker on the other. Quickly removing the sucker end from the windscreen, she dropped the holder into her handbag and stepped out of the car. In the distance she heard the clap of thunder.

Tonight she wore a black wraparound dress, thinking it'd be sexier to remove than a skirt and blouse. Beneath the dress she'd put on black, lace-topped stockings and the black corset bought during her shopping trip with Julian. She hadn't bothered with panties and had decided to wear the new shoes with very high heels and red soles. They matched the red lips on her novelty black facemask, which she fitted before entering the building.

The receptionist had left for the day, but two men were deep in discussion near the windows. Nicole was wondering if she needed to text Ciaran to let him know she'd arrived when the inner door opened, and he stepped through into reception.

He smiled and walked over. "Nicole, great to see you. I'm glad you're keeping yourself safe from the virus."

"Well, you know how I like to take precautions."

He raked his gaze down her body. "I hope we won't need to social-distance for the entire meeting."

"Hmm. Let's go upstairs and find out, shall we?"

A confident smile spread across his face, and he held his arm towards the inner door. "After you."

Nicole led the way, knowing his eyes would be fixed on her backside. She waited for him to open the door, then stepped through and started climbing the stairs so he could admire her shoes and legs as he followed her up.

They passed Bernice's empty desk and stepped into Ciaran's office. He locked the door behind them. A flash of lightning lit the sky, and torrential rain battered against the windows.

"Jeez." Ciaran walked to the window and watched the downpour. "Looks like you got here just in time."

Nicole nodded. She hadn't brought a coat or an umbrella.

He smiled. "At least the mask would have kept your chin dry."

"True." She walked slowly across his office to his desk, then turned to look at him. It had been her intention to have him sit here, but the weather had given her another idea. The sky was dark, the rain loud against the windows. "Take your trousers off, Ciaran."

He looked amused. "What, here?"

She nodded.

With a confident grin, he kicked off his shoes and unfastened his trousers. He let them slip down his tanned, toned legs. Even in just shirt-tails and black socks, he still managed to look sexy.

“And your boxers.”

When he pushed them down, she saw his cock was thick and heavy with the swell of early arousal.

“Sit on the table.”

He gave another smile and lifted himself onto the table, his legs hanging over the side.

Nicole took her phone from her bag, unlocked it and opened the camera app. After setting it to video, she handed it to Ciaran and retreated to stand by his desk. “Film me.”

When Ciaran touched the screen and held up the phone, Nicole stared at the lens and unfastened the belt of her dress. Once it was open, she slid the dress back and off her shoulders, revealing her corset, stockings and uncovered sex. She slowly walked toward him, bringing each foot in as if walking on a tightrope and swinging her hips like a catwalk model.

When she stopped in front of him, Ciaran pointed the phone at her face. “You look fabulous, as usual.”

“Thank you.”

“How will we have sex if we’re socially-distanced?”

She tilted her head to one side. “Who said we were going to have sex?”

He frowned. Nicole took the phone from him, stopping the recording. “Lie back on the table.”

He did so, though rather than lying flat, he propped himself up on his elbows so he could watch her.

Lightning illuminated the sky again. A couple of seconds later, thunder rumbled over the noise from the rain on the glass.

Nicole reached into her bag and took out the phone holder. She fitted the phone into the jaws and switched the camera to selfie mode. When she pulled down her mask, Ciaran stared at her mouth. She’d chosen bright red lip-gloss identical to the shade of the lips on her mask. She slipped two fingers into her mouth and covered the tips in saliva, then slipped the mask

back over the lower half of her face. Amused by his expression, she used her wet fingers to dampen the sucker of the phone holder.

“What are you doing?” he asked.

She stuck the holder onto the table, by Ciaran’s hips. “I thought I’d get my own copy. And this one will be in high definition.”

“I’m not sure I want to be filmed.”

That’s rich.

“I’m not going to be filming you, because you’re not important. I’m just filming your dick.”

His smile returned. “So my dick’s important?”

She adjusted the angle of the phone until Ciaran’s crotch was centre-screen, then wrapped her fingers around his cock and looked into his face. “Yes, Ciaran, your dick’s important.” She slowly pumped her hand up and down, feeling his cock stiffen under her touch. “Your dick is all I’m here for.”

He let out a sigh. “If you’re here for my dick, then I suggest you climb aboard and make the most of it.”

She chuckled and stroked him faster. “No, that’s not on tonight’s menu.” Bending at the waist, she leant over him. Watching herself on her phone screen, she wiped the tip of his cock across her face, smearing a thin line of precum from one cheekbone, across the bridge of her nose to the other cheek. Then she wanked him fast again, cupping his balls with her other hand.

Another flash of lightning was followed by more thunder. Nicole pushed his cock against her mask, using her tongue to prod it through the material.

A groan rumbled in Ciaran’s throat.

Julian had suggested she play with herself, but she didn’t need to. She was so aroused she’d probably be able to make herself come just from contracting and relaxing her pelvic muscles but decided to delay her own orgasm until she got home. Her husband would give her the relief she needed.

“Nicole, I need to go inside you.” He was breathless.

“No, you don’t.”

He squeezed his eyes shut. “Okay, I don’t need to. But I really *want* to.”

“Yes, I suppose you do.” She pulled the mask down, then watched his face for a moment, enjoying his desperation as she took the head of his cock into her mouth, swirling her tongue over and around the glans.

“Ah...” Ciaran thrust up with his hips, forcing more cock into her mouth.

Nicole slowly pushed down, feeding his cock into her throat. It was much fatter than the bananas she’d practiced on, but it was warm and slippery. *Time to see if the practice has paid off.* She swallowed and kept pushing down until her nose was buried into his pubic hair. She could’ve grinned with pride—she’d taken the entire length of his cock in her mouth and throat.

Ciaran gasped. She slowly pulled back a couple of inches, then pushed down. And again. And again. She fucked him with her mouth, the tip of his fat cock sliding deep in her throat.

“Oh God, Nicole...”

Lightning lit up the sky, and this time the thunder crashed simultaneously. The storm was directly overhead.

Nicole’s tongue was never still, constantly licking and pushing against the lower side of his shaft.

“Oh, Jesus fucking... Ahh.”

Nicole bounced her head and glanced at the screen of her phone. With the red-painted mouth stretched wide around his fat cock and the hunger in her eyes, she hardly recognised herself. She bobbed her head and breathed through her nose.

“Nicole, I’m not going to last long like this. If you want to get fucked, it’ll have to be soon.”

She pulled back until just the head of his cock was in her mouth and wrapped her hand around the slick shaft. She pumped her hand while sucking and licking the dome of his cock.

“Oh, Jeez...”

She released his balls from her left hand and slid her fingertips up to his arse crack. As she pressed against his puckered hole, his legs jumped.

“Nicole, what are...?”

Watching his face, she sucked hard, pumped her hand, then pushed her finger up his backside.

Ciaran cried out and flooded her mouth. Pushing her finger deeper, she pumped him faster. A second spurt erupted, then a third. She kept all his cum in her mouth, her lips closed tight around his girth, and swirled her tongue around his cockhead until it stopped twitching. Finally, while holding eye contact, she relaxed the seal of her lips, allowing his cum to escape from her mouth and run down his shaft.

Gulping in deep breaths, he shuddered as his spunk soaked into his pubic hair.

Nicole removed her finger from his backside and released his cock from her mouth. She straightened, picked her phone up and licked her lips while staring into the camera. Then she re-fitted her facemask and stopped the recording.

She dropped her phone into her handbag and walked over to retrieve her dress, which she quickly put on and tied. Then she returned to the table where Ciaran still sprawled, pulled off the phone holder and dropped it into her bag.

Another flash of lightning was followed a couple of seconds later by thunder. The storm was moving away.

She ran her hand down Ciaran's thigh and smiled. "That was fun."

"Nicole, wait." He sat up and took a breath. "God, would you just give me a second—"

"Sorry babe, gotta go."

"Nicole..." He got off the table and glanced round for his boxers.

"I'll see myself out." As she walked toward the door, she looked up to where the camera must have been hidden for Julian's film. There was a tall set of bookshelves crammed with files and folders. Nicole waved toward them as she left.

She didn't see anyone in the corridor or on the stairs, and reception was empty. Slipping off her mask as she got to the door, she saw the rain was still torrential. The entire carpark was awash with puddles from the flash flooding. Her car was thirty yards away, and there was no way she could run in these shoes.

By the time she'd reached it and got inside, she was soaked to the skin. She viewed her reflection in the interior mirror. Her hair was plastered to her head and face, and her mascara and lip-gloss were both smudged. She looked almost comical. Nicole approached the exit, where the barrier was now down. She waited for the security guard to raise it, hoping he couldn't see the state of her, then waved her thanks and headed home.

She wondered how Julian had reacted to the note she'd left:

*Been summoned by my bull at short notice, so I've
gone to suck his cock as you ordered.*

Would it have turned him on enough to sneak upstairs for another wank?

By the time she pulled onto their drive, she was shivering. The rain had eased to drizzle. She walked up their drive and in through the backdoor.

Julian was waiting in the kitchen, and his eyes widened when he saw the state of her.

She glanced down at herself, then looked at him and shrugged. "I got caught in the storm."

He raked his eyes over her body in the dress. He stared at her soaked new shoes, then looked into her face.

She couldn't read his expression. He looked somewhere between desperate and angry. "Do you want to go upstairs?"

"Here's fine," he rasped. Stepping close, he pushed her against the kitchen wall.

Nicole gasped in shock as he roughly mauled her breasts through her soaked dress.

"How was your *bull*?"

She stared up into dark eyes, unsure how to react. Her note had been the first time she could remember using the term. "He was fine."

Julian yanked at the belt of her dress. "I'm sure he was. And how did he enjoy your visit?"

She'd never seen Julian behave this way. Though not scared, she was a little unnerved. As her dress was pulled open to reveal her underwear, Nicole arched her back to push out her chest. "I think he enjoyed it."

“I’m sure he did.” With an expression that was almost a sneer, Julian reached down and pushed his hand between her legs.

Nicole’s breath caught as he stabbed two fingers into her cunt. She reached up and gripped the back of his head. “He loved his blowjob.”

“And did you play with yourself?”

“No. I thought I’d wait to do that with you.”

“So you didn’t come for your bull?”

“No. I just sucked his cock.”

He smiled and fingered her harder. “But you like him to make you come.”

“Sometimes.”

“But not this time?”

Her legs were starting to tremble as she edged closer to her release. “No, this time I just did what you wanted me to do.”

“You didn’t want his cock?”

“I only wanted it in my mouth.”

“And that’s all you got?”

The wave was about to break. “Well, not just his cock...” She gasped, clenching around his fingers as they curled inside her. “I got his... cum in my mouth, too.”

As he opened his mouth to answer, she gripped his hair, pulled his head forward and pushed her tongue into his mouth. Julian groaned and moved his tongue against hers, pumping his arm as she came, her inner muscles spasming against his fingers.

Nicole wrestled with the buttons of his trousers, forcing them open and pulling his cock towards her. Her shoes were so high he managed to enter her standing up. She screamed as his hot cock pierced her cold body. He slammed into her and she came again, crying out as he yanked down her corset to free her breasts.

Wrapping one leg around his, she clung to him as he fucked her with force, his fingers pinching and twisting her nipples.

She sensed his anger. His frustration. His need. “Give me your cum.”

He stared into her eyes and kept pounding her.

“I want your cum.”

His eyes narrowed. “Slut.”

“Yes, I’m a slut. Now, give me your cum, because I’ve already had his.”

Julian’s mouth opened and his body shuddered as he fulfilled her request.

“Oh...” She raked her nails over his back as his cock jolted and twitched inside her. She closed her eyes and squeezed, grinding against him. A third, albeit weaker orgasm rolled through her—or maybe it was a late aftershock of her second.

They stilled and held each other for several seconds, then Nicole lowered her leg and looked into his eyes. “I need to get out of these wet clothes and have a hot shower.”

He nodded. “Leave your shoes here. I’ll tuck newspaper in them and put them on a radiator to dry.”

“Newspaper?”

“I had to do it with my rugby boots at school. It’ll help them dry and prevent them from shrinking.”

She stared at him for a second, thinking this a strange conversation to be having straight after sex. “You played rugby at school?”

His embarrassed smile returned. “Only during PE lessons. I wasn’t good enough to get on the school team.”

She stroked his arm, then used it for support as she pulled off first one shoe, then the other and passed them to him. “Thank you.”

He smiled, but looked down at the floor. “I apologise if I was—”

“No! Don’t apologise. I loved everything you did. Everything *we* did.”

He nodded.

“Julian?”

Finally, he looked her in the eye.

“I love when you treat me like that. I don’t want it all the time, because I love you and I want you to make love to me. But sometimes... Sometimes, I like to be your slut.”

“Right. Yes.” He blinked, then frowned. “But you also like being Ciaran’s slut.”

“Yes, I do.”

He stared for a second, and she wasn’t sure if there was more he wanted to say. When he didn’t add anything else, she smiled and went upstairs. If they were going to have a long conversation about who could do what to her, she wanted it to be when she was warm, dry and comfortable.



$$\Psi$$


A horizontal line with a small square box in the center, containing a horizontal bar.

Chapter Three

Nicole walked downstairs wearing a pair of leggings and sweatshirt. Her hair was still damp from the shower, but she was now warm. She found Julian sitting in the living room.

He gave a half-smile but looked unsettled.

“Are you okay?” she asked, sitting on the end of the sofa closest to his armchair.

He nodded apprehensively. “I still feel a little...” Taking a breath, he shook his head. “I shouldn’t have acted that way, and I shouldn’t have said those things.”

“Don’t say that. I loved it.”

“You’re just saying that to ease my conscience.”

“No, I’m not. You gave me exactly what I needed.”

“Really?”

“Really. This is the life we’ve chosen, and we both want it. I’d just sucked a guy off, which turned me on. I was horny as hell driving home. All I wanted was for you to give me release, and that’s exactly what you did.”

“But I wasn’t very... respectful.”

She laughed. “I don’t want your respect when I get back from a date. I want your need and your passion. I feel your respect and love every day of the week, and I cherish it. But on nights like tonight, when for just a short time we’re different people, I want us to act in a different way.”

“Are we different people?”

“Maybe not different, but we’re revealing a side we usually keep hidden.”

He nodded but didn’t look convinced. “I’m sorry I called you a...” He shook his head, the Julianesque embarrassed smile pulling the corners of his mouth up.

She laughed. “If anyone else called me that, I’d be hurt. But in the context of our new life, it’s not hurtful. When I see Ciaran, I’m playing the

role of a slut. I know that you didn't use the word as an insult."

He looked relieved. "Right, yes. Thank you." Another shadow of guilt crossed his face. "And I didn't hurt you... physically? I know I was a little—"

"No. Everything you did to me felt good." She leaned forward and smiled. "I thought the fact I came so quickly and so often might've shown how much I enjoyed it."

He laughed and nodded. "Thank you."

"Was it the note?"

"I suppose seeing you refer to Ciaran as your bull affected me."

"I thought it would. I'm glad I wrote it."

"Really?"

She nodded.

"Why?"

"Because when I got home, you reclaimed me."

"I did?"

"Yes. You used my body and reminded me that I'm your slut, which I loved."

"Ah. Right."

"Ciaran only gets what I choose to give him. Or, in tonight's case, what *you* chose. It's just a loan. But with you, it's not a loan. I'm yours. You can do whatever you want to me."

He laughed and shook his head. "No, I don't think that's true."

She held his gaze, thought about what she'd said, and nodded. "Yes it is. If there's something you want to do to me, especially when I get back from a date, you can do it."

"No, I don't think—"

"I'm your slut, Julian. I want you to use me in any way you please." Nicole sat on the edge of her seat and leaned closer to him. "But you have to be honest with me."

"Of course."

"You have to tell me what you want." The idea of him jerking off to a videoclip of her being fucked by Ciaran was flattering, but she could only

share his enjoyment if he told her about it. “You need to be open with me, like I’m always open with you.”

He took a breath, then hesitated.

Nicole thought he’d been about to confess about the video. She wanted him to tell her about it, rather than her reveal that she’d looked at his phone.

“Well?” She waited.

After a few moments, he rubbed his chin. “Are you saying that you don’t want me to tell you what to do with Ciaran?”

“What?” She shook her head, exasperated. “*No!* That’s not what I’m saying at all.”

“But you seem angry that I’d told you what to do with Ciaran tonight.”

“That’s not true. I like you telling me what to do. I got a special buzz tonight simply because it had been your idea.” She wondered if he’d diverted the conversation intentionally. Maybe telling him she’d do anything had been the wrong way to approach the subject of his desire to watch her with Ciaran.

Julian cleared his throat. “When I said there were things I’d like you to do, I didn’t mean to suggest that I expect to dictate what happens during *every* meeting.” He raised his eyebrows. “Is there anything in particular that you’d like to do with him?”

The question caught her by surprise. Though annoying that he’d managed to steer their discussion in a different direction, at least this was something she was happy to talk about. “Well, now you mention it, yes. There is.”

“Oh?”

“I’d like us both to be naked.”

“Naked?”

“Yes. In a bed. Getting fucked half-dressed lying on a hard desk or bending over it can be fun, but I want the comfort of a bed. And I want the thrill of a naked body pressed against mine.”

Although he didn’t say anything, she could tell his mind was working at a hundred miles an hour.

“Would you want to meet him here?” he finally asked.

“No.”

“The new house?”

She laughed. “Of course not. What’s wrong with you? And I wouldn’t want to go to his place, either. We’d use a hotel.”

“What if someone saw you?”

“I think there’s more chance of us being seen in the office than in a hotel.”

His eyes widened, and she wondered if he was thinking about the video.

She pushed a strand of hair behind her ear. “He can book the hotel and I’ll meet him in his room. Then I’ll leave by myself.”

Julian’s brow creased as he considered the logistics.

“We wouldn’t be seen together at all,” she explained. “It’s not like we’d have a drink in the bar or breakfast in the restaurant.”

“Breakfast?” His eyebrows were now up near his hairline. “You’d spend all night with him?”

“Yes. Unless he becomes too exhausted to satisfy me.” She smiled at his shocked reaction. “Don’t you like the idea of me being in bed with him?”

“It’s not.... I hadn’t actually thought about it, but—”

“Didn’t you allow your friends to take your Star Wars toys home for the evening?”

He guffawed. “No, I didn’t. But as you’ve pointed out many times, you’re not a possession that can be passed around.” He stared her directly in the eye. “If you want to spend a full night in a hotel bed with him, that’s fine with me.”

“Thank you.”

“Have you already arranged another date?”

“No, but he’ll get in touch with me soon. I didn’t take the paperwork with me tonight.”

“Did you forget it?”

She smiled. “No. I just thought it’d be nice to have an excuse for another date.”

“Ah. That was sneaky.”

She thought about using his finger to unlock his phone while he slept. “I’m a woman. We’re always sneaky.”

He laughed, then got up from his chair. “I suppose we’d better eat. Stir fry?”

She shook her head. “We’ve already packed away the wok. Let’s order a pizza.”

He nodded and phoned in their order, then read a report from work while waiting for the delivery. Nicole flicked on the TV and watched the end of an episode of Bake Off. Julian had sated himself as soon as she came through the door, and since walking him through the blowjob would only spike her own lust, she decided to save the details until he had the stamina to do something about it.

* * * *

Ciaran texted her early the next morning.

You didn’t bring the paperwork with you last night.

She tapped out a reply:

I need the company bank statements to link the transactions to the receipts and invoices.

Her phone pinged.

I’ll download and forward them later, then we can arrange another after-hours meeting.

Smiling, she replied:

Okay, but not at the office. Book a hotel.

His reply was instant.

Really?

A warm glow spread through her body.

Yes.

She allowed herself to imagine his naked body lying on top of hers in a comfortable bed. Her phone rang as soon as she put it down. She

thought it'd be Ciaran telling her he'd booked the hotel already, but the caller ID told her it was Julian.

He sounded excited. "I've just heard from the solicitor. We'll get the keys at the end of this week."

"Oh wow. Really?" That was almost two weeks earlier than they'd anticipated.

"I've spoken to the removal company. They can bring things forward to next Monday. I've just booked the week off as holiday."

"Great. I'll do the same." Nicole ended the call and couldn't stop grinning.

She decided to celebrate with a cup of tea, then returned to her laptop and rushed through the rest of her work. Two hours later, she closed down her laptop and drove to the local DIY store to buy more packing cases.

By the time Julian arrived home, she'd emptied the closet in the spare bedroom. The clothes in there were mainly the ones she rarely wore—party dresses, ball gowns and skimpy summer stuff she wore on holidays. As the garage was already full, she stacked the boxes she'd just filled around the floor of the room.

To make more room, Julian helped her dismantle the spare bed and they stood it up against a wall.

"Shall I order another pizza?" he asked.

"I picked up a pasta bake. If you're hungry now, I can put it in the oven."

"No rush. I'll finish off my office."

"Ciaran texted me about the paperwork I didn't take."

"Oh?" His eyes shone with anticipation.

"He liked the hotel idea."

"Has he booked it?"

"Not yet. But since we're both going to be off work next week, I might suggest we arrange it for then."

"Right. Yes, that'd make sense."

She leaned close. "Mmm. It makes sense because you'll be there when I get back. We can spend our day in our new home, talking about the

dirty things I did.”

“The dirty things you did with your bull,” he clarified.

She laughed. “The *slutty* things I did with my bull.”

He took a breath, then smiled. “I still can’t believe this is us, sometimes.”

“Me neither. Do you want to stop?”

He shook his head. “Definitely not.” He glanced up at the cupboard in the corner of the room where the central heating boiler was situated.

“That reminds me, the solicitor suggested we get that serviced before we move out. I’ve arranged for someone to come in on Friday. I’ll work from home that day.”

“Okay.”

They spent the rest of the evening packing, then ate dinner late. Nicole headed up to bed while Julian filled in the sales figures using his algorithm. Apparently, his team were finding it very useful.

He still hadn’t asked her for details of the blowjob.

* * * *

On Friday morning, the heating engineer arrived while they were still eating breakfast. Julian let him in and, as the guy carried in his tools from his van, Nicole went into the hall.

“Can I get you a tea or coffee?” she asked.

He smiled. “Coffee would be great, thanks.” He was in his early twenties and had curly blond hair pulled back in a short ponytail. He looked like a surfer.

“Milk and sugar?”

“Just milk.”

She went back to the kitchen while Julian showed him up to the spare bedroom that housed the boiler. As she poured the coffee, her husband arrived back in the kitchen, grinning.

Puzzled, she asked, “What?”

“Nothing. I just couldn’t help noticing...” He tilted his head up towards the ceiling.

“Help noticing what?”

“How you two looked at each other.”

“Don’t be absurd. I was just being friendly, and so was he.”

He leaned back against the counter and folded his arms. “Are you saying he’s not attractive?”

“I don’t know him. We’ve exchanged about half a dozen words in total, and that’s not enough to build up an attraction.”

“What about a physical attraction?”

She scoffed. “I hadn’t thought about it.”

“Well, he did. I saw the way his eyes swept over your body.”

She shrugged. Men had been sweeping their eyes over her body since she was a teenager.

“And,” he continued, whispering conspiratorially, “I saw the way your eyes swept over his.”

She sighed. “I think this new-found kinkiness is making your imagination over-active.” She passed him the coffee. “Take this up to him.”

“I think you should be the one to take it. He’d prefer it that way.” Julian bounced his eyebrows.

Nicole rolled her eyes but carried the mug upstairs. The guy was kneeling on the floor, sorting through his toolbox.

“Here you go,” she said.

“Thanks.”

Close up, she saw there were flecks of gold in his hazel eyes. He definitely was attractive. She looked around the room, which was rammed full of boxes. “Sorry it’s so cluttered.”

“It’s not a problem.”

“Well, give us a shout if you need anything.”

She headed back downstairs and found Julian waiting in the kitchen, smirking.

Nicole slapped his arm. “Will you get a grip?”

“Is that what you said to him?”

“I thought you had work to do?”

“I do, but as I’ve said before, you’re a distraction.”

“I’m a distraction? You’re the one who’s having all the dirty thoughts.”

“I am. I admit it. So why don’t you?”

“I’ve nothing to admit to.”

“I don’t mean why don’t you admit it. I mean why don’t you...?”
He tipped his head in the direction of the hall. *“...Have some fun.”*

“Are you mad?” She laughed at the audacity of the suggestion.

“You’re a hotwife. That’s what hotwives do.”

“No it isn’t. That’s what women in porn films do.”

“I just thought it’d be a nice way for you to start the week’s holiday. A little fun...”

“Julian, what do you think could really happen here? He’s just doing his job, and there’s a married couple in the house. His focus will be just on the boiler, I’m sure.”

When they heard the engineer coming down the stairs, she glared at her husband. *“Just behave.”*

The engineer appeared at the kitchen door. *“Hi. There’s a problem. The boiler’s showing an error, and I haven’t got the part it needs. I’ve phoned the plumbers’ merchant and they have one, but it’ll take me about half an hour to go pick it up. Will you be here to let me in when I get back?”*

“I have to go into work,” Julian said, *“but Nicole will be here.”*

“Great, thanks.”

After the engineer had left, she turned to her husband. *“You’re going into the office?”*

“Of course not, but it’ll give you two more oppor—”

“Julian! Nothing’s going to happen.”

He stared at her, then took a breath. *“I want it to. I... I want you to... You know.”*

She shook her head, puzzled. *“He’s not going to be interested.”*

“I think he is. He couldn’t keep his eyes off you.”

“I can’t do it here, in my home.”

“It won’t be your home by tomorrow, and he has no idea where we’re moving to. You’ll never see him again.”

She stared at him, speechless.

“You can stare all you like, but I can see from your eyes that the idea appeals.”

“I think the idea of sex with a fit young guy would appeal to any woman, but—”

He smiled. “So you’ll do it?”

“No. It’s crazy, and I wouldn’t have a clue how to—”

“How to seduce him? Really?”

She shook her head, wondering why he was acting this way.

“All you’d have to do is take him another cup of coffee, then wait for his approach.”

“There’d be no approach.”

“You could say something suggestive, or use your body language.”

“Why?”

“Why what?”

“Why are you pushing me into this?”

“I’m not pushing you, I’m showing what’s available... should you choose to take it.”

“And yet it doesn’t feel like it’s my choice.”

He smiled. “I’m sorry. What I’m trying to say is, if you felt the urge to have sex with a man who’s undoubtedly attracted to you, and who I believe you find attractive, then it’d be something I’d like to happen.”

“Why?”

“It turns me on.”

“And what, you’d drive around the estate for half an hour while I spread my legs for the plumber?”

He shook his head. “I’d drive my car to the next cul-de-sac and walk back. I’d want to be here while it happened.”

She stared at him, speechless.

He shrugged. “You told me you wanted me to be honest with you. This is as honest as I can be.”

Nicole’s mind raced, torn between relief that he was opening up, annoyance that he was still hiding things, and serious temptation. The

engineer *was* sexy.

“What are you thinking?” he asked.

“I don’t know if I could do it.”

“Why not just play it by ear? Maybe I’m wrong and he won’t make a pass. But I suspect he will.”

She looked into his eyes. Her stomach was in knots, yet heat bloomed between her legs. Temptation was pulling ahead. “Move your car.”

He nodded and grabbed his keys.

“I’m not saying yes,” she warned as he opened the backdoor. “I’m still thinking about it.”

He nodded again, then hurried out. A few minutes later he returned, a little out of breath. Maybe he’d jogged back.

She glanced down at her baggy t-shirt and denim skirt. “I look a mess.”

“No you don’t.”

Suddenly, she had a thought. “Go up to the spare room and get in the closet.”

“What?”

“It’s empty. You’ll be able to peep through the gap between the doors.”

He shook his head. “I can’t do that.”

“I know you like to watch me.”

His expression froze in a mask of shock.

“What’s the point of you being here if you can’t see it?”

“I thought I’d listen... from the office.” He was hyperventilating.

“If I’m going to do it, you should watch.” She glanced out of the kitchen window. “But you’d better hurry. Get comfortable in the closet, and you’ll need to stop panting like a dog.”

“Right. Yes.” He frowned. “Thank you.”

“Nothing will probably happen.”

He nodded, then left the kitchen and took the stairs two at a time.

Nicole’s heart banged in her chest. *Is this who I am now?* She reminded herself it was Julian’s idea. The doorbell made her jump. Taking a

steadying breath, she walked to the hall and opened the door.

The engineer smiled and held up a small cardboard box.

She stepped aside to let him in. “Is that it?” She’d been expecting something bigger.

“Yeah, it’s just a circuit board.”

“Oh, okay.”

He flashed her another smile and headed upstairs. Nicole listened, dreading the possibility of Julian being discovered. Then she went back into the kitchen, deciding to give him a couple of minutes before going up to offer him another coffee. She had no intention of strutting in wearing stockings and high heels and offering sex. That’s not how she wanted it to happen today.

With Ciaran, she always made a point of being in control during their meetings, mainly because she enjoyed baiting him. Nicole didn’t feel in control now, and that was fine. She was happy to just see where the situation went.

Deciding bare feet were sexier than fur-lined moccasins, she kicked off her slippers and walked slowly up to the spare bedroom, her tummy tingling with anticipation. The front of the boiler lay on the floor next to the engineer’s feet.

“Hi. Can I get you another drink?”

He turned his head. “No, I’m okay. But thanks.”

She smiled, stepped closer and looked at the inner workings of the boiler. “We hadn’t noticed any problems.”

“One of the sensors was only working intermittently. You may not have noticed because the radiators would still get some heat, and the water in your taps would still be quite hot.”

“Ah, okay. So, will it take you long?”

He held up a small circuit board. “No, this just slides into the slot.”

“Ooh,” she murmured, raising her eyebrows.

He laughed. “Sorry, that sounded a bit—”

“It sounded okay to me.” She moved alongside him. “Show me how it slides in.”

“Er...” He looked uncomfortable, glanced down at her bare feet, then turned to the boiler. Gripping the old circuit board, he pulled it out and held it up to show her. “First, we remove the one that’s not working properly.”

“Yep. If it’s not doing the job right, it has no right being in the slot at all.”

He held her gaze for a couple of seconds. “Then, we put a new one in its place.” After inserting the new board, he flicked the mains isolator switch, and a small LED window flashed twice before displaying the words ‘System Normal’. “Voila. The old boiler is happy.”

“Hmm, we’ve got to keep the old boiler happy.”

Smiling, he looked down at her feet again.

“So is that it? Have you finished?”

“I’ve finished the boiler. I should drain the system, clean out the filter and put in some fresh inhibitor.”

“Does it need it?”

“Not really, but it’s part of the service contract.”

“We’re moving tomorrow, so if you don’t do it, who’s to know?”

He glanced round at all the boxes. “And I thought you were just messy.”

“I like getting messy sometimes.”

He gave a nervous laugh.

“Does our contract include you servicing all the old boilers in the house?”

“What about your husband?”

“He’s not here.” She reached down, grabbed the hem of her t-shirt and lifted it up and over her head. After dropping it on the floor, she unfastened her denim skirt and let that slide down her legs. “Work keeps him so busy he doesn’t attend to the boiler as often as it needs.” Wearing only a white lacy bra and matching panties, she smiled. “Take your shirt off.”

He quickly complied. His hairless chest, well-toned abs and tanned torso reinforced her surfer theory. “Are you expecting your husband to come back anytime soon?”

She moved close and looked up into his face. “Why, how long do you think this’ll take?”

Before he could answer, she went up on tiptoes and kissed him gently on the lips.

“Are you sure?”

She gave her answer by running her hand over the bulge in his work trousers.

He looked around the cluttered room. “Is there somewhere we can go?”

Nicole walked over to the packing boxes directly opposite the closet and pushed on one to see if it’d take her weight. It was crammed full of jackets and coats, and only sagged a little as she sat on the lid. “This seems like a good place to me.” She slowly parted her legs.

He stared at her but didn’t move. She gripped the gusset of her panties and pulled it aside. His gaze dropped to her sex. He stepped forward and opened his trousers. Nicole wrapped her fingers around his cock and took it into her mouth, making him gasp.

Looking up into his face, she bobbed her head a few times, then released him. “Go inside me.”

He dropped to his knees and positioned the tip of his cock at her entrance.

Still holding the gusset, she watched his face as he pushed into her dripping sex. “Ahh...” She wrapped her arms around his shoulders and pulled him close but kept her eyes fixed on the gap between the doors of the closet.

He fucked her slowly, his cock sliding deliciously in and out of her drenched channel.

“Oh, that feels good.” She stroked her hands over his back, pushing her feet up onto her toes to present herself at a better angle so his cock could slide deeper. Closing her eyes, she enjoyed the ripples of pleasure running through her body.

He was surprisingly gentle, tracing his fingertips over her neck and shoulders. Then he slid his hands down and caressed her breasts through the bra.

Keeping her eyes fixed on the closet, she kissed his ear and neck, rocking her hips to meet his thrusts. She let out a moan as the first tremors of the approaching orgasm fluttered through her lower body.

Maybe Julian would have preferred her to talk dirty and put on a slut's performance, but that wasn't going to happen today. The guy was too nice and too considerate in the way he touched her.

After reaching round to unclasp her bra, he gently stroked the sides of her boobs, his fingertips skating lightly over the skin. Her taut nipples grazed against his smooth chest. He continued to thrust with a slow, steady rhythm, and her orgasm built at the same pace, each prod from his cock pushing her a little closer, winding the spring a little tighter.

She moaned again and gripped his shoulders. Her eyes fluttered and her legs trembled. She was almost there and getting desperate for release. Jerking her hips, she lowered her hands to his buttocks and pulled him deep.

Finally, her orgasm broke. Screaming out in surprise at its intensity, she held him close and stared over his shoulder at the gap in the closet doors. Her whole body shook with the spasms, the aftershocks keeping her body on fire. She needed more contact, wanted him pressing down on her.

Wrapping her arms around his back, she lay down on the boxes and pulled him with her. He lifted himself up, resting his hands on the boxes, then started pumping his hips.

Nicole brought her legs up, knees bent and feet bouncing in time with his thrusts. She could tell from his expression that he was moving toward his own finish. She closed her eyes and concentrated on the sensations: the sharp edge of the boxes digging into her back and neck, the slick cock sliding in and out of her, the thought of her husband watching it all happen.

Her eyes snapped open. She was on the brink of coming again.

The guy frowned. "I'm getting close." He was breathless.

"Good."

"Where do you want it?"

She wondered if Julian would prefer the spectacle of seeing him come over her, but that wasn't how she wanted this to end.

"Inside me."

"You sure?"

She nodded, knowing she'd come at the same time.

Staring directly into her eyes, he pounded hard a few more times and then held still. The tendons in his neck stood out and his cock shuddered as the first jet erupted from him. It was enough to push her over the edge and send her tumbling into another bout of contractions and trembling limbs.

Her cries turned to yelps as he resumed his thrusts, bouncing her on the unsteady boxes as he rode out the surges of his own release. She wrapped her legs around his, worried the boxes would collapse, and stared up into his face until he finally stilled.

He took a deep breath and held it, then slowly exhaled. He looked exhausted, shocked and ecstatic.

Nicole couldn't help smiling. "Thank you."

He slowly eased out of her and stood up. After tucking himself away and fastening his trousers, he pulled on his shirt. Nicole slipped her t-shirt over her head and stood up. The shirt was long enough to cover her panties, so she didn't bother with her skirt or bra.

He looked around the room. "I guess I should let you get on with your packing."

She nodded. "And I should let you get on with servicing the next boiler."

He gave a nervous laugh. "Yeah, though I doubt any of them will be anything like this one."

He quickly packed his tools away, slipped the faulty circuit board into a side pocket of his work trousers and picked up his toolbox. Nicole glanced at the closet door as she made her way out of the bedroom and down the stairs. The engineer took out a sheet of paper and wrote something on it. For a second she thought he was giving her his number, but it was a signed certificate to confirm the boiler had been serviced.

She placed her hand on the doorknob, then stood up on tiptoes and kissed his cheek. "Bye."

He left, got in his van and reversed out of the drive.

By the time she got to the top of the stairs, Julian was standing on the landing. His eyes blazed and his breathing was shallow and ragged.

Stepping close, she stared up into his face. "Well?"

“It was...” He shook his head, looking dazed. “It was much more intense than I’d expected.”

“Oh?” This surprised her—surely the film of Ciaran fucking her bent over the desk was much more intense. What she’d just done with the plumber felt almost romantic in comparison.

“What I mean is, witnessing it was much more intense. I hadn’t considered some things.”

Although she was curious about what he meant, she got the impression he needed something more than a conversation. “Are you going to take me to bed now?”

His eyes widened. “Would you want to? I mean, you’ve only just—”

“I didn’t do it for me.” She placed her hand on his chest. He was trembling, and his heart thumped against her palm. “I did it so you could watch.” Before he could answer, she took his hand and led him to their bedroom. She pulled off the t-shirt and stood in front of him in just her panties. “Shall I take a shower?”

“You already know the answer to that.”

She nodded and began undoing his shirt. “But this one’s still warm.”

Julian shuddered.

“I shouldn’t have let him come inside me. I don’t know anything about him. It was reckless.”

“Sit on the bed.”

She did as she was told. He dropped to his knees, slipped his fingers in the waistband of her panties and slowly pulled them down her thighs. She was keenly aware of the gooey mess oozing out of her. She felt wetness on her ankles and feet as he slid the sodden garment off.

“Open your legs.”

Looking into his eyes, she slowly parted her thighs.

Julian lurched forward and sank his face into her sodden crotch. She yelped in surprise, then squealed in shock as his tongue pushed through the sticky mess and lapped at her drenched and still-tender sex. She tried to push his head away, grossed out by what he was doing, but his fingers gripped her hips and pulled her onto his face.

“Julian!”

He brought one hand round and pushed three fingers roughly into her. She squealed again, and he pumped his arm like a piston, curling his fingers up against her G-spot as his lips clamped round her clit and his tongue prodded and swirled.

She arched her back off the bed as she came, blue-white flashes skittering across the backs of her eyelids. He didn't relent, his fingers and tongue pressing hard, hurting her in the most beautiful way.

She gripped his hair and tugged hard. She kept pulling, and his face moved up to her mons, her tummy, then her chest. He kissed her every inch of the way and kept his fingers buried in her cunt.

When his face was immediately over hers, she leaned up and licked the mess from all around his mouth, chin and cheeks, tasting her own juices as well as the cum that had leaked out. Julian shivered and whimpered. She thought he might actually cry.

“Put your dick in me.”

He withdrew his hand, wrestled his trousers open and guided himself into her.

Nicole clamped her hands on the sides of his head. “Fuck me.”

He pushed in hard, hurting her.

She groaned and wrapped her legs around his. She wanted to be hurt. “Harder. Fuck your cheating slut.”

He pushed into her again and again, his jaw clenched.

“Fill me. Flush out all his cum with your own.”

His eyes widened at her words, then they fluttered. His body went rigid and his cock jerked as it unloaded.

Nicole writhed and undulated beneath him, gripping his buttocks as she pumped her hips and ground her clit. She was too tender to come again, but she was enjoying the pain.

Eventually, they both stilled. They lay locked together, both breathing hard. She could feel his heartbeat as well as her own.

After several minutes, the silence became a little awkward. Nicole pushed him to one side, and he rolled off and lay beside her. It was uncomfortable with their legs hanging off the edge of the bed, so they crawled up until their heads were on the pillows.

He looked as shocked as she felt. “What just happened?” she asked quietly.

“I’m sorry, I—”

“No. I’ve told you before, don’t ever apologise for what you do to me. I just want us to talk about it.”

He averted his eyes. “I don’t know what I...” He breathed hard, his lip wobbling. “I hadn’t planned that. I don’t even know why...”

When he sobbed, Nicole placed her hand on the side of his face. “Hey, come on. Don’t be embarrassed.”

He swallowed, took a couple of deep breaths then looked into her eyes. “Watching you earlier. Watching you was...” He sighed. “God, it was like nothing I’d imagined.”

You’ve watched me before. “Why?”

“It was so... Your flirting, the ‘sliding it in the slot’ and ‘servicing this boiler’. Your body language. I don’t think you’re aware of the effect you have on men.”

She smiled. “I was worried it’d come across like cheesy porn-dialogue.”

“I suppose it did, a little. When you kissed him, I thought my head would explode.”

“Just your head?”

He grinned, wiping his eyes dry. “Among other parts. As for sitting on the packing case and moving your panties to flash your...” He hesitated and blinked.

“My cunt. I showed him my cunt.”

“Yes. Right, your... Your cunt. When you did that, I worried that I might actually faint and give the game away.”

She giggled at the image of Julian falling pale-faced and sweaty from the closet. “Well, I’m glad you didn’t.”

“Then you sucked him. You took his dick into your mouth and looked up into his face as you sucked him. That was incredibly sexy to watch.” Julian’s eyes shone. “Then, when he was fucking you, there were so many details I wasn’t expecting. Your moans, the sound of your bodies. I could even hear his dick sliding in and out, the squelching noise it made. And I could smell your juices.”

“Eww!”

“No, it was wonderful. And when you stared in my direction, I could see the pleasure in your face. I could see you enjoying yourself with him.”

“I was worried that you’d want it to be more... physical. More vigorous fucking.”

He shook his head. “No. What do you mean?”

“I thought you might want to see different positions, dirty talk, the sort of things they put in porn films.”

“I found what you did incredibly sexy.”

“And what about the clean-up you just performed?”

“I...” He glanced away for a second, then back into her eyes. “I’ve read that some men enjoy it, as do their wives. It never occurred to me that I’d want to do it, but when I saw all his...” He nodded toward her lower half.

“His cum.”

He laughed. “I was going to say spunk.”

“Okay, spunk’s fine. Or jizz. Just as long as you call it what it is.”

“Well, when I saw it, I just...” He shrugged. “I’m sorry.”

“Don’t be. If that’s what you want to do, I’m not going to stop you.”

“It isn’t. At least, I don’t think it is.” He frowned again. “It’s a little embarrassing, to be honest.”

“Nothing we do together should embarrass you. What goes on between us stays between us.”

“Thank you.”

She flashed a grin. “Want me to sit on your face so you can taste your own?”

“No. The thought of what I did makes me a bit queasy now. But in the heat of the moment—”

“I get it. You were all revved up and horny for anything, but now...” She shrugged. “We all get like that. I get the urge to do things when I’m building up to an orgasm, but after it’s passed, I don’t want to do them anymore.”

“What like?”

Thoughts of sliding her finger up Ciaran's backside flashed through her mind, but she decided to give another example. "Once with one of my boyfriends at uni, we played with food. The idea of getting strawberry mousse rubbed all over my boobs and vagina turned me on, but afterwards it was sticky and uncomfortable."

"You've never told me that story before."

"No. But now that I know you like the idea of me with other men, I might tell you about some other things I've done." She stroked his face.

"I'm glad now that you made me do it. With the plumber."

"I didn't make you. I encouraged you."

"Hmm."

"And you seemed to enjoy it."

"Yes, I did." She sat up. "I need a shower, then I'll wash the bedding and get it dried so we can take it to our new house and sleep there tonight."



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Chapter Four

Nicole woke early and stared up at the ceiling of her new bedroom. They'd slept at Parkside Grange for the last three nights. Today, their furniture would be moved from their old house.

Sliding out from beneath the quilt, she stretched and then walked along the galleried landing, down the wide staircase and into their fabulous kitchen. She couldn't help smiling as she clicked on the coffee machine. Five minutes later she and Julian were drinking coffee in bed.

"So," she said, pushing a strand of hair behind her ear, "what's the plan for today?"

"The removal men are due at our old house at ten. I'll be there to let them in and show them where all the boxes and furniture are."

She winced. Workmen didn't always take to Julian. "Don't micromanage them. I'm sure they know what they're doing."

"I promise to take a very hands-off approach. All I'll do is show them the boxes in the garage and the boxes in the spare bedroom." He

grinned. “Or your ‘fuck-room’, as I like to think of it now.”

She slapped his arm.

“You can come along if you want, or you can wait here. In truth, it won’t take them long as I believe there will be four men.”

She rubbed her leg against his. “Ooh, that sounds tempting.”

He stared at her, wide-eyed.

“Sorry, I was joking.”

Julian swallowed, then continued. “I’ll drive back here so I can show them where to put the furniture and boxes. They’ll probably be finished by one.”

“Great. I’ll have a shower and make breakfast.” With that, Nicole got out of bed and headed into the en-suite.

Fifteen minutes later she was dressed in jeans and a sweatshirt, making scrambled eggs and toasted bagels. After they’d eaten, Julian headed off to their old house and Nicole sat in her new kitchen, grinning.

When the removal men arrived at the new house, Julian was true to his word and didn’t interfere with their work. The men were efficient and jovial, and Nicole made them bacon rolls and coffee. As Julian had predicted, they’d finished and left by early afternoon.

“How about we leave things for now?” he suggested. “I want to get my hair cut, and we have all week to get things straight here.”

“Fine. I’ll come with you and we can have a wander round town.”

As he drove past the turning to their old estate, Nicole said, “I’ll take the Hoover there tomorrow and clean up before we hand the keys over.”

“Good idea. I’ll come with you and dig up any plants you want to keep.”

After parking in the town centre, they wandered around the shops arm in arm. When Julian went to the barber’s, he seemed surprised when she said that she’d accompany him rather than continue shopping. Once in the chair, he asked the barber for just a trim.

“Actually,” she said, leaning forward and holding his gaze via the mirror, “why don’t you get it cut quite short?”

He patted his head. “It’s getting a bit thin, so I usually—”

“Leaving it long doesn’t hide the fact it’s thinning out, which is nothing to be ashamed of. If you don’t like it, you can always grow it again.”

Julian stared at her for a second, then nodded at the barber. “Do as the lady asked.”

She watched as the barber put down his scissors and picked up electric clippers. Julian’s dark locks fell to his shoulders and onto the floor around him as the barber buzzed it short.

The barber stood back, and Julian looked at her reflection. “Is that better?”

His comb-over style had annoyed her for a while. As had something else. Seizing the moment, she smiled and dragged her finger over her upper lip.

“You want my moustache trimmed?”

She smiled and repeated the action, more forcefully this time.

“Shave it off?” He looked horrified. “But I’ve had this for twenty years.”

“Like with your hair, you can always grow it back.”

He sighed, then nodded to the barber. In less than a minute, Julian was bare-faced.

Nicole stared at her husband in the mirror. He looked so different, she was now unsure if her suggestions had been good ones. After Julian had paid and tipped the barber, they stepped outside to discover it had started raining. They quickly returned to their car and drove back to their new house.

During the drive, Nicole noticed Julian running his tongue over his top lip. She imagined it must feel weird to have no facial hair after so long. “If you’re missing your hairy friend too much, don’t shave for a few days. You could even see what you look like with a beard...”

He laughed. “I guess so much has changed for us in the last few weeks that a missing moustache seems neither *hair* nor *there*.”

Nicole groaned at his pun, then placed her hand on his thigh. “I’m enjoying the changes.”

“So am I.”

“I’m enjoying them so much,” she continued, “that tonight I’ll cook you steak using my fabulous cooker in my wonderful kitchen.”

He laughed. “Splendid.”

“And after that, I’m going to show you how I sucked off my bull.”

His breathing became shallow.

“Would you like that?”

He nodded vigorously.

“Good.”

They spent the next hour or so in the kitchen, transferring stuff from boxes to the cupboards. Even with all their possessions unloaded, there were still several empty cupboards and drawers.

“I can’t believe how much space there is in here.” She smiled at him. “Maybe we could have another full day shopping for pots and pans instead of shoes and lingerie.”

He grimaced. “Stuff like that you can order online.”

She chuckled, then looked at their fancy coffee machine. “I’m going to try a latte. What do you want?”

“Cappuccino, please.”

She studied him for a few seconds, taking in his changed appearance. He looked younger, and definitely sexier. “I like your hair short. I also think losing the moustache really suits you, but if you’re missing it too much I won’t mind if you grow it back.”

He wiped his hand across his smooth lower face. “Let’s see how it goes.”

They drank their coffee at the kitchen table, looking out at their garden. Nicole was looking forward to spending many hours out there over the next few months.

“I think you should have a shower.” She leaned close and nibbled his earlobe. “I don’t want you all sweaty until afterwards.”

His eyes widened and he took a breath. “Right. Yes.”

She saw him swallow, and laughed. “Stop looking so nervous. I’ll be gentle with you.”

“Not too gentle, I hope.”

She held his gaze. “That depends on you.” Tonight she intended to find out about the video he had on his phone.

Julian got up and headed upstairs. Nicole turned on the Bluetooth speaker, set a playlist on her phone, then began preparing dinner.

Julian returned wearing chinos and a polo shirt. “Shall I open a bottle of wine?”

“Will you still be able to get an erection?”

He guffawed. “If I can’t, I’m sure you’ll be able to help.”

“Open the wine, then go and sit in the dining room.”

“That’s still full of boxes.”

“Oh. Let’s eat in here, then.”

Julian wandered off and came back with a bottle of red. Taking two glasses from the cupboard, he went to the table and poured them. Nicole plated his dinner and carried it across to him.

His eyes gleamed as she presented him with mushroom and cream sauce on his steak. “Thank you.”

“I think I should be saying that. You’re the one who got promoted, and you’re the one whose salary allows us to live here.”

His embarrassed smile seemed weird without his moustache, but she thought it was a definite improvement.

They talked about the things they hoped to get done in the upcoming week, though neither mentioned the fact that Julian would spend Wednesday night home alone while Nicole was in a hotel with Ciaran. Once finished they adjourned to their lounge, where she closed the blinds, lit the fire and sat on the couch next to her husband. When their glasses were empty, Julian stood up to refill them and Nicole headed upstairs. She’d decided to dress up for the occasion.

A few minutes later, she returned to the lounge in her black lace corset and thong, hold-up stockings and high-heeled shoes. Julian’s jaw dropped. She walked slowly across the room and stood by the fireplace, facing her husband. His gaze wandered down her body, the flickering flames reflected in his eyes.

“I thought I’d dress up for you, for a change.”

“Thank you.”

“And if you like, I’ll also play with myself.”

He smiled. “I still wish you’d done that for Ciaran.”

This surprised her a little. “Why?”

“I want him to...” He shrugged. “I want him to yearn for you.”

“He’s already come on my belly, in my cunt and in my mouth. I doubt watching me jill off would do much for him.”

“My asking wasn’t for him. It was for me.”

“For you?”

He nodded.

“Why?”

“I want you... I like the idea of you being a slut. For them.”

She stared at him, confused. Surely by letting other men fuck her, she *was* being a slut for them. “Isn’t that what I’m doing?”

“It’s arousing to imagine him watching you do filthy things.”

“I sucked his cock and let his cum dribble from my mouth. Isn’t that filthy enough for you?”

He gave a smile. “It’s more than I could ever have dreamed of. But you asked me to be honest, so I’m trying. I want you to act more provocatively with the men you sleep with. The thought of it turns me on.”

Is this for when he watches it on video afterwards? “You mean talk dirty to them?”

“I mean *be* dirty to them.”

Maybe he thought she wasn’t up to the task of being a hotwife. She’d have to up her game. “Go upstairs and stand by the bed.”

Looking like a scolded schoolboy, he lowered his head and left the room.

Nicole stayed where she was for a few moments, planning her next move before following him. Teasing him was on the menu tonight, so keeping him waiting would do him good. When she finally made it to the bedroom, Julian was still dutifully standing on the far side of the bed, his hands clasped.

Keeping her shoes on, she lay on her back in the middle of the bed and looked up into her husband’s eyes. “It’s a pity I threw away my vibrator when I packed up the bedroom stuff.”

His brow creased. "You owned a vibrator?"

She hadn't, but suspected that'd change in the next few weeks. "I've not needed it for a while because I've had fresh cock to satisfy me."

He looked like he'd been slapped. If he wanted her to act slutty with other men, she'd need to practice on him.

"And now I know you like me getting fresh cock," she said, "there's not really any need for my vibrator."

His nostrils flared. "I'd like you to have one."

"So buy me one." She ran her hand down her tummy to her mons and stroked herself through the thong. "But since fresh cock's not available to me right now, I'll have to use my fingers."

Julian swallowed, his eyes still on her face.

Teasing herself through the thin gusset, she looked up into his face. "Is this the sort of thing you wanted me to do for Ciaran?"

He nodded once.

She stroked herself through the material until her clit began that soft, insistent throbbing sensation, then slipped her fingers inside the waistband and back down to her crotch. Her outer lips were already slick. She slid her fingertip through the folds and sighed.

Julian's gaze flicked between her face and her crotch.

She pumped her fingers in and out, making squelching noises they could both hear. He swallowed again.

"Do you want me to make myself come like this, or would you prefer I removed my thong?"

"Take it off."

She smiled, then dug her high heels in the bed and arched her body between her feet and shoulders. "Pull it down."

Julian slipped his fingers around the thin cords high on her hips, then peeled the thong down her thighs. Nicole kept her fingers between her outer lips. She lowered her backside to the bed and let him slip the thong over her feet.

She smiled up at him, bent her legs and let them fall open. "Can you smell my arousal?"

He nodded.

Nicole worked her fingers, teasing herself by rocking her cupped hand over the mons while sliding a single finger in and out of her hole. “Did you know that Ciaran said that to me when he came to dinner?”

Julian frowned and shook his head.

“During our first meeting, your boss told me he could smell my cunt juices. I worried that it might be true, because I was wet throughout the entire evening.”

He took a breath but didn’t comment. His gaze had now settled on her crotch.

“I’ve made sure that he’s smelled my arousal every time we’ve met since. And I’ve smelled his. I’ve even tasted his arousal, just like you told me to.”

His gaze moved back to her face.

“Do you like the idea of me swallowing his cum?”

He nodded, his jaw clenched.

“Next time I’ll swallow it all. Last time, I let it run back out of my mouth. I thought it gave it a better visual, and I know how you like to watch.”

He frowned again, looking anxious.

She was now too close to her orgasm to follow up. She rocked her hand, fingered herself harder. As her legs began to tremble, she moved her fingers up to her clit and gently stroked it to get over the final hurdle. “Ahh...”

Squeezing her eyes shut, she melted into the climax. Her entire body thrummed as she arched up, bucking her hips against her palm. She moved her hand lower and slipped three fingers into her wet channel, pumping hard and fast until the spasms faded.

Dropping her bum back down onto the bed, she let out a contented sigh and opened her eyes. Julian stared at her with a look of wonder. She smiled, then withdrew her fingers and held them up. “Do you want to taste them, or doesn’t it work for you without my bull’s cum?”

He looked momentarily shocked, then bent and took her fingers into his mouth, sucking greedily and licking them clean.

Nicole adjusted her position until she was kneeling on the bed. “Get your dick out.”

After he'd complied, she wrapped her fingers around the shaft and squeezed out a huge pearl of clear precum. She pinched it between her thumb and forefinger and sucked them clean with her painted lips. "Is this how you want me to act with my bulls?"

He held her gaze for a few seconds, then nodded.

"You like the idea of me being slutty?"

"Yes."

"I'll be slutty, if that's what you want."

"Thank you."

She leaned close and ran her tongue around the head of his cock, making him shudder. "I can do anything you want. All you have to do is tell me what it is..." She took his cock into her mouth and swirled her tongue.

He let out a groan and closed his eyes.

Nicole released him and dragged her hair over his cock. "Ciaran likes my hair." She wrapped the long, soft tresses around Julian's cock and began to pump him. "Maybe I should wank him off like this." She pumped faster. "I can't do it in the office because your colleagues would see me walking back through reception, my hair drenched with your boss's cum. But I could do it in the hotel on Wednesday night. Then he can take me into the shower and wash my hair. And my body."

Julian's breathing was ragged. She'd teased him enough. It was time for answers. "You should have played with yourself while I was. You could have come all over me. I'd have liked that."

"Me too." His voice was a breathless rasp.

"Maybe I'll suggest it to Ciaran, but it'd work better with more men. Have five or six cocks spraying over me at the same time." She giggled at his stunned expression. "I guess seeing that would give you a big thrill, huh?"

He seemed too embarrassed to answer.

She gave him a placating smile. "Don't worry. It's flattering that you get turned on by me having sex with others. But I want you to tell me everything."

"I do tell you everything."

"No you don't."

“Yes I—”

“I saw you jerking off last week.”

His jaw dropped.

“I got out of the bath to invite you to join me. I looked through the door and saw you in the mirror.”

He swallowed, looking contrite.

She sensed his erection beginning to wilt in her fist, so pumped him faster and smiled. “Stop looking so worried. I probably masturbate more often than you do.” This seemed to send his mind in another direction, but she pulled him back. “I also saw what you were watching on your phone at the time.” She chose not to admit yet exactly how she’d seen what he was watching. “It was a recording of me in Ciaran’s office.”

Julian started hyperventilating. His cock withered, so she released it and placed both hands on her thighs.

“I couldn’t hear the soundtrack, though. You shouldn’t have muted it, because I screamed all the way through that part.”

“It’s... I didn’t...” He blinked and swallowed. “There’s no audio.”

“Well if you like, we can watch it together and I’ll overdub the soundtrack for you.”

His attempt at a smile failed. He looked like he might cry. “I’m sorry. I... I only wanted—”

“Were you checking to see if I was being completely honest about what I got up to with Ciaran?”

“No. There’d be no need to lie when you know what I want to happen. It was just that...” He sighed and shrugged, looking like a child caught stealing money from his mother’s purse.

“Did Ciaran offer to let you see how much your wife loves getting nailed over his desk? Or maybe that was part of the arrangement you two have—he gets to fuck me, and you get to watch.”

He shook his head vigorously.

She tutted. “Personally, I don’t think it’s worth watching if the picture is such poor quality. I told Ciaran I wanted to see myself in high definition. I mean, what’s the point of me putting on all that makeup if—” She stopped and stared at her husband. His already pale face had gone completely white.

He took short, gasping breaths, looking like he might actually faint. “You told *Ciaran* about it?” he croaked.

She’d actually been talking about the recording she’d made with her own phone, but it was becoming clear that Ciaran wasn’t involved in recording the secret footage. She stared at him in disbelief. “You planted the camera without him knowing, didn’t you?”

He nodded.

“Have you filmed everything I’ve done in there?”

“No, only that time.”

“Is the camera still there on his shelves?”

“No, I removed it early the following morning. I—”

“What the fuck were you thinking? Planting a camera in your boss’s office is probably a sackable offence. You could have lost your job.”

He paused, mouth open. Then he exhaled. “I wasn’t thinking straight.”

“Obviously.” She shook her head. “What happened to the placid, thoughtful, sensible man I married?”

He blinked and stared at her, a rabbit caught in the headlights.

“Why on earth would you risk everything you’ve worked for just to get yourself some wank material? Is that all I am to you now? Something you pass around as a way of getting your jollies?”

“No! Of course not. I love—”

“Really? Because loving someone doesn’t include planting a secret camera so you can watch them. So you can watch me be the slut you want me to be.”

“I just... I was just so desperate to see it for myself. When you’re with him, my mind fills with images. I try to picture you in the way you describe, and I...” He managed a half-smile. “I even dream, sometimes, about what goes on when... You know.”

“I tell you everything we do.”

“Yes, I know. But it never feels like enough, and my mind keeps thinking of questions to ask, details I need that occur to me later...” He sighed. “So, when I saw the advert for a spy-camera, it seemed like the answer to a prayer.”

Nicole shook her head. How had she changed her caring husband into a peeping Tom? Or was this part of him always there, lurking in the shadows? She knew it was all her own fault. Her infidelity had started this. She was the one who fucked Sam, who'd flirted with Ciaran, who'd clung onto his shoulder as he fingered her to a climax on her first trip to his office. She sighed and shook her head. "I'll tell you whatever you want to know. I let you watch with the plumber, and we can do something like that again if it's what makes it better for you."

His face brightened, but then the worried frown returned. "What am I going to say to Ciaran?" Panic seemed to be bubbling just under the surface.

Now she felt guilty for letting him stew for so long. "Nothing. I'm pretty sure I didn't tell him I'd seen the film of us, I just made some vague remark about making my own copy in high definition."

He closed his eyes and sighed. "Really? He doesn't know?"

She shook her head, and her anger dissipated. He'd looked terrified at the thought of Ciaran knowing what he'd done. "I remember the days when you wouldn't have even taken a pencil from your boss's office in case you got into trouble."

Finally, he smiled. "I suppose this new lifestyle is having an effect, blurring my perspective of what's right and what's wrong."

"Hmm, obviously." She nodded toward his limp dick. "We're supposed to be having sexy fun."

He ran his hand through his shorter hair, then let out a long breath. "I seem to have lost some of the impetus I had earlier."

"I don't care about your impetus, I just want you to get your hard-on back."

He laughed. "I can try."

"I'm pretty sure I know what'll make it hard again." She lifted it between finger and thumb and kissed the tip gently. "Shall I tell you about the film *I* made?"

"Huh?"

She wrapped her fingers around the soft shaft of his cock and tightened her grip. "When I gave Ciaran the blowjob, I filmed it."

He stared at her, a look of disbelief on his face. "Are you trying—?"

“It’s true. I filmed it all on my phone. The picture is much clearer than the one you have, *and* there’s audio.”

“Really?”

She nodded, aware that his cock was thickening slightly.

“Does Ciaran know?”

“How could he not know? I stuck the phone holder on the table right next to him so I could get a close up of my mouth working his dick.”

“And he let you?”

“I was about to suck his dick. He’d have let me tattoo his thighs if I’d asked.”

Just as Julian was about to say something else, Nicole pushed her head forward and took his cock into her mouth. He groaned, burying his fingers in her hair. She teased the head with her tongue until he was fully hard, then pulled back, smiling.

“If you ask me nicely, we can watch it in bed together one night.”

“That would be—”

His words caught in his throat as she pushed forward and introduced him to her new deep-throating skills. He shuddered and groaned, pushing his hips forward and dropping his head back.

Nicole held him there for a few moments, then pulled back and released him. She looked up into his face. “That’s enough talking. Now I’m going to give you what I gave Ciaran. But I don’t want to get the sheets dirty, so I’m going to swallow everything you give me, okay?”

He nodded eagerly.

She closed her eyes and pushed forward, taking him all the way into her throat again. Moving her tongue rhythmically against the lower side of his shaft, she began to slowly bob her head.

Julian let out low, grateful murmurs as she continued to slide his cock in and out of her throat. She brought a hand up and cupped his balls, which raised the pitch of his moans a semitone. The trembling of his legs told her he was already close.

She tightened her grip on his balls and bobbed her head faster. Julian’s moans grew louder, then he yelped and shuddered. The tip of his cock was beyond her tastebuds, but the heat of his cum flushing down her throat announced his orgasm. That, and the fact his entire body twitched as

if electrocuted. She gripped his buttocks and held him fast while he spasmed and flinched. Only when he stilled did she ease back and release him from her mouth.

She looked up into his face and held his gaze. “Was that slutty enough?”

He was close to tears.

* * * *

Over the next two days, they unpacked the rest of their boxes. They also visited their old house one last time, with Nicole vacuuming throughout while Julian dug up six of her favourite shrubs from the garden.

On Wednesday afternoon, Nicole announced she was going to take a bath and get ready for her night with Ciaran. She smiled at her husband’s barely contained excitement.

She shaved her legs in the bath, then moved into the shower to wash and condition her hair. She’d decided what to wear while packing the boxes the previous week. In the closet of clothes she rarely wore, she’d found the perfect outfit: a dark grey lambswool cardigan. It was fitted, came down to mid-thigh, and had a zip up the front. Nicole intended wearing only that with her new peep-toed fuck-me shoes.

Another thing she’d decided was to insist Ciaran wear a condom. She’d booked an appointment at a sexual health clinic, but in the meantime she was unwilling to risk passing on an STI. Julian had fucked her immediately after the plumber had left, so if she tested positive, he’d need to be treated too.

She painted her toenails, put on her makeup—applying a little more mascara than usual—and oiled her legs. There’d be no stockings tonight, and she wanted him to get the most from the softness of her skin. After putting on the figure-hugging cardi-dress, she stepped into her shoes. Checking her reflection in the full-length mirror, she smiled. The outline of her boobs and raised nipples made it obvious she wasn’t wearing a bra but, to emphasise the point, she pulled down the zip to show more cleavage. Finally she applied bright red lip-gloss. She looked like a slut, but a very sexy one.

Nicole walked downstairs and into the lounge, where Julian was watching TV. His expression was a picture.

She smiled. "Well?"

He shook his head and sighed. "Wow."

Slowly, she slid down the zip to reveal first her bare breasts, then her uncovered sex. "Is this slutty enough?"

"You look... Are you going out like that?"

"I'll wear a coat to get from the carpark to the room, but yes. Do you think he'll like it?"

Julian gulped.

Taking that as a 'yes', she went to get her coat and keys, then came back into the lounge. "Right, I'm going. Have a nice night, and try not to abuse yourself too much." She smiled. "I may need some attention when I get back tomorrow."

Julian stared open-mouthed as she left the house and walked across the wide drive to her car, her heels clicking on the block paving.

Twenty minutes later, she was standing outside room 306. She slipped off her coat, pulled the cardigan zip down to her belly button to expose more boob flesh, and knocked.

Ciaran opened the door. "Nicole..." His gaze fell, taking in her outfit. He blew out his cheeks. "Jeez. You look... Come in."

After she'd stepped into the large room, he closed the door behind her, a broad smile on his face. "Using a hotel is the best idea you've had."

She placed her coat on the chair by the desk.

His gaze wandered back down her body, lingering on the beads of her taut nipples only just covered by the soft lambswool. "You look absolutely fantastic."

"Thank you." She looked down at his t-shirt and jeans. "You look over-dressed."

He laughed for a moment, then furrowed his brow. "Are you serious?"

"Very. Get your kit off."

Ciaran peeled his shirt over his head, kicked off his shoes and pushed down his jeans and boxers in one go. In less than ten seconds, he

was naked. He was also completely at ease with his nakedness, confident in his own skin.

She took in his wide, smooth chest, muscled shoulders and arms, the flat, toned tummy, then nodded approvingly. "Very nice." She lowered her gaze to his thick cock, which was beginning to swell but still hung down over his big heavy balls. "You look as good naked as I imagined."

"Thanks." He looked down at her legs. "And you look fabulous, even without nylons."

"I thought it'd be nice for us to be skin on skin." She slowly pulled down the zip of her cardigan.

Ciaran's expression changed, became more serious. Hungry. "Fucking hell!"

Nicole pushed the cardigan back and off and carried it to the chair, draping it over her coat. She reached into the pocket and grabbed the cardboard packet. "I know I said I wanted us to be skin on skin, but..." She held up the condoms. "I'm afraid you're going to have to wear one of these tonight."

He frowned. "I thought we were past that, now."

"I'm sorry. Really I am."

He sighed and nodded. Taking the pack from her, he opened it and took one out. "Will you put it on for me?"

"If you like."

He nodded. "I like."

Dropping to her knees, Nicole gripped his cock in her fist, pumping him slowly with a twisting motion. Soon he was fully hard. She smeared the bead of precum around the tip, used her teeth to rip open the foil, then placed the rubber disc on the fat tip of his cock and rolled it down.

Standing, she stepped close and kissed him. Then she backed up to the bed, kicked off her shoes and pulled him on top of her. His knees slipped between hers and she spread her legs, enjoying the heat of his body pressing on hers, her breasts squashed against his chest.

She put her mouth to his ear. "Fuck me."

Ciaran pulled his head back and watched her face as he fed his cock inside her.

She groaned, arching up to welcome the penetration. It was the first time she'd had sex using a condom since Sam, and it felt strange. She missed the sensation of feeling the man's body-heat inside her.

As his thick cock slid all the way in, Nicole wrapped her legs around his calves and her arms around his waist. He moved slowly, fucking her with long, slow thrusts. The contrast of the cool sheet and his hot body was delicious. She should have insisted on a bed before now. They writhed together, his hairy legs sliding against her smooth ones, his hard chest pushing against the soft swell of her breasts, his thick, strong arms pulling at her waist. With every push of his hips, his pelvic bone mashed against hers. Her clit was on fire.

A tremor skipped through her lower body, and she let out a whimper. Ciaran responded by lengthening the thrusts, pulling back a little farther before pushing in even deeper.

"Oh..." Nicole nibbled his earlobe, kissed the side of his head. "Oh, fuck..."

Ciaran kept moving with the same steady rhythm, inching her closer to the edge. She put her hands on his buttocks and pulled him deeper, marvelling at the firmness of his backside and the flexing muscles in his legs.

The build-up to her orgasm was slow and delicious. Suddenly, she tumbled into a series of body-shaking waves of pleasure. At the end of each thrust, the thick base of his cock collided with her clit and sent fresh spikes to her already-overloaded nervous system. She wailed and cried until it passed, and she finally stopped twitching.

Ciaran slowly eased out.

She took a steadying breath and blinked. "Did you come, too?"

"No. I thought I'd let you get your breath back, then you can do some of the work."

She laughed and pushed him over onto his back. Straddling him, she reached down and guided his cock back inside her. She rocked her hips, moving as slowly as he had earlier.

Reaching up with his hands, he stroked her breasts. "You're beautiful."

"I bet you say that to all the women who ride your cock."

He laughed out loud. “And I’d say it to all the ones who sucked it like you did last week.”

She smiled and pressed down on his chest. “Stop talking and let me enjoy your dick.”

“Oh yeah, I remember now. I’m not important, but my dick is.”

“Exactly.”

“Fine. Be my guest.” He pushed his hips up, prodding deep and making her wince.

“Ow.”

He pushed up a second time.

Nicole rocked faster. “Do it again.”

With each push of his hips, the tip of his cock slid against something right up at the roof of her cunt. Nicole knew she’d be able to come again. Ciaran stopped his wisecracks, stroking his hands over her hips.

She closed her eyes and concentrated, blocking out the room, the hard body beneath her, the handsome face watching hers. Her entire focus was on the thick, sheathed cock that impaled her. It felt wonderful, and she pumped her hips forward and back. All she could hear was her own breathing and her speeding pulse pounding in her ears. All she could feel was the wet, slick hardness, pushing her ever closer to...

Nicole opened her eyes. “Will you come with me?”

He smiled and shook his head.

Her eyes fluttered and she dropped her mouth open as the orgasm broke. Jerking her hips forward and back, Nicole grunted in a most unladylike manner as her muscles clenched and her mind soared.

Finally, the spasms faded, and she stopped moving. With hair clinging to her face and her legs still shaking, she opened her eyes and looked down at Ciaran.

He reached up and stroked the hair from her eyes. “You’re so fucking sexy.”

She gasped for breath, her boobs heaving from the exertion. She raised her eyebrows. “If I’m that sexy, why haven’t you come yet?”

In a single move, he rolled her off him and onto her back. Then he climbed on top, holding himself up on straight arms, his knees between her

parted legs. “You made me wear a condom. It dulls the sensation. Gives me extra staying power.”

“Ah, I see.” She smiled. “I like staying power. This could be a very long night.”

He smiled, reaching down to lift one of her legs over his shoulder. “Yes it could, but I need to release the pressure or I’ll blow a gasket.” He lifted her other leg.

“Ooh, we wouldn’t want you to blow a gasket.”

“No. So what I need is...” He stabbed his cock into her, making her catch her breath. He smiled at her reaction. “What I need...”

Nicole began kicking her feet against his back, urging him to start fucking her. She smiled sweetly. “Hmm?”

He thrust his hips in time with her kicks. “I said, what I need is to...”

She gripped his hips, yanking them forward and back, sighing as his cock ploughed in and out of her. “What you need?”

“What I need is to blow my fucking load.”

She clenched her teeth and dug her fingers into his hips. “So blow your fucking load, then.”

He banged her so hard that the bed shook under his onslaught, her legs flailing in the air. Beads of sweat appeared on his forehead. Her hair covered her face as she thrashed her head from side to side.

Ciaran grunted. She watched his face as his eyes widened and then squeezed shut. He held still as his cock pulsed inside her. She writhed beneath him, trying to make it as nice for him as she could.

He sucked in air, opened his eyes and started pounding her again. Nicole cried out with each stab of his cock. Finally spent, he held the condom in place as he withdrew. She let her legs fall from his shoulders, grateful to be able to stretch out again.

He shook his head and laughed. “Jeez, woman. You’re going to be the death of me.” Closing his eyes, he took several deep breaths. “You’ll give me a coronary.”

She giggled and snuggled up to him. “If I’d known you could fuck for that long, I’d have made you wear a condom sooner.”

He laughed, then peeled off the flooded rubber, tied a knot in it and dropped it onto the floor at the side of the bed. “I’ll chuck all the condoms out in the morning.”

“Ooh, so you can go again?”

“Definitely. We’ve got the whole night.” He looked into her eyes and ran his hand over her boobs and down her tummy. “I hope you brought more than one pack.”



Ψ



Chapter Five

They slipped between the sheets, Nicole's head resting on Ciaran's chest as he traced his fingertips over her back. She listened as his racing heart slowed to a steady beat.

He broke the silence after a few minutes. "How did the move go?"

"Fine, thanks."

"And how's the new house?"

"Fabulous."

"Good." He kissed the top of her head.

Nicole found it a little unnerving. She didn't want this sort of closeness, which was weird considering what they'd just shared.

He took a breath. "Do you ever wonder what would have happened if we'd met when you were still single?"

She looked up at him, wary. "I can't say I have."

“I think about it a lot.”

She pulled away and leaned up on one elbow. “Why would you think about that?”

He shrugged. “I don’t know. It’s just...” He gave a smile. “The first time I met you, I just couldn’t see how you and Julian would work. I mean, physically, you’re like chalk and cheese.”

“Maybe that’s exactly why we do work. Opposites attract.”

He shrugged as if conceding the point. “But now I understand how your arrangement works, I guess it makes sense.”

“What does?”

“You know. You getting to have sex with men you find physically attractive.”

“I find my husband physically attractive.”

“Yeah, obviously. But I guess you get a bonus”—a childish grin creased his face—“as well as boners, from the other men you see.”

She wasn’t sure she liked the implication. “I didn’t marry Julian just so I could carry on seeing other men. Our arrangement is something that’s evolved.”

He nodded. “But do you think if we’d met when you were single, that you’d still want to do what you do now?”

She laughed. “If I’d met you when I was single, I wouldn’t have touched you with a barge pole.”

“*What?*” He looked crestfallen.

“You make a great fuck-buddy, but I wouldn’t have considered you boyfriend material.”

He looked genuinely hurt. “Why not?”

“I made a point of steering clear of Jack the Lad types.”

“I’m not a Jack the—”

“Hmm.” She gave a placating pat on his well-toned and possibly waxed chest. “And I doubt you’ve ever put anyone else’s feelings ahead of your own.”

“I don’t think that’s—”

“What’s more, you probably spend more time in front of the mirror than I do.” She smiled and shook her head. “Stop being so touchy. It’s a

pointless conversation anyway. I'm married to Julian and I couldn't be happier. He's everything I could ask for in a husband."

"If that was true, you wouldn't be here now."

Nicole sat up, annoyed. "You think I do this because I'm frustrated at home?"

He shrugged. "If I was married, my wife wouldn't need to get her kicks in someone else's bed."

"That's exactly what I mean by you never put anyone else's feelings ahead of your own. You're too selfish to share."

"It's not about being—"

"It's *precisely* about being selfish. What I do is something that works for our relationship. It works for both of us. When it stops working for both of us, then I'll stop seeing other men. But I won't be frustrated, because what I need, I get from my husband." She took a breath, regretting her outburst.

Shaking his head, he reached over and held her hand. "I'm sorry, I didn't mean to suggest—"

"No, I'm sorry." Feeling a little guilty, she shook her head and sighed. "I shouldn't have said the things I did. I'm sure you'll make some woman very happy when you get round to settling down."

"Yeah well, we'll see. It's just that I... I spend a lot of time..." He frowned. "I think about you. Often."

"Thank you. But I'm sure a man with a healthy appetite like yours thinks about a lot of women."

"Not since I've been seeing you."

"But you've been seeing other people? Women, I mean."

"No. I thought..." A shadow crossed his face. "Have you been seeing other men? I mean, apart from your husband?"

Images of her spread out on the boxes beneath the plumber flitted across her mind. "Well..."

"You have." He sat up, looking shocked. "You've fucked somebody else, and that's why I had to wear a condom. You had unprotected sex and haven't had the all-clear yet."

Now it was her turn to be shocked. *How could he have surmised that so quickly?*

He leaned close and peered into her eyes. "I'm right, aren't I? You let someone fuck you without a rubber, and now you're worried he left more than his jizz in you."

There was no point in denying it. She nodded but didn't look him in the eye. She hadn't come here for an argument.

"Who was he?"

"Does it matter?"

"Not really. I mean, I know *he* doesn't matter. It's just his dick that's important."

They were her own words. She couldn't help smiling.

Ciaran shook his head in disbelief. "Does Julian know?"

"Of course he knows. I don't do anything without his say-so."

"And was it worth it?"

She frowned, frustrated by how much he sounded like a jealous boyfriend. "Worth it?"

"The risk. Did you get enough kicks out of it to make the risk of unprotected sex worth taking?"

"Ciaran, I don't have to explain myself to you. But since you asked, yes, it was worth the risk. He was young and fit, and he rocked my world. Happy now?"

"You're unbelievable."

"Thank you. That's exactly what he said afterwards."

He shook his head, laughing. "Jeez. I guess I deserved that."

"Would you like me to leave?"

"Oh no. I've been looking forward to a full night together, and there's no way I'd want it cut short."

She nodded. "I'm glad to hear it. So stop talking and start doing what I came here for."

"That's fine with me. And now I know it's not only my dick you're interested in, but any man's, I'll make sure I keep my focus on the places where I stick it."

Ignoring his snappy tone, she glanced down. His cock was starting to swell. “Is this where we have angry sex?”

He snorted. “Do you want angry sex, Nicole? Do you want me to push you down and take out my frustrations on you?”

“I like the idea of being fucked hard.”

Ciaran pushed her onto her back and pulled her legs apart, placing his knees on the mattress between them. “Does it matter to you at all who does the fucking?”

“Not really, but you’re here now.” She smiled up at him. “You’ll need to get another condom.”

“Maybe I’ll take the same risk that you did. I assume you got carried away in a moment of passion and took him bareback. What’s to say I’m not getting carried away here, too?”

“I was trying to protect you.”

“I get that, but if you fucked him before you gave me the blowjob, you could have passed it on to me anyway.”

Not wanting to get into when exactly it had happened, she said nothing. The news that she’d had sex with another man had obviously hurt his pride enough. No point in going into details.

Ciaran reached down and guided his cock inside her. It was hard, smooth and hot. She moaned and shook her head, yet at the same time opened her legs wider and pulled him in.

He sighed. “And now it’s too late. I haven’t slept with anyone else since I first met you, so the only person at risk here is me.”

She looked into his eyes, clenching herself around his cock. “You promised me angry sex.”

He laughed. “I’m not angry, but I’ll fuck you hard if that’s what you want.”

She bit her lip, a little nervous but incredibly turned on. “It’s what I want.”

Ciaran gripped her by the wrists and pinned them to the bed above her head. Then he raised himself up and pounded her hard, driving his cock in with force, over and over. Nicole squealed and shook under the barrage. She came with a shudder, but he didn’t seem to notice. He maintained the

same intensity for a long time, and she came again, pushing her head back into the pillow.

Dipping his head, he bit her exposed neck, making her cry out in shock. He sneered down at her. "Is this angry enough?"

She dragged her nails down his sides.

"Ow, you..." He withdrew and rolled her over onto her tummy, roughly pulling her up onto all fours. After pushing her knees apart, he slid back inside and pumped his hips, sending his cock deep. "You like that?"

"Yeah." Nicole sucked in air as he pounded her from behind. "Yeah, I like that."

He fucked her hard, and it went on for a long time. He sped up, then suddenly pulled out. There was a hot splash on her back, then he pushed back in and continued to pound her. She remembered their time in his office when he'd come twice in a row. Maybe he'd be able to do it again now.

His hand ran over her backside, then she felt pressure against her anus. He pushed his thumb in and she squealed.

"What's wrong?" he said, never ceasing with the thrusts of his cock. "I thought you liked a bit of arse play."

Nicole squeezed her eyes shut as his cock reamed her cunt and his thumb pushed even deeper into her backside.

"You didn't seem to think it was a problem the last time we met. I took it as a hint..."

Both his cock and thumb withdrew. She'd just taken a breath of relief when she felt the hot, slick dome pressing against her anus.

"Ciaran..."

He pushed forward, and she felt herself opening up around him.

"Ciaran, wait..."

"I thought this was what you wanted. Isn't this why you fingered me during the blowjob?"

She shook her head and his cock slipped in further. His entire knob-end was now inside her. She could hardly breathe, but the fullness was... good. It felt good and it felt dirty. Slutty. She groaned and wiggled her hips from side to side.

"Do you want me to pull out?"

She took several deep breaths, hoping she could take him but not sure if she could. His cock was long. Thick. She wanted to at least try.

Ciaran ran his hand over her hips. “Nicole? Do you want me to keep going?”

“Yes, but take it slow.”

“I thought you wanted angry sex.” The playfulness had returned to his tone.

“Not up there, I don’t.”

He stroked her back, smearing his cooled cum into her skin. “Okay, we’ll go nice and slow.” He pushed in further, filling her up and stretching her to the limit.

She groaned and he pulled back. But he paused for mere seconds before pushing in again, going a little deeper. And then deeper.

He was slow, patient and relatively gentle, working on her until he was able to slide his cock all the way inside. Sweat drenched her forehead.

“Nicole, I’m getting close, so I’m going to move a little faster. Tell me if it gets too sore, okay?”

She nodded, a little breathless. As he slid his cock in and out, she started to push herself back to meet each thrust. It hurt, which was fine. She pushed back harder, willing his cock to poke her deeper than she’d ever felt anything before. Wanting him to hurt her.

He let out a long sigh. “I’m getting ready to blow.”

She nodded, slamming herself back against his thighs.

“Do you want me to pull out?”

“No.” She wished she could see his face.

“You want me to come where I am?”

She nodded, her head sunk in the pillow.

Ciaran pounded harder, then held still.

She felt him come, sensed the warmth spreading through her insides. He started moving again, pushing deep. More warmth entered her body. Nicole reached between her legs and rubbed her throbbing clit. It took a matter of seconds to bring herself off, and Ciaran cried out as her orgasm sent contractions through her inner muscles. Once the last ripples had gone, the grip around him easing, he pulled out. A warm trickle seeped out of her.

She got out of bed and walked on unsteady legs into the bathroom. She turned on the shower and let the hot jets massage her body, then washed herself thoroughly.

A few minutes later, Ciaran pulled the curtain back and joined her. They washed each other in silence, then turned off the water and dried each other.

Back in bed, they lay side by side. She was a little tender but surprisingly content.

Ciaran broke the silence. "I've never met a woman like you."

"Is that good or bad?"

"I'm not sure."

"Don't overanalyse it. Let's just allow our bodies to enjoy one another's."

He laughed, no doubt remembering his own words from their first meeting.

They lay in silence and, as Ciaran dozed, she thought about her husband lying in bed in their new home. Would he masturbate while imagining her with Ciaran? Maybe she should send him a text to say she'd had anal for the first time...

No, she wanted to see his expression when she gave him that piece of news. Reaching over, she turned off the small lights over the bed, then snuggled up to the warm, smooth body beside her.

In the middle of the night, Nicole woke to soft kisses being planted on her shoulders. She stroked Ciaran's head as he moved down to kiss and suck her nipples. When he slipped on top, she bent and parted her legs. He was already hard. She wrapped her arms around his waist as he slid into her and enjoyed his gentleness. This sex was unlike any of their previous encounters. Her orgasm seeped through her entire body, from her toes to her ears. She whimpered and hugged her thighs to his. He came immediately after her, and she clung to his back.

He fell asleep with his flaccid cock still inside her. She lay awake in the dark, a little worried that their latest session had been too tender, too intimate. He'd made love to her, which wasn't what she'd wanted. She eventually fell asleep in his arms.

She woke early, slid out of bed and got dressed, which only entailed pulling on her cardigan and stepping into her shoes. She slipped on her coat, then bent to wake Ciaran. "Hey, tiger."

He blinked his eyes open, then frowned when he saw she had her coat on. "What are you doing?"

"I'm going home."

He sighed and pulled himself up into a sitting position. "I thought we could order room service and have a little more..." He grinned. "I could go again."

She smiled. "You came four times already, and I lost count of the number of times I came."

"You're welcome."

She laughed and ruffled his hair. "Text me."

"I will."

She walked to the door and turned. "If our next meeting's in the office, I promise to dress appropriately."

"Good." He nodded at her feet. "And if you wear those shoes again, I'll be very happy."

She laughed, opened the door and headed toward the lift.

* * * *

It was still before seven when she let herself in at home. The house was in darkness. She walked upstairs and into their room, where Julian was fast asleep. She quickly stripped and slid into bed beside him.

He roused when she pressed her boobs into his back.

"Hey, sleepyhead."

He turned and looked at her, then flicked on the bedside light. He hadn't shaved since Monday, and his thick black stubble was noticeably longer. "You're home."

She smiled. "Hmm."

He blinked, squinting at the alarm clock, then looked back, puzzled. "Is everything alright?"

"Everything's fine." She ran her hand down his body, smiled when she felt his dick hardening.

“How was your night?” he asked.

“It was good. Want me to tell you about it with your dick inside me, or would you rather clean me up first?” His shocked expression made her worry she’d been excessively crude. “Sorry, was that too slutty?”

“No, I’m just surprised there’s anything to clean up. I thought you were going to use protection until after the test.”

“That was the plan, and we did for the first one. He guessed why I’d insisted we use condoms, and he...” She shrugged.

“And he what?”

“He said he’d take the risk. He took me bareback. Twice.”

Julian stared, and she could almost hear his mind working behind the dark eyes. “So he had you three times in total?”

“There’s lots to tell you.” She knelt up on the mattress. “Right, I can either sit on your dick or sit on your face. Either will make me come, so tell me which you want.”

“Sit on my face.”

“Are you sure?”

“Yes.” She reached to grip the headboard, but he shook his head. “No, turn around.”

Assuming he wanted a 69, she placed her knees either side of his head and leaned forward. Julian stopped her with a hand on her tummy and tilted her back upright. Smiling, she lowered herself onto his face. His three-day stubble prickled her soft skin. She sighed as he worked his tongue inside her, lapping at whatever juices were there. She wondered what he’d taste most clearly—her juices, Ciaran’s cum, or remnants of the condom lubricant.

She stroked Julian’s chest. “Oh, that’s nice. I never imagined having this done could feel so good, or so intimate. It’s like this makes us even closer.”

He gripped her wrist and moved it down to his cock. As soon as she wrapped her fingers around the shaft, he pumped her wrist.

“Wouldn’t you rather go inside me?”

He gripped her arm and pumped again. Taking the hint, she leaned forward to spit onto the tip of his cock, then used her palm to smear it all over the dome and around the shaft. She pumped slowly, twisting on the up-

strokes and relaxing her grip on the down-strokes, taking care not to pull the skin too far back.

Julian's tongue proved to be more efficient than her hand, and Nicole's orgasm arrived first. She held her breath and shuddered as he flicked her clit and then probed deeper with his tongue. She cried out, pumping faster as she bucked her hips, grinding herself against his face.

His body went rigid beneath her and a jet of cum arced out, landing on his chest and her thighs. She pumped him harder, rewarded with spurts that scatter-gunned across his stomach.

She raised herself up off and grabbed a tissue, wiping the mess from his tummy and her legs. Then she moved down the bed and lay against him. Julian pulled the quilt over them and held her close until she fell asleep.

* * * *

Nicole woke when Julian stroked her shoulder.

"I've made you a cup of tea," he said.

"Oh, thanks." She sat up and smoothed her hair out of her face. "I didn't notice you getting up."

He smiled. "You looked dead to the world, so I thought I'd let you catch up on some sleep."

"What time is it?"

"Noon."

"Wow. I'm sorry."

He smiled and shook his head. "Come downstairs when you're ready, I've made us brunch."

After her shower, she tied her damp hair back in a ponytail, pulled on leggings and a sweatshirt, then went downstairs. He'd made bagels with cream cheese and smoked salmon.

"I've started sorting the upstairs office," he said, scratching his stubble. "I'm going to search online for a set of bookshelves. You mentioned using the small sitting room as your workspace, so do you want me to order a desk for in there?"

"That'd be nice. Shout me when you have the website open and I'll come and have a look."

A few minutes later, he summoned her up to his office. When she arrived, he gave her his chair so she could look at the laptop. She clicked through a few pages until she found a desk she liked, then turned the laptop so he could see the screen.

He nodded at her choice. “Do you want to choose a chair while you’re here?”

As she clicked through the site, she could feel his eyes on her and sense his eagerness. Having found a chair she liked, she added it to the basket then looked up at him. “We were supposed to spend today talking about my night with Ciaran.”

“You mean your night with your bull.”

“Yes. My bull.”

“I didn’t want to pester.”

“You’re not pestering. I love that you want details. The fact they turn you on so much is flattering.”

“Thank you.”

She looked around the room, which was still a mess. “How about we spend another hour or so getting things out of boxes, and then retire for a bit of afternoon delight?”

He nodded eagerly.

She left him in the office to unpack the master bedroom, finding new homes for all her toiletries and makeup. When she’d slotted the last face cream away, she released her hair and brushed it out, then pulled off her sweatshirt and leggings. Wearing only a white bra and panties, she walked along the galleried landing to Julian’s office. He was facing the wall, sorting out the cables to his printer.

She leaned against the door jamb. “Hello.”

He turned, smiling. His expression changed as soon as he saw her, and he immediately dropped the wires.

She laughed, then held out her hand. “Come to bed so I can tell you what a dirty girl you’re married to.”

Julian allowed himself to be led back to their bedroom and undressed. He lay in bed and watched in silence as she unplugged her phone from its charger, then slipped into bed next to him, still wearing her underwear.

Clicking through the gallery, she found the video she'd taken and lay next to him. "I thought we could watch a dirty movie together."

"Is that from last night?"

"No, it's from the night I went to his office." She took a deep breath and decided to get a couple of things off her conscience. Her little secret was in danger of becoming a much bigger secret the longer she left things. "Julian, I have a confession."

"Oh?"

"I wanted to talk about when I caught you in your office, watching the other film."

"Ah. As I said, I just—"

"No, it's okay. I understand you were desperate to see for yourself. I get that." She licked her lips and hurried on before he could interrupt again. "At the time, I made a big deal of the fact you weren't being open with me —"

"I know, and I promise—"

"No, it's not that. I wasn't being open with you. I lied."

He frowned, scratching his head. "I don't understand."

"I said I could see what you were watching, but that's not true. I assumed it was porn. I went back to the bath and didn't say anything, but I couldn't stop thinking about what had excited you so much. Since all this started, I've done a bit of surfing on the web. I never realised how big a thing wife-sharing is."

He cleared his throat. "Yes, well... there does seem to be—"

"I assumed you'd done the same, and that you'd discovered the huge amount of cuck porn available. I couldn't help wondering what had been so sexy that you felt the need to give yourself release without me." She smiled. "I was jealous that it might be a hotwife who was much sexier than me."

He shook his head.

"I could make all sorts of excuses for why I wanted to know what you were watching, but whatever they were, I can't demand that you're honest with me when I go behind your back to search through your phone to find what you'd been watching."

"Is that what you did?"

His benign, patient gaze made her cheeks burn. At least the truth was out now. “I waited until you were asleep, then took your phone into the bathroom to try and search the history of websites you’d visited.”

“And you saw there were no porn sites.” He frowned. “But how did you—?”

“Unlock your phone?”

“I’d changed the passcode.”

“I know.” She sighed. “While you slept, I used your fingerprint to unlock it.” His eyes opened wide, and she giggled. “I know. It was sneaky, and I’m sorry for prying.”

He shook his head. “No, it’s okay. I should never have done it. Like you say, it was a stupid thing to do, and a betrayal of trust. To you *and* Ciaran.”

“Well, it seems to have turned out alright. You didn’t get sacked, and it inspired me to make a film of my own. Speaking of which...” She held up her phone. “Want to see it?”

“Yes please.”

Nicole hit ‘Play.’

The film opened with her in Ciaran’s office wearing a black wraparound dress and the black facemask with red lips. She’d forgotten that Ciaran had filmed this part. She watched herself unfasten the belt and slide off her dress, and was astonished how good she looked in the corset, stockings and heels. Even the way she walked looked sexy.

The shot zoomed in on her face, the lower half of which was hidden by the mask. Ciaran’s voice telling her she looked fabulous made Julian jump. Nicole glanced at her husband’s face as she heard herself thank Ciaran, and then Ciaran ask how they’d have sex if they were socially distanced.

The film ended just as she replied, ‘Who said we were going to have sex?’

Julian turned to look at her, puzzled.

“It’s in two parts.” She started the next clip, which opened with an unsteady image of her face filling the screen.

Nicole watched, fascinated by the clarity of the picture and the memories it rekindled as she heard her conversation with Ciaran. He said he

wasn't sure how he felt about being filmed, and she assured him it wasn't him she was interested in. His dick was all that was important.

She glanced at her husband, whose concentration was fully focused on the phone screen. She saw his surprised expression at the sight of his boss's penis. Maybe his film of the other session hadn't shown it clearly, but there in Nicole's phone, Ciaran's thick, throbbing erection looked impressive.

She leaned close and kissed his cheek. "Want me to suck you while you watch it?"

He smiled and shook his head. On the screen, the room briefly lit up. Julian's brow furrowed.

"That was the storm. Remember I got caught in the rain on the way to my car?"

He nodded but didn't take his eyes off the screen, where Nicole was now wiping Ciaran's dripping cock over her face, leaving glistening tracks of precum on her cheeks, forehead and facemask.

Ciaran's voice sounded whiny as he begged to go inside her. When it got to the part where she pulled down the mask and took his cock into her mouth, Julian's breath caught in his throat.

Without asking, Nicole slid her hand down over his tummy. He was fully erect, the tip soaked. She squeezed his cock, which made him shudder.

On the screen, Nicole pushed her head all the way down. As Ciaran's cock disappeared completely into her throat, Julian raised his eyebrows.

"That's what I did to you the other night," she whispered.

He nodded. Even though she was now slowly pumping his cock, his eyes never left the screen. Ciaran's cries grew more desperate, interspersed with expletives as her head pulled back until just the tip was in her mouth, her hand pumping the shaft. He could be heard asking what she was doing, then he screamed.

Nicole watched her husband's face. "Just there," she whispered, "I pushed my finger up his arse and he flooded my mouth."

Julian looked flabbergasted. On the screen, cum dribbled out of Nicole's mouth and down Ciaran's cock. Then she released it, looked into the camera and licked her lips. The film ended.

“Was that slutty enough for you?”

He laughed, shaking his head as if in disbelief. “It was...” He blinked. “Now tell me more about last night.”

Without warning, she clambered on top of him, pulled her panties to one side and fed his dick inside her, making him cry out. “Last night...?”

He took a steadying breath. “I know he took you three times, and that the first was with a condom.”

“Hmm, that’s right. After he’d worked out why I’d insisted on a condom, he said he’d take the risk. He pushed me down and entered me bare, and then it was too late anyway. After a while, we changed so I was on my knees and he did me doggystyle. He withdrew and came over my back, then went back inside. Sometimes he can come twice, like he did on the occasion you filmed.”

For reasons she didn’t fully understand, she decided not to reveal that Ciaran had taken her anally. Not yet. She wasn’t worried about how he’d react, but it just *felt* like the wrong time to bring it up. He was still on a high from the blowjob film. Hearing all the details about her night in the hotel bed might be too much for him.

Julian seemed to be struggling to keep his eyes open, his breathing shallow. “So, he came again during this one?”

She nodded.

“Where?”

“Inside.” Though technically the truth, guilt niggled at her for not being more precise.

Julian clenched his teeth and took deep breaths. She knew he was struggling to delay his orgasm. She leaned close and looked into his eyes. “He fucked me hard. He took me bareback, and he came inside. I could feel his cum pumping into me—”

“Ahh!” Julian bucked so hard he almost threw her off the bed. She gripped the sheets and thrust her body as quickly as she could, grinding her clit against him and achieving an orgasm of her own before he’d finished spurting into her.

She lay down beside him and kissed his stubbly cheek. “What did you think of the film?”

“I thought it was wonderful. Incredibly sexy.”

“Would you like me to send it to you by email? That way you can watch it on your laptop and jerk off in your office.”

He blanched, but she hadn't said it to be hurtful.

She stroked his arm. “I'll watch it again,” she said. “And when I do, I'll probably masturbate. It was a lot sexier than I'd expected.”

A smile creased his face, and he reached down and opened a drawer in his bedside cabinet. “Well, in that case, I'd better give you your new gift.” He held up a penis-shaped sex-toy in black rubber.

“You bought me a vibrator?”

“Is it like your old one?” he asked, a tentative smile on his face.

She didn't have the heart to tell him she'd been joking about owning one before, or that given the choice, she'd have preferred a wand. “It's much better.”

He beamed.

She took it from him, gauging its weight and girth. “I think I'll call it Denzel.”

* * * *

As they ate breakfast on Monday morning, Nicole regarded her husband. He'd trimmed and shaped his facial growth into a neat beard and, with his hair short, the difference in his appearance amazed her. But the change was more than just physical. There was an assuredness about him, now.

Less than two months ago, he'd been flapping around in a canary-yellow V-necked jumper, worried about having his immediate line manager to dinner. Now, dressed in a grey suit with blue silk tie, he seemed completely relaxed about his meeting with the sales director later.

“What are you going to do today?” he asked.

“Catch up with what's happened at work. Check emails, make sure all the bills got paid in my absence, that sort of thing.”

“Have you got another meeting booked with Ciaran?”

“No. Not yet.”

He smiled. “Well, I expect he'll be in touch.” With that, he kissed her cheek and headed out to his car.

Nicole tidied away the breakfast things, made herself a fresh cup of tea, then headed to the small sitting room. She'd have to make do with the coffee table until her new desk was delivered, but the lighting was good. She'd whizzed through a couple of hours' work before her phone pinged.

As ever, Ciaran's text was short and to the point. She replied, agreeing to meet him at the office at six on Friday. He followed up with a second text moments later:

Great, see you then. I may have a surprise for you.

A warm tingle crept through her body as she tried to get her mind back on her work.

An hour later, the doorbell rang. Nicole opened the door to a woman of about forty, who was holding a bunch of flowers. She introduced herself as Liz, and said she lived next door. Nicole invited her in for coffee and they nattered for about an hour, sitting a sensible two metres apart.

When Julian got home that evening, she asked about his meeting with the sales director.

A broad smile creased his face. "He likes the new way we're doing things and has decided on rolling out my method for collating data to the entire sales force."

"Oh wow, that's fantastic. I'm really proud of you."

"Thank you. How was your day?"

Nicole told him first about meeting their neighbour, and then that she'd been invited to Ciaran's office on Friday evening.

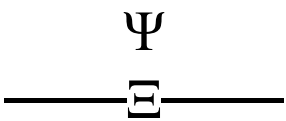
"Ah." His eyes shone with excitement. "Technically, that's casual dress day."

"I know, but I think I'll still dress the way he likes me to."

"Good."

She smiled at him, pleased that he got turned on by the thought of her wearing sexy lingerie for another man. "Go get changed. Dinner's ready to serve."





Chapter Six

During the rest of the week, Nicole finished off the accounts for Ciaran's business, linking all the bank transactions to the receipts and invoices.

She also visited the sexual health clinic for her tests. When the nurse asked why she thought she may have contracted an STI, Nicole explained she and her husband had an open marriage, and that while she'd been with another partner, the condom had split. It was a lie, but she needn't have bothered. The nurse had nodded as if open marriages or cheating partners were par for the course. After taking a vaginal swab, blood and urine samples, she advised Nicole to practice safe sex until all the results were in, which could take up to two weeks.

On Friday afternoon, Nicole took a shower then dressed in white blouse and black skirt over black underwear and stockings. She also wore her suede peep-toed shoes, as Ciaran had requested.

Julian arrived home a few minutes before she had to leave. He swept his gaze down her body, taking in her outfit. "You look ravishing."

"Thank you. I'm hoping to get ravished."

"I'm sure you will be."

"And what about when I get home? Will you ravish me, too?"

"I'd like that."

Nicole picked up the file of invoices and held it under her arm. "See you later." Not wanting to smudge her lip-gloss, she presented her cheek, which he kissed.

"Have fun."

As Nicole walked across the drive, her neighbours arrived home.

Liz waved. "Hi Nicole." She brought over her husband, stopping a couple of metres away. "Oh, you look fantastic."

Very conscious of her heavy mascara and bright red lips, Nicole forced a laugh. "I'm meeting up with some girls from work, and we're doing the dress up, not down thing. It's our way of making ourselves feel better about not being able to go out much due to the Covid restrictions."

Liz smiled. "I don't blame you. This is my husband, Ed."

"Hi Ed, it's nice to meet you."

"And you." Ed seemed to be struggling to keep his eyes on her face.

"Well," Liz said, "don't let us keep you."

Nicole smiled and walked to her car, concentrating on not catching her stilettos in the block paving. Liz and Ed were probably wondering if a high-class hooker had moved in next door.

When she arrived at the GLP office, she had to stop at the barrier. Smiling nicely at the security guard, she waited until he'd raised the gate, then waved as she drove through to the carpark.

Ciaran was waiting for her in reception. He nodded his approval at her outfit. "Hi Nicole. Gorgeous, as always."

"Thank you." She passed him the file. "I think this is all you need."

He grinned. "We both know I need more than that. Come on, let's go to the office."

He ushered her through the doors, up the stairs and along the corridor. Every office they passed was in darkness, as was Bernice's space. The only light in Ciaran's large office came from the desk lamp.

She smiled. "Ooh, this is cosy."

"I'm glad you approve."

Nicole pushed his laptop to one side and lifted herself up onto his desk. When he stepped close, she parted her legs and wrapped them around his waist. Her skirt rode up her thighs, revealing the lacy tops of her stockings. She looked up into his face. "Missed me?"

"Yes, but before you go any further and embarrass yourself, I'd like you to meet Will."

She grinned. "Willie?"

"My cousin and business partner. Will, come and say hello."

The sound of a chair being pushed back from the table under the window made her turn. A guy dressed in dark clothes walked across the

office and into the light. "Hello, Nicole. It's nice to meet you."

Nicole pushed Ciaran away, glaring at him as she stepped off the desk and smoothed down her skirt. She sighed, resigned to the fact that Ciaran had probably told him everything. "Hello, Will." They shook hands.

He nodded at Ciaran. "It was his idea for me to sit in the dark. He said it'd appeal to your sense of fun." He had a strong Irish accent.

"I bet he did. I can also imagine what else he's told you about me."

Will held up his hands, palms out. "It's nothing to do with me." He gave a smile. "But I have to admit, I've been looking forward to meeting you for quite a while."

She scowled at Ciaran again.

He smirked. "I thought it'd be a nice surprise for you to meet my partner, now that you're part of the team, as it were."

"Hmm."

Ciaran held up the file she'd brought. "How about we go for a drink? We can look over these figures and discuss if there's anything else that needs to be done before we submit them to the tax office."

Nicole stared at him. She really didn't think she was appropriately dressed to go into a pub. "I'm not sure if I—"

"Come on. We can go to the bar at The Willows."

Nicole blinked. "The Willows?" What was he playing at, choosing the place where they'd stayed last week?

"Yeah. It's a big hotel not far from the motorway junction."

"Yes, I know it." Her glare would have melted the retinas of a normal man.

"It has a nice bar, apparently. Come on. I'll take Will in my car, and you follow us, just in case you don't know the way."

The three of them walked out of the deserted building and across the carpark. Grinding her teeth, Nicole followed Ciaran's Audi TT through the barrier, off the business park and up to the main road. She briefly considered turning right and going home.

Ciaran flashed her a knowing smile as she locked up in the hotel's car park. "It's nice here, don't you think?"

"Hmm."

He grinned, reaching back into his car for the file and a pack of facemasks. “Do you have your one with the sexy lips on it?”

She held his gaze. “No, it needs washing.”

Laughing, he slipped his hand behind her arm and guided her towards the main doors. They all donned their masks and walked through reception to the bar, where Ciaran pointed towards a table in the corner before heading to order some drinks.

As she sat, Will gave her an awkward smile. “I’m sorry Ciaran felt the need for the drama in the office. He’s known I was coming over for a few days, and he should have told you.”

“Don’t worry about it. I’m sorry you had to witness my behaviour.”

He frowned, as if puzzled.

“Sitting on the desk and flashing my legs,” she explained.

“God, don’t worry about that. It made my day.”

She laughed. “Thanks.”

Will looked a bit younger than Ciaran, and she’d never have guessed they were related. While Ciaran had brown hair and blue eyes, Will’s hair was jet black and his eyes dark brown like Julian’s.

Ciaran arrived at their table carrying two bottles of wine—one red, one white—and three glasses. He saw Nicole’s expression. “Don’t worry, I know you’re driving. I am, too, so Will’s going to have to drink most of this.”

Once seated, he poured a glass of red each for Will and himself, then looked at Nicole. “You want white, I presume?”

She nodded, and thanked him when he’d poured her wine.

Ciaran picked up his own glass and held it up. “To Nicole, a great addition to our little team.”

“To Nicole,” Will echoed, and the three of them clinked glasses. Will sipped his drink. “So, what do you think of our little enterprise?”

Nicole smiled. “It seems to be doing well. Last year’s figures are much better than the ones from the two previous years.”

Ciaran nodded. “And with a bit of luck, the introduction of leasing the equipment will mean next year’s figures are better again.”

“Not necessarily. Moving to leasing usually makes the numbers look worse, because you don’t book the sales margin into gross profit. Instead, it comes in over the life of the lease.”

The men stared at her in silence.

“And,” she continued, “since the cash comes in over time, you may need to get extra financing to buy the stock and pay your staff’s wages, and that will make your balance sheet look worse.” She smiled at their worried expressions. “On the bright side, investors like to see recurring revenue, so your business may be valued higher. Plus, you’ll probably shift more units because the cash requirements of your customers are lower. Less outlay to lease five units than buy two.” She gave a sweet smile, then picked up her wine and took a sip.

Ciaran shook his head. “You’ve never displayed your financial know-how before.”

“Hmm.” She slowly crossed her legs, the whisper of nylon on nylon making him glance down at her knees. “And why do you think that is?”

Will shook his head. “I just hope Boris doesn’t fuck it all up with his Brexit strategy.”

Nicole looked at him. “Are you dreading a no-deal?”

“Amongst other things. What I’m dreading the most is a hard border between us and the north.”

“Where are you based?”

“Galway, on the west coast.” He looked at Ciaran. “You should bring her over, show her our boardroom.”

Ciaran laughed out loud. “He’s trying to be funny—all our business meetings take place in an upstairs room of his parents’ pub.”

Nicole turned to Will and smiled. “Your parents own a pub?”

He nodded.

She looked from one to the other. “You two don’t look like cousins.”

“There’s a reason for that,” Will said with a wry smile.

“We are,” Ciaran assured her. “Will’s dad is my mum’s brother.”

Will took up the explanation. “But my mother isn’t from Ireland, she’s from Myanmar.” He paused. “Actually, it was still called Burma when she lived there. Her family came to Ireland in the seventies.”

“I see.” That explained his colouring.

“I’ve told Will about the arrangement you and Julian have,” Ciaran announced.

Nicole felt her cheeks flush. “Well, thanks for that.” She’d given up glaring. He was obviously impervious.

Will smiled. “I think it sounds like a great arrangement.” He glanced in Ciaran’s direction. “For everyone.”

Feeling more than a little uncomfortable, she nodded. “Well, it works for us.”

“Good on you.” He smiled again.

Ciaran’s eyes twinkled with mischief. “I chose this bar for a reason.”

“Well, there’s a surprise,” she said with as much sarcasm as she could manage.

“Will’s staying here.”

Nicole felt a tightness in her stomach.

Ciaran gave her another disarming smile, then turned to his cousin. “What room are you in?”

Will shrugged, then dug in the pocket of his jeans to find his cardkey. “Three-Oh-Six.”

Ciaran’s eyes widened slightly. “That sounds like a nice room. Is there a desk where we could go through the details of the file?”

Will looked puzzled, then glanced at Nicole. “There is, but this table here’s probably better. There’s only one chair upstairs.”

“Oh.” Ciaran stared at Nicole, as if waiting to see her reaction.

She knew what he was suggesting and was momentarily dumbstruck. Will was either a talented actor, or he hadn’t any idea what Ciaran had in mind.

“What do you think, Nicole?” The corners of Ciaran’s lips twitched.

“I think here in the bar is the best place to discuss what’s in the file.” *You bastard!* “But if we’re being honest, there’s not really anything to discuss. All I’ve done is collate the figures. You see your bank balance every week, so you know how much profit you’ve made. Your overheads are similar to the previous two years, so you should be able to estimate what your tax bill will be.”

Ciaran's eyes bore into Nicole's.

Will switched his gaze between them, looking troubled. "Am I missing something here?"

Nicole turned to look at him. "Ask your cousin."

Ciaran shrugged. "I don't know what you're getting at."

"Oh, I think you do."

Ciaran sat back and laughed. "I just thought it'd be a nice way for us all to celebrate you finishing the bookkeeping."

"Did you?" There was heat between her legs, and she despised herself for it. She was far from happy about the way he'd set this up. "Maybe Will and I could celebrate together in his room while you read the figures, here in the bar..."

Will's startled expression suggested he'd only just realised what was being discussed.

Ciaran offered a mirthless smile. "I should warn Will that he's not allowed to develop any feelings for you, though. Make it obvious that you'll never be interested in him as a person."

She nodded. "That's right. He'll need to understand the difference between physical pleasure and emotional closeness."

Ciaran nodded. "I also know that everything you do is agreed with your husband beforehand, so do you need to make a phone call?"

She thought Julian would be thrilled if she returned home and told him she'd just taken two men, but running it by him first might be the wise option. If nothing else, it'd give him more to think about until she got home.

Nicole reached down into her bag for her phone, then decided to take the entire bag instead. She was so angry, she wanted the option of driving straight home without so much as a bye-bye. After slipping on her facemask, she walked to reception and plonked herself down on one of the leather couches. Then she called her husband.

It took a few seconds for him to pick up. "Hello?" He was obviously surprised to hear from her.

"Hi, it's me."

"I know. Is everything alright?"

"Not really, no."

“What’s wrong?”

“Ciaran seems to be in a playful mood.”

“Isn’t that a good thing?”

“Usually it is, but tonight he’s stepped way over the line. He’s pissed me off.”

“What’s he done?”

She could hear the concern in his voice and struggled to keep the tremor out of her own. “His business partner is over from Ireland. He was waiting in the office, and we’re now in a hotel bar.”

“Ah.” She could imagine Julian’s changing expressions as he worked out the implications.

“And,” she said, “his partner’s staying at the hotel.”

“Ah, right.”

“It’s the same bloody place we met last week, and Ciaran’s even booked him into the same room!”

There was only silence at the other end of the line.

“Ciaran’s also told him about our arrangement, and has just suggested we all go to the room to celebrate me finishing the bookkeeping.”

She could hear him breathing, a slight wheezing as if his throat had constricted, yet still he didn’t say anything. His silence was beginning to test her patience. “Do you understand what I’m saying?”

“He’s suggested you take them both?”

“Yes.”

“And what do you think?”

“I think he’s just proved what a pig-headed bastard he is.”

“You’ve always known that.” There was a cajoling tone in his voice, and she could tell he was smiling.

“Yes, but this is more than him being full of himself. He put me on the spot, and…” Nicole heard her voice echo and took a calming breath. “Julian, things happened when we spent the night here. Things I haven’t told you about.”

“What things?”

“Just…” This wasn’t the time or place to reveal they’d had anal sex; that was something she wanted to discuss when they were naked in bed. “I

feel like Ciaran's trying to punish me because of the plumber. I get the idea he saw himself as special."

"Isn't he special?"

"No. He's just someone we use for our pleasure." She sighed. "I'm going to come home. Do you think he'll try and make things awkward for you at work if I tell him to fuck his partner himself?"

Julian guffawed. "Please don't put that image in my head. But no, don't worry about things at work. It won't be an issue."

"Okay, if you're sure." She picked up her bag and started to push up from the seat. "Right, I'll see you in—"

"Before you do anything..."

Nicole paused, leaning back against the couch again.

"Before you do anything that you might regret, and I don't mean how you handle Ciaran, you should decide *why* you're coming home."

"Because I'm not a piece of meat he can pass around. I hurt his pride by telling him he's just one of the men I use for sex. He's the centre of his own universe, and doesn't like the fact he's not the centre of mine."

"But you knew that when you went to see him tonight. If his partner hadn't been there, what would you and Ciaran be doing now?"

"I know, and you're right. It's just—"

"What's he like?"

"Sorry?"

"The partner from Ireland. What's he like?"

"He seems like a nice guy. Ciaran's suggestion shocked him as much as it did me."

"Is he attractive?"

"Yes, but that doesn't make any—"

"All I'm saying is, don't let Ciaran's behaviour dictate your actions. By all means, tell him to fuck off and drive home. I saw the way you look tonight, and I'd be the happiest man in the world to have you come home all frustrated, dressed like that."

She laughed.

"It's your decision, Nicole, and I'll respect whatever you choose to do."

“Thank you.”

“Out of curiosity, how *do* you feel about it?”

“I’ve just explained—”

“No, I understand how you feel about the way the trap was set. I mean the idea of a threesome. It’s not something we’ve ever discussed.”

“I’m not sure.”

“Think about it, but don’t make your decision based on Ciaran’s behaviour. Base it only on what you want. Does the idea of having a threesome turn you on?”

“I suppose it’d be... Yes, it’s sexy to imagine doing it.”

“So maybe there’s your answer.”

“Are you telling me to do it?”

“No. I’m telling you to decide if *you* want to. Ciaran’s feelings are immaterial.”

Nicole gazed at her reflection in the window and chewed her lip.

“What about you? Would you be happy for me to go to bed with two men?”

“It’s a rather... It’s...” Julian cleared his throat. “Yes, the idea of it’s... Um. It’s very, very...”

“Arousing?” Nicole grinned. It was almost like having the old Julian back.

He guffawed. “The idea of two men pleasuring you at the same time is more than arousing. It’s mind-blowing.”

This surprised her, but in a nice way. “Do *you* want me to do it?” In her mind’s eye, she could see his clenched jaw and intense eyes.

“I want you to decide for yourself.” There was a short silence, then he asked, “Do you want to do it?”

She let out a breath. “Yes. Now you’ve talked me out of my rage, I realise I do.”

“Where are you now?”

“In the hotel reception. They’re still in the bar, waiting for my answer.”

“And what’ll happen?”

“Sorry?”

“When you get to the room. What do you want to happen?”

“I’ve not actually thought about the specific—”

“A spit-roast? Will you suck both their dicks?”

She almost dropped her phone. “I hadn’t—”

“I want you to. I want you to kneel between them and suck them one at a time. I want you to get them both fully hard—”

“Okay, I get it. Be slutty.” She listened to his chuckle, then lowered her voice. “Thank you for being the voice of reason.”

“I understand your discomfort, but I think you should turn it to your advantage.”

“How do you mean?”

“From what you’ve said, Ciaran isn’t happy that he’s not seen as special. But if that’s how he sees you, watching you with his business partner is probably going to hurt him.”

“I hadn’t thought of that.” She smiled. “Maybe I should make sure Ciaran sees how much I enjoy his partner.”

Julian gave a quiet chuckle. “And it’ll serve him right. Will you spend the night there?” He sounded almost hopeful.

“No. No, I’ll definitely come home later tonight.”

“Okay, I’ll wait up. How do you feel?”

She thought about it. “I’m no longer angry, but now I’m nervous.”

“Anything else?”

“Maybe there’s some excitement, too. But it’s a nervous excitement.”

“Are you wet?”

She squeezed her thighs together. “Yes.”

“That’s what I thought. Right, I’ll see you later.”

“I love you.” She wasn’t sure why she’d felt the need to say it.

“I love you, too. Now go and be slutty.” The line went dead.

Nicole stayed where she was for a few moments, then walked back to the bar and stood by the table, her feet apart.

Both men looked up with anxious expressions.

She didn’t bother removing her facemask. “Shall we go up to the room?”

Ciaran smiled broadly while Will looked more than a little surprised. Ciaran picked up the white wine, leaving the empty bottle of red and half-full glasses on the table. As they took the lift, none of them said a word.

Will opened the door and stood back to let the others go in first.

Nicole walked to the middle of the room, slipped off her mask and turned to look at the men. They'd disposed of their face coverings. Ciaran wore a smug smile and a designer suit. Will wore black jeans, a green round-necked sweater and a look of complete disbelief.

She looked at Will and started to unbutton her blouse. "I'm not sure exactly what he's told you, but my husband's happy for me to enjoy myself with other men."

Will nodded, his eyes darting down to her black bra as she removed her blouse and dropped it to the floor.

"Ciaran's *one* of the men I've enjoyed myself with lately." She undid the fastener and zip of her skirt, then wiggled her hips. The skirt slid down and Will took a deep breath. Nicole stepped out of her skirt and stood before them all in black—lace bra, matching panties and suspender belt, stockings and shoes. "And now it appears he wants me to enjoy myself with you, as well."

Will managed to tear his gaze back up to her face. He nodded. "Well... If that's okay with you, it's fine by me."

She smiled. Will was less confident than his cousin, and probably a nicer person, too. She glanced at Ciaran, who seemed more amused than aroused.

With Julian's requests echoing around in her head, Nicole stepped closer and slowly dropped to her knees. She looked up at Will, whose eyes had gone wide. Reaching up, she ran her hand over the bulge in his jeans then unfastened his belt and popped open the buttons of his fly. Releasing his cock from his boxers, she watched his face as she leaned forward and parted her lips.

Will sighed, his eyes never leaving hers. She slid her head forward and back, inching his cock a little deeper into her mouth each time. Then she pushed her face all the way forward until her nose nestled in his pubic hair and his cock was deep in her throat, making him groan.

Slowly pulling back, she released him and turned her attention to Ciaran. “Get your dick out.”

Still wearing his suit, he unbuckled his belt and opened the zip of his trousers. Taking out his cock, he pointed it at her face. “Here you go. I know this is all that’s important to you.”

She resisted the urge to roll her eyes. “Yes it is. Get used to it.” With that, Nicole took his cock deep into her throat, prodding his ballbag with the tip of her tongue. She held him there for a few seconds, then moved back to Will and treated him to the same.

Nicole spent about five minutes on her knees, pleasing and teasing the men in turn before finally sitting back on her heels and looking up at them. “I think it’s my turn now.”

They helped her to her feet and propelled her backwards to the bed. Keeping her shoes on, she allowed them to position her in the middle of the mattress. The men quickly stripped off their own clothes and joined her. To her surprise, Ciaran traced his fingers over her shoulders and down her arms. She’d been expecting one of them to mount her immediately.

Will copied his actions, and she closed her eyes and enjoyed the sensation of being stroked. Both men were gentle, spending several minutes fondling her breasts through her bra and stroking her tummy before moving down to her legs. She felt their hot fingers on the bare flesh of her thighs, then revelled in the feeling of them sliding over the fine denier of her stockings. As the hands made their way back up her legs, she opened her eyes and looked at them.

Her bra fastened at the front, and Nicole unclipped it, pulling the cups aside. Both men immediately slid their hands up to her boobs, caressing the orbs of flesh and teasing her nipples. She moaned and arched her back.

Will lowered his head and took a nipple into his mouth. Ciaran did the same, and she closed her eyes and writhed beneath their ministrations. A hand slid down her tummy and beneath the waistband of her panties. She eased her legs open but kept her eyes shut. She didn’t know whose hand it was, and she didn’t care. A finger skated over her slick, engorged labia.

Pushing her groin up, she sighed as it slipped inside her. The hand rocked, fingering her harder, and she tilted her hips up and down to meet the pressure.

Both mouths released her boobs as the men knelt up and moved on the bed. Nicole decided to keep her eyes closed, adding a little mystery to her evening. She felt the clips of her stockings being undone, then fingers slipping into the waistband of her panties. She raised her bum, and her panties were slipped down her leg and off over her shoes.

Firm hands pushed against the inside of one legs, and she spread them, bending her knees. Someone knelt between them. She could still smell Ciaran's aftershave right up close so it must have been Will preparing to enter her.

Something warm and wet pushed against her cheek. She turned her head toward Ciaran and opened her mouth. He fed her his cock. Just then, Will's cock slipped between her outer lips and into her drenched, waiting cunt.

Nicole groaned around the cock in her mouth, and Ciaran forced it further into her throat. She slipped her hands around Will's waist and undulated beneath him, keeping her head on Ciaran, taking him deep. After just a few minutes, Ciaran whispered something and both men withdrew. She opened her eyes and watched them swap places, then opened her mouth for Will as Ciaran entered her.

Locking her ankles around his calves, she bucked her hips and ground her clit against Ciaran's body as his cock ploughed in and out. Without releasing Will from her mouth, she moaned and shook through her orgasm. Ciaran fucked her harder, bouncing her body. She had to hold Will's cock in place with her hand as she sucked him.

Ciaran groaned. Keeping Will's cock in her mouth, she turned her eyes toward the man fucking her.

He groaned again. "Where do you want me to come?"

She used her free hand to pull at Ciaran's hip to indicate she wanted him to stay inside her.

"My pleasure." He poked hard and fast, then held still. His cock pulsed and twitched and, as she tried to clench around him, a hot gush of cum filled her mouth. Crying out, she wanked the base of Will's cock and bobbed her head, swallowing his load in time to feel a fresh spurt erupt onto her tongue.

Ciaran resumed thrusting and she pumped the base of Will's cock, licking and sucking the tip as the final drops of his orgasm oozed out. She

rocked against Ciaran, but couldn't quite get over the hurdle for a second orgasm. Her entire body trembled, somewhere between frustrated and sated. Gratified, and yet not completely satisfied.

Ciaran withdrew and moved to lie back on her left. Will crawled down the bed and lay on her right.

Nicole relaxed between them and took a breath. So, that was her first threesome. She smiled. "Well, that was fun."

Ciaran propped himself up on one elbow. "Are you glad I suggested it now?"

"I don't appreciate being manipulated, which is how it felt in the bar."

He grinned. "My first idea was to get you bent over my desk with my dick in your mouth, then let Will sneak in and fuck you from behind."

"If you'd done that, I'd have bitten your dick off."

Will shook his head. "There's no way I'd have done that, Nicole. I didn't know anything about this, I promise."

She turned and gave what she hoped was a reassuring smile. "I believe you. I could tell in the bar that both you and I had been kept in the dark."

Ciaran scoffed. "Don't make me out to be the bad guy. I've just seen how much you two enjoyed yourselves."

Nicole looked at Will. "Did you enjoy yourself?"

"God yes."

"Hmm. Me too."

Ciaran looked down the bed. "That'd make a great picture."

Nicole raised her head and looked down at their bodies. There were two sets of hairy legs, one either side of hers. Her suspenders hung free on her thighs. The stockings had slipped down to just above her knees, one slightly higher than the other, and the fuck-me shoes were still on her feet. She looked at Will. "Pass me my bag."

He reached down and passed it to her. Nicole took out her phone, aimed the camera down the bed and snapped several shots. Ciaran had been right. It made a sexy picture, and she couldn't wait to show it to Julian.

Feeling the tell-tale trickle, she switched the camera to selfie mode and took another three photos of her sex, hoping to capture the cum oozing out and dripping down the crack of her backside. A smile crossed her face at the thought of her husband's reaction to those.

Ciaran tutted. "You're unbelievable."

"I know. Now hurry up and get another hard-on."

Will laughed, shaking his head. "You're unlike anyone I've ever met."

She turned and smiled at him. "Thank you, but it's just an act. When I do this, I act like a slut. Most of the time, I'm the sort of girl you'd be happy to let meet your mum."

He smiled and nodded.

"Well," Ciaran said, pushing her into a sitting position. "If you're so eager for me to get hard, why not give me some encouragement?"

Nicole twisted round and knelt between the men's legs, facing them. She looked down at their cocks. Both were flaccid and coated with her body fluids. She put her phone down. "Neither of these look worth photographing."

Ciaran manoeuvred himself until he was lying flat on his back. "Maybe if you suck some life into them, they'll be worth taking a picture of then."

"Hmm, maybe." Nicole leaned down and ran her tongue along the shaft of his cock, the taste of her own juices exciting her. Then she slipped the end into her mouth and hummed, knowing the vibrations would feel nice for him. She spent a minute or so doing this, then released him and turned her attention to Will's. He was already semi-hard. In less than a minute, she was bobbing her head up and down on his full erection. She continued until he was breathing hard, then released him and looked back at Ciaran.

In his hand was her phone. He'd either taken photos or a video of her sucking Will's cock.

She smiled sweetly. "I hope the dirty pictures are helping."

He moved the camera up to his chest, still pointing the lens at her face. "See for yourself."

Nicole looked into the lens and leaned down to take his tip into her mouth. He was now fully hard. After sucking him for a while, she released his cock. “And now, you can film this...” Crawling up his legs, she held his cock vertical, got into position and slowly lowered herself onto it.

She closed her eyes and let out a long breath, then looked into the camera and started to thrust her hips.

Ciaran smiled at her from over the phone. “How does it feel?”

“It feels good, but”—she nodded toward the other side of the bed—“I think I’ll give that one a try now.” With that, Nicole dismounted and crawled over to straddle Will. As soon as she was riding his cock, she smiled back at the camera. “This one feels pretty good, too.”

Ciaran chuckled and kept filming.

Nicole returned to ride Ciaran for a minute or so, then moved back to Will.

Ciaran sat up and pressed his hand against Nicole’s back, encouraging her to lie on Will’s chest.

Her heart raced. She knew why he was getting her into this position.

Ciaran ran his hand down her back and caressed her bum cheeks, then leaned close. He was probably capturing the image of her with Will’s cock buried inside. He slipped his fingers down her arse crack, which was soaked from her own juices and his cum seeping out earlier. He pushed a finger in, making her groan. He worked it in and out, then added a second, stretching her.

“Oh, this is as hot and tight as I remember,” Ciaran murmured, going deep. “I know you like it. I know this is what you want.”

Nicole looked down at Will, who was staring up with a stunned expression. He could probably feel Ciaran’s fingers moving against his dick.

Ciaran positioned himself between her legs. She held her breath as his cock pressed against her rosebud. He pushed, and she squeezed her eyes shut as the pain built until his cockhead slipped inside.

Trying to relax as much as she could, she puffed through her lips like an expectant mother in the delivery room. Now he was inside, the pain was replaced by an overwhelming sense of fullness. Ciaran eased himself in, feeding in more of his cock with each thrust. The sensation of taking two

cocks inside her was incredible—what was it like for the men, though? Surely they'd be aware of the other cock pushing against their own.

They moved at different times, one sliding in as the other slid out, and then sometimes moving in synchrony. Nicole closed her eyes, lost on a sea of pleasure. She'd always tried to keep the upper hand when with Ciaran, but at this moment it took all her concentration to breathe.

Crushed between two hard bodies, all she wanted was for them to use her. To be nothing more than a piece of meat.

To be their slut.

A groan rattled her chest. It had started somewhere deep but never made it to her lips. She groaned again, the tremors of an orgasm rumbling through her loins.

She pretended she could see inside herself, imagined the two cocks sliding together, sparking lines of electricity arcing from the tip of one to the other, burning through the membrane.

Digging her knees into the mattress, Nicole jerked her body between the men. There was no pain now, just the wonderful feeling of being crammed. Of getting thoroughly fucked. Of becoming completely...

"Oh fuck." She could hardly breathe. "Oh my... fuck."

It was as if a pinball had been fired into her guts and was ricocheting around her body. Each prod of cock produced buzzes and bells, and behind her eyelids neon lights flashed—red, blue and pink.

Nicole clung to Will's head, crushed against him as Ciaran plunged her depths from behind. She screamed when the orgasm finally burst. Will groaned, and she thought he was coming too, but when she opened her eyes he was trying to get his hair from her shaking hands. She released her grip and started to apologise, then was shaken by another orgasm. Her contractions drove Ciaran to fuck her harder. He grunted in her ear, then warmth spread inside her. Will held his breath and jerked beneath her.

Two men were coming in her at the same time. Nicole closed her eyes and writhed between them, both still pumping their hips in the throes of their own release. Another spasm racked her, clenching every muscle in her body. All three groaned and shook until they eventually stopped moving and lay in a tangle of limbs, breathing heavily.

Eventually, Ciaran pulled out and rolled onto the other side of the bed. Nicole stayed where she was, her boobs crushed against Will's chest, his shrinking cock still inside her. She heard clicks and knew Ciaran was taking more photographs.

He dropped her phone on the bed and stood. "I need a shower. Care to join me?" Without waiting for an answer, he walked into the bathroom.

Easing herself up and off Will, Nicole felt their juices seeping out. She lay on her back for a few seconds, considering what else she might enjoy with two men. Would Julian be disappointed if she left before indulging in a spit-roast? She stared at the anonymous ceiling of the anonymous bedroom, and then in the direction of the bathroom, where the master manipulator had gone. Julian might be disappointed not to hear of further exploits taking place tonight, but her decision was made.

She sat up, found her discarded bra and slipped her arms through the straps.

Will looked up at her. "Are you leaving?"

Pulling the cups over her boobs and fastening the clip, she looked up him. "Yes, I think now's the time to take my leave."

"About earlier, I really had no idea what he had planned. I never—"

"I know." She found her panties and pulled them on, then rolled her stockings back up and attached them to her suspender belt.

He sat up. "Ciaran's a lucky guy."

"Hmm. Though I'm not sure he deserves to get lucky again after the trick he pulled tonight." She stood up, straightened her suspenders and stepped into her skirt.

"Didn't you enjoy it?" He looked disappointed.

She laughed. "Couldn't you tell? Of course I enjoyed it."

"Phew. I was worried that I'd not done my part right."

She shook her head. "Men! Always obsessed about their own performance." She bent and kissed his cheek. "You were wonderful."

"What's going on?" Ciaran stood in the doorway, a towel in his hand. He was completely naked, droplets of water covering his athletic body.

Under different circumstances, she might have been tempted to get back on the bed. Instead, she picked up her blouse. "I've just thanked Will

for giving me such a nice time.” She walked over and stood before him. “And I thank you, too.” She looked deep into his eyes, hoping he would see he’d hurt her. “But I wish you’d asked if I liked the idea, first.”

“I did ask.”

“Not until you’d got us here. This was more awkward than it needed to be”—she nodded toward the bed—“for Will and for me.”

“Sorry.” His smirk suggested he wasn’t sorry at all.

Nicole wanted to slap him, and knew it was over. She wouldn’t have sex with Ciaran ever again. Fastening her blouse, she picked up her phone. After dropping it into her bag, she turned to the bed. “It was lovely meeting you, Will.”

“Yeah, you too.” He gave her a smile.

She headed for the door. “Bye, Ciaran.”

“I’ll call you.”

She opened the door and turned to look at him. “Why? I’ve finished the bookkeeping.”

He looked bewildered, his mouth agape.

Nicole stepped out into the corridor and headed for the lift. It was time to go home and tell her husband what a dirty girl she’d been.

As she walked through the hotel reception, two men sitting together on a leather couch followed her progress. She watched their reflection in the floor-to-ceiling window, their heads turning in unison to check her out from behind. They couldn’t see her expression beneath the facemask. Nor could they see the inside of her panties, damp front and back where semen seeped out of her. She’d just experienced her first threesome and should have been floating on a cloud of sexual euphoria, but for the first time since she’d become a hotwife, she felt dirty and cheap.

It was almost eleven when she pulled into the drive at home. Once in the house, she went straight to the lounge. Julian must have seen her car headlights because the TV was muted and he was standing on the rug by the fire.

She walked slowly across the hardwood floor and stopped a few feet from him. “Hi.”

He ran his eyes down her body, then looked back at her face. “Welcome home.”

She forced a smile. "Thank you. How was your evening?"

"Oh, you know. The usual. Couple of drinks, a little TV. I also got a phone call."

"Really?" She stepped closer, watching his eyes. She could sense his pent-up energy. His frustration. "And was the phone call from that slut of a wife of yours?"

"Mm-hmm."

"And what did she want?"

Julian began to undo the buttons of her blouse. "She wanted my permission to sleep with two men at the same time."

"What a hussy!"

"My thoughts exactly." He slipped the blouse back and off her shoulders, sending it onto the floor behind her feet.

"So, what did you say?" She turned to the side so he could reach the fastener of her skirt.

"What could I say? She was already at a hotel with them." He slid her zip down. "They had a room there, with a bed big enough for three people."

"Wow. That's just..." Her skirt slid down her stockinged legs and pooled around the four-inch spiked heels. "Talk about asking too late."

"Hmm."

"What did you do?"

His dark eyes bore into hers. "I gave her my permission."

"She's a lucky girl."

"I agree. Get on your knees."

Though a little shocked, Nicole did as instructed. In a way, it seemed appropriate. During all her previous encounters with Ciaran, she'd taken control. Likewise, on returning home to tell her husband about what she'd done, she'd been the one calling the shots. Tonight had been different. In the hotel, she'd submitted herself to Ciaran and Will. And now, it appeared that Julian intended to dominate her as well.

Nicole looked up into his face. "You want me on my knees like this?"

"Yes. Because that's what I told her to do with the men."

“To kneel before them?” She desperately wanted to enjoy this game. Julian’s new-found self-confidence was showing everywhere, now—not just in the boardroom at work.

“I told her to kneel between them and suck their dicks.”

“Wow.” She licked her lips for effect, regretting not re-applying her sexy red lip-gloss before coming into the house. “And do you think she did it?”

He reached down and unzipped his trousers. “I expect so. She’s a cocksucker.”

Trying to hide her surprise, she lowered her eyes to his crotch as he pulled out his dick. It was already hard. “And will she suck your dick too, when she gets home?”

“Like I say, she’s a cocksucker.”

His tone made her shiver. She tried to keep the roleplay going. “But if she did what you told her to earlier, sucking you would mean she’d have had three different dicks in her mouth in a single night.”

“Yes, I suppose it would.” He flashed a lascivious grin. “But she’s such a slut, she’d think that was fun.”

Nicole knelt up a little and leaned forward. Parting her lips, she watched his face and she leaned in and took the entire length of him into her mouth and throat. Keeping eye contact, she slowly slid her head forward and back on his cock.

Julian’s eyes fluttered, and he took several short breaths. “I wonder if any of the other dicks came in her mouth.”

She kept him in her mouth until his thigh muscles went taut, then released him. “Would you like for them to have done that?”

“It’s a sexy image.”

“What is?”

“My slutty wife, on her knees sucking a cock, then gulping down the spunk he shoots into her mouth.”

She couldn’t believe her ears. His behaviour tonight was unlike anything he’d ever shown before. She wasn’t sure she could stay in character long enough to satisfy him.

“What do you think?” he asked, sliding his fist up and down his cock. “Do you think they would have come in her mouth?”

She held eye contact, paused for effect, then licked her lips again. “I expect... I expect one of them did.”

Another lusty grin creased his face, but then he frowned. “What’s wrong?”

Determined not to spoil this for him, she tried to smile. Her eyes prickled and she blinked. Tears ran down her cheeks.

Julian tucked his cock away and pulled her up, wrapping her in his arms. “Nicole, what is it?”

Shielded in his warm embrace, she lay her head against his chest for a moment, feeling safe. Then she looked up into his concerned face. “I shouldn’t have done it.”

“Didn’t you enjoy it?”

She laughed, wiping her cheeks as she nodded. “The physical side was good.” She took a breath to control her breathing, swallowing back the sobs. “Actually, the physical side was a lot better than good. It was fantastic. But afterwards, I felt like I’d let myself down.”

“What, physically?” He looked confused.

She laughed and slapped his chest. “No, of course not. I was a slut queen and gave them both a wonderful time.” More tears welled up, clouding her vision. “But on the way home, I kept thinking how I must have appeared to them. Some cheap, dick-hungry slut with no self-respect.”

“We both know that’s not who you are.”

“Really?” She stared at him, seeing her own face reflected in his dark, worried eyes. “After tonight, I’m not so sure.”

He sighed and pulled her close again. “I’m sorry.”

“Why are you sorry?”

“Because I talked you into doing it.” He pulled his head back and looked at her. “You wanted to come home, and I talked you out of it. I put my own desires ahead of your self-esteem, and that’s unforgivable.”

She shook her head. This was on her, not Julian. “Don’t say that. It’s not your fault.”

“Yes it is. I was the one who convinced you to do it.”

She kissed his chest. “Let’s not fight over whose fault it was. It’s done now.” She tried to give a sexy smile. “This conversation isn’t helping

your needs any, so why don't we—?" She saw him shaking his head vigorously. "No? Why not?"

"Have you taken a shower?"

"No, I thought..." She didn't finish the sentence. *Clean-up.*

"Why don't you go and run a bath? I'll bring a drink up."

Nicole nodded, disappointed that she hadn't been able to satiate his needs after the hours of anticipation he'd endured. She headed upstairs to the family bathroom, turned on the taps and added a generous squirt of bubble-bath. In the bedroom she stripped, grabbed her robe and headed back to the tub.

Julian came in ten minutes later with a glass of white wine and a bottle of beer. He handed her the wine.

"Thank you." The steam instantly condensed on her glass. "Do you want to get in, too?"

He smiled and shook his head, sitting down on the stripped pine captain's chair left by the previous owners.

"I'm sorry I've ruined your—"

"You haven't ruined anything," he assured her. "Stop apologising."

She nodded, took a sip of her drink. "I'm not going to see Ciaran again."

"Okay."

"You don't mind?" She thought he'd be disappointed.

"I don't want you to do anything you're uncomfortable with."

"Thank you."

He gave her a reassuring smile, but didn't say any more. She got the impression he was letting her gather her thoughts and bring things up in her own time. They sat in a comfortable silence for several minutes.

"I'm not saying I want to stop what we're doing," she said. "I just don't want to do it with him anymore."

"That's fine."

"Do you want to carry on? You know, with this... loaning thing."

"Yes. But only if you're still comfortable with it."

"I am. But I won't be put into situations like that again. I've usually kept the upper hand, but tonight I decided to be more submissive. I thought

it'd be nice for a change."

"And was it?"

She sat quietly for some time, enjoying the soothing water while Julian waited patiently. Eventually, she nodded. "Yes and no. Tonight was the first time I wasn't in control. I allowed myself to be used. The physical side of that was great." She flashed him a smile. "There's something to be said for allowing two men to just use your body. But thinking about it emotionally..." She shook her head. "If it wasn't for Ciaran's manipulating behaviour, tonight could have been wonderful. I think I cheapened myself by going along with it, and I'll never forgive him for making me feel that way."

"Okay." Julian looked sombre, but then a playfulness appeared in his expression. "But you might take the submissive role again?"

"Maybe. I enjoy taking charge, too. It depends on the situation." She grinned. "And on the man."

They finished their drinks in peaceful silence. Eventually he nodded at her glass.

"Want a top up?"

"No, I'm fine thanks. Why don't you turn the lights off downstairs and we'll go to bed."

He took her empty glass and left the bathroom. Nicole finished washing herself, then lay back in the hot water for a few more minutes before getting out. By the time she was dry, the rest of the house was in darkness. Julian was waiting for her in bed.

She climbed in naked and scooted up close. He slipped his arm around her shoulder and stroked her hair, then turned off the bedside light.

After a few moments, she kissed his neck. "Am I really a cocksucker?"

He gave a quiet chuckle, then kissed her on the top of her head. "Yes, but only in a wonderful way."

"If you like, I can do it in a wonderful way for you now. Or I could climb on top and—"

He shushed her by putting his finger to her lips, and kissed her forehead. "We'll have a lifetime together for you to do those things. Tonight, all I want to do is hold you."

She blinked away her grateful tears. “Thank you.”

He kissed her forehead again, and she closed her eyes and fell asleep in his arms.



Approved by The Board

Ψ



Chapter One

Nicole and Julian spent the weekend after her threesome in what seemed like a sexual vacuum, neither of them mentioning what she'd done on Friday evening. Julian spent his Saturday unpacking tools and finding places for them in his new garage, and Nicole cut back all the dead foliage from the shrubs in the garden. On Sunday, they walked hand-in-hand around the estate to get their bearings along the numerous paths running through the surrounding fields and woods.

It was Monday morning by the time Nicole finally broached the subject of having told Julian's boss that she wouldn't be seeing him again. She stroked her husband's hand across the breakfast table. "You'll be civil today, right? And professional."

He flashed her a grin. "I'm always civil and professional. But if you're referring to how I'll behave with Ciaran, there'll be no need. I won't see him until Thursday at the earliest."

"Oh?" She tried to remember if either of them had mentioned not going to the office this week. "Why's that?"

"Ciaran's going to be spending today and tomorrow at the Leeds branch, and I'll be visiting clients on Wednesday with a new member of my team. But as I've said before, what happens between you and Ciaran will have no bearing on my relationship with him. We've only ever discussed work-related issues in the entire time you two have been seeing each other, and I see no reason why that will change."

"Good." Having her husband's boss as a bull was fraught with potential complications; she was still worried that dropping him as a bull may prove troublesome.

Ciaran had been the perfect bull—handsome, fit and hung. His self-confidence bordered on arrogance, but with his designer suits and penchant for women in stockings and high-heels, he'd treated Nicole to several enjoyable encounters in his office. To counteract his cockiness, she'd been inspired to act out of character. Strutting into his large office wearing a crisp blouse, figure-hugging skirt and heels she could barely walk in, she'd

become the empowered slut. She'd stripped down to her lingerie, bent over his desk and ordered him to pleasure her. They'd both loved every minute of it, but Friday night had changed all that.

"How about you?" Julian asked, breaking her from her reverie.
"Anything exciting in your calendar?"

"No, just more of the usual drudgery."

He laughed and went off to get his jacket and briefcase.

After he'd left, Nicole tidied the kitchen and made another cup of tea, then headed off to start work on her laptop.

She received a text from Ciaran just before lunch.

*I'm in the Yorkshire office for a couple of days.
Fancy meeting up later in the week?*

She'd intended ignoring his texts completely, but decided she'd have to answer.

No.

The bookkeeping's finished, and I don't like being manipulated.

She got an instant reply.

*The way you reacted to having two men
manipulating your body at the same time suggests
otherwise. :-)*

Seething, Nicole typed out a succinct *Fuck off* and put her phone to one side. A couple of minutes later, it pinged again. Though sorely tempted to delete without reading then block his number, she opened the message.

*Sorry, I was joking. If you send me your bank
details, I'll pay you for all the bookkeeping you've
done.*

She did so, then put him out of her mind and went back to concentrating on her day job.

She had the satisfaction of finishing everything she needed to do by the time the office furniture they'd ordered was delivered later in the afternoon. She spent a rewarding couple of hours after dinner putting her new desk together and getting her own workspace just as she wanted it.

When they went to bed that night, Nicole didn't bother with her usual attire of vest top and panties. Julian's expression at her nakedness made her smile.

"I want to make up for the disappointment of my return home on Friday night."

"There's nothing to make up."

She leaned close and traced kisses along his jawline, the hair of his beard softer now it'd grown a bit longer. "I'm not offering kinky fun. That'll come later. Tonight, I want to make love to you."

"That sounds nice."

"Nice?" She eased his boxers down his thighs and wrapped her fingers around his growing erection. "Your sexy young wife offers to make love to you, and it's just nice?"

He grinned. "Should I have said arousing?"

She pinched his nipple and laughed. "I think it's probably best if you don't say anything." Nicole climbed on top and guided him inside. They both sighed, and she moved slowly on him. He ran his hands over her back and bum, and they kissed often as she rode him. After she'd reached her orgasm, her legs lost strength and Julian guided her hips to help her move her on him.

Nicole bit into his shoulder when she knew he was on the brink, and he cried out and shuddered beneath her. She held him close and clenched herself around his cock as it jerked and spasmed.

Nicole fell asleep lying on top with his arms around her waist.

* * * *

Tuesday was one of her days off so, after Julian had headed off to work, Nicole decided to go for another walk around the footpaths they'd discovered a few days earlier. She enjoyed the bright December morning walking through fields and woods, encountering only a few joggers. The trees were bare, many birds and squirrels hopping through the branches.

As she made her way back up their road, neighbour Liz passed in her car and waved. Liz was still unloading shopping bags from her car when Nicole passed their drive.

She waved. "Morning."

"Hi Nicole. Fancy a coffee?"

"Yeah, that'd be lovely." She paused on the driveway. "Am I allowed to come inside? The law seems to change every five minutes."

Liz laughed and shrugged. "Yeah, I know. I'm sure it'll be fine."

Nicole left her walking boots outside the front door and followed her hostess through to the kitchen.

"How are you guys settling in?" Liz asked, putting milk and yogurts into the fridge.

"Great, thanks. We discovered the paths through the woods at the weekend, and I've just been down there again."

"Next time you go, could I come with you?"

"Sure." Nicole nodded. "That'd be nice."

Liz sighed. "This whole year's been so weird. I'm going stir-crazy, and now they're saying there's going to be another lockdown."

"Yeah, I wish they'd hurry up and get the vaccine sorted."

Liz slipped off her coat. "Tea or coffee?"

"Ooh, tea, please."

Taking two mugs from a cupboard, Liz asked, "How was your night out with the girls?"

She remembered meeting Liz and her husband on her way out to see Ciaran. She saw no need to confess that she'd spent the evening in a hotel room getting pleased by two men. "It was nice, thanks."

"Well, you certainly made an impression on Ed." She gave a grin. "I think he rather approved of your decision to dress up, not down."

Nicole grimaced. "Oh God! We'd all agreed to dress a bit slutty."

"Well, I'm not complaining. He kept me awake for most of the night."

Nicole stared, open-mouthed.

"Sorry, TMI?" Liz cackled, pouring the boiling water into the teapot. "I guess I need to rein back my dirty side."

“No, don’t rein back at all. I was just a little...”

Liz poured the tea and took a seat on the opposite side of the kitchen island. “So, where were you guys living before you moved here?”

“Just a few miles down the road. On the Meadows estate.”

“Oh, okay. We used to live on the other side of town and only moved in a couple of months before you did.”

“Do you work?” Nicole asked.

“Officially I work for Ed, but that’s mainly for tax purposes. He has his own business and I do some ‘admin’ so he can pay himself some of his salary at the lower tax band.” She shrugged, either not understanding it or not caring. “How about you?”

“I’ve been part-time at home for the last nine months. I work for the Tax Office.”

Liz’s face blanched.

Nicole burst out laughing. “I’m joking. I work for a local company that makes heating system controls.”

“You bitch! Nearly gave me a heart attack.”

Nicole was still giggling. “Sorry. Maybe I should rein back my evil sense of humour.”

“Tell you what, you can show me more of your humour if I can show you more of my dirty side.”

“I’d like that.” Nicole wondered if she’d ever show her own dirty side to their new neighbour. They chatted and laughed while they finished their tea, then Nicole headed back home.

While pottering around in the garden that afternoon, her mind started to wander. Although last night’s love-making had been sensual and rewarding, she suspected Julian would need more than that to scratch his kinky itch. The days when her husband was satisfied after missionary with the lights off had long since passed. The wife-sharing voyeur he’d evolved into needed to hear about, and visualise, everything she’d done with another man.

Tonight, Nicole would tell him everything she’d done with *two* other men. She smiled at the thought of how he’d react to her having done anal and reminded herself to slip the tube of K-Y into her bedside drawer for later. No doubt Julian would want to experience it for himself.

As the light faded, she went inside to prepare dinner. Once the casserole was in the oven and she'd set the table in the dining room, she then went upstairs to shower. By the time Julian's car pulled into the drive, she'd showered and dressed in a knee-length skirt and sparkly top.

He smiled as he came into the kitchen. "Hi." After putting his briefcase down, he let his gaze wander down her body. "Have you been out?"

She shook her head, stepped close and offered a cheek, which he duly kissed.

He inhaled. "You smell nice."

"I got dirty and sweaty in the garden, so I needed a shower."

"It's not soap or shampoo I can smell. It's perfume."

Nicole slipped a hand inside his jacket lapel and stroked his chest. Sometimes she loved the fact she was almost a foot shorter than him when barefoot. She smiled up into his eyes. "I thought maybe you could help me get dirty and sweaty again later... in the bedroom."

He grinned, then turned serious. "There's no need. If you don't feel ready—"

"I'm ready." She tilted her head towards the hall. "Go get changed, then pour yourself a drink. Dinner's ready."

As he headed upstairs, she plated up their food and carried it to the dining room. Returning to the kitchen, she poured herself a glass of white wine from the fridge and grabbed an empty glass for Julian. He came downstairs dressed in jeans and a black t-shirt, chose a bottle of red from the rack, and sat opposite.

"So, how was your day?" she asked.

"Fine. I had another call from Keith, and he—"

"Keith?"

"The sales director. He's suggested I go down to Head Office next week."

"Oh?"

"He wants to chat about the company-wide implementation of the algorithm. He's worried that if we don't sort it soon, there'll be another lockdown which would postpone it for a few months."

“Will it be an overnight stay?”

He nodded, then smiled. “Why, are you thinking of arranging another night out with your bull?”

“No. It’s a nice offer, but I’m between bulls at the moment.”

“You’re not going to go back to Ciaran?”

“I got a text yesterday asking if we could meet later this week, and I said no.”

“How did he take it?”

“I’m hoping he got the message. He asked for my bank details so he could pay me for the work I did on his accounts.”

“And has he paid?”

“I haven’t checked yet.”

They ate for a while, then he asked about her day.

“I’ve had a really nice one, making the most of the sunshine. This morning I repeated the walk we took the other day, and then spent a few hours in the garden this afternoon.” She took a sip of wine. “Actually, I bumped into Liz from next door on my way back from my walk and popped in for a cuppa. Apparently they only moved in a couple of months before us.”

“Ah, okay. It’s nice that you’ve got someone close by that you can chat with.”

“I think we’re going to get on, she seems like a lot of fun. Did I mention I’d also met her husband?”

He shook his head.

“They arrived home just as I was heading out to meet Ciaran on Friday—the first impression he got was that I dressed like a high-class escort.”

Julian chuckled.

She shook her head, still cringing. “I made some lame excuse about me and the girls from work doing a DUND thing, and—”

“A what?”

“DUND – dress up, not down. Anyway, from what Liz said today, I think he liked my outfit. She said it inspired him to keep her awake for most of the night.”

He laughed out loud. “So, what are they like? I don’t think I’ve seen either of them.”

“Liz is friendly and attractive. Maybe your age, slim with a curly blonde bob. Ed’s probably ten years older than her. He has his own business, but I don’t know what he does. Liz gets a salary, but I don’t think she actually does anything to earn it.”

“If he kept her up all night, I think that tells you what she does to earn it.”

Nicole giggled. “I think that’s part of the marriage contract and nothing to do with her salary.”

“Speaking of jobs,” he said, picking up his wine glass, “do you remember I’m visiting clients to introduce Mitchell tomorrow?”

“Yes, I remember. What’s your new team member like?”

“Very young, and very shy.” He grinned. “Probably not your type.”

“I wasn’t asking for that, and I certainly don’t intend getting involved with another of your colleagues.”

“Sorry, I was being facetious. Although he’s bright, I worry that he’s too introverted to impress most people.”

“Sounds familiar.”

He gave his trademark embarrassed smile. “I think that might be why they’ve put him in my team. But I brought it up now because I need to prepare a few things beforehand.”

Nicole tried to keep the disappointment from her face “You’re going to work tonight?”

“It won’t take me long, I promise. I just need to gather some info and print a couple of things out. An hour at most.”

“Okay. Do you want to do it now, or wait until you’ve satiated your slutty wife?”

He guffawed and put his glass down. “I worry that if I don’t do it now, I’ll be too tired to do it later. My slutty wife can be quite demanding, now that she’s used to taking two men at once.”

“Hmm. Go and do whatever you need. I’ll clear up. And drink more wine.”

He helped her carry the plates through to the kitchen, where he picked up his briefcase and headed up to his office. Nicole loaded the dishwasher, tidied the kitchen and topped up her glass.

Back in the lounge, she curled her legs beneath her on the couch and sipped her wine, planning how to tell Julian about the better part of her Friday night adventures. Or should she go back a bit further and tell him about her overnight stay in the hotel with Ciaran? That had been her first anal experience; opening her sex-talk with that particular night would pave the way for describing how she came to take both Ciaran and Will inside her at the same time on Friday. She regretted not telling him about her first anal experience sooner, because then she could go straight into her description of the threesome, which she was looking forward to. She'd only just worked out how to get her stories in order when Julian returned to the living room, smiling.

“All done.”

“That was quick. Want to talk here, or in bed?”

“During your entire adult life, how many men have chosen to sit with you on a couch over taking you to bed?”

She put a finger to her chin and looked up at the ceiling as if thinking about it. “Erm... None.”

“So there’s your answer.” Without waiting, he turned and headed upstairs. Nicole followed him up, taking her glass of wine with her.

Once in the bedroom, Julian quickly stripped and climbed into bed. He sat up and watched as she pulled off her top, slid down her skirt and knelt on the bed in her bra and panties.

She leaned close and kissed him gently. “So, I know you’ll have questions about Friday, but first—”

“Tell me what they said when you returned to the bar after our phone call.”

“I don’t think they said anything, but before we get onto—”

“What did you say?”

She sighed. “I can’t remember exactly. I didn’t sit down. I just walked back to the table and suggested we go to the room.”

Julian closed his eyes, and she knew he was visualising the scene in his head. Best to change tack and let him have his moment, then. She’d

have to double back to her big revelation later.

“What did they say to that?” he prompted.

“I don’t think either of them replied. They just got up and we all walked to the lift. I can’t remember anyone speaking until we were in the hotel room. And before you ask, I think I did most of the talking from that point. I told Will that you were happy for me to enjoy myself with other men, and that Ciaran was just one of the men I had sex with.”

“Ha! I hope that hurt him.”

“It was why I’d said it, but he didn’t seem to be hurt. He was grinning like a Cheshire cat. So, as I was telling Will this, I removed my blouse and then my skirt.”

“What were they wearing?”

“Ciaran was in a suit and tie, Will had on jeans and a jumper.”

He opened his eyes, grinning apologetically. “I’m sorry, I just—”

“I get it. You like to see it in your head.” She stroked his chest. “Anyway, as you’d suggested when I rang you, I stepped in front of them and dropped to my knees. I’d decided to start with Will, so I unzipped his jeans and took out his cock.”

“Was he big?”

She shrugged. “I didn’t measure or compare, but he was big enough. And he was hard. I leaned in and took him into my mouth and sucked him, watching his face as I did it. Then I pulled back and told Ciaran to get his dick out.”

“You didn’t undo his trousers like you did for Will?”

“No. He made some sarky comment about his dick being all I cared about. I should have bit it, but instead I sucked him for a while before moving back to do Will again.”

“How long did you spend there?”

“Not long. I alternated between them, sucking each one for about half a minute at a time. Probably for about five minutes or so.”

“And one of them came in your mouth.”

She was puzzled, then remembered she’d told him that much when she’d returned home. “Yes, one of them did, but neither of them came at

that point. I stood up and told them it was my turn for pleasure, and they manoeuvred me onto the bed.”

“Still wearing your underwear and stockings?”

She nodded. “And my shoes. They stripped and got on the bed, one on either side. Then they started to stroke me, which was a surprise.”

“Why?”

“I thought they’d be eager to...” She smiled and shrugged. “I’d just sucked their cocks and sort of teased them. I expected them to fuck me.”

“Were they returning the pleasure and teasing?”

“Yeah, I guess. So I lay still, enjoying being stroked and fondled.”

“How did they fondle you, and where?”

“Just touching me through my underwear. Boobs, tummy, legs.”

“They didn’t take anything off?”

She shook her head. “My bra fastened at the front, and I undid it for them. They played with my boobs and then each sucked a nipple. I closed my eyes and enjoyed it. While this was happening, one of them fingered me.”

“Which one?”

She reached down and wrapped her fingers around his cock. It was semi-hard, the tip already slick with clear precum. “I don’t know. I didn’t open my eyes.”

“Did you come?”

“No, it didn’t go on for long. But then they both undid the suspender clips from my stockings to get my panties off.”

He looked puzzled. “Don’t you usually put your panties on over your suspenders to save you unclipping stockings every time you need to pee?”

She laughed. “Look at you, Mr. Practical. Yes, I sometimes do, but it depends on the design of the panties. I wanted to look good. When I left on Friday night, I’d only expected to sit on Ciaran’s desk and have him pull the gusset aside, so I’d put my panties on first. The detour to the hotel and the threesome hadn’t been in the game plan.”

“Ah, right. Sorry...”

She squeezed another pearl of precum from him, then leaned closer to look into his eyes. “Want me to get this inside me before I continue?”

“Be warned, I may not last until the end of the story.”

“That’s fine. I’m sure I’ll be able to coax you into going again, later.” She slipped off her panties and straddled him, watching his face as she lowered herself onto his cock.

Reaching up, he ran his fingers over her lace-covered nipples. “Take your bra off.”

She obliged and jiggled her boobs. “Happy now?”

“Very. So, they unclipped your stockings...”

“Then pulled off my panties, and—”

“Who did? Which man took them off?”

She sighed in frustration. “My eyes were closed. When fingers hooked into my waist-band, I raised my bum and they were dragged off.”

“And then?”

“Then one of them got between my legs and got into position to enter me.”

“They didn’t reciprocate the oral sex?”

“What?”

“Didn’t they go down on you?”

“No.” That hadn’t occurred to her at the time, or since. “Neither of them licked me.” She rocked her hips, trying to move things along. “I still didn’t open my eyes but, from their positions on the bed, I knew it was Will kneeling between my legs. I felt Ciaran press his cock against my face, so I turned my head and opened my mouth. Then they both pushed in.” She leaned over Julian and looked into his eyes, letting her hair drape down on either side of his face. “And for the first time ever, your slutty little wife had two dicks in her at the same time.”

Julian placed his hands on her hips to slow her movements, presumably to make him last a little longer. He took a breath. “How did it feel?”

“Slutty. Wait, does that count as a spit-roast?”

“What?”

“I had a dick in my cunt and another in my mouth, but I was on my back. Don’t I have to be on all fours with a man kneeling at each end to qualify as a spit-roast?”

“I don’t know.” He cupped her breasts. “Did you come like that?”

“Yes, but I’m not sure when. After a while, the men swapped places. I can’t remember whose dick I came on.”

Julian’s breathing grew ragged. “Did they come with you?”

He was obviously close, so she reached down and placed a finger on either side of her clit. “No, I came first. They carried on for a while, and both came pretty much at the same time. Ciaran inside, and Will in my mouth.”

Julian’s mouth dropped open and she felt his cock shudder as it unloaded. She rubbed faster with her fingers, getting herself over the line. Her contraction made him cry out, and she jerked her hips forward and back until he’d finished coming.

She lay down on his chest and kissed his neck. “I’m sorry you had to wait to hear about it.”

He slipped his arms around her and stroked her back. “It was worth the wait.”

She suddenly remembered the photo she’d taken of their legs. “Ooh, wait here.” Within moments, she was back in bed, the picture gallery in her phone opened for him to see. He peered over at the image of three pairs of legs, men lying either side of a woman, her stockings rolled down her thighs.

“Oh, I like that.” Julian sat up next to her and took her phone for a closer look. “I really like that.”

“I took a couple. Click through.”

He slid his thumb across the screen and brought up another almost identical image. Then a third. He looked closer and nodded. “I think this one’s even better. You’ve moved your leg slightly, and we can now see the heel of your shoe. It’s very sexy.”

Nicole took the phone back and, keeping the screen out of Julian’s view, slid through to the next three photos. They were all close-ups of her sex with cum seeping out. She chose the one that showed the biggest glob and then passed it back.

His eyes went wide. “Oh my word!”

“Is that sexy?”

“It’s... pornographic.”

She worried she’d gone too far. “Sorry, I thought—”

“No, no! It’s fine.” He glanced at her and smiled. “It’s very sexy. And slutty. I’m just surprised you allowed anyone to take it.”

“I took it myself. After I’d captured the legs, I felt stuff dripping out and on impulse, I held the phone down there and took some photos to show you.”

“Thank you.” He smiled and pulled her close. “How do you feel about it now?”

“The photo?”

“No, the threesome. Do you still regret doing it?”

She’d had time to get the messy ending in perspective since Friday. “No. I still resent Ciaran for how he’d arranged a surprise third party in our arrangement, but it was a unique experience.”

He held her gaze. “And will it remain unique? Will it be your one and only threesome?”

A shiver ran up her spine. She could still feel the delicious stretch of both cocks inside her. “I hope not.”

He smiled. “Good.”

“You’d like me to repeat it?”

He gave an uncomfortable shrug. “You were upset when you got home. I like the idea of it, but I’m not going to try and force you—”

“I know, and I wouldn’t allow myself to be put in that situation again. But, what I’m asking is...” She pushed her hair behind her ear and stared into his eyes. “Do you want me to take two men again?”

He held her gaze for a couple of seconds, then nodded.

“Okay.” She lowered her voice to a whisper. “Maybe the next time I do it, you can be one of the men.”

He stared wide-eyed, his breathing shallow. “Could you do that?”

“Of course. Up until the plumber, I’d have been more worried if *you* could. Hearing stories about me being with other men is one thing, seeing it

happen is another. But since watching me from the closet didn't seem to upset you..."

He grinned. "No, it had the opposite effect. So, are you going to carry on with telling me about your night?"

"If you like." She placed her hand firmly on his chest. "But before I do, I should probably—"

"How long did you lie like you were in the photograph?"

"I don't know. Not long. Five minutes, maybe ten."

"Then what happened?"

She sighed, feeling the opportunity to give him the rehearsed spiel sliding away from her again. "I knelt on the bed and sucked them in turn to get them hard again."

"Ah. That's a rather sexy image to visualise."

"Sexy or slutty?"

He grinned. "Both."

Nicole remembered Ciaran had videoed her sucking them both. "Actually, you don't have to visualise it. Hang on..." She found the clip of her kneeling up and sucking Will, pressed play and handed the phone to Julian.

He held the phone and watched, breathing a little faster.

"That's Will," she explained. "Ciaran picked up my phone after I'd taken the photos I've just shown you."

On-screen, Nicole turned to look directly into the camera as she spoke. "I hope the dirty pictures are making you hard."

Ciaran's voice boomed loud. "See for yourself." The image jolted and then settled on Nicole's face. With her eyes fixed on the lens, she lowered her head and took Ciaran's cock into her mouth.

Deciding to treat her husband to the same, she scooted down the bed and took him into her mouth as he watched the film of her sucking Ciaran. His cock soon began to swell.

She heard herself say, "And now you can film this," and remembered riding Ciaran's cock while he filmed her. She bobbed her head faster on Julian, getting him fully hard. As soon as the film ended, she'd tell

him what had happened next, then take out the lube and offer him to do the same.

Ciaran's voice asked how it felt, and she'd replied that she was going to try the other cock. Julian was watching a film of his slutty wife sucking and riding two men, and his dick was as hard as she'd ever known it. The only noises coming from the phone now were her moans, and she remembered she'd moved back to ride Ciaran for a while before returning to Will.

Knowing the film was almost over, she released Julian's cock from her mouth. Wrapping her fingers around the base of his shaft while cupping his balls with her other hand, she waited for him to put down the phone and look at her.

Ciaran's voice said something about it being as hot and tight as he remembered.

Nicole frowned. She hadn't known he'd filmed this part. She moved up the bed and reached for her phone, but Julian held it at arm's length, never taking his eyes from the screen.

"Julian, wait—" She reached for her phone again, but he held it out on the other side of the bed. They could both see the screen, where she lay impaled on Will's cock as Ciaran fingered her backside. "Please, turn it off. I need to tell you—"

The image shook, flashing across the bedspread, the wall and the ceiling as Ciaran adjusted his position without putting down the camera. Then the shot settled on Nicole's middle section. Her legs were open on either side of Will's, his cock completely buried inside her. Ciaran's cock came into view, and Nicole watched with dread as the huge fat tip pushed against her asshole.

Julian seemed to have stopped breathing.

On screen, with frightening ease, she seemed to open around Ciaran and his cock slipped inside, though most of the shaft was still visible. The screen shuddered and changed to another view, shot from between Nicole's legs, showing her being reamed by one cock from above and another from below. Her groans and whimpers filled the room.

"I didn't know he'd filmed..."

She cringed as the screen view moved to the side, showing her upper body crushed between the two men, her eyes closed and her mouth open. She groaned, she screamed, shouted expletives and obviously experienced two powerful orgasms, then the phone was dropped on the bed. The shaky footage showed just the ceiling and both men were heard grunting over her screams as they finished.

The image stopped shaking but sounds of heavy breathing kept coming through the phone's speaker. Then the phone was picked up and aimed to show just her and Will on the bed. Ciaran had withdrawn and was kneeling by their feet. The image zoomed in. Will's cock was still buried in her, but it was withered, traces of white oozing out around it. More cum ran from her still-gaping backside. The film ended.

Her cheeks raging, Nicole remembered hearing clicks as she'd come down to earth, lying next to Will. There must be some still photographs of them together. But that didn't matter now.

Julian passed her the phone, a coldness in his eyes.

She dropped it onto the mattress. "Jul—"

"What happened to the openness and honesty you said was so important?"

"I wanted to tell—"

"Really? So why didn't you?"

"I was waiting for the right—"

"And since it was *as hot and tight* as he remembered, I'm guessing that wasn't the first time."

Nicole opened her mouth, but no words came.

"It wasn't the first time, was it?"

She shook her head.

"When?"

"On the first night in the hotel." Her voice cracked. "Wh-when it was just him and me."

"And how long ago was that? How many nights have you decided it wasn't the right time yet?"

"I just wanted us to enjoy—"

"*You've* already enjoyed it. Isn't that all that matters?"

“No!” The accusation stung, but she tried to stay calm. “I wanted us to enjoy it together. I tried to tell you earlier, but you kept interrupting.”

“You’ve had *weeks* to tell me!”

“I wanted to...” She could hardly admit she wanted to wait until he could do the same to her. She reached for him, but he got out of bed. The erection she’d lovingly brought to life had disappeared completely.

“I still have some things to prepare for tomorrow,” he said as he opened a drawer in his dresser.

She didn’t know if that was true, but she sat silently on the bed as he tugged on pyjama bottoms and the t-shirt he’d worn earlier. After he’d stomped out of the bedroom and gone to his office, Nicole lay back on the pillows and cursed herself for not telling him about the anal straight away. She also regretted not watching the film before tonight.

She could see Julian’s point. She’d made such a big deal out of him secretly filming her, and now she’d done something that was probably worse. He had every right to feel aggrieved.



$$\Psi$$
A horizontal black line with a small square box centered on it. The box has a horizontal line passing through its middle.

Chapter Two

Nicole woke alone in bed. It was still dark outside, and on checking her phone she saw it was just before six-thirty. She reached over to Julian's side. The sheets were still warm, so he must have come to bed after she'd dropped off. Just then, he walked out of the en-suite with a towel wrapped around his waist, his hair damp from the shower.

She sat up and turned on the bedside lamp. "Morning."

He gave her a weak smile and pulled on a pair of boxers before dropping the towel. Then he went to his wardrobe and took out a shirt.

"Julian, can we please talk about—?"

"We can, but not now. I need to meet Mitchell at the office at seven-fifteen."

"I was going to tell you about it. I was just waiting until—"

"I know." He sighed and pulled on his suit trousers. "Let's wait until we have time to discuss this properly. I can't set a bad example by being late." He put on his tie and didn't look at her until he'd tied his shoes.

"We're going to the north-east today, so it'll be late by the time I get back."

"Okay."

"See you tonight."

A few seconds later she heard the front door close, then his car start and pull off the drive. Closing her eyes, she lay her head back on the pillow. Although she'd handled things badly, she was still surprised by his reaction. Giving her the cold shoulder wasn't something Julian had ever done, not even after she'd cheated on him. He always approached everything with an open, thoughtful attitude, and that had been especially true regarding their new sex life.

Maybe there were other issues she wasn't aware of. Was his new role at work putting extra pressure on him? Was his reaction to her not telling him about the anal a symptom of him being stressed in other aspects of his life?

Eventually she pulled herself out of bed, showered and dressed. Once downstairs, she made herself a cup of tea and booted up her laptop, then spent the next couple of hours working through the tasks for the day, paying for one-off purchases and making sure all the regular payments had been made.

There was an email from Ciaran in her personal inbox. A feeling of dread crept through her stomach. *Why can't he just take the hint?* Taking a breath, she opened it up.

*Hi Nicole,
I trust the payment for the great work you did for us has now reached your account. I hope you buy yourself something nice with the money.
I have another request regarding what you'd told me and Will about the possibility of us needing to raise finance in the short term. Would it be possible for you to come into the office to discuss?
Thanks.
Ciaran.*

Nicole sighed. At least his tone was a lot more reserved than in some of his previous emails. A quick check of her banking app showed a payment for £750. That was a lot more than she'd been expecting. She tried to work out how much time she'd spent doing the work and doubted it could have been more than ten hours. If she could earn £75 an hour in her regular job, she'd be very happy.

Deciding she had no option but to reply, she tapped out a quick email.

*Hi Ciaran,
Yes, the money is there. Thank you.
I'm not sure exactly what you need regarding the extra finance, but I could come into your office one lunchtime to discuss.
Regards.
Nicole*

Hopefully her stipulation of a lunchtime meeting, along with her formal tone, would leave him in no doubt that any future liaisons between them would be strictly business.

She'd barely had time to sit back down with a cuppa before he replied.

How about tomorrow?

She sent a quick reply explaining she wouldn't have time this week, and suggested Friday of the following week. That sent, she closed down her private inbox and got back to work on her real job.

During her lunchbreak, she resisted checking to see if he'd replied. Instead, she spent an hour doing some online shopping in readiness for Christmas before returning her attention to the spreadsheets that made up her working day.

By the time it got dark outside, she'd still not looked for his response. The ease with which she could ignore Ciaran confirmed he wasn't important to her anymore. She may not have yet found a new bull, but she'd certainly moved on from her previous one.

She texted Julian to ask if he wanted her to save him any dinner. He replied within a few minutes.

No thanks. I'll treat Mitchell to the delights of a Motorway Services banquet of grease, carbohydrates and additives to prepare him for life as a travelling salesman.

Today's meetings went smoother than I expected, and we should be leaving here soon. I may even be home before 10.

That sounded a lot more like the old Julian. She smiled in relief.

Okay, I'll eat now. Enjoy your banquet!

Drive safe. See you later.

xxNxx

When Julian trudged into the living room just after half ten, he had dark circles under his eyes. Nicole stood up and gave a smile, and he stepped close and wrapped his arms around her.

She slipped her arms around his waist and squeezed, laying her head on his chest. "I'm sorry." Tears blurred her vision.

He shushed her, running his hands up and down her back. "No, *I'm* sorry." Pulling his head back, he looked down at her. "I overreacted. I don't know what got into me."

"I should have told you. I was just waiting until—"

He kissed her forehead. "Let's put it behind us. It was a misunderstanding and nothing more. I'm sorry for behaving the way I did. I've spent the whole day regretting it."

She wiped her cheeks. "You look shattered."

"It's been a long day."

She knew he probably hadn't slept very well the night before, either. "Can I get you anything?"

"I just need to sleep."

"You go up, I'll turn things off down here."

He gave a grateful smile before heading upstairs. Nicole checked the back door was locked, then turned off all the lights and followed him up. He was taking a shower. After putting on a white vest top and clean panties, she brushed her teeth and waited for him in bed.

Julian slid in beside her and she snuggled up to him, inhaling the shower gel and his own familiar smell. He slipped his arm around her shoulder and kissed the top of her head. She lay in his embrace and listened as his breathing settled into the steady rhythm of peaceful sleep.

* * * *

Nicole woke early and slipped out of bed without disturbing her husband. She made him a coffee and took it up, kissing his cheek to wake him. Julian blinked and sat up.

She passed him the cup. "Good morning."

"Hi." He frowned and checked his watch. "Sorry, I was dead to the world."

Sitting on the edge of the bed, she stroked his leg through the quilt. “I’ve never seen you look as tired as you did last night.”

He nodded. “It was a long day, with much of it driving through roadworks and traffic jams.”

“And you didn’t get much sleep the night before, either.”

He gave an embarrassed smile. “Well, that serves me right.”

“We’ll talk about that later, but if you need to be in the office for nine, you’d better make a move as soon as you’ve finished your coffee.”

“I don’t have any meetings this morning, so I’ll work from home. I’ll write up the outcome of yesterday’s meetings, then go into work this afternoon to catch up with Mitchell.”

“Okay.” She considered mentioning that today would be his first meeting with Ciaran since her threesome but decided against it.

He read her expression and smiled. “I’m not avoiding anyone at the office, if that’s what you’re thinking.”

Nicole laughed. “Good. Speaking of Ciaran, he’s paid me for my bookkeeping.”

“Really? So he’s been in touch?”

“He emailed to say the money should be in my account. I got seven hundred and fifty quid.”

“That seems pretty good money.” He grinned. “Just under a hundred pounds per orgasm.”

She slapped his arm, laughing. “He’s also asked about another task, so I’ll go and see him next week.”

“Okay.” He didn’t say anything else, but she could tell from his expression that he was wondering if Ciaran would be able to charm his way back into her affections.

“I’ll see what work he wants me to do,” she said. “Nothing more.”

He nodded.

Nicole couldn’t tell if he was pleased or disappointed. “Since you don’t need to rush out, would you like me to make us a cooked breakfast?”

“No, I think it’ll take my body until Spring to metabolise the fat from last night’s dinner.”

“That good, eh?”

“A slice of toast and another coffee would be perfect.”

Nicole headed back downstairs and made them breakfast. Julian joined her wearing pyjama bottoms and a t-shirt. They sat at the kitchen table.

“Are you working today?” he asked. Her part-time schedule was much more fluid now she was working from home.

She shook her head. “No, they’ve asked if I can work tomorrow instead. There’s some management meeting today, and the outcome of that will have financial implications that I’ll need to be aware of.” She brushed toast crumbs from her fingers and picked up her cup. “If another lockdown happens, which seems likely, then they’re going to have to decide if they furlough staff or actually make some redundant.”

He nodded his understanding. “Yes, worrying times.”

“Maybe I could come and work for you.” She smiled. “I have some nice skirts and blouses, and a wide selection of lingerie that’s perfect for the office.”

He guffawed. “If you were to join our workforce dressed how you did for your meetings with Ciaran, I’m pretty sure production would grind to a halt.”

“Your team’s all men, right?”

He nodded.

“How many?”

“Six, though we’re never all in the office on the same day.”

She narrowed her eyes and took her lower lip between her teeth for effect. “Mmm, six men.”

Julian held her gaze, then sighed. “As I’ve said many times, you’re quite a distraction.”

“Really?” Nicole looked down at herself. She’d pulled on a pair of dark blue leggings and still wore the white vest top she’d slept in. She wasn’t wearing a bra.

“Oh, I think you know you are.”

“How am I a distraction?” She slipped the straps of her vest off her shoulders and pulled the front down to expose her breasts.

He took a breath, then looked up into her eyes. “I don’t know. Perhaps I’m being too critical, but something about your demeanour makes me think your presence in the office wouldn’t be conducive to a high-functioning environment.”

She ran her fingertips around her nipples, making them stand out. “I’m not sure what you mean...”

“I doubt that.”

She widened her eyes in mock-innocence. “You’re using management-speak and HR-babble—*so* many long words that I find hard to follow. What exactly are you saying?”

“I’m saying that the presence of a beautiful woman in an off—”

“And sexy.” She pulled at her nipples, enjoying the fact he couldn’t resist dropping his gaze to look at them.

“Yes, a beautiful *and* sexy woman in an office full of men wouldn’t —”

“*Six* men, you say?”

“Yes, six—” He paused as she closed her eyes. “What is it?”

She opened her eyes and looked at him. “I was just imagining giving myself to six men.”

His jaw dropped.

She stood up and walked around to his side of the table, rubbing her bare breasts against his shoulder. “I’m going to go upstairs. I’m going to take all my clothes off and lie on the bed. I’ll wait for five minutes, and if you don’t come up and join me, then I suppose I’ll have to take Denzel out of my drawer and use it to satisfy myself.”

Without another word, she left the kitchen and headed upstairs. She stripped, took the KY from her drawer and put a large blob on her finger. Lying on the bed, she reached down and smeared it around her bum-hole. She added another glob to her finger and repeated the action, this time pushing in a little to lube inside. Then she put the tube away and took out the black vibrator she’d christened Denzel, dropping it onto the mattress beside her. She still hadn’t used it, so if Julian didn’t join her in the next few minutes, she might be forced to christen it in another way.

Her husband appeared in the doorway. He walked to the foot of the bed and stared down at her, his eyes flicking to the vibrator. “If you’re still

fantasising about six men, I'm happy to wait in line while you take one of the others first."

She was surprised by his initiated roleplay but happy to go along with it. "And what will you do while I take the first one?"

He blinked and licked his lips. "I'll just watch. We both know how much I like to do that."

Spreading her legs, Nicole ran her hand down her body and stroked her fingers either side of her outer lips. She could feel the wetness there already. "And what exactly will you be looking at?"

"Him, stroking your body. Groping your tits, then running his hand down between your legs. I'll watch him stroke his finger through the wet, slick valley of your cunt."

Nicole clenched involuntarily. *Where has this come from?*

"And then, when he pushes two fingers into you, my eyes will go up to your face. I'll watch your mouth drop open and your eyes squeeze shut, and I'll hear your breathy sigh when his thumb finds your clit."

"Julian, get on the bed." She reached for him. "Put your dick inside me. Now."

When he pushed his pyjama bottoms down, his cock sprung out, straight and hard. Nicole gripped his shoulders as he guided himself into her. She cried out as he sank all the way in, then bit his neck when he began thrusting. He raised his upper body and pinned her arms down on the mattress above her head.

Looking into her eyes, he fucked her. "I wait patiently while the first man fingers you, but I can tell you want more than that. You want his cock."

Nicole stared at him, struggling to believe this was her sweet, shy husband.

"I tell him it's not enough." Julian maintained the slow thrusts of his hips and the calm voice of his roleplay. "Fingers might be all a puppet needs inside it to make it come to life, but you're not a puppet. I explain that you're a slut, and sluts need cock."

She desperately wanted to join in with this game, but she could hardly breathe. Rocking her hips beneath him, moving with his thrusts, she nodded. "I need cock. Tell him I need his cock."

"I watch him unzip and take it out..."

“Is he big?” Her voice was a hoarse whisper. Her legs were starting to tremble as she moved towards orgasm. “I hope he’s big.”

Julian swallowed. “Yes, he’s big. Long and thick. I worry for you a little because it’ll probably hurt.”

“I want it to hurt. I want him to split me open.”

Julian ploughed into her with slow, deliberate thrusts. He was showing a level of self-control she’d never seen before, and it thrilled her. “He places the huge tip of his cock between your lips. I’m torn because I want to see it stretch and fill you, but I also want to watch the expression on your face when he enters you.”

“Oh God! Julian...”

“He pushes in and makes you shriek. My eyes are drawn to your face. Your expression is a wonderful mix of emotions. Shock and gratitude. Agony and ecstasy...”

“I’m coming...”

“That’s exactly what you tell him. His big cock plunges in and out and I watch as you scream and thrash beneath him.”

Nicole wanted to see him but struggled to keep her eyes open. She wanted him to know how much he’d stimulated her. She sobbed several times, then forced herself to ask one more question. “Does he come with me?”

“Yes.” Julian released her wrists and brought his hands to her breasts. “He comes in your cunt while you writhe beneath him.” He pinched her nipples and Nicole screamed with her release, gripping the sheets, pushing her head back into the pillow and arching her back.

The orgasm shook her like an earthquake, every nerve-ending tingling with the aftershocks. It seemed to last a long time, and as the sensations ebbed away, she became aware of his cock still buried inside, and still rigid. He hadn’t come yet.

She opened her eyes and looked at him. He smiled down, his expression one of embarrassed smugness.

“Thank you.”

“Any time.”

She placed her hands on his hips and pushed him gently. He frowned but withdrew.

“So,” she said, her voice still raspy after the exertion, “I’ve had the first guy. He fucked me good, and you saw how much he pleased me.” She glanced down at his dick, slick with her juices. “But he’s no longer here. He’s come and gone, as it were.”

Julian smiled at the way she’d said it.

“Now I’m ready for the next man, and that’s going to be you.”

“I know.”

“How many more are waiting?”

He shrugged. “I’m not sure. Three or four, maybe.”

“Are they watching, too?”

He nodded. “Some have their cocks out and are playing with themselves. They may not last long enough to go inside you.”

She licked her lips. “That’s fine. They can shoot it over me. But you...” She pushed him away enough so she could bend at the waist and raise her legs. She placed them over his shoulders. “You’ve waited patiently because you want to go inside me.”

He nodded.

“You can come over me later with the others if you like, but I want your first shot inside.”

“I’d like that, too.”

Nicole lifted her bum off the bed, inching her feet further down his back. “But the first guy’s just filled my cunt. You’re going to have to use somewhere else.”

His eyes widened as she reached around her raised right leg and gripped his slippery cock. “I want you to fuck me in a different hole.” She pulled him closer. When his cock touched the entrance of her backside, she wondered if he could feel the coldness of the KY.

“Are you—?”

“Don’t break the spell. Please.” She flashed an encouraging smile. “I’ve had one guy come already, and now I want you to come in me as well.”

Julian stared into her eyes and pushed forward, opening her up, filling her. She sighed, relishing the feeling.

Once he’d got about halfway in, he held still. “Is that okay?”

She rocked her hips, moving herself on him. “It’s much better than okay.”

He moved his hips slightly forward and back. “Oh gosh.”

She watched his face, feeling herself opening more, taking him deeper. “Does it feel good?”

He nodded, breathless. “What about for you?”

“Feels wonderful. Fuck me.”

Taking a breath, he began to thrust his hips. His eyes were half-closed, and he was breathing through clenched teeth.

Nicole slipped her hand down her sex. “To show what a slut I am, I’m going to play with myself while you fuck my arse. And after I’ve come on my fingers and you’ve come up there, I’m going to move on to the next guy.”

Julian’s breathing became ragged.

Nicole wet her fingers with her juices, then ran the slick fingertips around her clit. “And since he’s the third guy, he gets to use my third hole. I’ll take him into my mouth. You can watch me suck him…”

Julian’s legs began to shake.

He was already past the point of no return. She rocked her hips faster, making him gasp. “You’ll hear him moan and see my cheeks bulge out when he fills my m—”

“Ahh!” He pushed deep and her insides bloomed with heat as he came. Nicole rubbed her clit and came with him, both of them groaning, panting and shaking.

When they finally stilled, Julian looked shellshocked. He slowly pulled out and eased her legs from his shoulders.

“Let’s go for a shower,” she said.

He helped her up and they walked hand in hand to the en suite.

Under the water, she shuffled up against him. “You surprised me in there.”

“I surprised myself, but not as much as you surprised me.”

“That’s how I wanted to tell you about it. I wasn’t hiding things. I was waiting until we could share it like that. I wanted to show that when we do it, it’s more than a sex act.”

Julian kissed the top of her head.

“I’m sorry you found out by watching me do it with someone else.”

He wrapped his arms around her and held her close. “I understand that, and I’m sorry for behaving the way—”

She placed her finger to his lips. “It was a misunderstanding, nothing more.”

He nodded.

She squeezed shower gel into her hand and washed his cock. He let out a sigh as she cleaned him. Gripping his shaft, she slowly rubbed her soapy palm over the tip. “Why did you pretend you were part of a gangbang?”

He shrugged. “The discussion over breakfast sparked something.”

She laughed. “Well, it certainly worked for me. I guess if I’m not going to be getting fresh cock for a while, this is a good way to keep it exciting.”

“How long do you think it’ll take you to find a new bull?”

“I have no idea. There are websites I can use, but for now, I’m happy to just take things slow.” She held his cock against her tummy. “Especially now I know you can talk me through fantasies.”

“That’s good, because I have an idea for another one.”

“Oh?” Nicole stood on tiptoe and kissed his cheek. “And what’s that?”

“I thought we could recreate the threesome you had, using Denzel.”

A shiver ran through her as she remembered the exquisite sensation of her DP with Ciaran and Will. “I think that’s a great idea.”

Smiling, he hosed himself off. “Now, I really need to do some work. I need to show Mitchell how to write up meetings and use the algorithm.”

“Okay. You’re clean, so if you get out now, I’ll wash my hair.”

Once dressed, Nicole made Julian a coffee and wandered next door to invite Liz for a walk.

She rang their doorbell, waited for about thirty seconds, then rang again. She was just about to return home when the door opened.

Liz wore a long bathrobe. “Hi Nicole. Sorry, I was in the shower. D’you want to come in?”

“No, I just came to tell you I’m going for a wander down the paths. You asked me to let you know when I’d be going again.”

“Yeah, I’d love to. Can you give me half an hour?”

Nicole nodded. “See you in in a bit.”

Thirty minutes later, Liz showed up on her doorstep dressed in jeans and a big fluffy jumper. “Here’s my card with my mobile number.”

“Cheers—next time I can text rather than interrupt your shower.” Nicole left Liz’s number in the kitchen and went to grab her coat. They walked down the road and followed the route through the fields and woods, chatting like old friends about their plans for Christmas.

“I’m hoping my mum can come and stay,” Nicole said. “What are you two doing?”

“My parents are going to my sister’s house because she has three kids. We’re going to see Ed’s parents for the day.”

The walk took them almost an hour, and as they trudged up their road, Nicole saw Julian’s car still on the drive. “Fancy coming in for a coffee? You can meet Julian. He’s working from home this morning but going into the office later.”

Once in their kitchen, Nicole proudly used their posh gadget to make two cappuccinos. She called to Julian, who came downstairs and smiled at their visitor.

“Hi, Liz. Nice to meet you,” he said.

“You too.”

“Want another coffee, hon?” Nicole asked.

“No thanks. I need to be on my way.”

He headed back upstairs, and the women wandered through to the small sitting room, settling together on the leather Chesterfield couch.

“I love this room,” Liz said, looking around and through the window to the side garden.

“Me too. I’ve commandeered it as my office. I can’t wait for summer so I can get out in the garden.”

Just then, Julian popped his head in to say goodbye.

They drank their coffee and chatted a little longer, and then Nicole mentioned that Julian was going to London the following week for a

meeting.

“Why don’t you come around one evening and have dinner with us?” Liz suggested. “It’ll be better than sitting in on your own.”

“Thanks, I’d like that.”

“When’s he away?”

“The latter half of the week, I think.”

“Shall we say Thursday, then?”

“That’ll be great.”

After Liz had headed home, Nicole spent the afternoon pottering around in their house, trying not to think about Julian and Ciaran meeting at work.

She needn’t have worried. When he arrived home, Julian said he’d only seen Ciaran briefly, and that they’d discussed a couple of work projects but nothing more.

“Like I told you,” he said, “we’ve never discussed what goes on between the two of you. I don’t see why you not seeing each other would be discussed, either.”

She smiled, then headed off to serve dinner.



$$\Psi$$


A horizontal line with a small square box in the center, containing a horizontal bar.

Chapter Three

On Saturday morning, Julian picked up the huge Christmas tree they'd ordered, and Nicole spent the afternoon dressing it. She had to go out and buy more fairy lights and decorations because their previous tree had been tiny by comparison. When finished, it made their living room look cosy. They spent the evening cuddled together on the couch watching TV and drinking hot mulled wine.

Nicole was tipsy when they went to bed and keen to maintain the closeness they'd shared all week. She didn't want roleplay or kinky sex, just to make love with her life partner. Julian caressed and kissed her, then eased himself on top. She whimpered when she came and sobbed when he did. They fell asleep in each other's arms and slept in late on Sunday.

On returning from work on Monday evening, Julian said the details of his trip had been finalised. He'd drive down to Head Office on Wednesday afternoon, spend Thursday and Friday overseeing the roll-out of his algorithm for all sales staff, then drive home Friday evening.

"Okay. I've been invited next door for dinner on Thursday night."

"I'm glad you're finding friends here—Liz seems nice."

"Yeah, she is. Have you remembered that I'm also seeing Ciaran on Friday?"

He gave a smile. "Of course I've remembered. How do you feel about it?"

"I'm not sure. I don't want to make a scene, but he needs to understand there'll be no repeat of what's happened in the past."

"Yes, quite." He stood up from the table. "Right, I just need to sort a few things out in the office—"

"Before you do that, can we discuss Christmas?"

He nodded and sat back down.

"Are you sure it's okay for my mum to come and stay with us?"

"Of course. The rules seem clear about the size of the bubble—"

“Yeah, I know, but that’s not what I mean. I don’t want to steamroll you into staying here so my mum can visit without checking if you wanted us to go and visit your parents.”

“No, let’s stay here. We can catch up with my folks in the Spring. It looks like another lockdown’s inevitable.”

“Thank you. Next, is there anything in particular that you’d like for a present? I have a few ideas for little things, but I wondered if there was anything in particular you wanted?”

He pursed his lips in thought, then nodded. “Walking shoes. If we’re going to spend time at weekends exploring, it’d be good to have the appropriate footwear.”

“Great, I’ll start searching online.”

“How about you? Anything you’d like?”

She scrunched up her nose. “Maybe a well-hung stud to help you spit-roast me.”

He nodded sagely. “I’ll see what I can find on Amazon.”

She laughed and stood to clear the dinner table. While he worked in his office, Nicole sat in the lounge with her phone and opened the gallery. She clicked onto the photos she’d taken during her night with Ciaran and Will. Julian had liked the pictures that showed the three sets of legs on the bed. She found the one that showed the heel of her shoe and uploaded it into the photo-editing app. She trimmed it to a square, then chose a monochrome filter that made it look really sexy. Her phone took better photos than any of the cameras she’d ever owned, and the definition of the picture was certainly good enough to get a large print for Julian’s office wall. She sent the jpg to an online printer and ordered a 500x500 frame to go with it.

Having found a good pair of walking boots for Julian and other bits and bobs for him and her mum, she went upstairs to find him still working at his desk. “Hi. How’s it going?”

“Slowly.” He flashed her a smile. “I need to set a few things in motion because I’ll be away from the office for a couple of days.”

“That’s fine. I might have a bath.”

He nodded. “Okay.”

She remembered them being in this situation before. “If you’re going to have a wank, make sure the door’s closed this time.”

He guffawed. “If I find myself getting too aroused by the sales figures, I’ll walk along to the bathroom and relieve myself over your wet, slippery body.”

A shiver ran up her spine. “Well, I can see you’re busy—but in the not too distant future, I’m going to hold you to that.”

“I’ll look forward to it.”

* * * *

After her shower on Thursday evening, Nicole pinned up her hair and put on minimal makeup. She pulled on black jeans, a grey angora jumper and flat shoes, picked up the lilies and bottle of sauvignon blanc she’d bought, and walked to her neighbours’ house.

Liz opened the door, thanked Nicole for the flowers and wine while admonishing her for buying them, then ushered her into their living room.

Ed stood up from his armchair to greet her. “Nicole, good to see you again.”

“Hi.”

“White wine?” Liz asked.

“That’d be lovely, thanks.”

Once all were seated in the living room, they made small talk until dinner was ready then headed through to the dining room. Nicole enjoyed the food and the company, spending a very pleasant hour laughing and chatting while eating.

“So,” she said, “how long have you guys been married?”

Liz replied. “It’ll be seven years next month.”

“Similar to us.”

Ed took a sip of wine and smiled. “I actually got married thirty years ago this month.”

“Really?” Nicole looked at Liz, then back at Ed. “I hadn’t realised you’d been married before.”

He nodded. “Serial offender. What can I say?”

Liz giggled. “Ed has a son from his first marriage.”

“Oh. Does he live close by? Will you meet up over Christmas?”

“No, he’s in the army. He’ll be spending Christmas in Afghanistan.”

“Oh wow. That must be hard for you.”

He gave what looked like a forced smile. “I think it’s harder for him, but he’s nearly at the end of his time there. His regiment is returning in March.”

“Was Julian married before?” Liz asked. Then she smiled. “I noticed he’s a bit older than you.”

“He’s fourteen years older but no, I’m his only wife to date.”

Liz smiled and nodded toward her husband. “He’s thirteen years older than I am, the dirty cradle-snatcher.”

Ed snorted. “I don’t think I can be accused of cradle snatching—you were thirty-three when we got married.”

Nicole did the calculation. “So you’re forty-one?” she asked.

Liz nodded.

“The same age as Julian.”

Ed obviously did his own calculation. “Which puts you at twenty-seven.” He grimaced. “Which makes me exactly twice your age.”

“Aww...” Liz patted his hand. “Don’t worry, baby. Men get better with age, like a good whiskey.”

Nicole nodded. “It’s true.”

“I hope you’re right,” Ed said with a smile.

Back in the lounge, Liz revealed that Ed’s company was actively involved with a children’s charity, and that he’d dressed up as Father Christmas a couple of years back to distribute presents to kids in hospital.

“Ah, that’s nice.” Nicole noted his flat belly appreciatively. He must have needed a lot of padding.

Liz smiled. “I thought he looked very sexy in his red suit and big black boots.”

Ed snorted again. “The trouble with being Santa is, he only gets to come once a year, and then it’s down a chimney.”

“Yeah,” Nicole said with a laugh. “But at least he gets to completely empty his sack.”

The other two looked at her with startled expressions.

Nicole put her hand over her mouth. “Sorry, was that a little too—?”

Liz burst out laughing and put her hand on her leg. “You don’t need to hold anything back while you’re here. I can see we’re going to get on fine.”

Relieved, Nicole smiled. “I blame the wine.”

They chatted for another twenty minutes or so, then Nicole announced she should be getting back home. “I do bookkeeping for someone who has a business in Ireland, and I’m meeting him tomorrow to talk about another task he wants me to help with.”

After Nicole had bid Ed goodnight, her hostess walked her to the door. “We’ll do this again,” Liz said.

“Definitely,” Nicole agreed. “I’ll cook next time, though if there’s going to be another lockdown after Christmas we might have to eat in the garden.”

Liz gave her a hug. “I suspect I’m in for another sleepless night.”

Nicole laughed, a little uncomfortable. “Is that a good thing or a bad thing?”

“It’s good. I’ll enjoy every minute of it.” She ran a finger down Nicole’s cheek. “You’re beautiful, and I don’t blame Ed for getting excited by you.”

“But...” Nicole shrugged. “Doesn’t it bother you?”

“Not at all.” Liz leaned close and whispered, “Our marriage is a little different from most.”

Holding her friend’s gaze, Nicole bit her lip. “So’s ours.”

“That’s good to hear. I look forward to sharing more secrets with you.” Liz hugged her again. “Maybe we can go for another walk before Christmas?”

Nicole nodded, then walked back home. Once in her kitchen, she grabbed a bottle of sparkling water from the fridge and sat down at the island. She checked her phone for texts and found a short, formal one Ciaran, asking if tomorrow’s meeting was still convenient. She replied with a simple ‘Yes’, then composed a text for Julian.

Hi

Just got back from next door and had a lovely evening – great food, great company and too much wine. Hope your day has been good, and you're not still working.

Let me know what time you'll be getting home tomorrow. I'll cook you something nice.

xxNxx

She turned off the downstairs lights and checked the deadlock on the front door, then retired to bed. Lying in the dark, Nicole thought about what Liz had said when she'd left—how different was her neighbours' marriage? Was it open? Were they swingers? Was Liz also a hotwife?

One thing *was* certain: Liz would be having a lot more fun than her tonight.

Closing her eyes, she let her mind drift to what might be happening in the bedroom next door. She imagined Ed laying his wife down on the bed and removing her bra and panties, kissing each part of flesh as it was revealed. Then climbing on top and...

Nicole sat up and opened the bottom drawer of her bedside cabinet. Taking out Denzel, she lay back down and quickly slipped off her panties. Closing her eyes, she brought back the image of Liz and Ed in bed, him looming over her and swiping the tip of his cock through her folds. Nicole flicked the switch on Denzel and held the buzzing shaft against her clit. She let out a groan.

She pictured Liz looking up at her husband with a teasing smile, asking him who was responsible for the erection he was rubbing against her. Ed asked if it mattered and she shook her head, pulling him into her.

Nicole swallowed, then eased the vibrator inside. She sighed, took a deep breath and rocked her hips as she slid it all the way in. *This isn't going to take long.*

Rolling over onto her front, she gripped the end of the vibrator and thrust her hips. She clenched her teeth and groaned through her orgasm, then rolled onto her back and pumped the toy in and out until she came again.

Sated but a little shocked by her reaction to Liz's whispered confession, she flicked the switch, eased Denzel out and wrapped it in her

panties. She couldn't be bothered to get another pair from her dresser and lay in the dark naked from the waist down as her heart slowed. Then she picked up her phone and sent Julian another text.

*I wish you were here, but Denzel's just taken
care of me :-)*

xxNxx

Fifteen minutes later, she heard her phone beep. Though almost asleep, she picked it up. Julian had replied.

*Just got back to the hotel. I read your text while
sharing a taxi with two colleagues, and
struggled to hide my reaction. What a wonderful
image to keep in my head. Thanks.*

Good luck with your meeting tomorrow.

xx

Nicole smiled and put her phone down, wondering if her text would motivate Julian to pleasure himself as well. All this from a simple comment made by Liz. It showed how inspirational sex talk could be.

* * * *

When Nicole walked into reception at the GLP office, Ciaran was waiting for her on one of the leather and chrome chairs. He stood as she approached, offering her a smile and his hand. "Nicole, good to see you."

"You too." She was pleased that he frowned at her outfit: a deliberately modest combination of cream fluffy jumper, jeans and Cuban-heeled ankle boots.

He already had her visitor's badge and led the way upstairs to the office where they'd shared so many exciting liaisons. Bernice wasn't at her desk. Ciaran let Nicole walk into his office first, then closed the door behind them.

She sat on the chair opposite his desk, and he perched on the closest edge of the desktop, wearing a friendly smile. "Thanks for coming in. So,

I've been thinking about what you'd said regarding the potential shortfall in company cashflow with the change in focus from selling to leasing."

She nodded. "And?"

"And I was thinking it might be prudent to have a word with our bank about setting up an overdraft facility to cover that shortfall."

"I assumed you'd already have that sort of arrangement. Wouldn't you need it to cover salaries for the months when you don't make any sales, or if customers are late making payments?"

"At the end of each year, we pay a Christmas bonus and then have a celebratory dinner for all staff in January."

"That's nice."

"And since you've been a part of the team this year, I thought it'd be nice for you to join us."

She wasn't sure she liked where this was going. "For the celebratory dinner?"

He nodded.

"And where does this take place?"

"Galway, where all the other employees live."

"You want me to go with you to Galway?"

"Well, not just Galway. The company accounts are with a bank in Dublin, so I thought we could kill two birds with one stone. Rather than fly to Shannon, we could take my car on the ferry to Dublin, go see the bank manager to make the financial arrangements, then drive over to Galway."

Nicole didn't answer immediately. Though the idea of a trip to Ireland was nice, she didn't trust Ciaran. A few weeks ago, an offer like this would have been wonderful. "I'm not sure if that's a good idea."

"Why not?"

"How long would the trip take?"

"Just a couple of days. We could drive to either Liverpool or Holyhead to catch a ferry. I'll book an appointment at the bank, because having you there would show the manager we have a financial genius working with us."

"I don't think any bank manager would be impressed by someone who simply does bookkeeping."

“Don’t sell yourself short. You’ll impress him, especially if you dress in one of your power suits and high heels.” Reading her expression correctly for once, he held up his hands. “Believe me, having you there for the meeting would be a great help. We’d spend the night in Dublin... Have you ever been?”

She shook her head.

“It’s a fantastic city, then—”

“And where would we stay?”

“I’ll book a hotel.”

“We’d need two rooms.”

He paused, holding eye contact, then nodded. “Of course. And then we could drive over to Galway the next day.”

“How far is it?”

“About a hundred and twenty miles. It’ll take a couple of hours or so, and you’ll get to see the country. We have the celebratory dinner in a great restaurant near the harbour, and you can meet the rest of the staff.” He grinned. “And you’ll get to see Will again.”

She sighed. “If you’re expecting—”

“No, nothing like that. This is purely business. You’ll get your own hotel room.”

“What about travel restrictions? Another lockdown looks likely, and there’s no way I’m going into a fourteen-day quarantine with you.”

He laughed and shook his head. “That’s something I’ll have to check up on, but hopefully our scheduled bank meeting qualifies our trip as business-critical.” He gave another grin. “Maybe I won’t mention the dinner, but say I’ll need to go to Galway to discuss the outcome of the bank meeting.”

The alarm bells were ringing loud enough to make her head swim. This entire trip was clearly an excuse for the two of them to end up in a hotel together. “I’ll have to think about it,” she said.

“Great. Talk it over with Julian. I’m sure he’ll agree that having someone with financial experience will be seen in a positive light by the bankers.”

“Hmm.”

He laughed at her response, then nodded at her clothes. “I see you’ve dressed down for today’s meeting.”

“I thought it’d be more appropriate.”

“More appropriate for...?” He gave her a smile that might once have made her tingle.

“More appropriate for a work-related meeting on casual-dress day.”

“Ah, yes. Though I’d hoped you’d spend some of your earnings on something nice.”

“I did. I’ve ordered a new mirror for the bathroom.”

“A mirror?”

She nodded. “With LED lights.”

“LED—”

“And Bluetooth speakers.” She smiled sweetly.

“I was thinking more along the lines of a dress and new shoes, maybe.” He flashed another grin. “Some nice lingerie.”

“Ciaran, if I were to buy those, you wouldn’t be the one who’d benefit from them.”

He scoffed. “Nicole, I don’t understand why you’re still behaving like such a ball-breaker.”

“I think you know exactly why.”

“I was there, don’t forget.” He leaned forward and looked into her eyes. “I saw how much you enjoyed it.”

“Yes, but I didn’t enjoy how you’d set it up. You made me feel uncomfortable, and you made me feel cheap.”

He shook his head. “I didn’t *make* you do anything. Taking cock is what you do best, and taking two at once was your decision.”

Her heart thumped in her chest, but she was determined not to let him see he’d upset her. “Yes, it was.”

“And it was my cock that you came on, remember?”

“Yes. And if you’d had the decency to mention what you were planning beforehand, we might have had more fun together.” She shook her head. “That won’t happen again, Ciaran. But thanks for the glowing endorsement—‘taking cock is what you do best.’” She shook her head. “Jesus, and they say that romance is dead. But you’re right. I *did* enjoy

taking two at once, so it's something I may well repeat in the future." She made her voice as icy as she could manage. "But it certainly won't be with you. From now on, all you'll be getting from me is bookkeeping. If you're not happy to accept that, find someone else to do the accounts."

"Okay, okay. Calm down." He walked around his desk and dropped into his office chair. "Jeez, Nicole. I didn't mean it as an insult."

She stood up. "Well, I guess this meeting's run its course. While a trip to Ireland sounds fine, I can't honestly see that it would be considered a necessary trip during a global pandemic."

"Leave that to me." He stood up and walked to the door but didn't open it. "Well, I suppose I should wish you a Happy Christmas."

"Thanks. You too." She nodded at the door. "If you wouldn't mind, there are things I need to do before Julian comes back from his trip to Head Office."

Ciaran sighed, opening it. "Nicole, what we had was special, and I don't want to—"

"I know." She looked deep into his eyes and kept her expression serious in the hope the message would penetrate his skull. "It *was* special, but you ruined it. And I'm afraid there'll be no going back to what we had." She walked past him and headed down the corridor, calling over her shoulder, "I can find my own way out."

Ciaran followed her as far as the top of the stairs. She didn't look back before going through the door to reception. After handing back her visitor's badge, Nicole walked out to her car and drove off the carpark. She knew she wouldn't come back to see Ciaran here again.

Once home, she made herself cheese and biscuits and poured a glass of white wine. She ate her lunch on the leather couch in the small sitting room while reading the news on her phone. Then she tapped out a quick message to her neighbour:

Hi Liz

Just wanted to thank you again for last night. I had a really nice time.

I hope you managed to get some sleep :-).

Nicole x

Smiling to herself, she hit send. A couple of minutes later, she received a reply.

Hiya

You're welcome, but I should be thanking you.

*Your comment about Santa emptying his sack
meant I was awake for quite a while!!*

*I look forward to discussing our secrets when we
go for a walk.*

Liz

Nicole grinned, wondering if she'd have the courage to admit to her neighbour what she got up to with Julian's blessing.

Her phone beeped again. It was a text from Julian saying his final meeting was scheduled to end by four, and that he'd be home around seven-thirty.

Deciding to enjoy a lazy afternoon, she topped up her wine and wandered through to the lounge. She found a Christmas film on Netflix and settled down on the couch to watch it.

* * * *

Not having heard Julian's car pull onto the drive, Nicole was surprised when he walked into their kitchen shortly after seven. "Hiya," she said, walking over to kiss his cheek. "You're early. I've only just put dinner in the oven."

He smiled as he placed his briefcase on the floor, then wrapped his arms around her waist. "Traffic was lighter than usual—the only positive effect of the pandemic."

"Can I get you a beer, or would you prefer wine?"

He gave her his familiar grin then walked to the hall, coming back a few moments later with a bunch of orange roses and a bottle of champagne. The last time he'd done this was after he'd been put forward for a promotion.

"Are we celebrating?" she asked.

"I celebrate every time I see you."

She took the flowers. “That’s sweet. But what are we really celebrating?”

“Maybe I was just so happy that the traffic was light that I decided to stop and buy these.” He grinned. “Or maybe I wanted to celebrate you finally using the special gift I bought you.”

She frowned, regretting telling him she’d pleased herself with her vibrator.

“Or... maybe it’s because after Christmas I’ll be starting a new role.”

“What?”

“I’ve been promoted again.” His eyes lit up. “They seem to think my algorithm is making a significant impact and want me to look into some other processes to see if I can come up with ways to streamline the way we do things.”

Nicole couldn’t believe it. “Ciaran never mentioned anything about it.”

“He probably doesn’t know. It’s a role they’ve just introduced, and what’s more...” He gave her another smile. “Ciaran will no longer be my boss.”

“Really?”

He nodded. “He’ll now be my peer.”

“Wow.” She shook her head and stepped close, tilting her head up to kiss his cheek. “Congratulations.”

“Thank you.” His expression of boyish happiness faded a little. He looked apprehensive.

“What’s up?”

“Once this pandemic is out of the way, the new job will involve considerably more travel.”

“Oh, that’s fine.”

“Sure?”

She gave a teasing smile. “I have a lovely big house to sit in while you’re suffering all the Motorway Services banquets.”

“I think it’s more likely I’ll be eating on airplanes. The new role will involve helping overseas branches as well as UK ones.”

“Oh dear. Don’t they know you’re afraid of flying?”

“It’s not flying I’m afraid of. It’s crashing.”

She laughed. “Will you be going anywhere nice?”

He slipped his arms around her waist. “Europe and the US, possibly China. And I see no reason why you can’t accompany me on some of the trips. We’ll be able to afford an extra plane ticket with my new salary.”

“There’ll be more money?”

He grinned. “Oh yes.”

Nicole was speechless. This was all like a dream.

Julian stroked her back. “I know you like some aspects of your job, and that you’ve got friends within the company, but there’s actually no need for you to carry on working if you don’t want to.”

She blinked. “I’m not sure I like the idea of being a free-loader.”

“Oh, I’ll make sure you contribute.” He dropped his hands to her bum and squeezed her buttocks. “I’ll demand my pound of flesh.”

“I like the sound of that. But what about me?” She batted her eyelids. “Will I still be allowed to get my pound of flesh from wherever I want?”

“Certainly.” He pushed his groin into her tummy. “The more the merrier.”

“Hmm. Hold that thought until after we’ve eaten.”

He laughed, releasing her from his grip. “I’ll go and get changed. The champagne was in a chiller but doesn’t feel very cold. Pop it into the freezer for ten minutes, and then you can tell me about your meeting with Ciaran as we wait for it to cool.”

“Do you want a beer while you’re waiting for the bubbles?”

“Good idea.”

While Julian was upstairs, Nicole put the bottle in the bottom drawer of the freezer and checked the dinner. It needed longer in the oven.

She topped up her white wine and opened a beer as Julian walked in wearing his pyjama bottoms and a t-shirt. “I see you’ve dressed for dinner,” she said, smiling.

“It’s casual-dress day.”

“Heh. That’s exactly what I told Ciaran.” At Julian’s quizzical expression, she described how she’d dressed for the meeting.

“Was he disappointed you weren’t in your usual attire and killer heels?”

“I think he was more disappointed when I told him he’d never get to see my sexy lingerie again.”

“Come and give me the details.” He led her into the lounge, and they sat together on the couch.

Nicole told him about Ciaran’s proposed trip to Ireland. “He assures me there’s a need to see the bank manager in Dublin, and says he’d also like me to go to an annual dinner with the other employees.”

“It might be nice to meet everyone.”

“Yeah, but you know Ciaran. I suspect there’s an ulterior motive that involves non-business activities.”

“Ah, right.”

“How do you feel about it?”

“As I’ve said before, I’m happy for you to do whatever you’re comfortable with.”

“You’d be happy for me to go to Ireland with him?”

“I’d be happy if you chose to sleep with him. Or Will. Or anyone else, for that matter.” He took her hand in his and squeezed it, his face serious. “But only if it’s something *you’re* comfortable with. Don’t let anyone pressure you into something you don’t want.”

“I definitely won’t be having sex with Ciaran.” She nodded, more to herself than her husband. “Will, maybe.” She smiled. “I’ll see how I feel at the time.”

“When would the trip happen?”

“That’s the thing. I don’t know if it will because of the travel restrictions. Ciaran seemed to think a trip to see the bank manager makes it business-critical, but this sort of thing is usually carried out online. It’s simply a matter of applying for a larger overdraft facility, which is why I think he’s inventing excuses to take me to Galway with him.”

Julian nodded. “I can understand your misgivings.”

“Come on,” she said, standing up. “Let’s eat, and you can tell me all about your new role. If you take cutlery through to the dining room, I’ll plate up dinner.”

While they ate, Julian explained that GLP had several offices in the US, the largest ones being in Delaware and Boston, and several in Europe, with Strasbourg and Budapest being the ones he’d probably need to visit first.

“Who told you about your promotion?” she asked between mouthfuls.

“Keith. Apparently, during a videoconference between higher managers last week, the use of the algorithm was discussed. It was decided to implement trials in other countries to see if it works for them as well as it does for us.”

“I’m so proud of you.”

He gave another embarrassed smile, then dabbed his mouth with a napkin. “Changing subject slightly, when’s your mum coming over for Christmas?”

“With the ever-changing policy from Downing Street, I’m not sure. I’ve suggested she drive down early on Christmas Eve and stay until after lunch on Boxing Day. But there are rumours that they’ll limit visits to just Christmas Day.”

“She can’t be expected to drive all the way from Durham and back again in a day!”

“I know—she’s expected to stay home alone if she can’t make the return journey. That’s why everyone’s up in arms about the way it’s being handled.”

He tutted. “Let’s see what happens.”

Once they’d carried their plates through to the kitchen, Julian took the champagne from the freezer and two glasses from the cupboard. “And now,” he said, tearing off the foil from the cork, “we can toast your first date with Denzel, and you can tell me all about it.”

Nicole laughed. “What goes on between me and Denzel is private, unless I choose to let you watch.”

He removed the cork and poured their drinks. “That hardly seems fair.”

“Well, Denzel will be staying in my drawer tonight, because you’ll be giving me what I need.”

“Will I?” He smiled down at her as she stepped close.

“Mm-hmm.” She ran her hand over the crotch of his pyjama bottoms. “Unless you’re too tired from your late night and long drive...”

“I think I’ll manage to rise to the occasion.”

“Good. Come on,” she said, picking up her glass. “Let’s go and sit in the lounge and enjoy the bubbles.”

Once they were snuggled up on the couch with the only light coming from the fire and the Christmas tree lights, Julian asked about her visit to their neighbours’ house.

“It was lovely, and I’ll invite them round as soon as we can.” She told him about the food she’d been served, that she drank more wine than usual, and that Ed had an adult son from his first marriage.

“I think he and Liz might have some sort of open marriage arrangement,” she said.

“Really? What makes you say that?”

“Just stuff Liz has said.” She sipped her wine. “You remember me saying that after he’d seen me dressed up—?”

“He kept her up all night, yes.”

Suddenly, she felt a little embarrassed. “Well... she said the same would happen after my visit last night.”

“What did you wear?”

“Nothing.” She shook her head. “And by that, I mean nothing that would have excited him, not no clothes.”

He laughed. “You look sexy no matter what you wear.”

“Thanks, but according to Liz, it was something I said. Ed’s company’s involved with a charity, and one year he’d dressed as Father Christmas to visit kids in hospital. He made some joke about Santa only ever coming down a chimney, and I pointed out that he gets to empty a full sack.”

He laughed and shook his head. “Well, what do you expect if you talk dirty?”

“If it helps gets my friend laid, I’m not going to complain.”

“Was it the thought of Ed being all revved up by you that made you feel the need to pleasure yourself with your vibrator when you got home last night?”

She stared at him, surprised he’d worked that out so quickly. “Is that bad?”

He smiled. “Not at all.” He ran a finger down her cheek. “Did you pretend it was Ed’s cock inside you?”

“No.” She shook her head, then shrugged. “Not really, but I imagined him fucking Liz while I fucked Denzel.”

“They sound like very open-minded people. Have you told Liz about our arrangement?”

“No.”

“And will you?” He gave a friendly smile.

“Would you want me to?”

Julian shrugged. “While I wouldn’t want to advertise it in the local Gazette, I don’t think it’s anything to be ashamed of. And if they’re like-minded people, there could be an opportunity to have some fun.”

“Hmm.” A tingle ran through her. “Do you find Liz attractive?”

“I find a lot of women attractive, but my only focus is on you. I don’t want to sleep with other women.”

Nicole frowned. “That doesn’t seem fair to you.”

“It’s what I want. *You’re* all I want.”

“And do you want me now?”

“Here?”

She nodded.

“What do you want me to do?”

“Nothing.” She took his glass and put it next to hers on the coffee table, then slipped off the couch and knelt on the floor between his feet. “You’ve had a hectic week at work, getting promoted and working late into the night.”

“That’s true.” He raised his bum off the seat as she pulled down his PJs.

“And then there was the long drive home this evening...”

He nodded, then shivered when she ran her tongue up the length of his thickening cock.

She watched his face. “So I think you should just sit still while I do all the work.”

“I think I can manage that.”

Nicole took him into her mouth, making him sigh. He was fully hard in less than a minute. She quickly removed her jeans and panties, then straddled his thighs and fed him inside.

Julian groaned and held her hips as she rode him. She leaned forward and kissed him, then gripped his head and rocked her hips. She came quickly, and he lasted long enough for her to build towards a second orgasm. When he finally came, she came with him. They clung to each other as their bodies shuddered.

Eventually, Nicole sat up and stroked his face. “Maybe I could give you that sort of welcome home after every trip.”

“It’d certainly help take my mind off flying.”

She laughed, pulled her panties back on and sat next to him. Picking up both glasses, she offered a toast. “To your wonderful algorithm.”

Julian laughed out loud, then sipped his champagne.



Ψ



Chapter Four

“Are you all ready for Christmas?” Nicole asked, holding open the gate into the woods.

“Yeah, just waiting for a couple more things to be delivered. Ed’s mum’s ordered all the food online, so I won’t need to face crowded supermarkets and fight over the last bag of sprouts or parsnips.”

“I still have that to look forward to.”

“You said your mum’s coming, is that right?”

Nicole nodded.

“No dad?” Liz looked concerned.

“He’s still alive, but I don’t have anything to do with him.” She shrugged. “Don’t ask.”

“Okay.” Liz linked her arm into Nicole’s and pulled her close. “So, these secrets we have...”

Nicole looked at her friend, who was smiling broadly. “Secrets?”

Liz laughed. “It’s okay if you don’t want to share.”

“I didn’t say that. It’s just... I’m not sure how to—”

Liz squeezed her arm. “That’s fine. How about I tell you how it works with me and Ed?”

Nicole nodded.

“We both sleep with other people, so I suppose it’s an open marriage. Ed’s had several sexual partners since we’ve known each other, but I have some intimacy issues and only sleep with one man.”

“Oh?”

“I’ve been sleeping with him for over twenty years.” When she saw Nicole’s expression, she gave a sad smile. “He was married when I started sleeping with him.” They walked in silence for a few steps. “I know how that makes me sound, but it wasn’t some seedy thing. He was everything the boys I’d been out with before weren’t, and he swept me off my feet. I fell for him. I loved him, and I still do.”

“Wow.”

“When I started seeing Ed, I told him about John—the other man. Ed accepted it and said it wasn’t a problem. When he asked me to marry him, he said I could continue to see John.”

“And Ed sees other people to even things up?”

“I’m not sure it’s a revenge thing, but yes, he sees other women. Some he’s seen over a period of time, others are just one-night stands.”

“And do you two tell each other about what you do?”

“No. At least not in any detail. Sometimes he’ll tell me certain things, like he once met a woman while attending a meeting in Germany, and they ended up having sex in a toilet at the airport just before they boarded different planes. She was French.”

“Is John still married?”

Liz shook her head. “His wife knew about us, and she didn’t mind. It was a complicated situation. She had medical issues, and they couldn’t have a physical relationship. She died five years ago. They couldn’t have kids, and now John’s all alone.”

“He still has you.”

Liz smiled. “Yes, he does. So...?”

Nicole wasn’t quite sure where to start, so she kept things simple. “Our arrangement is a little different, and it’s something that’s only started happening recently.”

“Okay.”

“I’m the only one who has other partners. While Julian’s happy for me to sleep with other men, he claims to have no interest in sleeping with

other women.”

Liz bounced her eyebrows playfully. “Would I be right in thinking he wants to hear about what goes on between you and the other men?”

Nicole nodded. “He also likes to watch.”

“Oh my.” She pulled Nicole close. “I guess that means you’re a hotwife.”

“Apparently so.”

“God, Ed will blow a gasket when he hears about this.”

Nicole laughed out loud and slapped her friend’s hand. “I thought we were sharing secrets.”

“Do you keep secrets from Julian?”

“No.” She remembered their argument about her having anal with Ciaran. “I tell him everything, now. It’d be wrong not to.”

“Exactly. And I tell Ed everything about John—if he asks. But he stopped asking for details a long time ago.”

Nicole nodded. “Are you surprised? About me, I mean.”

“Not really. There’s something about you that’s sexual. The way you move and hold yourself. The way you dress when you’re going out.”

“Oh *God!* Remember the first time I met Ed, when I was dressed like an escort?”

Liz nodded.

“I wasn’t meeting girls from work. I was meeting the guy I was having sex with.”

“Well you looked fabulous, and he’s a very lucky man.”

Nicole briefly considered telling her what Ciaran had arranged for that night but decided against it. For now, at least. She’d already shared more than she’d expected.

They walked on in comfortable silence, and when they started chatting again, the subject moved back to Christmas and more mundane things. After their walk, they drank coffee sitting at the patio table in Nicole’s garden.

Liz stood up to leave. “Right, I should be getting back. If I don’t see you before we leave for Ed’s parents’, I hope you have a lovely Christmas.”

“Thanks. You too.”

As the women hugged, Liz whispered, “Thanks for sharing your secret.”

Nicole bit her lip, then smiled. “It felt weird actually telling someone.”

“I’m glad you did.”

Then, to Nicole’s complete shock, Liz leaned in and kissed her gently on the lips. The women held eye contact for a few moments afterwards, then Liz smiled again and walked up the garden path and around the house.

Nicole stood motionless, a little stunned, and licked her lips. She could taste the other woman’s lipstick. There was a low-level buzz in the pit of her stomach. Not sure how she felt about what had just happened, she walked back into her house and put the mugs in the dishwasher.

To save the need for going out while Julian was off work, she decided to do the Christmas food shop. When she arrived home she found a card pushed through the door: a parcel had been left behind the garage. As soon as she saw it, she knew it was the photo she’d ordered for Julian. She took it into the house, opened it and smiled. It was fantastic. She was shocked how sexy her legs and shoes looked, but proud of how sharp the image was. Taking photos wasn’t usually something she did particularly well.

By the time Julian returned from work, she’d put all the food away, wrapped all the presents and put their dinner in the oven. He was in a good mood, and his team had bought him a thirty-year-old bottle of malt whiskey as a going away gift.

“Of course,” she said. “It never occurred to me that you’d be saying goodbye to your team. Who’s taking them over?”

“They’ll become part of Ciaran’s team in the short term. I guess they’ll see what happens when things get back to normal.” He frowned. “All areas have been asked to make cuts, and a niggling little voice at the back of my head keeps telling me that my new position is helping this. By using algorithms and similar programs, the company can reduce the number of data-entry employees.”

“It’s progress, I guess.”

“I know, but can’t help feeling a little guilty.”

* * * *

Nicole's mum arrived as planned in the early afternoon of Christmas Eve. She loved their house, displaying a fresh expression of awe in every room.

The two women eventually sat on the high chairs at the island in the kitchen while they drank tea. Julian had nipped into town for something, and Nicole suspected he'd left it until the last minute to buy her a present.

They had an early dinner in the dining room, then Julian watched TV while Nicole and her mum chatted away on the couch. He retired to bed around eleven to let them catch up properly.

"Julian's changed," her mum said.

"Hmm. I much prefer the short hair and beard to the comb-over and moustache."

"Not just that. He does look different, but he acts differently, too. He's less... Well, he's more in control, somehow."

"Yeah, I know what you mean." Nicole had no intention of suggesting their new sex-life might have contributed to the change in her husband. "I think he's finally being appreciated for what he does at work, and that's had an effect."

"Good." Her mum smiled. "He's always been nice, but something about him now makes him seem more..." She shrugged.

"I always saw this side of him," Nicole said. "But I know his shyness made it hard for other people to see it."

"It's nice to see you both so happy. Right, I'd better let you get to bed, otherwise Santa won't be coming down your chimney."

Nicole laughed, thinking about Ed's comment. She hugged her mum, then tidied the glasses away before going to the bedroom. Julian looked up from his novel and smiled.

She brushed her teeth in the en suite and slid into bed in her vest-top and panties. She leaned close and kissed his cheek. "Mum thinks you've changed."

"I suppose I have."

"She also loves our new home."

"Not enough to come and live with us, I hope?"

“No, stop panicking.” She laughed, then turned serious. “Can I ask you something?”

“Anything.”

“It’s about the other day, when we were in bed having sex.”

He laid his book face-down on the duvet. “You might have to be more specific.”

She smiled. “I’m talking about when you described being one of several men waiting in line to take your turn with me.”

“Ah.”

“Where did that come from?”

“Like I told you at the time, it was based on your comment about joining all the men in our office. Comments like that tend to make my mind wander.”

“It turned me on.”

“Having six men at once?”

“No—well, yes—but I meant you talking to me like that while you fucked me. It was incredibly sexy.”

“Thank you.”

“Can we do it again sometime?”

“Definitely. Or maybe I could do it while you’re using Denzel.”

“Hmm.” All her muscles clenched at once, and the mention of Denzel brought to mind her reason for using it. “I meant to tell you, I went for a walk with Liz the other day.”

“Oh?”

“She told me about their arrangement. They have an open marriage, but she only sleeps with one particular guy. She’s been seeing him for most of her adult life.”

“And what about her husband? Does he just only see one other woman?”

“No, he sees several. Some long term, some one-night stands.”

“And he fancies you.”

Nicole looked into his dark eyes. He was smiling.

“And do you fancy him?”

“I hadn’t thought about it.”

He chuckled. “You can’t expect me to believe that.”

Nicole smiled and shook her head. “No, I suppose I can’t. Yes, I find him attractive. Even though he’s exactly twice my age.”

“And did you tell Liz about our arrangement?”

“Yes.”

“What did she say about what we do?”

“Nothing, really.”

Julian looked at her expectantly. “Is this where you’re going to politely ask me if I would condone you sleeping with the man who lives next door if the opportunity were to arise?”

She held his gaze. “Would you?”

“Of course. Do you think Liz would approve?”

“I’m not sure. But just before she left, she kissed me.”

“Kissed you?”

“Hmm.”

“Where?”

“In the garden.”

Julian rolled his eyes. “You know what I mean.”

“Oh, sorry. On the lips.”

“Ah.”

“It was just a peck, nothing more. But...”

“But what?”

Nicole shrugged. “I’m sure it was nothing more than a friendly gesture, but after what happened with Ciaran, I wanted to tell you it had happened.”

He pulled her down next to him and kissed the top of her head.
“Thank you.”

“If you want to abuse my body, put a pillow over my face so my mum can’t hear my moans.”

“I’ll wait until your mum’s gone home—I love hearing the noises you make.”

She kissed his neck. “Okay, I promise I’ll be vocal then.”

* * * *

Julian woke Nicole with a cup of tea. "Merry Christmas."

Smiling, she sat up. "Thanks, same to you." She took the cup from him. "Is Mum up yet?"

He shook his head.

"Okay. I'm going to do eggs benedict for breakfast."

"Wonderful."

Nicole slipped out of bed and walked to her wardrobe. She took out the wrapped photograph and passed it to Julian. "You're going to have to open this one here. It's not really suitable for Mum's eyes."

Looking intrigued, he sat on the bed and unwrapped his gift. As the picture was revealed, he smiled broadly. "That's wonderful."

"I thought you could put in on the wall in your office."

"Am I allowed to masturbate while I look at it?"

She was shocked into laughter. "Only if I can kneel in front of you while you do it."

He took a deep breath. "I'd love that."

She held his gaze. "Me too."

Julian studied the photograph closely. "Did you get the printers to make it black and white?"

"I did it all on my phone. Trimmed it to size and chose the filter. I tried sepia and a few others, but that was my favourite."

"It's fabulous, and incredibly erotic." He held it out at arm's length. "How do you feel about it now? I mean, how do you feel about what you'd experienced just before you took that photo?"

"Physically, it's a nice memory."

He nodded. "Good. Just keep thinking of the physical side of it."

* * * *

Nicole had a wonderful morning. Her mum loved her gifts and told them off for spending too much on her. Julian tried on his walking shoes and played gleefully with all the other gadgets she'd bought him. He'd

bought her a long fluffy dressing gown and matching slippers, which she put on over her leggings and vest-top.

Finally, he handed her a small, gift-wrapped box. "This is your main present," he explained.

Nicole looked at it, then glanced at her mum who shrugged to show she didn't know anything about it. Julian had always claimed ignorance when it came to jewellery, so Nicole had wondered if he'd asked her mum's opinion.

"Before you open it," he said, "I think we should go outside."

Nicole frowned, but he was already walking towards the hall. *Maybe it's something for the garden.*

He opened the front door and strode out. Nicole and her mum followed, both still wearing dressing gowns and slippers.

Julian walked to the garage, then nodded towards the doorhandle.

Nicole smiled, now certain he'd bought her something like a birdbath or statue. She turned the handle and swung the door upwards. Her jaw dropped and she heard her mum gasp.

In the middle of the double garage, facing out, was a Mini. It was metallic pale blue with a white roof. She turned to look at Julian, who was grinning from ear to ear.

"You've bought me a *car*?"

He nodded. "I couldn't help noticing that yours looked a little tired compared to all the others down this road."

She looked back at the Mini, then opened the gift box, which held a key fob. On pressing the button, the indicators flashed and the doors unlocked. She opened the door and sat in the driver's seat. It smelled of leather and carpets. "Is it brand new?"

He nodded again, still grinning.

"I've never had a new car before."

Nicole's mum climbed into the passenger side. "I've never known anyone to get a car for Christmas."

"Me neither." Nicole still couldn't believe it. She got out of the car in a daze and walked all around it. It was a Cooper S, which meant it was the sports version. Climbing back in, she started it up; the engine sounded throaty. She smiled at her mum. "Fasten your seatbelt, we'll go for a spin."

“But I’ve only got my dressing gown on.”

“Me too. Let’s hope we don’t break down.” As Julian stepped to one side, Nicole drove slowly out of the garage and down the drive. She took the car for a short drive around the estate, marvelling at the way it handled and its acceleration. Less than five minutes later, she’d parked neatly and flung her arms around her husband’s waist. “Thank you.”

“You’re welcome.”

“Can we afford it?”

“Yes.”

After Julian had closed and locked the garage door, Nicole linked arms with her husband and mother as they headed back towards the house. “Come on, we’ve got Bucks Fizz to drink before breakfast.”

Her mum laughed. “So this is how the other half lives.”

A boozy breakfast was followed by a late lunch, then Nicole and her mother watched *It’s a Wonderful Life* for the umpteenth time, both of them dabbing their eyes by the time the credits rolled up.

As ever, Julian went to bed while the women stayed up talking. When Nicole finally joined him in bed, he was already asleep. She spooned him from behind, still unable to believe he’d bought her a car, let alone managed to get it in their garage without her seeing anything.

* * * *

After Nicole’s mum had left on Boxing Day, Julian suggested a walk to try out his new shoes. It was a clear, cold day and they spent almost two hours walking hand in hand around the now familiar trail. Back at home they ate cold turkey sandwiches while listening to music. After they’d finished, Nicole took her husband’s hand and pulled.

“Where are we going?” he asked, standing up from his chair.

“Bed. You’re going to talk to me while Denzel satisfies me. And then I’m going to show you how grateful I am for my new car.”

He grinned. “Maybe I could wear my new walking boots.”

She laughed and led him upstairs. She stripped naked and lay on the bed, resting on her elbows. “Get Denzel out.”

Julian found the vibrator in the bottom drawer of her bedside cabinet, then sat on the edge of the bed and held up the toy.

She took it from him, fond memories of the only occasion she'd used it flashing through her mind. After placing the tip against her outer lips, she flicked the switch. Denzel buzzed to life and made her quiver. "Tell me a story."

Julian looked down at her. "I've been away on business, but managed to get an earlier flight home."

She stared into his eyes, marvelling at how easily he could conjure this up. Six months ago, he'd get tongue-tied trying to explain the type of dress he wanted her to wear.

"You're not expecting me home until the evening. When I pull onto the drive, there's a car I don't recognise. I surmise that you have a visitor. I try to remember if you'd told me who you were seeing." He smiled. "We've gotten into the routine of you having a date while I'm away. It's entertainment for you in my absence, and also provides things for you to describe when I get home."

She sighed. "I like that idea."

"Me too." He reached down and gripped her wrist, then pulled it up slightly, guiding the first couple of inches of Denzel inside her. "I open the front door quietly, not wanting to disturb you. I assume you're in the bedroom and intend sneaking up to my office and waiting in there."

Nicole watched his face, her insides already tingling in anticipation of her release.

"As I approach the stairs, I hear you moan. But the sound's not from above—it's coming from the room you use as an office. I see the door is slightly ajar, and I imagine you bent over your own desk in the way you used to bend over Ciaran's."

"Please tell me it's not Ciaran."

He smiled and shook his head. "No, he's the past. This is someone else."

Nicole nodded. "Go on."

"I know I should go upstairs and wait, because once he's gone, you'll sit on my cock and tell me all about it."

Nicole rocked her hips and slid Denzel deeper, letting out a long sigh.

“But the open door is too much of a temptation. I’ve watched you before, and I know how wonderful you look when you’re having sex. I put down my briefcase and tiptoe along the hall and peer through open door. It turns out that you’re both lying on the rug, but I can’t see much. Your upper bodies are hidden behind the couch, your feet obscured by the door. All I can see is two pairs of legs from knees to waist. One pair’s still in trousers, but yours are bare. So is your sex. A hand is busy between your spread thighs, and I watch you writhe and hear you moan. I can smell your juices from the hall. You arch your back and beg to have your nipples sucked.”

Nicole’s legs began to tremble, her breathing shallow and unsteady.

Julian leaned down and kissed her forehead. “It’s only then that I notice how small the hand is, and the arm is slim and has no hair.”

Nicole stared at him, puzzled.

“And I realise it’s not a man you’re entertaining.”

Her eyes fluttered and she frowned at the twist in his story.

“I’m watching you being finger-fucked by a woman and, as she brings you to orgasm, you scream—”

“Ahhh...” Nicole rammed the vibrator deep and arched off the bed, stabbing herself time after time as she came. She grunted, then slipped it out and dropped it onto the bed. She pulled Julian on top of her, yanking his t-shirt up and off, then grappling with his zip. “Get your dick out. I want—”

She gripped his cock and guided him into her, wrapping her legs around his waist and rolling them both onto their sides. Nicole thrust her hips, scratched his arms and pulled his hair. She came again, a sharp, intense spasm that wracked her body.

Pushing him onto his back, she clambered on top and ground her clit against him as she shuddered and moaned. Julian reached round and pushed a finger up her backside. Nicole yelped and arched her back, then came for a third time. She bounced up and down with force, relishing the feeling of his cock and his finger invading her at the same time. She growled obscenities, calling him a dirty bastard and herself a slut and then, with an overwhelming feeling of fulfilment, she welcomed the gush of his orgasm

as he flooded her. She wriggled her hips from side to side, then rocked in small circles until his cock stopped pulsing.

After hiding from his gaze for a few moments, she slowly lifted herself up until his cock and finger slipped out. She shuffled up the bed on her knees and held herself over his waist, then clenched her muscles. Julian looked down and watched as she squeezed out his cum. It dribbled onto his stomach, soaking into the dark hair.

“Sit on my face,” he whispered.

She shook her head. “Not this time.” She lowered her crotch onto his stomach and began to gyrate her hips, spreading the cum over his tummy. She felt more of his stuff ooze out and continued smearing the mixture of their combined juices all over his belly and her thighs. She rocked faster, grinding her clit against his sternum, the wiry hairs tickling the soft, sensitive skin around her cunt. Her legs began to shake again. She gritted her teeth and stared down into his eyes.

Before she could get over the final hurdle, he flipped her off him and onto her back, then roughly pushed three fingers into her, making her squeal. When he dropped his head and took her clit between his lips, she exploded. Flashes illuminated the insides of her eyelids and shockwaves convulsed her body, her feet kicking as if she were being electrocuted.

With her back arched and her head pushed back into the pillow, Nicole let out a final, guttural groan. Julian released her clit from his lips and withdrew his fingers, then sat back on his haunches. She opened her eyes and looked at him, his trousers tangled around his knees and his chest hair a matted mess.

He ran his hand down her leg. “You’re amazing.”

She let out a sigh. “That was all you. That was...” She shook her head. “I’ve never come like that before. Nobody’s ever...” She let out a long, ragged exhale. “Your story. What made you think of that?”

He shrugged. “I know I need to find ways to keep it fresh. To push buttons.”

She laughed. “You’re pushing buttons I never knew I had.”

“Your comment about Liz kissing you made my mind wander.”

“I’m sure it was just a friendly gesture.” *Liar.*

“It doesn’t matter. It worked for my story, and it’s a nice scenario to think about.”

“You like the idea?”

“Very much.” He narrowed his eyes. “Do you?”

She held his gaze for a moment, then sighed. “God, what am I turning into?”

He guffawed. “I need a shower. Someone seems to have used me as a rubbing post.”

She ran her hands through the sticky mess on his stomach. “I’m not sorry.”

“Neither am I.”

While Julian went to clean up, Nicole lay on the bed for a couple of minutes to get her breath back before joining him. They slowly washed each other, and she avoided his eyes as she spoke. “If I were to do anything with Liz, would you mind?”

“Of course not.”

“What about if I were to do something with Liz *and* Ed?” She looked up to gauge his expression.

“I wouldn’t mind that, either.” He tucked a strand of wet hair behind her ear. “Why, do you think it’s a possibility?”

She shrugged. “I’ve no idea. They’re the first couple I’ve ever met who admit to having an open marriage. I just wanted to know what you thought, before—”

“Whatever happens, it’ll be fine with me.”

“Thanks.” She kissed his chest. “But I don’t think anything will happen.”

“I’m not sure either of us believe that.”

* * * *

Over the next few days, the wet weather prevented them from going on any more walks, though they did take Nicole’s new car for a longer drive. She loved everything about it. Julian explained that someone would be collecting her old car to take to the auctions in the next few days. He’d

bought his parents a tablet for Christmas, and they had a Zoom meeting with them. Neither of his parents commented on his beard.

They spent New Year's Eve at home on their own, which was the first time they'd done that since they'd met. When someone further down their road set off fireworks at midnight, they took their glasses of champagne into the garden and watched. Nicole checked to see if Liz and Ed were outside, but there was no sign of them.

Once the fireworks had finished, they headed back into the lounge. All the talk in the papers and on the TV that day was about how everyone would be glad to see the back of 2020, Covid's devastating death toll, and the shattered economy.

"With all the negative reviews of this year, I feel guilty for being so fortunate," she confided as they snuggled back down onto the couch.

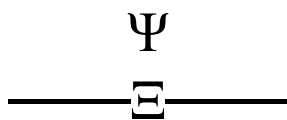
"I know what you mean. This year will be a black spot for many people when they look back, but for us..." He smiled. "It's been life-changing."

"What will 2021 bring, I wonder?"

"More of the same for us, I hope."

She raised her eyebrows. "And maybe more variety, too."





Chapter Five

Nicole had been asked to go into her employers' office for a meeting on the day that Julian started his new role. It was the first time she'd been there in more than nine months. The employees gathered in the company canteen, where all the tables had been pushed to one side and all chairs, though spaced further apart than usual, had been lined up in a way that reminded her of assembly at school. She looked out for Sam, the man she'd had a brief fling with eighteen months ago, but couldn't see him.

As the managing director made his way to the makeshift stage at the front, everyone fell silent. His expression was solemn.

Nicole listened as he thanked them for coming in and then explained that the board had been left with no alternative but to make some painful decisions. They would need to cut the workforce by twenty percent. She glanced around, seeing sad eyes and creased brows over the facemasks in the audience. After thanking everyone for their service and apologising yet again, he left the stage to the noise of almost ninety chairs being pushed back. Everyone stood up and headed for the door.

Nicole went up to her old office and chatted with a couple of women in her work group. Their line-manager, Ian, joined them and said that while he hoped to retain everyone in his team, some might be asked to do fewer hours.

"I could do that," Nicole said, after seeing Tracy's face fall.

Ian gave her a wan smile. "Thanks, but you're already part-time. We might need to ask more people to do the same. At least for a while."

Nicole thought Tracy might cry. Her husband worked on the factory floor, so he might be out of a job altogether. "I'm happy to be laid off until things pick up again."

"We're not sure if the furlough scheme will—"

"I'm not asking to be furloughed. Just suspend my contract until this thing's over. Then I'll come back, though I'd like the chance to keep

working remotely.” She smiled. “It’s much easier to sit in my jammies all day and not worry about putting on makeup and doing the commute.”

“Okay, I’ll mention it,” he said. “But I don’t want to lose you from the team.”

After he’d wandered off to talk to other people, Nicole stayed and chatted for a few more minutes before leaving the office and walking along the path towards the car park. She sensed someone behind her. When she turned, she came face to face with Sam. “Hello stranger,” she said with a smile.

Fortunately, they’d managed to maintain their friendship after Nicole had called a halt to their lunchtime trysts. She’d enjoyed the excitement but had felt too guilty to continue the affair.

“Hi.” He stopped a couple of paces away. “How are you?”

“I’m good, thanks. You?”

“Yeah, great.” Frowning, he looked around at the site. “Worrying times.”

“Yeah. Will your job be safe?”

“I hope so, we have a baby on the way.”

“Ah, that’s lovely. When’s it due?”

“April.”

“Well, congratulations. And I really hope things work out with the job situation.” Nicole gave him a warm smile and walked away, wondering if she’d ever meet him again.

Once on the open road, she turned the music up loud and revelled in the pleasure of driving her new car. When she got home she headed into the kitchen and put the kettle on. Before it had boiled, her phone pinged.

Hi Nicole

HNY !

*Just seen you get back — fancy coming over for
a coffee?*

She replied with a thumbs up emoji and headed next door.

Liz was waiting on her porch. “Hiya. Happy New Year.”

“Thanks. You too.” They hugged with a closeness that made Nicole shiver slightly.

Liz nodded toward Nicole’s drive. “New car?”

Turning to look at the Mini on her drive, she nodded. “Yes. It was a Christmas surprise.”

“It’s fabulous. Come on in.” They walked through the hall and into the kitchen. “How come you’re all dressed up?”

Nicole glanced down at her white blouse, black trousers and high heels. “I wouldn’t call it dressed—”

“I love your hair pinned up. You look great.” Liz filled the kettle from the tap.

“Thank you. I had to go into the office today for an announcement. There are going to be job cuts as a result of the Covid situation.”

“Oh no. Are you at risk?”

“I actually volunteered to take a break. Julian’s just been promoted again, and some of the girls I work with need the job more than I do, so I offered to become a lady of leisure for a few months.”

“Ooh, I like the sound of that. A lady of lei—s-u-u-re.” Liz narrowed her eyes. “Maybe ‘lady of pleasure’ would be more appropriate for you, though.”

Butterflies fluttered in Nicole’s stomach. “Hmm.”

Liz stepped closer. “I thought about you a lot over Christmas.”

She stared into Liz’s eyes, aware that their boobs were almost touching. Nicole felt her nipples tighten, and her mouth became dry. “I’ve thought about you, too.”

“And what in particular did you think about?”

The kiss. Nicole swallowed. “I wondered if you’d told Ed about our shared secrets. And I wondered if he’d kept you awake as a result of our conversation.”

Liz smiled. “Yes, and yes.” She glanced down at Nicole’s mouth, then back into her eyes.

Nicole hoped she was going to kiss her again, and her heart thumped in her chest.

“Did you tell Julian about our secrets?”

Nicole wondered at first if Liz meant their shared kiss, but then realised she meant their open marriage. She nodded.

“Good.” Liz traced her fingertips along Nicole’s upper arm, sending tiny electric shocks down her spine. “I love the feel of this blouse.”

Nicole smiled, but what she really wanted was for Liz to keep stroking her. And not just her arm: her shoulders, back, tummy. Tits. She realised she was holding her breath.

Liz stepped back as the kettle clicked off. “Coffee or tea?”

“Coffee, please.”

Liz poured their drinks and tilted her head toward the door. “Shall we go through to the lounge?” Without waiting for an answer, she walked out of the kitchen.

Liz sat on the couch and patted the cushion next to her. Nicole placed her cup on a coaster on the small side table, then sat down next to her friend and crossed her legs.

“I have a confession,” Liz said as she turned to face her, bringing her knee up onto the seat between them. “I was as much to blame as Ed for us not getting much sleep.”

“Oh?”

“It was something you’d said, about...” Liz frowned, as if embarrassed.

“About what?”

“About what you do, and—”

Nicole was enjoying her friend’s sudden attack of shyness. She leaned closer and lowered her voice. “What I do?”

“When you’re with another partner...”

“Hmm?”

“You said Julian likes to watch.”

Nicole felt her sex clench. She wondered if Liz wanted Julian to watch the two of them. “Yes he does. It turns him on, gets him all worked up.”

Liz took a breath, then licked her lips. “I’ve never watched anyone having sex.”

“Neither have I.” She grinned. “I’m always the one having sex.”

“I can understand that. You’re so beautiful.”

Nicole leaned closer still. She was desperate for another kiss, but afraid to initiate it. “You’re pretty hot yourself.”

Liz giggled, then looked over to the door. “Hey, you.”

Nicole turned, shocked to see Ed. He wore jeans, a chequered shirt and carpet slippers. He also had on a pair of black-framed reading specs. “Hi, Ed. Happy New Year.”

“Hi Nicole,” he said, smiling and removing his glasses. “I didn’t hear the doorbell. Did you have a good Christmas?”

“Very nice, thanks, though it was odd not being able to go anywhere other than shopping for food.”

As he nodded his agreement, Liz leaned forward. “Nicole got a new Mini for Christmas.”

“Oh?”

“Don’t get all excited,” Liz warned him. “It’s a car, not a skirt.”

Nicole grinned. “Santa came in my garage this year.”

Ed laughed out loud, and Liz elbowed her in the ribs. “Stop it, you’ll give him another hard-on.”

Nicole turned and stared at her friend, who looked embarrassed by her own comment.

“What I meant was, you’ll... He’ll...” She looked up at her husband. “Help me out here.”

He shook his head. “It’s all your own doing. I’ll get myself a coffee.”

After he’d gone to the kitchen, Nicole turned to Liz. “I didn’t realise Ed was home.”

“Is it a problem?”

“Of course not.”

“Good.” Liz sat closer and inhaled. “I love that perfume you’re wearing.”

“Thanks, it’s...” Nicole found she couldn’t remember what she’d sprayed on that morning, and neither did she care. Liz’s face was so close, her eyes half closed and mouth slightly open. Nicole leaned in and kissed

her softly on the lips, then pulled back. The women stared at each other. Nicole wondered if Liz's heart was thumping as hard as her own.

Just at that moment, Ed returned with a mug of coffee and sat in the armchair. Nicole wondered if he could sense the charged atmosphere.

Desperate to find something to talk about, she nodded toward the French doors leading to their garden. "Did you see the fireworks on New Year's Eve?"

"No, we actually had an early night..." He glanced at his wife, then looked down into his cup.

Liz giggled. "Don't worry, I've already told her how little sleep we've been getting."

Ed looked uncomfortable and glanced at Nicole.

Liz reached out and stroked Nicole's arm. "I've also admitted how much I like the idea of doing what Julian does... Watching."

Nicole looked into her friends' eyes, then glanced at Ed. He looked as surprised as she felt by his wife's admission.

"I can imagine how sexy you must look," Liz whispered, her eyes fixed on Nicole's.

Though self-conscious in Ed's presence, Nicole couldn't deny the heat that bloomed between her legs and which diffused through her entire body. "Would you only want to watch?"

Liz opened her mouth, then closed it again and nodded. "Like I told you, I have some intimacy issues..."

Nicole reached out and took her hand. "Maybe I could help you get over them?"

Flashing a nervous smile, Liz nodded. "I'm sure you could, but for now..." She freed her hand and used it to undo the top button of Nicole's blouse. "I just want to watch."

Nicole held her breath and sat perfectly still, allowing her friend to unfasten all five buttons of her blouse. Purposely not looking at Ed, she kept her eyes fixed on Liz's face.

Liz pulled open the blouse and looked down at Nicole's bra-clad breasts and stomach, then turned to her husband. "Isn't she beautiful?"

He nodded his agreement.

“Come and see her up close.”

Nicole swallowed the lump in her throat, unable to believe what was happening. That she was actually letting it happen.

Ed put down his cup, dropped off the chair and slowly crawled across the carpet. He stopped with his knees by Nicole’s feet, his gaze resting inside her gaping blouse.

Liz ran her hand down Nicole’s arm. “Would it be okay if I asked Ed to take your trousers off now?”

Her throat felt tight and her pulse raged in her ears. She nodded.

Smiling, Liz undid the trouser button, then pushed the zip down. She leaned close and whispered, “Raise your bum up.”

As if in a trance, Nicole did as ordered. Ed slipped his hands into the waistband and eased it down over her hips. As Nicole lowered herself back to the cushion, he slid the trousers down her thighs, over her bent knees and over her feet, removing her shoes with the trousers.

Liz placed her hand on Nicole’s thigh and let out a murmur of approval. “You’re so perfect.”

Nicole bit her lip. “No I’m not...”

“Yes you are. Your legs are firm and yet so soft to touch.” She ran her fingertips down Nicole’s thigh, then tilted her head toward her husband. “I know he’s been fantasising about seeing you like this.” She leaned close and blew in Nicole’s ear. “And so have I.” Liz slid her soft palm down Nicole’s leg to her knee, then slowly up again.

Nicole turned to look into her friend’s eyes, then glanced down at her mouth again. “Kiss me.”

Liz leaned close and kissed her softly on the lips. Nicole brought a hand up to cradle the back of Liz’s head. It was strange to kiss someone so soft and smooth, but incredibly erotic. Liz ran her hand up Nicole’s leg and over her tummy, then higher still. Delicate fingers circled over a taut nipple, then stroked it through the soft lace of her bra.

Nicole felt two other hands, the skin of the fingers and palms rougher, stroking the outsides of her calves. As Ed’s hands moved over her knees and up to her thighs, the women’s kissing became more passionate, their tongues sliding against one another. When Ed’s fingers reached her inner thighs, Nicole spread her legs without breaking the kiss.

He stroked a finger over the wet gusset of her thong, and Nicole let out a quiet groan. He did it again, then slipped the finger beneath the edge of the silky material and touched her slippery folds.

Nicole opened her eyes and let out a louder groan. Liz broke the kiss and watched her face. Ed's hands moved to behind her knees, pulling gently and encouraging her to slide to the edge of the cushion. Nicole inched forward, which also lowered her head on the backrest of the couch. As Liz smiled down at her, Ed slipped his fingers into the waistband of her thong. Nicole allowed him to peel it off.

Liz glanced down at Nicole's uncovered lower body. "You're so sexy."

Before Nicole could respond, Ed kissed her inner thigh. His lips weren't soft like Liz's, and she could feel the graze of the stubble on his chin. The kisses trailed higher up her leg until she could feel his warm breath against the wetness of her sex. When she felt a warm wet tongue slide up through her folds, she whimpered. He did it again, and Nicole closed her eyes and raised her hips to meet his tongue.

"Does she taste as good as she looks?" Liz whispered.

Ed pushed his tongue into Nicole's channel. She tilted her hips to give him easier access. Her bra fastened at the front and, holding Liz's gaze, she unclipped it and pulled the cups aside, pushing her blouse wide open.

Liz stared at her boobs for a second before tentatively lifting a hand to caress one.

Nicole's passion took over. She pulled Liz close and kissed her hungrily while her husband lapped at her sex. Then she put her hand on Liz's head and pushed gently downwards. With wide eyes, the other woman allowed herself to be moved until her face was positioned over Nicole's erect nipple.

"Suck it," Nicole whispered.

Liz pushed her tongue out and ran it round the areola, then took the nipple between her lips and sucked. At the same time, Ed moved his attention up to her clit. Liz grazed her teeth over one nipple while using her fingers to tease the other.

Nicole felt the tightening of muscles throughout her body. Her toes curled and she let out a sob. She looked down at Liz, whose eyes had never

left her face. “Oh...”

Liz released her nipple and moved up until the women were face to face. As Ed sucked her clit between his lips and lathered it with his tongue, Nicole let out a yelp.

Liz stroked her cheek, then leaned down and kissed her lips. “Tell me when, and try to keep your eyes open for me...”

Nicole’s eyelids fluttered, but she forced them open. “Now. It’s now. I’m... Oh.” She pushed her crotch up into Ed’s face, grinding herself against his nose and chin.

“God, you’re beautiful,” Liz whispered.

Nicole failed in her quest to keep her eyes open. She squeezed them shut and pushed her head back against the couch as the orgasm thundered through her.

She eventually managed to open her eyes and took a deep breath. She smiled up at Liz. “God, that was...”

Liz stroked her face. “You looked fantastic. Are you ready for more?”

“Mm hmm.”

“Can he make love to you?”

She smiled and shook her head. “My husband’s the only man who does that. Other men have to fuck me.”

“Oh.” Liz grinned. “So, can he fuck you now?”

Nicole nodded, then looked down at Ed. She was about to tell him he’d need to wear a condom, but he was already rolling one on.

Liz ran her hand over Nicole’s mons, then reached out and gripped her husband’s cock. As he leaned forward on his knees, she guided him into position, then turned to watch Nicole’s face as her husband pushed slowly inside.

Nicole let out a moan and gripped Liz’s hand. Ed eased back and pushed in again. His cock was thick, stretching her. She pushed her bare feet up on tiptoes, arching her bum off the cushion.

Liz bent until her face was inches from hers. “Does that feel good?”

“Oh, yeah.” Nicole winced as Ed pushed in deeper still, his girth causing pleasant discomfort. “Oh fuck, yeah.” Looking down her body at

Ed, she rocked her hips in time with his thrusts. “Fuck me.”

Liz’s expression was like a kid’s at a fair; she stared wide-eyed, her gaze flicking between Nicole’s face, her writhing body, and Ed’s cock driving in and out of her sex. He placed his hands on Nicole’s hips and held her in place as he pounded her.

Panting through clenched teeth, she urged him on by raising her hips to meet each thrust. She looked up at Liz. “Is this what you wanted to see?”

“Yes.”

Nicole noticed Liz jerking her own hips in time with her husband’s thrusts. Maybe she was clenching and able to get herself off that way. Reaching up, Nicole cupped Liz’s breast through her t-shirt, making her sigh.

Ed increased his force—probably excited to see the woman he was fucking grope his wife—and Nicole felt the early tingle of another orgasm. She clamped a finger and thumb on one of Liz’s nipples, twisting it and making her squirm. Liz bent and kissed her, probing Nicole’s mouth with her tongue in time with the thick cock plunging again and again into her body.

Nicole let out a groan, but Liz didn’t let up—she kissed harder, grinding their lips together. Even the occasional clash of their teeth didn’t seem to bother her.

Ed was now fucking her with long, deep thrusts. Nicole felt his palm on her mons, pushing her tummy down around his thick dick. Then he moved his thumb over her clit, making her orgasm erupt like a Jack-in-the-box. She screamed and shook, breaking the kiss.

She was vaguely aware of Liz watching her entire body jerk and twitch. Spasms rippled through her, then Ed grunted. He pushed deep and held still, pumped his hips twice and held still again. Nicole tried to clench and wriggle for him, but her body seemed to have a will of its own. Her legs shook and her buttocks repeatedly clenched and relaxed spontaneously.

Eventually, the two performers stopped moving and the room became silent except for their ragged breathing. Nicole had her eyes closed and was reluctant to open them in case Liz was having second thoughts. She knew only too well how easy it was to go from really enjoying something to regretting it almost the second the adrenaline rush had faded. A soft hand stroked her cheek, and she opened her eyes.

Liz smiled down, her face inches away. “Thank you,” she whispered, before kissing her gently on the lips.

“It was my pleasure,” she replied, glancing down at Ed as he withdrew.

“And mine,” he said, standing and turning around. It was obvious he was removing the condom. He left the room and came back a few moments later, buckling his belt.

Liz helped Nicole sit upright. “That was so much sexier than I’d dared hope for.”

Nicole pulled on her thong and trousers, and Liz took their cups of cold coffee out, leaving Nicole and Ed together in the lounge.

An awkward silence might have ensued, but Ed dropped into his armchair and smiled broadly. “You’ve just made an old man very happy.”

She laughed and shook her head. “You’re not an old man, and I think it was pretty evident you weren’t the only one who was happy.”

He nodded gratefully.

“Besides,” Nicole said, re-fastening her bra and buttoning her blouse, “I happen to know that, like me, you’re not new to this.”

“Touché.” He let out a long exhale. “There are a million questions I’d like to ask, but for now I’m still wrapped in a cocoon of sated euphoria.”

Nicole laughed. “Yeah, I’m feeling kind of that way myself. I was only expecting coffee.”

Liz came back into the room carrying a tray with three cups and a cafetière. “Did I hear you mention coffee?”

“I was pointing out that I thought coffee was all I’d be getting today.” Nicole gave her a knowing smile.

Liz placed the tray on a side table. “I don’t know what you mean.” A smile tugged at the corners of her mouth. “But I think all three of us have had that on our minds for a while.”

Nicole remembered pleasuring herself after she’d visited them for supper. “Yes, that’s probably true.”

Liz poured the drinks and sat beside her on the couch. “Will you tell Julian?”

“Of course. I don’t do anything behind his back, and I don’t do anything I think he’d disapprove of.”

“Had you two already discussed the possibility of—”

“Yes.” She smiled at Liz’s surprised expression. “What can I say? I’m easy.”

Her friend put her hand on her arm and smiled warmly.

“So,” Nicole asked. “Was watching as much fun as you expected?”

“Better. Much better.” She nodded thoughtfully. “I’ll spend time thinking about it, let the images percolate in my dirty brain for a while, and then I’ll tell you exactly which parts turned me on the most.”

“I’d like that. Maybe you can tell me on our next walk.”

“Yeah, maybe.”

They drank their coffee in a comfortable silence for a few moments, and then the conversation turned to Nicole’s impending career break.

Ed put his cup down. “Well, if you need something to fill your time, my accounts are a mess.”

Nicole had a dreamy déjà vu of being bent over a receipt-covered desk. “I can show Liz how to do them, then she can start earning her salary.”

He chuckled and nodded. “Now *that* would be a nice change.”

“Cheeky sod,” Liz muttered.

Five minutes later, Nicole stepped back into her shoes and said she should be getting back home. All three stood up together, and after a moment of awkwardness, she hugged Ed. “I hope we get a chance to repeat that.”

“Me too.”

Liz walked her to the door, but before opening it she smiled at Nicole. “You’re so incredibly sexy.”

“But not sexy enough for you to join in?”

Liz gave a self-conscious frown. “It’s not through lack of wanting to, I’m just a little...” She shrugged.

“It’s okay. I’m happy to wait.” Nicole stroked her arm. Lowering her voice, she said, “I’ve never been with a woman before.”

Liz looked down at her feet, then up into Nicole's eyes. "Me neither. When I do, I'd prefer it to be just the two of us. At least for the first time."

Nicole hugged her. "That'd be fine with me." She kissed Liz's cheek, then waited for her to open the door. "Text me when you fancy a walk."

As soon as she got home, Nicole headed up to shower and change. She considered texting Julian but thought it might be best not to distract him on the first day of his new job. She'd tell him tonight.

* * * *

Ciaran texted her later that day. Wishing her a Happy New Year, he said he was still trying to arrange their trip but needed to wait for permission from the Irish authorities. Now confident that she wouldn't get herself into an upsetting situation if she did humour him with her presence at the bank, she replied with a simple 'Okay' then put him out of her mind.

When Julian arrived home, he looked a little frazzled. She poured them both a glass of wine while he changed, then they sat in the lounge while he described his day. Apparently he was working from a temporary office while his new one was having the cables upgraded.

"Ooh," she said, smiling. "Do you get shiny new leads for your printer if you're management?"

He laughed. "All the printers are wireless now, as I'm sure you know. What I'm getting is a better ethernet connection. It'll be back-to-back videoconferences until the travel restrictions are relaxed."

Nicole tutted dramatically. "Video cameras in offices, whoever thought of that."

Julian frowned, but then seemed to realise she was just teasing—rather than having a dig—about his impulsive hiding of cameras in Ciaran's office. He relaxed, smiling, then told her about the rest of his day.

"Ideally," he said after a ten-minute diatribe on the company's concerns about the post-Brexit 'settling in' period, "our IT system needs to be updated. Or at least standardised. I discovered today that some branches in Europe are still using an older version of our in-house software. And that could mean the algorithm—"

“Blah blah blah.” She smiled sweetly. “I stopped listening halfway through the free-trade agreement strategy.”

“Sorry.” Julian’s sheepish grin gave way to a more sombre expression. “So, how was your day? Was this morning’s meeting what you feared?”

She nodded. “There’s going to be job losses.”

“Well like I’ve said, there’s really no need for you to continue.”

“I know, and because you’d said that, I’ve offered to let them suspend my contract for a few months. They suggested everyone in our team go part-time, but some of them really need their full salaries.”

“Will they go for that?”

“I hope so. I also said that when things finally get back to normal, I’d like to continue working from home.”

He nodded his approval.

“I also bumped into Sam.”

“Oh?”

She smiled. “I only spoke to him briefly.”

“Did you tell him about what we’re doing? The loaning—”

“Of course not!” She shook her head in exasperation. “We chatted long enough for him to tell me that not only is he now happily married, they have a baby due in three months.”

“Ah. That’s nice.”

“Yeah, but now he’s worried about keeping his job, which is understandable.”

“Yes, I would expect it—”

“And then I let the man next door go down on me while his wife watched.”

Julian almost dropped his wine glass. “You... He... *Really?*”

She nodded.

“How did that happen?”

“Liz saw me drive back from the meeting and texted to ask if I fancied a coffee. Ed was there, and one thing led to another.”

“Just like that?”

She nodded, then shrugged. "I think it might have been planned on their part."

"Why do you say that?"

"It just seemed odd. Liz opened the door before I could ring the doorbell, and then we went into the lounge when every other time we've stayed in the kitchen. She said she'd been thinking about what I told her we got up to, and then Ed walked in. I'd assumed he wasn't in the house, and he said he hadn't known I was there. Plus, he had a condom in his pocket."

Julian's eyes went wide. "I thought you said he went down on you?"

"He did. And after that, he fucked me."

"Right..."

Just then, the oven timer started to beep. Nicole walked quickly to the kitchen and took the moussaka out of the oven and left it resting on the hob. She returned to the lounge and sat back next to her husband, who still looked in a state of shock.

"Do you want to eat?" she asked.

"I can wait."

"Do you want to fuck?"

"I can wait for that, too." He leaned close. "What were you wearing?"

Nicole laughed, picked up her own drink and leaned back on the couch. "I'd been to work, so I had a blouse and trousers on."

"Shoes?"

"Black heels."

"Hair?"

"Pinned up."

"Makeup?"

"Minimal. Mascara, no foundation, a bit of lippy."

"Underwear?"

"White lace bra, and a thong to avoid a panty line through my trousers."

"Did they match?" He was grinning.

"No, but it didn't seem to matter. At least they were both white."

His brow creased as he thought. "Was this the first time a bull's gone down on you?"

That gave her pause. "I hadn't thought of Ed as a bull. Would that make Liz a cow?" She grinned, then thought about his actual question. "I..." Images of being with Ciaran flashed through her mind. She'd sucked his cock several times. She'd also sucked Will's, and even briefly sucked the plumber's, too. "I can't actually remember."

"I'm not sure you're expected to remember everything that's occurred. So, did you go to the bedroom?"

Nicole shook her head, then told him as much as she could remember. How she let Liz undo her blouse, how she'd slid down the couch and let Ed pull off her shoes and trousers, and how her friend had held her hand and kissed her while her husband licked her sex.

"Did you come like that?" He shook his head before she could answer. "Sorry, silly question."

"Liz asked me to keep my eyes open, but I failed."

"And then he fucked you?"

"Hmm."

"And?"

"And I came again."

He smiled broadly. "Of course you did. What about Liz?"

"She's shy. She only watched, though I did force her to kiss my breast."

"I thought she saw another man?"

"She does, but only him. I'm not sure what her problem is, but..." She smiled. "I intend helping her overcome it."

"Ah."

"Would you mind if I took another woman to bed?"

"That's another silly question."

Nicole drained her glass. "Anything else you need to know?"

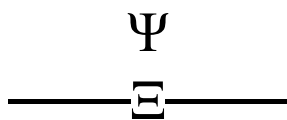
He shook his head.

"Okay," she said. "What do you want to do first, eat or have sex?"

"We'd better eat first, otherwise I may not have the strength to meet your demands."

“Hmm, and we can’t have that.” She stood, took his hand and led him through to the kitchen.





Chapter Six

Julian's new role at work kept him busy for the rest of the week. After full days in the office, he spent between two and three hours locked away upstairs every evening. He explained it wouldn't always be like this, but that it was a steep learning curve. Nicole assured him it wasn't a problem.

When Nicole got up on Monday morning, she saw it had snowed heavily overnight. After Julian had cleaned off his car and left for work, she texted Liz like an excited child and suggested they go for a walk and build a snowman. Twenty minutes later, wrapped up in warm clothes, a woolly hat and Wellington boots, she knocked on her neighbours' door. Liz came out similarly dressed, and the two women headed off down the snow-covered path. They discussed what each had done over the weekend, how the new lockdown was impacting their lives, and the weather, though Nicole sensed Liz was eager to discuss what had happened the last time they'd met.

They walked further into the wood, the hitherto undisturbed snow on the path indicating that they were the first to do so since last night's whiteout.

Surrounded by nothing but bare-limbed trees, Nicole turned to her friend. "So, have you had time to let all the images percolate?"

Liz chuckled. "I've barely thought about anything else. Every time I close my eyes, you're there."

"And what am I doing?"

"Fucking my husband."

Nicole stopped walking, trepidation seeping through her.

Liz saw her expression and laughed, taking Nicole's gloved hand in her own and urging her to keep walking. "I'm kidding. He barely registered in them. All I see is you."

"Ed didn't feature?"

“Not really. He was mainly offscreen, or at least out of focus.” She leaned close to whisper, even though there was probably nobody within a mile of them. “I knew he was there, but he was just a prop causing the reactions I was focusing on.”

Nicole couldn't help smiling. “A prop?”

“Well, two props. His tongue, then his dick.”

“And it didn't bother you, what his tongue and dick were doing?”

Liz looked puzzled. “You mean was I jealous of you?”

Nicole swallowed. “I was worried that after the initial excitement passed, the memory of what took place might have been spoiled by twinges of—”

“No, not at all. In fact...” Now Liz was the one who stopped walking. “If I was jealous at all, it was of Ed. He got to touch you, to make you squirm and—”

“He made me do a lot more than squirm.”

“Yes he did.” Liz stared into her eyes for a moment, then pulled on Nicole's hand. They resumed walking. “What did you do when you got home afterwards?”

“I showered and had some lunch.”

“Can you guess what we did?”

“Well,” Nicole said, “I'd guess that after watching two people getting their jollies, you'd probably want some of your own.”

“Too right. I dragged him upstairs and we went at it like teenagers.”

“I hope you allowed him a rest.”

“Nope. What's more, we've been going at it like teenagers ever since.” She squeezed Nicole's arm. “You've given our libido a massive boost.”

“Good.”

“What about you and Julian? Did he want some, too?”

“Oh yeah.” She smiled but was determined to get to the bottom of Liz's strange shyness so she could help her friend get over some of her inhibitions. “So, which parts did you enjoy the most?”

Liz looked up at the sky, which had turned quite dark. “I think we're in for more snow.”

“Stop evading the question.”

“Okay. Skipping past the fact that your body is fantastic and makes me jealous, the thing—”

“Your body’s just as good. You’ve got a lovely figure.”

Liz gave a sad smile and shook her head. “I wasn’t as firm and toned as you are, even when I was in my twenties, and I’m certainly not now I’m in my forties. Your boobs are pert with nipples like cherries. Your legs are fantastic, your arse is like a peach and your skin’s perfect.”

Nicole stared, flattered but shocked by the impact she’d made on her friend. Other than Julian, she couldn’t remember anyone being so... into her. “I don’t think—”

“The thing that stands out the most is your face. You’re beautiful, and even if your boobs were saggy and your thighs were mottled with cellulite, men would still covet you so they could watch that face while they fuck you.”

Nicole stopped dead in her tracks, speechless. Snow had begun to fall in big, thick flakes.

Liz stepped close until they were nose-to-nose. “When Ed was pleasuring you, I watched your brow crease, your eyes flutter and your nostrils flare. I saw your mouth go from pouting to panting to screaming. I heard your little oohs and ahs turn to cries of ecstasy. Your body writhed, and I wanted to be the one who made you react like that.”

“And I wanted you to. I still do, but for some reason you seem...” Nicole searched for the right word but struggled. “Reluctant, somehow.”

“I’m not reluctant. I’m just...”

“Just what?”

Liz released a long sigh. “When I was a kid, I had an accident. I jumped on a hot water bottle my dad had just filled, and it split. It’s left unsightly red scars over my tummy and groin, and the top of one leg.” She gave a sad shrug. “It’s hard to watch people see it for the first time, and—”

“Do you think a bit of red skin would stop me wanting to touch you? To devour you?”

Liz sighed. “It’s just that you’re just so perf—”

Nicole cut off Liz’s words with a kiss, reaching up to hold her head in place. She backed Liz off the path until she was pressed against the wide

trunk of an oak tree, and only then broke the kiss to remove her own right glove with her teeth. She then slipped her hand inside Liz's coat and started to unbuckle her belt."

Liz giggled. "What are you doing?"

Nicole kissed her again, her hand now popping each button of the jeans' fly. She slipped her hand through the gap and pushed it inside her panties.

Liz jumped. "Your hand's freezing," she said, laughing.

"Good."

"Nicole, we're out in the open and anyone—"

Nicole cupped Liz's sex for a brief second, then slid in a finger.

"Oh..." Liz's eyes fluttered, and her mouth dropped open.

Nicole rocked her hand, curling the finger. The act of touching another woman like this was a terrific turn-on. Liz was soft, hot and wet.

"Nic... Oh god..."

The snow fell thick and heavy all around them, covering their hats and shoulders. A large flake landed on Liz's eyelash and Nicole kissed it away before it had a chance to melt.

Liz groaned and dropped her head back against the bark.

"Somebody might come."

"Hmm. It'll be you." Nicole kissed her jawline and pumped her hand, remembering how she'd felt a few months earlier when Ciaran had done this to her in his office. It had been their first contact, and they'd gone on to share many intimate moments. She had every intention of sharing more intimate moments with Liz.

"Oh god, if you don't stop doing that..."

Nicole moved her thumb over Liz's clit.

"Oh god, Nicole..."

Running her thumb gently over the raised, swollen bud, Nicole experienced a huge thrill as she brought another woman to climax for the first time ever. Liz squeezed her eyes shut and clenched her teeth, and Nicole could feel the spasms gripping her finger.

Liz whimpered quietly as her body jerked and trembled. Nicole continued to rock her hand, the finger as deep in Liz's channel as she could

manage, and her thumb still stroking gently, but now around rather than across her clit.

Once the orgasm had passed, Liz opened her eyes and stared at Nicole, breathing heavily. “God, that was...”

Nicole kissed her gently. “Next time,” she whispered, “I’ll rub my body against yours so we can both come.”

“I’d... I’d like that.”

“And maybe the time after that, you can watch your husband fuck me doggy-style while I make you come with my mouth.”

Liz gave a wide smile. “I see you’ve been giving this some thought.”

Nicole pulled her hand out of Liz’s panties and slipped her finger into her mouth, sucking it clean of juices.

They held eye contact for a moment, then Liz removed her gloves to refasten her jeans. “I’ve just been finger-fucked in a snow-globe.”

Nicole laughed. “From now on, every time I see a snow-globe I’ll think about today.”

“So will I.”

The women walked back to the path and, without discussing it, headed back the way they’d come.

After walking in silence for a couple of minutes, Nicole had a thought. “Have you told John about what happened between you, Ed and me?”

Liz seemed surprised by the question. “No, I...” She frowned, then shrugged. “I hadn’t thought about that. I don’t know what he’d say.”

Nicole shrugged. “It might give his libido a kick, too.”

She nodded, then smiled. “I’ll have to think about it.”

The snow fell thick and fast, their own earlier footprints now completely covered.

Nicole hooked her hand into her friend’s arm as they made their way up the slippery pavement toward their houses. “Are we still going to build a snowman?”

“No,” Liz said with a smile. “My panties are soaked and getting cold.”

“I’m not sorry.”

“Neither am I.” She looked up at her house. “Do you want to come in for a coffee? Ed’s there, but that—”

“No, I need to get some work done. It’s been agreed that I’ll work until the end of this week and then stop. It’ll be reviewed again at the end of April.”

“Okay. Ed actually does have work that needs doing, so once I understand what that is, maybe you could show me what to do?”

“I’d love to.” She glanced at Liz’s house. “Are you going to tell him what just happened?”

“Of course. He’ll drag me straight upstairs and I’ll get another going over.”

“Good. That’ll give me something nice to think about while I’m filling in spreadsheets.”

The women hugged before going their separate ways. Nicole walked up her drive, thinking about what her neighbours were about to do, unable to decide who she envied the most, Liz or Ed.

* * * *

Ciaran phoned later in the week. “Hi Nicole,” he said, his tone cordial and professional. “Have you got time to talk for a few minutes?”

“Yes.” She was actually having a break and sitting on the couch in her office space, drinking tea. Tomorrow would be her last day at work for a few months.

“I’ve just been chatting to the people in Ireland about our trip.”

“Right...”

“Case numbers were low there last year, but they’ve started to rise through December. We can still go, but I’ve been advised that it looks likely tougher restrictions will be coming into force in February, including a fourteen-day quarantine period.”

“Ciaran, there’s no way—”

“I know, I know. I’m the last person in the world you’d want to be stuck with. But this trip’s important, now more than ever, which I’ll tell you

about when I see you. If we go next week, we'll be there and back before the new restrictions are implemented."

"Next week?"

"Yeah. Would that be a problem with your work?"

"I doubt it, but I can find out." She saw no harm in letting him think that he still had to compete for her time.

"Great. We can catch the ferry from Liverpool early on Thursday morning, I'll book an appointment at the Dublin bank for the afternoon, then we can drive over to Galway on Friday."

She noticed that he made no mention of what would happen in Dublin on Thursday night.

"Friday's dinner will be in a private room in the restaurant," he continued, "so no issues regarding lockdown. Next morning we'll drive back to Dublin and catch the ferry to Liverpool. You'll be home early Saturday evening."

"Well that sounds okay, but I honestly don't see the point in me accompanying you."

"You'll make a big difference with the bank," he insisted. "I need the manager to be putty in your hands."

Nicole sighed and closed her eyes. If this had happened last year she'd have been thrilled.

"One other thing," he said. "If you could arrange to have a Covid test less than seventy-two hours before we leave, that'd be good. The ferry people will probably ask to see evidence of a negative result."

"That's fine," she said, giving into the fact that this trip really seemed to be happening. It would probably take more effort to keep telling Ciaran to go away. Plus, a bit of extra cash never hurt, and she wouldn't mind seeing Will again. "I'll book one now."

"Great. If you can let me have a scan of your passport, I'll book the tickets for the ferry and a hotel in Dublin."

"Two rooms, remember," Nicole said firmly.

He laughed. "How could I forget? Bye, Nicole." The line went dead.

Nicole scanned her passport, emailed it, then booked her test appointment.

She was working on her employer's spreadsheets when she received another call on her mobile. When she saw it was Liz, her heartbeat sped up. "Hi, Liz. How are you?"

"I'm good thanks. Getting over hypothermia after someone exposed me in a blizzard."

She could tell Liz was smiling. "Who'd do something like that? I was more concerned about any soreness you might have from subsequent encounters with your husband."

"You're right to be concerned. He hasn't left me alone, but what I'm actually calling about is his accounts."

"Oh, that's a shame. What is it you need?"

"What I need is nothing to do with his accounts."

Nicole grinned, a warm shiver running through her. "Well let's get the accounts question out of the way first then."

"I have several lists of figures on loads of different sheets, and I'm always having to cross-check them before even starting my calculations because Ed sometimes makes mistakes filling them in. I have..." There was a pause as Liz clicked through the pages on her screen. "Eight different sheets. My eyes have gone square. There's got to be an easier way of keeping track of all these numbers."

"Send me what you've got, and I'll have a look, then get back to you if I have any questions for Ed later." Nicole gave her email address.

"That's super, thanks Nicole."

"Anytime."

Liz giggled. "I'll hold you to that."

Another warm shiver ran through her, and they hung up. Nicole struggled to concentrate on her work.

Liz's email arrived an hour or so later, with numerous attachments. Nicole skimmed through them, confident she could simplify everything pretty easily. She spent the rest of the afternoon finishing off her real work, then prepared dinner for Julian's return.

They had a pleasant evening, the first in a while where he didn't have extra work, and she mentioned that Liz had sent her the spreadsheets.

"I'm still not sure what Ed's business is," she said. "Most of his customers are universities or small pharmaceutical companies, and Liz

mentioned it's something to do with compliance."

"I assume it's successful."

"Definitely. His figures are much better than Ciaran's. But I'd like your opinion on something."

"Oh?"

She smiled. "Can I mention the word 'algorithm' without you going into raptures?"

"I'll try to contain myself and will take a cold shower if necessary."

"Hmm. Well, I was wondering if there was a way to make doing the accounts much easier. He seems to fill in everything in different spreadsheets, quite often duplicating the same information. I was thinking that if there were numerous sheets *within* the same file, then it could self-populate most of the duplicates from the master page."

He nodded. "Do you want me to have a look at them now?"

"It's not urgent, but if you could take a peek in the next couple of days, that'd be good."

"Sure."

"There's something else..."

"Oh?"

His hopeful grin made her laugh. "No, Liz didn't bring the files round in person. Ciaran phoned. He wants to do the Ireland trip next week. Apparently another lockdown is going to happen there soon, or so he claims."

"You don't believe him?"

She shrugged. "He dropped some cryptic clue, saying it was important I was there *now more than ever*, but I suspect it's all bullshit."

Julian narrowed his eyes. "I kind of envy his involvement."

"What, asking me to flash my legs at the bank manager?"

"Is that what he did?"

"Pretty much. He seems to think that if I wear a power suit and heels, the bank will give him whatever he wants."

He smiled. "You have to admire his tenacity. No, what I meant was, it must be nice to have an interest in a totally separate business venture."

This was a surprise. “You’ve never mentioned an interest in anything like that before.”

“No, but I’ve never had surplus money to invest before. I remember Ciaran telling me that he’d first gotten involved as a way of avoiding paying too much tax.” He shrugged. “But that’s by the by. So, when are you going to Ireland?”

“We leave next Thursday morning and will be returning Saturday evening.”

“Okay.” He gave her a smile and raised his eyebrows.

“What?”

“I was just wondering if Ciaran will manage to convince you that you’ve made a mistake by cutting him out of your life.”

“I’m sure he’ll try to convince me, but my stance hasn’t changed. What he did was unforgivable, and there’ll be no way back for him.”

“What about Will?”

She laughed. “It sounds like you’re hoping I get up to something during my trip.”

“I just thought it’d be nice for you to mix a little business with pleasure.”

“We’ll see what happens. Knowing that I have your approval means that if an opportunity arises, I may well have something to tell you about when I get home.”

“Good.”

* * * *

After Nicole had sent off her final piece of work for her employer on Friday afternoon, she put an out-of-office notice on her company email account saying she’d be unavailable for the next three months and gave two alternative contacts within her team.

Deciding the mini career break celebration demanded more than another cup of tea, she poured herself a glass of chilled white wine and returned to her desk to play around with copies of the files that Liz had sent, all gathered in a single workbook. She was pleased to see the banking expenses on the master sheet appearing in the correct section in the

corporation tax schedule, but she couldn't seem to set up conditions to move a figure between sheets if they were above or below a certain threshold. Convinced that Julian would be more adept at this, she decided to wait until he got home. She took her wine through to the lounge and sat on the couch, waiting for his return.

Her thoughts wandered to her upcoming trip to Ireland. She was determined to have a nice time and make the most of it, but it could've been a lovely trip if Ciaran hadn't ruined things. A couple of nights of filthy sex in hotel bedrooms would have been perfect, and she could even have given him a blowjob while he drove them cross country. She couldn't deny being disappointed with the way things had ended between them.

Julian arrived home before six for the first time that week. She poured him a glass of wine while he was upstairs changing out of his suit, then they sat together in the lounge and chatted about their respective days. It was obvious that he was enjoying his new role, but she could see how demanding it must be. He looked mentally exhausted.

She told him about uploading her final set of figures onto the company's database and then activating her out-of-office notification, which made him smile.

"I've also started to look at the stuff Liz sent for Ed's business," she said. "I may need your help, though."

"We can do it now if you like."

"You've only just got home. This is your down time."

"It'll only take a few minutes to look." He stood and held out his hand. "Why don't you bring your laptop up to my office so we can use my monitor?"

By the time Nicole got up to his office with her Lenovo, Julian had fired up his PC and his large 24-inch monitor. He made room on his desk for her laptop, then handed her a cable. "Here, plug this in then we can go through the dogle."

"Ooh, I like it when you talk dirty."

He sniggered, hit a few keys on his own laptop then a few more on Nicole's. "Right, do you want to open up what you've got?"

"There you go again with your nonstop smut." She leaned over his desk and wiggled her hips. "It's a surprise that you ever manage to get any

work done at all.”

Julian blinked, took a deep breath then looked into her eyes. “Let’s get this out of the way, then you can carry on talking like that all night.”

Nicole laughed, opened the spreadsheet she’d started to work on, and showed him what she was hoping to do. He nodded, listening as he tiled the various sheets across his screen, getting an overview of what was needed.

“Yes, this should be fairly straightforward.” He pulled his chair closer and spent a couple of minutes typing long and many-bracketed formulae.

Nicole glanced around his office, admiring the photo of the three pairs of legs she’d given him for Christmas. “Have you wanked off to your photo yet?”

“No,” he said, in a deadpan voice. “Though obviously, the temptation has been unbearable.”

Nicole laughed. “Well, don’t forget to let me know when you do. I want to kneel on the floor so you can come all over me.”

He gazed at her for a few seconds, then turned his attention firmly to her laptop. “If I show you what I’ve just done…”

She stepped next to his chair and bent down.

He quickly showed her the look-up techniques he’d used to fill the same information across the array of sheets and calculations. “In fact, there’s probably an easier way for Ed to upload the data, which would save a lot of work. I’ll have a think about that, too.”

“You’re a genius.” She kissed his cheek. “Dinner should be ready now, if you’re hungry.”

“Okay. Leave your laptop here, I’ll mess around with it tomorrow.”

After dinner, they cuddled on the couch and watched TV. Although there had been no more teasing or dirty talk, they got into bed naked. Nicole lay back and enjoyed him kissing her neck and breasts. When he started to trail kisses down her belly, she stopped him.

“Sorry,” she whispered. “I’m impatient. I want cock.”

“That’s fine by—.”

She gripped his shaft, which was already rigid, straddled him and guided it inside. Both let out a sigh.

Nicole stared down at him, rocking her hips, relishing the feel of him inside her. He brought his hands up to caress her breasts.

“So,” he said breathlessly. “Why are you so impatient?”

“I don’t know.” She rocked her hips.

“Is it something to do with—”

She put a finger to his lips and closed her eyes, concentrating on the sensations rippling through her body. For a moment it felt like a game, as if she were chasing a puppy through narrow passages. She saw herself laughing and bending and trying to grab something just out of reach, always evading her until finally—

“Oh...”

The orgasm surged through her, sending every muscle into a spasm. She arched her back and bounced up and down, his cock prodding her deep inside. With arms and legs trembling, she gasped through her clenched teeth as she drove herself down over and over, screaming with delighted pain when he pinched her nipples. Julian arched up, lifting her off the mattress, and his cock twitched and pulsed inside her. She clenched and relaxed while rocking her hips, milking him dry.

Reaching down between his legs, she squeezed his balls gently. He opened his eyes and looked at her, and she lay down on his chest.

After a couple of minutes, he kissed her eyes. “What brought that on?”

“I thought we both deserved to celebrate my last day at work for a while.”

“And that was the perfect way to do it.”

They lay in silence for a short time, then she kissed his cheek. “Do you want me to move?”

His arms were still around her waist, and he gripped her tighter. “No.”

“If I stay here I’ll dribble your stuff all over your groin.”

He kissed her lips gently. “That’s fine. Dribble away.”

* * * *

Nicole had showered and almost dressed before Julian woke up on Saturday morning. He smiled at her from the bed as she pulled on her sweatshirt.

“Morning,” he said.

“Hi.” She approached the bed, bent and kissed him. “Want a coffee here?”

“No, I’ll get up. Give me five minutes to shower.”

Nicole walked downstairs to the kitchen, where she put the kettle on for her tea and fired up the coffee maker. Julian arrived ten minutes later, wearing jeans and a polo shirt. They drank in relative silence, then Julian asked if she’d decided what clothes to take to Ireland.

“I’ll wear jeans and a jumper for the journey, but I’d better take a suit and blouse for the meeting with the bank manager to stop Ciaran whining.”

“What about for the dinner?”

“I haven’t thought about that yet.”

“Well think about it now.”

She saw the playful twinkle in his eyes over the rim of his coffee mug. “Any suggestions?”

“Wear something outlandishly sexy. Your tightest dress and highest heels. Maybe even those strappy sandals we bought at the Trafford Centre, with fishnet stockings and your nails painted red.”

“And why would I dress like that?”

“To make Ciaran regret what he did. I want him to yearn for you.”

“But what would the other men think if I dressed like that?”

“I’m happy for them to yearn for you as well.”

She laughed. “Three of them are retired. I’d be more likely to give them heart attacks than hard-ons.”

Once he’d finished his coffee, Julian stood up. “I need fuel for my car. How about I call for a couple of bacon rolls from the bakers for breakfast?”

Nicole nodded enthusiastically. “Great. I’ll have a play with Ed’s spreadsheets and see if I can do what you showed me last night. Can I use your big monitor and dongle?”

“Of course.” He grinned and leaned close. “My dongle is yours whenever you want it.”

After he’d left, Nicole made herself another cup of tea and headed up to his office. She followed Julian’s instructions and by the time he returned Nicole had finished nearly all the relative reference calculations. She stood up to let him sit and go over what she’d done.

“I’ve had a few thoughts about this,” he said, taking a bite out of his bacon roll. “It depends how Ed gets the figures, but if he receives them in some sort of spreadsheet—or even a csv file—”

“A what?”

“Comma-separated-variable file, sorry, there’s a chance we could set up a macro for automatic import. He’d literally just have to click a button to select which datafile he wants to upload. If so, then all he—or Liz—would need to do is fill a handful of figures, just once.”

He leaned over the keyboard and saved the spreadsheet to her hard-drive, then replaced all the figures on the first sheet with a zero and saved that one, too. “This could be the master sheet, and they could add new figures monthly, quarterly or annually, however he wants it.”

“Brilliant.” She smiled at him. “I could get Liz and Ed to come over and you could talk them through it?”

Julian nodded. “Certainly, although it might be best if they climbed over his garden fence so none of the neighbours see we’re breaking lockdown rules by having house visitors.”

Nicole finished her bacon roll then sent a text to Liz. Ten minutes later she got a reply:

Hi Nicole

Sorry, but I’m visiting my parents and getting a month’s worth of groceries for them. I’ll be out most of the day, but Ed’s at home. I’m sure he’d be thrilled to see you again :-)

Liz xx

She’d added Ed’s mobile number at the end of her message. Nicole decided to phone rather than text.

He picked up on the third ring. “Hello?”

“Hi Ed, it’s Nicole from next door.”

“Nicole, hi. How are you?” His voice was warm and friendly.

“Good, thanks. Listen, you know how Liz sent me the accounting fig—?”

“She’s not in, I’m afraid. She’s gone—”

“I know. I texted her earlier, and she gave me your number. I’ve had a look, or more accurately, *Julian’s* had a look, and we’ve found a way of streamlining your data entry quite a lot.”

“Really? That’d be great if you—”

“Do you want to come over now so we can chat about them? Julian reckons that, depending on how you get your figures, he may be able to make it even easier.”

“Great. Should I come over now?”

“Yep. Julian suggested you climb over the fence in case our nosier neighbours report the breach of lockdown rules.”

He gave an apprehensive laugh. “I was more concerned about actually meeting your husband after, you know...”

“There’s no need to be concerned about that, I promise.”

“Okay. I’ll be there in ten minutes, but I’m a bit too old for climbing six-foot fences. I’ll walk up the path to your back garden, if that’s okay.”

“That’s fine. I’ll go and unlock the gate. See you soon.”

He arrived just a couple of minutes later, smiling as she let him into the kitchen. Nicole kissed his cheek.

“Good to see you again,” she said.

“You too.” He bent down and undid his laces. “I’ll take these off—the snow’s turned to slush on the path.”

Nicole looked down at his broad back and shoulders, fond memories of their encounter of last week filling her mind.

“It’ll be easier to show you on the big screen in Julian’s office. Come on up.” She led them out of the kitchen and up the stairs.

“Wow,” he said looking around. “This is so different from ours.”

She nodded. “I like that every house is individual. So much nicer than when all the houses are identical.” She reached the office door. “He’s

in here.”

Julian stood up and greeted Ed with a handshake. “Ed, nice to meet you.”

“You too.”

Both men smiled, and Nicole wondered what it was like for Julian meeting a guy who’d already fucked his wife.

“Thanks for taking the time to look at my accounting nightmare,” Ed said. “I’m afraid I relegate that to the bottom of the pile every time I have things to do.”

Julian laughed. “Yes, I can imagine.” He dropped down in his chair and turned the monitor slightly so the other two could see it easily.

By the time he’d shown Ed what they’d achieved so far, the man’s eyes were lit up with awed gratitude.

“Wow, that’s... That’s fantastic.” He smiled at Nicole, then turned to Julian. “I didn’t know you could do half this stuff in Excel.”

“It’s a great program for things like this,” Julian said. “There are loads of bespoke accounting software packages that are probably more powerful, but for what you’re doing, this is perfect. I was wondering, though, how do you get the figures in the first place?”

“I’m not sure what—”

“Do you receive a spreadsheet of some kind from your clients? If so, we might be able to link the data so you’d hardly need to type anything in yourself.”

Ed shook his head regretfully. “No, I have to invoice each customer, and then they pay their bill. There are no spreadsheets as such.”

“Ah, shame.”

Ed snorted. “What you’ve already set up is a big improvement on the way I’ve done the last two years’ accounts, I can assure you.” He turned to Nicole. “Is this something Liz could do?”

She nodded. “Yeah, of course. I’ll talk her through it. The program’s already set up. She can just put new figures in as the invoices are paid and the expenses are logged.”

“Fabulous...” His eyes seemed to catch the photo on the wall for the first time. “Wow. I love the photograph.”

Julian smiled. "Yes, me too." He glanced at Nicole. "Nicole took it. They're her legs."

Ed turned to her, shocked. She briefly considered admitting the photo had been taken a couple of hours after she and Ed had been introduced for the first time.

"However," Julian continued, "neither pair of men's legs are mine."

Nicole stared at her husband, totally taken aback by this calm show of open daring. Since neither man seemed fazed by Julian's announcement, she turned to Ed and shrugged. "What can I say? I'm a slut."

Ed laughed and shook his head. "It's really a great photograph."

Julian turned back to the keyboard and tapped away, and for a moment Nicole was afraid he was going to bring up the picture she'd taken of cum dripping from her sex. Or worse still, the one Ciaran had taken with cum dripping from both her holes. But then he said, "I've saved this to Nicole's hard-drive. She can send it to Liz when she shows her how to do it."

"That's great," Ed said, looking very grateful. "I really appreciate it. I have to confess that things like this are not my forte."

As Julian asked about Ed's business, Nicole slipped out onto the landing. The comments about the photograph had inspired her, and she knew what she wanted to happen next. Once in their bedroom she stripped and put on a black suspender belt and a pair of black stockings. Then she stepped into the peep-toe shoes she'd worn in the photograph, applied lip gloss, brushed her hair and sprayed a little perfume on her neck.

After putting a pack of condoms and the tube of lube in the top drawer of her bedside cabinet, she walked along to her husband's office. The men were still chatting about Ed's work, but the conversation stopped mid-flow when she stepped through the door. Both men's eyes wandered down her body. Her nipples tightened under their gaze.

She looked at Ed. "I thought I could pay you back for last week. How about I perform oral sex on you while my spouse watches?"

Ed opened his mouth to speak, but then turned to Julian as if waiting permission. Before either of them could reply, Nicole turned and left the room. Both men followed, and she swung her hips as she strutted along the galleried landing to their bedroom.

She walked over to the far side of the room and turned to face them. “Come here,” she said to Ed.

He did so while Julian stopped at the wall opposite the bed.

“Take your clothes off,” she ordered.

Ed glanced at Julian, then began to unbutton his shirt. Nicole went to work on the buckle of his belt, then slowly dropped to her knees and pulled his jeans down his legs and off as he raised each leg in turn. She also removed each sock, so he stood before her in only a pair of black jockey shorts. She ran her hand over the bulge while watching his face, then slipped her fingers into the waistband and eased them down. His cock sprung out and Nicole pushed the shorts all the way down so Ed could step out of them.

She ran her hands up the outside of his legs, then brought her right hand in and wrapped her fingers around the base of his shaft. Looking up into his eyes, she stuck her tongue out and leaned forward to lick the salty clear pearl from his slit. She ran her tongue around the glans several times, as much for Julian’s benefit as Ed’s, then pushed her head forward and took his full length into her mouth and throat.

Ed let out a gasp of pleasure, and she was pleased to see the shock on his face when she pushed the tip of her tongue against his scrotum.

She swirled her tongue against the underside of his shaft and then pushed forward to swallow the entire length again, her nose buried in his thick pubic hair. She sucked and teased but didn’t get into any sort of rhythm. Although the idea of making him come like this was sexy, it wasn’t what she wanted today.

She pulled back, reached over to her bedside cabinet and took out a condom. After ripping the foil with her teeth, she placed the rubber on the tip of his cock and slowly rolled it down the length. She stood up, turned her back on him and placed one heeled foot on the bed.

Nicole twisted to look at him over her shoulder. “Fuck me.”

Ed glanced at Julian again, then stepped close and ran his hand over her backside. The height of her heeled shoe on the floor made her tall enough for him to reach without difficulty. He bent his knees and put his cock between her slick folds. As he straightened his legs, he entered her.

Nicole groaned and let her head fall back onto his shoulder. "Play with my tits," she whispered, eager to put on a show for her watching husband. Ed raised his hands and cupped her breasts as he fucked her slowly. She let out little moans when he began to tease her nipples, pinching and twisting them.

She opened her eyes and stared at her husband. His eyes glowed with lust, and she could see his chest rise and fall with his shallow breaths.

Nicole reached round and pushed on Ed's stomach, easing him back and out of her. She took her foot off the bed, turned to face him again and kissed him gently on the lips. "Time for a change of position." Nicole crawled onto the bed on all fours, her hands in the middle of the mattress and her knees on the side nearest to Ed, her feet hanging over the edge.

She looked over at her husband. "Julian, get naked and get involved."

As Julian started to remove his polo shirt and jeans, Nicole turned to look back at Ed. "Don't wait for him."

Ed slid his cock back inside her. Nicole pushed back to meet his thrusts.

Now naked, Julian stood at the foot of the bed looking a little uncomfortable. This was the first time he'd been involved in front of anyone else, but she remembered him saying he wanted her to be spit-roasted by Ciaran and Will.

Nicole looked up at him. "Kneel on the bed and fuck my face."

Julian quickly clambered on and held his dick out, and Nicole parted her lips. She closed her eyes and focused on the sensations. Ed reached around her and brought his fingers into play. As soon as they brushed over her clit, she felt the first tingles of an orgasm. The next contact his fingers made sent her over the edge. She grunted, gagged and mumbled around Julian's cock, and finally had to release it from her mouth as she cried out. Her head dropped, she gasped in deep breaths, and Ed slowed his thrusts. She hoped he hadn't come when she had, because there was something else she wanted.

She crawled forwards and Ed's cock slipped out. Holding her husband's gaze, she dragged away the hair that clung to her face. Then she turned to let her eyes wander down Ed's body. He was still hard, the condom's teat still empty.

Nicole moved to the foot of the bed and patted the middle of the mattress. “Ed, lie here.” As he did so, she straddled his legs. Reaching over to the top drawer again, she took out the KY and another condom. Though she had no problem with Julian going in bare, she wasn’t sure how Ed would feel about his neighbour’s cum dribbling onto his balls at the end of the session.

She opened the condom for Julian and told him to put it on, and then handed him the lube. Ed’s stunned expression suggested he’d finally cottoned on to what was about to happen.

While Julian prepared himself, Nicole crawled up Ed’s legs until she was directly over his groin. She looked down into his eyes. “Are you okay with this?”

He nodded eagerly, so she gripped his cock and impaled herself on it. She rocked her hips a couple of times, then leaned forward onto his chest as her husband climbed on top. The coldness of his lubed cock pushed against her backside, opening her up.

She stared into Ed’s eyes and gritted her teeth as her husband’s cock pushed in a little harder. Ed stared in awe as she tried to relax, then suddenly Julian was all the way inside, nestling snugly against the cock already filling her other hole.

Nicole closed her eyes and started to rock herself between their bodies. Ed pushed up as Julian pushed down.

Unlike the only other time she’d experienced this, Nicole was completely relaxed. This was her own doing, and this was exactly where she wanted to be.

“Fuck me,” she whispered. “Fuck me and use me.”

Both men increased their movements—pushing, prodding, thrusting, grinding. Hands stroked her arms, hips and thighs. Julian bit the side of her neck. Another orgasm built inside her, sending tremors through every muscle. Her eyes squeezed shut and she raked her fingernails down both torsos sandwiching her own. As her legs moved on the bed, a shoe came off. She rubbed her stockinged foot against Ed’s hairy leg and ground her clit against his pubic bone.

Julian cried out, pushed in deep and held still as he came first. Nicole wished he’d gone in bare so she could feel the heat of his cum. Ed pushed up and held still. Nicole came with him. All three let out cries and

groans as their bodies became a single mass of pumping hips and shaking limbs.

Another spasm shook Nicole to her core, making her scream. It was either the most intense aftershock she'd ever experienced, or she'd come twice in quick succession.

Her pulse raged in her ears. As they all finally slowed down their thrashing, she let out a long, satisfied moan.

Julian raised himself off her and flopped down on his side of the bed, and Nicole stayed where she was with Ed's cock still inside her. She knew Ciaran could stay hard and come a second time, but Ed's cock was already soft and when she clenched her muscles it forced him out.

She rolled off and lay between them, a contented feeling seeping through her still-tingling body. "Hmm. Thank you, gentlemen."

Ed laughed. "I'd be understating things if I said it was a pleasure." He sat up and looked at Julian, then at Nicole. "That's a first for me, and it was something else."

Nicole smiled, secretly elated that this had been Ed's first threesome. Julian removed his condom and then got off the bed and started to dress. Ed followed his lead, and Nicole looked down at her legs. Both shoes had come off and one of her stockings was laddered. She unclipped both stockings and rolled them off, then put on her robe before unclipping the suspender belt.

There was no awkwardness as the three of them headed back downstairs and into the kitchen.

Ed put on his shoes, then looked from Nicole to Julian. "Well, thanks for everything. The accounting thing is a great help, but that fades into insignificance after what just happened."

Nicole leaned in and kissed his cheek. "Tell Liz to phone me when she wants to go through the spreadsheets, but it might have to wait—I'm off for that Ireland trip for a couple of days next week. Providing I test negative, of course."

Ed nodded. "Okay." He opened the door and smiled one last time before heading out into the cold.

Nicole turned to her husband. "Was I too forward?"

He shook his head.

“I wanted you to watch, and I wanted you to share in a threesome.”

“I’m glad I did. Watching you with your foot on the bed as he took you was very erotic. I wish I’d been able to film it.”

“That would have been nice.” She stepped close and looked up into his eyes. “You know what would have been even nicer?”

“What?”

“No condoms. If I’d taken you both bare, and felt you both coming inside me.”

“Well, if Ed’s going to become a regular, maybe you should broach the subject. Ask how careful he is with other women, and see if he’d be prepared to dispense with condoms for you.”

Nicole stared into his eyes. “You’d like that?”

“You know I would. I understand that for strangers condoms are a necessity, but maybe not for people you trust.” He shrugged. “See what Liz thinks.”

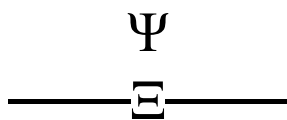
“Okay.” A thought occurred. “It’d also be nice if he didn’t wear a condom when I go to bed with Liz *and* Ed.”

“Is that what you’d like to do?”

“Yes.” She kissed his cheek. “Fancy another coffee before you take me back to bed?”

“No.” After taking her hand, he led her upstairs.





Chapter Seven

On Wednesday evening, Nicole laid her suit for the bank appointment and little black dress for the dinner on top of her case. She added her red-soled stilettos, strappy black sandals, and found room for her sexy underwear around the edges.

Packing finished, she found Julian working in his office. “Ciaran’s picking me up at six,” she said. “I think I might have an early night.”

“Okay. I’ve finished here, too.” As he stood, he nodded towards the photograph of the three sets of legs. “Are you excited about seeing Ciaran and Will again?”

“No. I’m worried it’ll be awkward.”

“Why? What you did was nothing to be ashamed of.”

She laughed. “I sucked and fucked them both, and left their hotel room with cum in every orifice. I’m pretty sure most people would view that as something to be deeply ashamed of.”

“Ah, but we’re not most people.”

“Hmm.” Nicole walked along the landing and into their bedroom. After brushing her teeth, she stripped down to her panties, pulled on a white vest top and slid into bed. Julian joined her after he’d finished in the bathroom.

“So... Will you do something dirty and then describe it for me when you return?”

“I don’t know.”

He pushed his leg against hers. “What if I want you to?”

“Julian, I don’t need a pimp.”

“That’s not what I...” His face blanched. “I’m sorry, I wasn’t trying to put pressure on you to—”

“I know. I’m sorry, I didn’t mean—”

“No, you’re right. I shouldn’t have said anything. I still feel guilty for talking you into having the threesome in the first place.”

“You didn’t. I’m just tense about how Ciaran’s going to behave.” She ran her hand down Julian’s arm. “Let’s not keep going over what’s already happened. If I have regrets, they’re down to the choices I made. Okay?”

“Thank you. And I’m sorry. It’s not my place to tell you what to do.”

She could see his sincerity and kissed his cheek. “Let’s just see what happens, eh?”

They turned the lights off and snuggled in silence for a few seconds, then Nicole whispered, “I’ve packed six condoms, but can always buy more.”

He chuckled and kissed the top of her head.

* * * *

Nicole woke before her 5.30 alarm and went to shower in the main bathroom to avoid disturbing her sleeping husband. She dressed in jeans, jumper and trainers, didn’t bother with makeup, and pulled her hair back into a ponytail. As she drank a cup of tea in the kitchen, a text from Ciaran arrived saying he was five minutes away.

She went up to the bedroom and woke Julian by kissing his cheek. “I’ll be leaving in a few minutes.”

He blinked and sat up. “Okay. Have a good trip.”

“Thanks. I’ll text you later from Dublin.”

She’d put her bags and leather jacket in the hall already, so as soon as she saw the headlights on the drive, she opened the front door and stepped outside. Ciaran gave her a reassuringly friendly smile as he opened the boot for her to put in her holdall and suit cover.

He nodded toward the house. “Nice place.”

“Thanks.” She climbed into his Audi TT and put her jacket on the backseat.

Ciaran drove slowly along the icy roads of the estate, but the main roads had been gritted and he was able to go faster. “Have you remembered your passport and proof of negative Covid test?”

“Yes, Dad.”

He laughed and shook his head. "Sorry. So, how are things with you?"

"They're good, thanks."

"Is Julian enjoying his new role?"

"Yes, he seems to be."

They made small talk for a while, then Ciaran put on the radio and they drove in a comfortable silence. Still tired, Nicole enjoyed the peace. The sun rose behind them as they drove west towards Liverpool.

At the docks, they went through passport control, then nipped to the hospitality shack for coffee. Nicole bought a pastry as well, but, as ever, Ciaran resisted.

Back at the car, Ciaran followed the instructions of the men controlling traffic and drove slowly along the ramp onto the ferry. He was directed to a parking space near one side.

"I hope you've brought something to read," he said. "We're not allowed out of the car during the trip."

"Really?" She hadn't realised this. "How long's the journey?"

"We're on the Seacat, which is fastest. It'll be under four hours."

"Four hours?"

"The normal ferry takes seven and a half."

"Jeez. I just assumed we'd be allowed to wander around the ferry, sit in the restaurant and go on deck. I've dressed for standing in a sea breeze."

"And I thought you'd dressed like that to piss me off."

She saw from the twinkle in his eyes that he was teasing, and she couldn't help thinking what fun they could have had if things had been different. "You shouldn't have let me choose a large latte."

"There'll be toilets we can use, I'm sure."

"Hmm." She looked around at the other people in their cars. "Will I even be able to get a signal on my phone?"

"Who cares?" He reached into the pocket of his door, took out a paperback and grinned.

She ate her pastry in silence as she watched him, wondering if he was actually concentrating on his murder mystery. "If I'd known I'd be

sitting in a car for four hours, I'd have worn a skirt and brought my wand."

Ciaran looked up from his book. "Well if you want to slip your jeans off, I could get you the wheel brace from the boot."

Nicole laughed out loud. "Cheeky bastard."

Just then, the boat started moving. Nicole finished her pastry but only drank about a third of her coffee. Then she closed her eyes and dozed.

After ten minutes of silence, she remembered what he'd said about the timing of the meeting with the bank. "Why is seeing the bank manager so important now?"

He put his book down and looked at her. "I'm thinking of selling my stake."

"What? Why?"

"I think it might be a good time to invest in other things. Stocks have crashed, and if I get a decent price for my half of the business, I could make a killing when the share prices pick up again."

"But would you get a decent price now, during the pandemic?"

"I think so. The business is doing well, and we've had quite a bit of interest from other customers wanting to lease."

"What does Will think?"

"I haven't told him yet." He shrugged. "I need to make sure the financial back-up is there first, because that'll make the business look stronger."

"Is that to safeguard everyone's jobs, or to get you a better price?"

"That's a bit cynical, don't you think?"

She thought about the accounts she'd done and remembered the salaries the men were being paid. Men who probably needed those salaries—especially now, when so many other people would be looking for jobs.

"Have you actually got a buyer?"

"No, but I've drawn up a list of companies that'll be worth approaching. They'd be happy to get their hands on the contracts we've got."

"But would they keep the staff, or just let their own people do the work to fulfil the contracts?"

"What's with the inquisition? It's just a business decision."

“It just seems a little mercenary, that’s all.” She was struck by the horrible thought that he might blurt his plans out during the celebratory dinner. “When are you planning on telling them they might be out of a job?”

“They won’t be out of a job. Some of the guys are retired, anyway. They were just helping Will out when he first got started. They’ll probably be glad of the rest.” He sighed. “But obviously I’ll have to tell Will as soon as possible.”

Nicole shook her head and remembered Julian’s comment about envying Ciaran’s involvement in the business. She wondered how much Ciaran’s share was worth.

They fell silent again. Nicole’s phone did indeed get a signal, and she spent the rest of the journey reading the news and surfing the web. By the time they reached Ireland, the sky was clear. At the hotel, Ciaran told Nicole to take one of the seats in the foyer while he checked in.

He returned after five minutes. “There’s some kind of plumbing problem, so only one of the rooms is ready at the moment.”

Nicole stared at him. “A plumbing problem?”

“A leak or something in the room above. They’re working on it now, so hopefully it’ll be sorted by the time we’re back from the bank. We can both get ready in the one room, though.”

She stood up. “What time’s the appointment?”

“Three.”

It was a little after one. “Let’s drop our stuff off in the room, have something to eat, then we can get ready.”

He nodded. “Good plan.”

The room was huge, with a couple of easy chairs either side of a large window, and a queen-sized bed. Nicole put her holdall on the floor and suit cover on the bed, then waited by the door while Ciaran wandered over to the window.

“What do you think of the room?” he asked, a broad smile on his face.

“It’s lovely. I hope yours is as nice.”

In the nearly deserted restaurant, they were shown to a table under the window. Nicole chose the soup with a ham sandwich, and Ciaran

ordered himself a chicken salad.

They discussed what they were going to ask for at the bank. Nicole felt more strongly than ever that her presence was totally unnecessary. This, coupled with the apparent ‘problem’ with the second room in the hotel, confirmed her suspicions about Ciaran’s motives for inviting her on this trip. And he’d been behaving so nicely, too.

“Do you need to shower before we go to the bank?” she asked.

His eyes sparkled with mischief. “I wasn’t going to, but I will if you want company.”

She held out her hand. “Give me the cardkey.”

He passed it over.

“I’ll get ready first, because you’ll probably spend more time in front of the mirror than I will.” She stood up. “I’ll text you when I’m dressed.”

Once back in the room, Nicole stripped down to her underwear, applied her makeup, slipped on her stockings, cream silk blouse and grey suit, then pinned her hair up. After stepping into her black stilettos, she texted Ciaran.

When she opened the door to him, his eyes wandered over her body. He sighed.

“I’ll wait in the foyer,” she said, secretly pleased to see the longing in his eyes.

Five minutes later, Ciaran joined her, looking wonderful in a charcoal suit and crisp white shirt with a maroon silk tie. Despite her best intentions, seeing him dressed like this rekindled some very sexy memories.

“Ready to go?” he asked.

Nicole dropped her phone into her bag and stood up. “How far away is the bank?”

“It’s only a couple of hundred yards. That’s why I chose this hotel.”

As they walked, she noticed Ciaran kept flashing looks at her legs and stilettos.

“I really love those shoes,” he said.

“Thank you.”

“And I can’t stop thinking about the last time you wore them.”

“You should concentrate on what you’re going to say to the bank manager.”

“I doubt he’ll be even listening to what I say. Try and sit where he can see your legs.” He grinned. “They’re stockings, right?”

She ignored him, pulling her facemask from her handbag as they approached the bank. A young man in an ill-fitting suit asked them to wait in the far corner until the manager came to collect them. A minute or so later, the door opened and a lady in her mid-fifties wearing a blue trouser suit walked over and introduced herself as the manager. Nicole couldn’t help smiling at Ciaran’s shocked expression as the lady escorted them to a small meeting room.

“You can take your masks off for now,” she said with a lovely Irish brogue. “Please replace them before you walk back through the bank, though.” She sat by a laptop at the far end of the table. “Now, what can I do for you both?”

Ciaran cleared his throat and turned on his most winning smile. He’d obviously realised he needed to change his planned strategy of having Nicole repeatedly cross her legs. “We’d like to discuss the possibility of extending our overdraft facility.”

The bank manager tapped a few keys, then frowned. “You already have quite a big overdraft facility...” While dragging her finger over the touchpad, she checked the screen then looked over at Ciaran. “You’ve never used more than thirty percent of the overdraft available to you, so I’m not entirely sure why you feel it’s necessary to increase it. Are you expecting an immediate fall in revenue as a result of the current situation?”

“Yes, possibly. Nicole is our financial expert, and she predicted a potential downturn...” He glanced at the astonished Nicole. “I’ll let her explain.”

You twat.

“I think Ciaran’s overstating my importance—I’m certainly not a financial expert. All I’ve done is prepare this year’s books for submission to the tax office.”

Ciaran turned to look at her. “But you’d highlighted the potential shortfall—”

“Ciaran announced his plan to change the emphasis of the business from sales-only to a leasing and servicing strategy, so I simply made him aware of the potential short-term fall in revenue due to the income from leasing arrangements being spread throughout the year.”

The bank manager nodded and studied the screen again. “Well, that’s certainly true in a lot of cases, but your accounts haven’t shown any downturn. When is the new strategy going to start?”

“It’s already started,” he said. “And as a result, we’ve been approached by a couple of other potential clients, so I just wanted to know that we’d have the capacity to buy more stock before we committed to any new business.”

“I see. Well, there’s certainly plenty of capacity there, so I’d suggest leaving the overdraft limit as it is for now. If you find you *do* need to increase the amount to cope with the initial purchase of stock for any new contracts you may secure, then we can certainly do that. You can apply online or, if you’d prefer, phone us.” The woman gave Nicole a knowing look. “I hope you haven’t come all this way just to ask about the overdraft?”

“No,” Ciaran said with a laugh. “We have a meeting with the staff tomorrow in Galway, so this was en route.” He smiled at Nicole. “I thought it’d be nice for Nicole to see a bit of Dublin, too.”

“Well, if there’s nothing else?” The bank manager stood and walked to the door. Ciaran went to shake her hand, then thought better of it and simply nodded instead. He walked out past the bank’s main service counter to the entrance.

The manager looked at Nicole. “I’m sorry if it’s been a wasted trip.”

“I knew it was unnecessary, but he insisted.”

“And did he also insist you dressed accordingly?”

Nicole’s jaw dropped.

The manager offered a reassuring smile. “There will be better times to see the city than now, but I hope you enjoy your stay.”

“Thank you.” Just before Nicole fitted her facemask, she whispered, “I’m not completely naïve. Ciaran isn’t getting anything more than bookkeeping advice.” After leaving the meeting room, she marched past Ciaran and out of the bank.

—” He caught up with her on the pavement. “So, my plan to have you

“It was stupid, and I can’t believe I listened to you.”

“We got the extra—”

“As she pointed out, you could have got it using online banking. That was so embarrassing.”

“I thought you showed why you were—”

“She thinks you’ve brought me here to fuck me,” she said, a little louder than she’d intended.

Ciaran checked over his shoulder to see if anybody had overheard her outburst. “Why would she think that?”

She closed her eyes and took a deep breath, trying to gather her patience.

“Come on,” he said, putting his hand on her elbow. “Let’s see if we can find a bar that’s open and we can talk about things.”

She glared at him but the day was actually quite cold, so the thought of finding somewhere warm had its own appeal. They entered the first pub they saw. Once inside, a pretty waitress who seemed unable to stop smiling at Ciaran, led them to a table. Nicole ordered white wine, Ciaran a pint of Guinness.

When their drinks arrived, Ciaran raised his glass. “I always drink this when I’m here. Cheers.”

Nicole took a sip of her pinot.

He put down his glass. “Nicole, I honestly thought that your presence in the bank would be needed. I had no idea they’d be so accommodating, with the pandemic and all the uncertainty it’s raised. But she was right about something...” He gave her a smile. “I’d really like us to go back to what we used to have.”

“I’ve already explained that’s not—”

“Come on. I know you enjoyed all those times in my office.”

“Yes I did, but then you—”

“And you enjoyed the night with Will. Don’t try and tell me you didn’t, because I was there.”

“You weren’t there when I got home and cried about being passed around like a piece of meat.”

“That’s not... You weren’t *passed around*. You were shared. You had two men worshipping your body. You’d even discussed it with Julian beforehand. The way you’re acting, it’s like I’d smuggled in another man and we’d taken turns abusing you. Have you forgotten that you walked up to the room knowing exactly what was going to happen? Or that for most of the time, you were directing the action?”

Nicole remained silent, unable to contradict anything he’d said.

Ciaran rubbed his chin. “I know I upset you, and I’m really sorry. I honestly never meant to hurt you.”

Nicole stared into his cobalt-blue eyes. Was she being unreasonable? Was this a case of her cutting off her nose to spite her face? Memories of their other times together flashed before her eyes. They’d had great sex. Looking at him now, she could imagine slipping off his jacket and undoing his perfectly knotted tie. Even Julian seemed to be hoping she’d relent and take Ciaran back as her bull. It would be so easy to go back to the fabulous hotel room, and—

Room, singular. She raised an eyebrow at him. “Tell me again about the leak.”

He frowned. “About the what?”

“The problem with the second hotel room.”

“Oh, yeah. Er...” He shook his head. “Something happened in the room above.”

“What’s the hotel phone number?”

He shrugged. “I booked online.”

She took out her phone. “I’ll look it up.”

“Why...?” He watched her scrolling through the hotel website. “Okay, stop. Can we just talk about—?”

“Talk about what? she asked. “The fact that you never learn?”

He took a breath. “Nicole—”

“So, what was your plan? Get me to dress like I did for our dates, have a few drinks and reminisce about the hot sex we had in your office, then go back to the hotel and find the other room was still unavailable?”

He looked into her eyes. “Would that really be so awful?”

“Ciaran, I know you’re used to getting your own way, but this is you manipulating me again.”

He stared into her eyes. “I think about you all the time. I spend every day thinking about what we did together. About the night we shared the bed, and all those times in my off—”

“Yes, we had fun, but that’s all it was. I’m happily married, and you were someone I had sex with. I’ve moved on, and you should too.”

He frowned. “What d’you mean, you’ve moved on?”

“Exactly that.”

“You’ve already had sex with somebody else?”

She laughed. “Haven’t you?”

“No.” He looked hurt and angry. “I can’t believe you’ve—”

“Ciaran, what I do is none of your business.”

“Well since you’re such a slut, I can’t see why one more night here would make much difference.”

Nicole’s jaw dropped and tears blurred her vision. She picked up her bag and stood up.

He sighed. “I’m sorry. Please, just sit down and we can—”

“I need some fresh air.” Nicole walked out, avoiding eye contact with any of the other customers or the pretty waitress.

She walked through the streets and alongside the river. Maybe Ciaran was right, but it had still hurt. It was getting dark, and she felt a little vulnerable. She’d find a bar and calm down, then find a restaurant and have something to eat. By then, Julian would be home, and she’d phone him. She’d explain she intended getting a taxi back to the hotel and see if there was another room available.

The temperature had dropped, and her heels were too high for walking long distances on uneven pavements. When she saw the lights of a bar up a side street, she headed for it. Inside it was warm and cosy, and five minutes later she was at a table near the back with a glass of white wine.

Taking out her phone, she saw she had four missed calls from Ciaran; she’d set it to silent before they’d gone into the bank. He’d also sent a couple of texts, which she quickly read. He was sorry. Please phone him.

Had she overreacted by storming out? She'd just confessed to having sex with somebody else, so could she really take offence at his slut jibe?

Her phone lit up on the table as another text arrived. Expecting it to be another from Ciaran, she was pleased to see it was from Julian:

Hope the trip is going well. xx

Nicole tapped out a reply to ask if he was free to talk, and he called her. She picked up immediately. "Hiya."

"Hi. How's Dublin?"

"It's lovely, and we should come here together sometime in the future."

"I'd like that." After a brief silence he asked, "Is everything alright?"

She loved that he could read her mood so easily. She told him about the appointment at the bank, and how the manager had made her feel. Then she revealed Ciaran had only booked one hotel room.

"Ah."

"Ah? A guy brings your wife to another country under false pretences and expects her to sleep with him, and that's your response?"

"Sorry. Obviously I understand your anger."

"Thank you."

"Even if his ulterior motive was to try and convince you to share his bed, he should have booked two rooms anyway."

"I'd already told him we'd need two rooms, and he assured me there would be."

"In that case, he was being devious."

"Exactly. I think he was hoping to keep me dressed up in the way he likes me, ply me with drink and then take me back and seduce me."

There was a brief silence. "Why, what are you wearing?"

"Pardon?"

"You said you're dressed how he likes you, so what are you wearing?"

“My grey suit with silk blouse and heels.”

“And stockings?”

She frowned. “Hold-ups.” She wondered if Julian thought that by dressing like this, she was encouraging Ciaran to make a pass. “Why?”

“Nothing, I just like to visualise you. So where are you now, back at the hotel?”

“No, I’m in a bar somewhere. I left Ciaran in a pub after...” She closed her eyes and sighed.

“After what?”

“He said he wanted us to go back to what we had before. I told him I’ve moved on and suggested he should too.”

“You told him about Ed and Liz?”

“No, but I admitted I’d slept with someone else.”

“How did he take that?”

“He wasn’t happy. He said that since I’m such a slut, it shouldn’t be that big a deal for me to sleep with him again tonight.”

“That’s... I can see how that would hurt.”

“Yeah it did, though to be honest, I’m now wondering if it should have done.”

“What do you mean?”

“He’s right, I’m a slut. It’s who I am now we’re doing this loaning thing.” She checked that nobody was sitting close enough to overhear. “Should I really be offended if someone points out the obvious?”

“What you do is always on your terms. You choose who and you choose when. It’s not for anyone else to decide, and you should remind him of that.”

Nicole smiled. Talking it through with Julian always helped. She doubted there were many husbands who were this understanding.

“So,” he said, “what are you planning on doing?”

“Keep ignoring his calls for now. This bar seems to be serving food, so I’ll eat here and then get a taxi back to the hotel.”

“You’re not planning to find somewhere else to stay?”

She sighed, regretting having left all her stuff in Ciaran’s room. “All my clothes are in the first one, and I’m sure there’ll be other rooms

available. The restaurant was practically empty at lunchtime.”

“Okay, well do whatever you think best.”

“I will. I think this little accounting job has reached its natural end, anyway. Ciaran said that he’s looking to sell his share in the business.”

“Really? Why?”

“He seems to think he can make more money by investing in the stock market after the crash.”

“Hmm, he might be right. Haven’t some companies suspended dealing in their shares for the time being?”

“I have no idea, but I was wondering if you’d be interested in buying his share.”

“I could be. Why? Any idea how much that would cost?”

“I really have no idea. I only mentioned it because I remembered you saying that you envied him having a business venture of his own.”

“Well, we can certainly think about it if that’s what you’d like to do.”

They said their goodbyes and hung up. Nicole asked the waitress for another glass of wine and a menu, then ordered herself lasagne and chips—her favourite comfort food.

After she’d finished eating, a couple of young guys came into the bar and took a nearby table, chatting away in strong Irish accents. They gave her friendly smiles, then studied the menu. Nicole checked her phone to see if Ciaran had sent another text; he hadn’t.

By the time the waitress delivered the food for the two men, Nicole was ready for another drink and ordered a third glass of wine. She decided this would be her last, because getting drunk in a strange city while dressed to the nines wasn’t the smartest thing to do.

When the two men had finished their meal, one of them looked over at her. “Excuse me, are you waiting for someone?”

She shook her head. “No.”

“Well you’re welcome to join us, if you like.”

Nicole intended leaving when she’d finished her drink but didn’t want to appear rude. “I’m not going to be staying long.”

“That’s fine. We’re dull company, but probably a little more interesting than none at all.”

She picked up her bag and glass, then joined them at their table. “Is this allowed? In England all the pubs are closed, and we can’t mix with anyone indoors.”

“That’ll be happening here soon enough, so let’s make the most of it while we can. I’m Declan, and this is Colin.”

She smiled from one to the other. “Nicole.”

They made small talk for a few minutes, Nicole explaining she was here on business and would be going to Galway tomorrow before returning home on Saturday. Colin insisted they all have a drink to celebrate and ordered a round from the waitress. Three small glasses of clear liquor were duly delivered.

Nicole frowned. “What’s that?”

“Poitín, an Irish tradition. It’s a liqueur made from potatoes.”

She took a sip and coughed as the liquid burned its way down her throat. “Jeez, I can’t drink that.”

Declan laughed. “As this is your first trip to Ireland, you should really drink it with another Irish tradition.” He called the waitress back and ordered more drinks. Several minutes later, three pints of Guinness were delivered, a shamrock etched in the head of each.

Nicole started to giggle again. “There’s no way I’ll be able to drink that.”

“I’ll show you,” Colin said. He picked up his glass of Poitín and took a sip, grimaced, then washed it down with a large gulp of Guinness. “See?”

Nicole took a slug of the fiery liqueur, then a gulp of stout but before she had a chance to swallow the second drink, she coughed, spraying Guinness over the two men and dribbling it down her own blouse.

Colin laughed and handed her a napkin. “Okay, I think we still need to work on that.”

Just then, Nicole’s phone rang. She took it out of her bag, saw it was Ciaran, and declined the call.

Declan glanced down at her phone, then raised his eyebrows. “Husband?”

“No, he’s back in England. That was Ciaran, the business colleague I’m here with.”

“Right. Didn’t he want to eat with you?”

“I didn’t give him the chance. We had a disagreement.”

Her phone rang again, and this time she decided to answer it. “Hi Ciaran.”

“Nicole, where are you?”

“I’ve no idea.” She looked at Declan. “Where are we?”

“Temple Bar.”

“Apparently, I’m in a temple bar.” She peered around the building. “It doesn’t look like a temple, though.”

“Who’s that you were talking to?” He sounded concerned.

“Declan. Colin’s here too, but it was Declan who answered my question. So if this isn’t really a temple, blame him.”

“Temple Bar is the area,” Ciaran explained. “If you tell me the name of the actual place you’re in, I’ll come and find you.”

“No, I’m fine.”

“Nicole, just tell—”

She ended the call and looked up at the two men. “He gets a little possessive sometimes.”

“Your colleague gets possessive?” Colin asked.

She nodded.

The two men glanced at each other, then Declan asked, “And how does your husband feel about your colleague getting possessive?”

“He just tells me to do what I think’s best.” Their puzzled expressions made her giggle. The alcohol was starting to kick in. “My husband isn’t the possessive type, and he’s happy for me to have a little fun. My colleague *is* the possessive type, and he’s only happy when I’m having fun with him.” She shrugged. “There’s a bit of history there, you see.”

The men shared another look.

“What’s more,” she went on, “Ciaran has brought me to Ireland in the hope of winning me back.”

“Winning you back from your husband?”

“No, from Ed.”

“Who’s Ed?”

“My next door neighbour. Though to be honest, I’m actually more interested in his wife.”

Both men laughed and shook their heads.

Nicole leaned forward over the table. “When he asked me to accompany him on this trip, I told him we’d need two rooms. And d’you know what he did?”

“He only booked one?” Colin asked.

“Or,” Declan said, leaning forward, “he claimed he’d booked two, but said there’d been a mix-up with one of them.”

“Exactly,” she said, slapping her hand on the table. “Some plumbing problem.”

“Men, eh?”

“Hmm.” She smiled, took another sip of her potato fire-water and washed it down with Guinness.

“So, what are you going to do?” Colin asked.

Nicole shrugged. “All my clothes are in the hotel, and we’re driving over to Galway tomorrow, so I’ll have to go back there. Julian suggested I get another room.”

“Julian?”

“My husband.”

“He knows your colleague only booked one room?”

She nodded. “He said Ciaran had been devious.”

“And he wasn’t angry?”

She shook her head. “I think he was hoping I’d maybe hook up with Ciaran again. Or Will.”

“Who’s Will?”

“He’s the guy we’re meeting up with in Galway. Another colleague.”

“Sheesh. They should make a soap opera about your life.”

Nicole’s phone lit up as a text arrived from Ciaran. She read it and looked up at the two men. “He says he’s worried about me.”

“Sounds like he’s worried you might get a better offer than sharing his hotel room.”

“Hmm.”

Another text arrived. “He says I don’t know anything about you, and you’re not to be trusted.”

Declan nodded. “That’s right enough. Tell you what, give me your phone.”

Nicole passed it over, and Declan signalled the waitress over. After passing her the phone, he and Colin got up and came to crouch on either side of Nicole. Each slipped an arm around her shoulder while the photograph was taken.

Declan took the phone back from the waitress and passed it to Nicole. “Send him the photo to assure him if anything bad happens, he has evidence for the police.”

Nicole giggled and forwarded the picture to Ciaran.

“You’re welcome to come back to our place and sleep there,” Declan said.

She gave him a warm smile. “That’s very kind of you.”

“But I should warn you that you might be disappointed.”

“No I won’t. I think you two will be the perfect hosts, and I’ll be very grateful to use your sofa.”

“You’ve guessed?” Colin asked.

“I suspected.” She smiled. “It’s nice to talk to men who look you in the eye rather than glancing down at your chest.”

“Well, there’ll be no need for the sofa—we have a spare bed. Now, let’s finish these and try another bar.”

Nicole pointed to her Poitín and Guinness. “I really can’t drink these.”

“That’s fine. You’ve drunk some, which is good enough for your first Irish trip. Come on, there’s a bar with live music just around the corner.”

As they got outside, the cool air hit Nicole and she stumbled in her heels. The men walked either side of her, helping her. Once inside the next bar they found a table and sat Nicole down. She ordered a sparkling water and a coffee, which made both men smile. Traditional Irish music was performed by a three-piece band consisting of one man on a bodhrán, another on an accordion and a woman on a violin. Some of the customers

sang from their tables, others danced in the small space at the back of the room. Nicole wondered if social-distancing rules were being broken but decided she really didn't care. For the next hour she laughed and had a great time. She hadn't realised how much she'd missed just going into pubs.

Declan and Colin convinced her to dance, but she couldn't do it with her shoes on. Declan got another customer to take a few photos of the three of them crushed together on the dancefloor.

"I'll send you these, and you can share them with your colleague," he said with a smile.

By the time they'd reached the men's house, Nicole had sent Ciaran two pictures of her dancing with Colin and Declan and had also sobered up considerably. Once inside, she accepted a decaf coffee while the men each had a shot of Jameson whisky.

"What hotel are you booked into?" Declan asked.

Nicole couldn't remember the name until she scrolled back through her search history. She showed him the photo on their website.

"Ah, that's a nice place. I'll drive you over there in the morning. To be honest, their breakfasts will be a lot better than what we can offer."

After she'd finished her coffee, they showed her to the spare room. After they'd wished her goodnight, Nicole draped her suit and Guinness-stained blouse over the seat of a rowing machine in the corner. The feet of her stockings were laddered and ruined from dancing on the wooden floor, so she balled them up and put them in her bag. Then she slipped between the sheets in her bra and panties and fell asleep almost immediately.



$$\Psi$$


A horizontal line with a small square box in the center, containing a horizontal bar.

Chapter Eight

Nicole woke, dressed and wandered downstairs to find Colin on the couch in a t-shirt and shorts.

Declan came out of the kitchen carrying two mugs. “Morning,” he said in a cheery voice. “Coffee?”

“Ooh, yes please.”

Colin moved along to make room for her. “How’s the hangover?”

“Not too bad, considering how little I usually drink.”

“I think you made a wise choice by going onto non-alcoholic drinks.”

Declan returned and passed her a steaming mug. “Here you go, pet.”

“Thank you,” she said, then looked from one to the other. “And thank you for last night. I had a great time.”

“I’m glad.”

“And thank you for...” She shrugged. “In the cold light of day, I can understand why Ciaran was concerned. I could’ve gotten myself into a really nasty situation.”

Declan shook his head. “I think you knew we were safe from pretty early on. I’m sure if you were picking up any negative vibes, you’d have walked away. You weren’t drunk until we made you sample the Irish drinks.”

“True. I can blame it all on you two.”

When she’d finished the coffee, Declan went to get his car keys. She gave Colin a hug before she left. Declan had a Mini like her own, though his was five years old and not the Cooper S.

It took them less than ten minutes to get to the hotel. When he pulled into the small drop-off area at the front, Nicole leaned over and kissed his cheek. “Thank you.”

“Any time. And if you come back to Dublin, drop me a text. You have my number from the photos I sent you.”

“I will. I’ve told Julian we should come here after Covid’s disappeared.”

“Is that your husband, your neighbour or your colleague in Galway?”

She slapped his arm. “Stop making me sound like such a floozy.”

“You should bring your next-door neighbour’s wife with you, then we can all go to the best gay bar in Dublin.”

Nicole laughed but a tingle ran down her spine. “I actually really like that idea.”

“It’s a solid offer. We’ll even let you two have the double bed.”

She shook her head. “We’ll stay in this hotel, but meet you for dinner and dancing.”

“Right, it’s a date.”

She smiled, got out of the car and headed into the hotel. Through the glass panels she saw Ciaran having breakfast in the restaurant. She walked up to his table. “Morning.”

Ciaran looked her up and down, taking in the stain on her blouse and the lack of stockings. “Have a nice night?” he asked.

“Fabulous.” She smiled sweetly. “How about you?”

“What do you think?”

“Can I have the cardkey, please?”

“Why?”

“You know...” She wiggled her hips. “After two guys going at me all night long, I really need a shower.”

Ciaran snatched the card from his pocket and held it up. She saw his hand shaking slightly.

“Thank you. I’ll only be ten minutes. Can you order me a pot of tea and a full breakfast? I seem to have worked up quite an appetite.” She smiled again and left the restaurant.

In the hotel room she quickly showered, tied her hair back and put on her jeans and trainers with a fresh top. Ciaran was still eating when she got back to the table.

“So, tell me about your share of the business,” she said.

He looked puzzled, then shook his head. “Tell me about your hot night of passion, and why you didn’t insist they use protection.”

“What makes you think they didn’t use protection?”

“There was cum on your blouse, and if you needed a shower so bad, they must have come inside you as well.”

She poured her tea, wondering how long she should tease him. “Maybe they started off using protection but ran out of condoms before they ran out of stamina.”

His expression was as cold as she’d ever seen it. “You know what you are, Nicole?”

“Yes, you reminded me yesterday.”

He looked away, then took a sip of his coffee.

She didn’t like seeing this side of him and decided to put him out of his misery. “Ciaran, nothing happened.”

He scoffed. “You can’t expect me to—”

“They’re a gay couple. They took me to a bar with traditional music and I had a great time. Then we went back to their house and I slept in the spare room.”

“But the stain—”

“It was Guinness! I’ve never met a man whose cum leaves a brown stain.”

He stared at her, obviously trying to decide if she was being honest. “What about your stockings?”

“Laddered while dancing without my shoes on.”

Just then, her breakfast was delivered to the table. Nicole poked a slice of toast into her fried egg, then smiled at him. “So, how much is your share of the business worth?”

“Why?”

“I’m just curious.”

“Over the last three years I’ve put in thirty-five grand, but I’ve also reinvested all the profit I was due, so I’d like to think it’s worth somewhere between eighty and ninety grand now. I’ll need to sit down with Will and work it out.” He smirked. “Maybe you should join the discussion. You seemed to enjoy the last time the three of us got together.”

Nicole ignored his comment. “Did Will invest the same amount?”

“Yeah. He actually started it all. Other than a small salary, his whole share of the profits has gone back into the business. Why?”

“I just wondered what sort of figures were involved, that’s all.”

Ciaran finished his breakfast. “Right, if you give me the door card I’ll go and bring the bags down and check out. Come through to reception when you’ve finished your breakfast.”

Once Ciaran had left, Nicole phoned Julian. “Hi, are you free to talk?” she asked.

“Yes, I’m alone in my office, but have a meeting in fifteen. How was your night? Did you get another room?”

“As things turned out, I didn’t need one.”

“Oh?”

“No. I met two men in the bar I phoned you from, and they took me back to their place.”

He was silent, but she could hear his ragged breathing.

“Are you still there?”

“Yes. The two men, they just asked you back to their place?”

“Not immediately. They took me dancing first.”

“Dancing?”

“Yep. If there’s supposed to be social distancing here, they’re not very strict with it.”

“What about Ciaran?”

“He stayed in the hotel room. I sent him photos of me with the two men.”

“You sent him photos?”

Julian sounded so bewildered she had to suppress a giggle as she dropped her voice to a sultry whisper. “I’ll show them to *you* when I get home.”

“Right... right. Good. So, how was it?”

“Wonderful.”

“Good—you know I’ll want the details. And how did Ciaran take it?”

“Not as well as you.” She laughed. “I hate to disappoint you babe, but nothing happened.”

“What do you mean?”

“They were a lovely couple who offered me their spare room when I told them about Ciaran’s deviousness with the hotel booking.”

“They were gay?”

“Yep, though I didn’t tell Ciaran that until after his tantrum.”

Julian guffawed. “Oh dear, poor Ciaran. Where are you now?”

“I’ve just finished breakfast at the hotel. Ciaran’s checking out, and we’ll be starting the drive to Galway in the next few minutes.”

“Right. Well, you might want to make up for your teasing by giving him a blowjob while he drives.”

“I don’t think he deserves one.”

He gave a soft chuckle. “No, probably not. Anyway, I’ve been thinking about what might be involved in raising funds to buy Ciaran’s business. For each of my two promotions, I got share options. Although I can’t sell them yet, I can use them as security to borrow money from the bank. You’ve seen the figures—does the business look like a good investment?”

“On paper it certainly looks successful enough, but I can’t help wondering... If it’s doing well, why is Ciaran looking to sell out?”

“Well, like he says, he could probably make a lot more if he’s shrewd with his stock investments.”

“Then shouldn’t we be looking at doing that, rather than buying into a business he seems to think isn’t good enough for him?”

“I don’t enjoy tracking share prices,” he said. “Besides, this would be about being part of a venture—I’m not really aiming to make the biggest, fastest profit available. I thought this could be something for you to be more involved with.”

His considerate nature made her smile. “Thanks, but this whole discussion might be for nothing anyway. Ciaran seems to think his share of the business is worth between eighty and ninety thousand pounds.”

“Really? That’s a lot more than I’d imagined. We could only raise about forty thousand, maybe fifty at a push.”

Just then, Ciaran appeared at the restaurant entrance. Nicole got up from her seat. “It looks like he’s checked out, so we’ll talk about this later, okay?”

“Right, yes. Enjoy the drive over, and try not to cause an accident with your oral skills.”

* * * *

The day was dull and overcast, with occasional drops of rain hitting the windscreen as Ciaran drove out of the city.

“I’m sorry for only booking one room,” he said. “Thinking about it now, it wasn’t the smartest strategy.”

“No, it wasn’t.” She turned to look at his profile. “If you hadn’t done that, we could have had a nice evening. Maybe even gone dancing.”

“Did you tell Julian?”

“Yes. I also told him about pretending to have spent the night with two men.”

“Heh. What did he say to that?”

“He told me I could make it up to you with a blowjob while you drive.”

Ciaran snapped his head around to look at her, his expression one of shock.

“Don’t get excited. It’s not going to happen.”

He shook his head. “Nobody at work has any idea what Julian’s like. People see him as a quiet, straitlaced—”

“Basil Fawlty?”

He smiled. “He’s changed that look, but nobody would ever guess what goes on in his life.”

“Good, because what we do is nobody else’s business.”

It was early afternoon by the time they reached Galway. Ciaran asked if she wanted to stop for lunch, but Nicole was still full from breakfast.

“We have a few hours to kill,” he said. “If the weather had been better, we could have taken a walk around the city. I need to talk to Will

before tonight, and I'll also go and see my folks. You're welcome to join me —"

"No, I think you need to talk to Will on your own. And I certainly don't think it'd be appropriate for me to meet your parents."

"Okay, well I can drop you at the hotel if you want to rest up in the room before dinn—"

"*The* room?"

Ciaran chuckled. "I only booked one because I'll be staying at my mum and dad's house."

"Oh, right." She shook her head. "Sorry, I just—"

"I know." He grinned sheepishly. "So, how about we go to the factory so you can meet the rest of the guys before tonight's get together?"

"That'd be nice."

"Great. While we're there I'll talk to Will, then I'll drop you at the hotel and go see my folks. I'll call at the hotel later and walk you to the restaurant."

"Okay."

The factory was a modern unit in a small industrial park. Ciaran parked next to a large black pickup truck with chrome bumpers. "That's Will's," he said.

Nicole wasn't sure how she felt about seeing Will again. He'd seemed like a nice guy and had appeared as shocked as she was when Ciaran had suggested the threesome, but it would still be awkward chatting to him as if that had never happened.

They got out of the car and hurried through the rain to a door which led into a small office. Will was sitting behind the desk, talking to an extra-petite blonde who was leaning against a filing cabinet. They both stood upright to greet the new arrivals.

Ciaran did the introductions. "Nicole, Will you've met, of course..." She smiled warmly. "Yes, hello Will."

The blonde hugged Ciaran and kissed his cheek.

"And this lovely creature," Ciaran continued, his smile smug as he held his arm around the blonde's waist, "is Will's wife, Meg."

Nicole's expression froze. She'd had no idea that Will was married when she slept with him. She doubted if it would have made any difference, because that night she'd acted like a complete—

“Hi Nicole,” Meg said with a broad smile, holding out a tiny hand.

Recovering quickly, Nicole forced herself to return the smile and shook the proffered hand. “Hi.”

Meg was stunning, with short-cropped spiky blonde hair, big green eyes and a pointed chin that gave her an elfin appearance. She wore tight faded jeans, a black jumper and flat ankle boots. She couldn't have been any more than five feet tall. Nicole avoided looking at Will, who was probably feeling as uncomfortable as she was.

“Meg,” Ciaran said. “Is there any chance you could introduce Nicole to the guys while I have a quick word with Will?”

Meg looked surprised. “You want me to take this beauty into that den of depravity?”

“I thought it might be nice for her to meet them before we all go out tonight.”

She looked at Nicole. “You'll have to ignore the pornographic calendars, and slap any of them that try to pinch your backside.”

Nicole laughed.

Meg turned to Ciaran. “What've you got planned for the rest of the day?”

“Nothing. I was going to drop Nicole off at The Galmont and go see my folks.”

“Ooh, swanky.” Meg gave Nicole a broad smile. “Nice to see he's not put you up in some cheap backstreet dive, but you could have stayed with us.”

Nicole risked a glance at Will, who looked suitably embarrassed. She was now angry at him for what they'd done together. “Thanks, but I'm sure the hotel will be fine.”

“It's a lovely hotel with a spa. I hope you packed your cozzie.”

“Unfortunately not.”

“Shame.” Meg took her hand. “Come on, let's go and meet the perverts.” She led Nicole through another door and onto the factory floor. It was a single room, about forty-foot square with numerous work benches. A

radio was playing, though one of the machines was making so much noise the music was barely audible. There were four men at the benches, all wearing dark grey overalls.

“Gents, come and meet the latest recruit,” Meg called.

The noisy machine was turned off, and the men converged on the two women.

“This is Nicole,” Meg told them. “She’s the lady from England who’s been doing the accounting. She’s joining you for dinner tonight, so you’d all better behave.”

Nicole was greeted with friendly smiles, and each man wiped his hands on a rag before being introduced. None of them were wearing facemasks.

“This is Brian,” Meg said as one of the older men shook Nicole’s hand. He had a full head of grey hair and a goatee.

“Nice to meet you, Nicole,” he said.

“John, put your tongue away,” Meg warned as another man with thinning salt and pepper hair stepped forward. “He’s the one responsible for all the filthy pictures on the wall.”

“I also have a few of Meg but like to keep those to myself,” he said with a wink.

“Dream on,” she said with a laugh, slapping his arm when he held onto Nicole’s hand for too long. “Put her down, you dirty old bugger.”

Another man shook Nicole’s hand. He was younger than the first two, maybe forty, with a wide chest and big shoulders.

“Donal’s a former rugby player who keeps the others in check,” Meg said. “But don’t let him get you into a scrum because they’ve corrupted him, too.”

“Rugby?” Nicole asked.

He nodded. “In my younger days.”

“He used to play professionally,” Meg announced, proudly.

Donal gave a sheepish smile. “It was a long time ago and was short and sweet. Busted my knee when I was twenty-two.”

“Yeah,” John said with a laugh. “He used to be a hooker, same as Meg.”

Meg glared at him, then turned to the last man. “And this is Paul, the baby of our outfit.”

A guy who looked about Nicole’s age smiled and shook her hand. He had black hair pulled into a short ponytail and eyes as blue as Ciaran’s. “Hi.”

“There’s also Ted, but you’ll meet him tonight,” Meg added. “Right guys, you’ll all see Nicole again later. Please be nice to her, because I won’t be there to slap your wrists.”

John laughed. “You can count on us to keep a close eye on her.”

“Not too close.” Meg led Nicole back toward the office. “They’re all lovely guys really. We’re lucky to have them.”

“Do you work here?” Nicole hadn’t seen any payments to Meg in the accounts.

“No, I’m a nurse. I just like to call here to see everyone whenever I can.”

“And you’re not coming to the dinner?”

“No, employees only.” Meg pushed open the door and saw Will and Ciaran in deep conversation at the desk. Their faces were serious, which made Meg frown.

When they looked over, Nicole could tell that Will wasn’t happy.

“Is everything alright?” Meg asked.

“Not really,” Will said. “We’ll talk about it later.”

“Okay...” She glanced at Ciaran, then back at Nicole. “Well I’m off now, so if you want, I can drop Nicole off at The Galmont and you two can carry on here.”

“That’d be great if you could.” Ciaran looked at Nicole. “Is that okay with you?”

“Yes, fine.” She turned to Meg. “If you’re sure you don’t mind.”

“No problem. We can call for a coffee on the way.”

“The car’s unlocked if you want to get your bags,” Ciaran said.

Outside, Nicole left her suit in Ciaran’s car but took her holdall and leather jacket.

“Will doesn’t look too pleased about something,” Meg said as she manoeuvred out of the space and through the gates onto the main

thoroughfare of the industrial park. She turned to Nicole. “Do you know what it’s all about?”

“I suspect Ciaran’s just revealed his plan to sell his share of the business.”

“What?” Meg shook her head. “Is that what...? *Fuck!*” She turned to Nicole with wide eyes. “Sorry about the language, but this...” She shook her head again. “This is a bit of a shock.” She stopped at the junction with the main road. “Why does he want to do that now? We’ve had so many enquiries about new work. Will was thinking we might even need to hire another engineer, but now...” She dragged her fingers through her hair.

“I’m sorry,” Nicole said. “I was surprised too.”

“How long’s he been planning this?”

“I’ve no idea. He only told me yesterday, which was the first time I’ve seen him in quite a while.”

“How come?”

“Well, we’re not exactly close.”

“Aren’t you two an item?”

“No.” Nicole wasn’t sure what Meg knew about her, or about the relationship she’d had with Ciaran.

“Sorry. I thought you two were seeing each other.”

Nicole sighed. “I’m actually married. What I had with Ciaran was just a brief fling, which my husband knew about.”

“God, I had no idea.” Meg looked stunned. “I’m sorry for being so... I didn’t know any of that. I just knew that Ciaran was keen. He talked about you constantly at Christmas, and he’s never done that about any of the other women he’s seen.”

“That’s a surprise, because it was over by then.”

“Oh. Well, it’s none of my business, and I’m sorry for bringing it up.” Meg concentrated on her driving for a few moments. “Do you mind if we have a coffee at our house instead?”

“No, but if it’s too much trouble—”

“It’s no bother, I just don’t feel like going to a café now.”

Their house was in a row of old stone cottages. The ceilings were low with exposed beams, and the floors were polished quarry tiles. The

entire ground floor had been converted into a large open-plan area, with the kitchen at the back.

“What a fabulous house,” Nicole said, following Meg to the kitchen from where a set of French doors led to a paved area. “You’ve even got a sea view.”

“They used to be fisherman’s cottages. We’ve spent the last two years doing this up.” She picked up the kettle. “Tea or coffee?”

“Could I have tea, please?”

“I’ll have the same. I could do with something a little stronger, but I’ll need to drive you to your hotel.”

“If you want something stronger, I can get a taxi back to my hotel.”

Meg thought about it, then nodded. “Tea first, then see how we’re feeling.”

They sat at the circular pine table and chatted about the business that Will and Ciaran owned.

“Will got made redundant a few years back, and he used his redundancy money to start the business. It was just Will at first, with Brian and Ted helping him out a couple of days a week. They’d all been laid off at the same time, but the others took early retirement.

“Then Ciaran offered to put some money in, and the business grew from there. We got the new premises, took on John and Donal, and started to see a profit. We hired Paul last year, and—”

A mobile phone rang somewhere, and Meg stood up and walked to retrieve it from the kitchen countertop. She clicked it and put it to her ear. “Hiya.” She listened for a few seconds, then said, “Yes, Nicole’s already told me.”

She was obviously talking to her husband. A fresh wave of guilt washed over Nicole.

“We’re actually at home because I didn’t feel like... Oh, okay. See you in a bit.” Meg put her phone down and sat back opposite Nicole.

“Ciaran’s dropped his bombshell then gone to see his family. Will’s coming back here now, so he can run you to the hotel and we can have a real drink. Gin and tonic okay?”

“That’ll be fine, thanks.”

Meg fixed the drinks and brought over two tall tumblers, placing one in front of Nicole. "Cheers."

By the time Will arrived, the women were halfway down their second glass. He walked through to the back of the house and gave Nicole an embarrassed smile.

"Are you alright?" Meg asked him.

There were only two chairs at the kitchen table, so Will leaned against the kitchen counter. He shook his head. "I'm still in shock."

Nicole studied his face. Even though she was still angry with him, she could see the worry etched on his face. "How much is Ciaran's share worth?"

He scoffed. "He seems to think it's worth ninety grand."

"*What?*" Meg shook her head. "How the fuck is it...?" She turned to Nicole. "Sorry, again. I can't believe Ciaran believes it's worth that much." She looked up at Will. "If his share is worth that, then maybe we should sell up as well."

"We might not have a choice. He seems to think one of the big boys will buy him out to get the contracts. He says they'll keep us all on, but I doubt it. Why would they, when they have their own factory and their own engineers?"

"How much do *you* think it's worth?" Nicole asked again.

"I really hadn't thought about it. He's obviously spent some time working things out..." He studied Nicole's face. "Did you know about it?"

"Not until yesterday."

"Nicole and Ciaran aren't seeing each other anymore," Meg informed him.

"Oh?" Will looked embarrassed again. "I'm sorry, I didn't know that. He never said anything about—"

"It was over by Christmas," Meg informed him.

Will blinked but didn't say anything.

Nicole put down her glass. "I was talking to my husband, and it's possible we may be in a position to help."

"How?" Will asked.

“We’d like to invest in the business, though there’s no way we could raise ninety grand.”

“I think Ciaran’s over-estimating how much it’s worth.” Will walked through to the middle of the room and picked up a pine stool. After carrying it back to the table, he sat down and looked at Nicole. “How much could you and your husband invest?”

They spent twenty minutes discussing the possibility of raising the money to buy Ciaran out of the business. Meg suggested asking the other men if they wanted to buy in, and also said her parents might be able to help financially.

It had gone dark outside by the time Meg asked Will to drive Nicole to her hotel. “Take her in my car, because her bag’s in the boot.”

Nicole gave Meg a warm hug goodbye, but once inside the car, she glared at Will. “What the fuck were you thinking when you came over to England?”

“I didn’t have time to th—”

“Bollocks, you had plenty of time. How could you cheat on her? She’s gorgeous, and she deserves better.”

“I know.”

“So why?”

He shrugged. “I don’t know. It was all a bit of a blur. You waltzed into Ciaran’s office and flashed your stocking-tops, and—”

“I thought we were alone.”

“Yeah, but he’d told me about this new woman he was seeing, how you were the sexiest thing he’d ever met, and how your husband actually liked the idea of you—”

“He had no right to tell you any of that.” Anger flared inside.

“I didn’t ask him anything,” Will assured her. “He was brimming over with all the tales. He told me you’d seduced him in his office during a thunderstorm.”

“I didn’t seduce him, I just sucked him off.”

Will’s jaw dropped.

She shook her head. “Have you any idea how awful I felt, drinking and chatting to Meg, knowing what we’d done in that hotel room?”

“I’m sorry. If Ciaran had suggested anything before I saw you, I’d have said no. But when you came into his office looking all gorgeous and acting like—”

“A whore?”

“No! No, you were just...” He shook his head again, clearly flustered. “I know it was wrong, and there were a hundred reasons why I should have stayed in the bar while you two went to the room, but...” He shook his head. “That was before Ciaran mentioned you coming over to Ireland. I didn’t think I was likely to see you again anytime soon. I’m sorry, I know that’s not any kind of excuse.”

Nicole stared at him and shook her head. Could she really blame him? Wouldn’t most men have taken advantage if a woman had behaved the way she had? “You’d better start driving, or Meg will wonder what we’re talking about.”

He nodded, put the car in gear and pulled away from the kerb. “I didn’t know it was all over between you and Ciaran.”

“It stopped after that night with you.”

“Really? I thought you’d had a good time.”

“I did, but afterwards I was angry about being manipulated.”

Will was silent for a few moments. “I was torn about whether to confess to Meg about—”

“Don’t, for God’s sake. Nothing good will come of it. It could end up ruining your relationship.”

“Yet you share everything with your husband.”

“Yes, but that’s because we have an arrangement that we *both* like. How would you feel about another man fucking Meg?”

“It’d drive me mad.”

“Well, the chances are she’d feel the same way.”

He nodded. “You’re right. It’s just that...” He shook his head.

Nicole looked at him. Saw his grim profile illuminated by each streetlight they passed. “You have a lovely wife and a lovely home, Will. It was stupid to risk losing them for a couple of hours of illicit fun.”

“I know.” He gave a shy grin. “Though I’m too ashamed to admit how many times I’ve thought about that night.”

She sighed. "Yeah, you're not the only one. While I hate myself for going along with it, another part of me..." She shook her head. "What's done is done. I haven't let it ruin my life, and you shouldn't let it ruin yours."

"No, but he's started..." He sighed, then slowed the car down. "Right, there's The Galmont."

Nicole looked at the hotel. It was much bigger than she'd expected. Will steered the car to the area in front of the steps and got out. He lifted Nicole's bag from the boot and passed it to her. "I'll see you later."

She nodded. "I'll call Julian and tell him what you said about raising the rest of the cash. You must also get an independent valuation as soon as you can."

He nodded. "Okay. Well, I'll see you in a couple of hours."

Nicole walked into the hotel and checked in. Fifteen minutes later she was in the bath, drinking another gin and tonic from the minibar. When her glass was empty she got out, wrapped herself in the white fluffy robe and called her husband.

"Hi," he said, sounding a little breathless.

"Are you alright?" She heard the sound of a car door being closed.

"Yes, I'm just..." There was a muffled noise, then the sound of their front door being slammed. "Sorry, I'm just home. I've called for some groceries on the way." There was another muffled sound, presumably as he put down the shopping bags, then his voice came through clearly. "So, how was the drive across country?"

"Well I didn't give him a blowjob, but it was okay. Horrible weather. I couldn't see much of the countryside."

"So you're now in Galway?"

"Yes, in a very nice hotel."

"Two rooms?"

"No, Ciaran's staying with his parents. We went to the factory today so that I could meet the rest of the workforce before tonight's dinner."

"And did you meet Will again?"

"Yes. And I also met his wife."

"Ah..."

Nicole could imagine Julian's face as he considered this information. "And how was that?"

"Awkward. I had no idea he was married, and I felt guilty because she's so lovely. She took me back to their house for a drink."

"Is she aware of what happened?"

"No, thank God. Anyway, what I wanted to tell you was that Will reckons some of the other guys might be interested in raising the money to help buy Ciaran's share. Are you sure it's what you want to do?"

"Yes. I've thought about it, and you seem to like the business, so definitely."

"Okay, good. Well, I suppose I'd better start getting ready."

"What dress did you take with you?"

"I took your advice and brought a tight little black number."

"And underwear?"

"The silk basque you chose."

"Nice. What about shoes?"

"The strappy black sandals you bought for me, along with a pair of fine-meshed fishnet stockings."

"Wonderful. You'll be giving heart-attacks dressed like that."

She giggled. "The men are actually younger than I'd imagined. The part-timers all took early retirement when they were made redundant. They're in their fifties, but there are a couple of younger guys—an ex-rugby player in his forties and a guy about my age."

"Well, maybe you'll get lucky then."

"If we're going to be investing, me behaving like a slut probably wouldn't be a good idea."

"I'm not so sure—they might consider it quite a perk to have someone like you on the Board." He gave a dirty laugh. "Though they'd probably prefer to have you on the boardroom table."

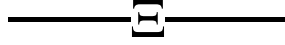
"Right, I'm going before your fantasies get too crude. Do you want me to call you when I get back to my hotel?"

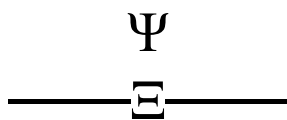
"Yes, that'd be nice."

"Even if I'm not alone?"

"If that's the case, FaceTime me."

“Pervert.” Giggling, she ended the call.





Chapter Nine

Ciaran walked into the hotel bar wearing yet another designer suit, this one dark blue with a subtle pinstripe. His eyes raked over her. “Wow, you look fantastic.”

“Thank you.”

“Is that gin?”

She nodded.

“Do you want a top up?”

“No thanks.”

He ordered himself the same from the bar, and they took their drinks to a table.

Ciaran’s eyes glanced down when Nicole crossed her legs. When he saw that she’d caught him looking, he shrugged. “Sorry. You’re a hard habit to break.”

“Isn’t that a song title?”

“Probably.” He gave a wry smile. “Am I not allowed to miss you?”

“You can miss what we had, but not me. All we were doing was allowing our bodies to enjoy each other’s.”

“It was more than—”

“No, Ciaran. It wasn’t.”

He bit his lip, then sighed. “It was for me.”

“Then I’m sorry.”

Ciaran looked away, and they drank in silence for a couple of minutes. Once the drinks were finished, he stood up. “I guess we should be getting to the restaurant.”

Nicole followed him through reception and out of the hotel. It was a cold night, and she pulled her shawl tighter around her shoulders.

He nodded toward a side road. “The restaurant’s just down there. It’ll only take us a couple of minutes to get there.”

The combination of cobbled pavements, four-inch heels and tight dress meant it actually took them closer to five minutes.

The restaurant door, which displayed a sign saying Private Party, opened into a small hall. Will and the other engineers—all dressed in suits and ties—stood at the bar at the back of the dining area. When they noticed Nicole, all conversation stopped, and they stared at her.

She gave them a shy smile. “Hello again,” she said.

All of them started talking at once. They gathered round her, offering drinks and compliments. She asked for a gin and tonic and thanked them all for the nice things they said about her dress.

The only man she didn’t recognise introduced himself as Ted, who explained that he only worked Monday to Wednesday. He was probably the oldest of them all and also the shortest. In her heels, Nicole was slightly taller.

As John delivered her drink, one of the facemask-clad restaurant staff approached and offered to take her shawl. Nicole slid it from her bare shoulders and passed it to the waiter. Another brief silence ensued as all the men took in her form. The dress had a fitted waist and hugged the contours of her hips and thighs. The cold night had also raised her nipples so that they were hard behind the silk of the basque, but she hoped that this wasn’t obvious.

While Nicole was receiving all the attention from the other men, she saw Will talking to Ciaran near the bar. After a few more minutes, a waiter requested everyone move through to the dining area and sit at the table. Nicole felt a hand on the small of her back and looked up to see John herding her to the far side of the table.

“You come and sit over here with the workers,” he said. “Let the management sort out what’s going on between them.”

Nicole was more than happy with this arrangement. The large, circular table was lit with candles. Ciaran and Will were almost directly opposite Nicole, who sat between John and Donal, with Brian and Ted to her left and Paul to her right between Donal and Will.

As the waiter took their orders, Nicole was aware of all eyes continually glancing her way. Paul, the youngest engineer, couldn’t seem to keep his eyes off her.

John and Donal kept Nicole entertained all through the first course, each telling bawdy stories. They kept her wine glass topped up and by the time the main course was delivered, she'd laughed so much she feared her eye-liner would run.

Brian and Ted were obviously old friends and were more old-fashioned than John and Donal. They told her about growing up in Galway, and how each had acted as best man for the other's wedding. Ted had been married over thirty-five years, but Brian's wife had died of cancer fifteen years ago, at only forty years old.

Every time Ciaran tried to interrupt her conversation with the engineers, John would talk over him, which she found amusing. Before dessert was served, Ciaran excused himself and headed to the loo. As soon as he'd left the room, Brian asked Will if he'd told Ciaran about the plan.

Will looked at Nicole. "After I'd dropped you at the hotel, I called these guys and told them to get here early so we could all talk. Everyone's agreed to put up some money to buy Ciaran's share, so we—" he waved his hand at everyone at the table "—will be in charge from now on."

Nicole smiled. "That's great news."

"And how's he taken it?" John asked, nodding toward the door through which Ciaran had left. "The queer 'un?"

The other men giggled.

"That's their name for Ciaran," Will explained to Nicole. He looked around at the men. "He's happy. He keeps saying he'd only have sold to another company if they'd guarantee all our jobs—"

"Yeah, sure he would." Brian shook his head. "Tosser."

"Well," said Will, "as soon as it's sorted, we'll be the new Board."

All the men whooped.

Ciaran finally returned, and dessert was served. More wine was ordered, and John and Donal both pressed their legs against Nicole's under the table as they regaled her with more smutty stories from their pasts. Paul continued to watch her. Even when he was talking to other people, his gaze rarely veered away for long.

When coffee and petit fours were served, Donal insisted Nicole also have a brandy. "This will be the last company dinner we're not paying for,

so let's enjoy it," he said. "Next year I'll be overseeing the bar bill, and you'll all be limited to one glass of wine each."

Jeers rang around the table, and Brian threw a rolled-up napkin at him.

Once the coffee had been finished, they all moved back to the bar area while the waiters cleared the table. The men ordered more drinks from the bar. Nicole still had a full glass of white wine and half of her brandy, so declined a top-up. Spirits were high as everyone chatted and laughed.

It was getting late, and the restaurant staff were obviously eager to close. Brian invited everyone back to his house because he lived closest. His suggestion was greeted with nods of approval.

"How far is it?" Nicole asked.

"About a mile," John said.

"A mile? These shoes are not—"

"Those shoes are perfect," John assured her. "Besides, we'll be getting a taxi. The guy can do a couple of trips, no problem."

A taxi was ordered and as they all stood around finishing their drinks, Ciaran wandered over to stand by Nicole.

"Are you sure you want to go back to a house with all these guys?" Ciaran asked.

"Of course. They're my colleagues now."

"It's just that they seem a bit..." He shrugged. "I don't think they're used to women who dress like... that."

She stared at him. "Like what?"

"You know. I think that style's a little racier than they're used to." His eyes bored into hers, and she could tell he didn't approve of the way she'd been laughing and flirting.

"Do you think I look too cheap, Ciaran?"

"No, I'm not saying that. I just—"

"Well lads," Ted announced. "I'm going to love you and leave you." He walked over to Nicole, took her hand and raised it to his lips. "It was a pleasure to meet you, Nicole. I look forward to seeing you again."

"Thank you, Ted." She stepped closer and kissed his cheek. "It was lovely to meet you, too."

* * * *

Brian's house was a small cottage overlooking Galway Bay. Inside it was snug and warm, so she left her shawl on a chair. Drinks were passed around, Nicole choosing a beer rather than a shot of tequila or an Irish whisky.

Like in the restaurant, Paul couldn't seem to keep his eyes off her. Deciding he was obviously shy, she went over and started a conversation. He seemed nervous at first, but soon became more relaxed and talkative. He'd grown up in Cork and had moved to Galway ten years ago after securing an apprenticeship on leaving school.

Out of the corner of her eye, Nicole noticed that Will and Ciaran were getting more animated as their conversation became heated. The other men in the room had noticed, too.

As Will strode into the kitchen, Nicole approached Ciaran.

"What was that all about?" she asked him quietly.

"Nothing."

"It didn't look like nothing."

"What I should have said was, nothing to do with you."

Nicole blinked, shocked at the venom in his tone. If her reflexes hadn't been dulled by alcohol and the warmth of the camaraderie she'd felt part of all evening, she would have responded with a barbed comment of her own. As it was, she turned her back and followed Will through to the kitchen.

She found him rummaging through a drawer. "Hey, are you okay?" she asked.

He looked at her bottle of beer. "How did you open that?" Glancing down into the drawer again, he shook his head. "I can't find—"

She passed the opener from the counter behind him.

"Oh, cheers."

Nicole could see from Will's expression that he was still seething. "Was Ciaran being awkward about selling the business?" she asked.

"No, I think he's happy that he won't have to tout it round to prospective buyers."

“So,” she said, tipping her head towards the room they’d just left. “What was all that about?”

He chewed his lip, as if unsure of whether to divulge the real reason behind the argument with his cousin.

“Will?” Nicole stepped closer and looked up into his eyes. He was clearly upset about something.

“Ciaran’s been... suggesting things for a while. He keeps reminding me about how much fun we’d all had together that night in my hotel room. He seems to think I owe him something.”

Nicole frowned. She wouldn’t put it past Ciaran to ask for a high price for his share of the business in exchange for his discretion regarding Will’s night with them in England.

Will glanced at the door to make sure nobody else would overhear. “When I found out you and Ciaran had stopped seeing each other, I asked him why he’d kept talking about you all Christmas. Or, to be more specific, I asked him why he kept talking about you in front of Meg.”

A chill settled in Nicole’s stomach. “Was he threatening to tell Meg unless you paid top dollar?”

“What?” Will shook his head, obviously confused. “No, nothing like that. It’s not money he wants.”

“Then what is it?”

“Meg.” Will clenched his jaw and shook his head. “He said that since he’d agreed to share his woman with me, it was only right that I did the same.”

“*What?*”

“He says if I don’t convince Meg to take us both on—like you did—then he might let it slip about what the three of us got up to in England.”

Nicole saw red and stormed out of the kitchen before she had any idea of what she was about to do. Ciaran was standing alone in the place where he’d been arguing with Will. She stopped in front of him and slapped him as hard as she could across the face.

The room went quiet.

“You fucking weasel,” she said through clenched teeth. “I was never yours to barter with. You were nothing more than a piece of meat.” She saw a glass of red wine on a nearby windowsill and, before she could think

about the consequences, she'd picked it up and thrown the contents in Ciaran's face, covering his shirt, tie and suit.

Ciaran stared at her in mute shock.

Nicole leaned close and looked into his wide eyes. "You fucking *wanker!*" With that, she turned on her heels and stomped back into the kitchen, passing a stunned looking Will in the doorway.

She heard quiet conversation from the living room, then the firm thud of the front door closing. A few seconds later, peals of laughter rang through the house. All the engineers trooped into the kitchen, grinning. John kissed the palm she'd used to slap Ciaran.

She turned to Brian. "I'm so sorry, I hope I haven't ruined your carpet."

"A small price to pay for what you've just done."

The others added their approval, nodding and laughing. "He's had something like that coming for a long time..."

"Always talking down to us, thinks he's the dog's bollocks..."

"Thinks his English education makes him the sharpest tool in the box..."

John was still holding Nicole's hand. "Anyone who spends that much time preening himself deserves a slap. He gets his eyebrows sculpted, for fuck's sake."

"Yeah, and probably wears man-scarf as well," Paul added with a laugh.

"This," Brian announced, "deserves to be toasted." He opened a cupboard and took out a bottle of whisky. "If that isn't worth a 15-year malt, I don't know what is."

He lined up six non-matching glasses on the countertop, then poured a generous measure into each. Once he'd handed everyone a glass, he raised his own. "To Nicole, our feisty new member—"

"And gorgeous," Donal pointed out, which received numerous murmurs of agreement.

"Our feisty *and* gorgeous new member of the Board."

Everyone took a drink. The strong liquor made Nicole cough and John patted her back.

“Sorry,” she said. “I don’t usually have trouble swallowing.”

The men stared in stunned silence until Donal whooped and passed his empty glass to Brian. “Now *that’s* worth another toast.”

Brian refilled Donal’s glass, then went round the circle topping up everyone else’s. “To Nicole, our feisty, gorgeous and dirtiest new member of the Board.”

“Who swallows,” John added, before knocking back his drink in a single gulp.

Everyone made their way back into the living room and settled on the easy chairs. The conversation moved to buying out Ciaran’s share, and the men’s excitement about being more involved.

“To be honest,” Will said. “The way things are looking, I reckon it’ll only take us a couple of years to make enough for you all to get your investment back. We’ll pay cash bonuses at the end of each year.”

“And because it’s repaying the director’s loan,” Nicole pointed out, “there’ll be no tax to pay on it.”

“Good point. After that, whatever you guys make will be profit and will be taxable. But if you want to sell up and get out, then hopefully we’ll be in a position to give you a fair price.”

Brian was grinning. “I like the idea of keeping my share and retiring, knowing that all your hard work is paying for me to go fishing on my boat every day of the week.”

For the next thirty minutes or so, the mood remained high. Nicole noticed that the engineers were far more relaxed now that Ciaran had left. She’d never imagined that they’d resented his involvement in the business, and she doubted it’d ever occurred to Ciaran, either. She had a nice warm feeling about the atmosphere and felt a real kinship with the men in the room.

She returned to the kitchen to get another bottle of beer, and found Will topping up his whisky.

“I’m sorry for making a scene,” she said.

He smiled. “Don’t apologise. Most of this is my own fault. It was my actions in England that brought it on, and—”

“No it wasn’t. What you do has nothing to do with Ciaran. I still can’t believe he was trying to get you to let him...” She shook her head.

“That is such an awful thing to do.”

Will shrugged. “Ciaran’s been getting his own way with women for as long as I can remember. He’s always fancied Meg, even when we were teenagers.”

“You’ve known her that long?”

He nodded. “Childhood sweethearts. Met at high school and been together for more than half our lives.”

“Then why the hell did you—?”

“I don’t know. Like I told you in the car, it all happened so fast. You were this sexy thing that Ciaran kept going on about. I’d only ever slept with Meg, and when you...” He shook his head.

“Never admit to what happened. I promise if Meg asks, I’ll deny it. I’ll say it’s just Ciaran trying to get his own way.”

Will nodded toward the door. “You’ve got that lot in the palm of your hand, too.”

She giggled. “I think I’d need both hands.”

He turned serious. “I mean it, they can’t keep their eyes off you. Every time you cross your legs, I worry that Paul will nip upstairs for a wank.”

“Ha-ha!” She stepped closer to him, looking up into his dark eyes. “As you know only too well, I could give him something much better than a wank.”

“Nicole, don’t—”

“Shh.” She put her finger to his lips. “Please don’t turn into Ciaran. I’m having fun. If they want to ogle me, that’s fine by me. I’m having a really nice time, and if I want it to progress into something else, then it’s not for you to tell me otherwise.”

“Sorry, I just wouldn’t want you to get yourself into a situation you’re uncomfortable with. I was worried you might not be aware that—”

“I’m very aware of their eyes, and their thoughts.” She smiled. “And I have to confess, the idea of being the centre of their attention is making my heart race.”

Will stared at her. “Nic—”

“Are any of them married?”

“What? No. John’s divorced. Donal lived with someone for ages, but she’s moved away. Brian’s a widower and Paul’s probably too shy to talk to girls.”

“Perfect.”

“You can’t possibly... I mean, not with all of them.”

“Not all.” She smiled at him. “Nothing will happen until you leave.”

“What?”

“You’re going to take a taxi home, and you’re going to make love to your beautiful wife. Whatever I do here won’t be anything like as sensual, but it’ll be something that my husband and I will both enjoy.” She nodded toward the living room. “And so will those four.”

“Nicole, you... You can’t take on four guys.”

She grinned. “Want to bet?”

He frowned. “How many drinks have you had?”

“A lot, but I won’t wake up tomorrow with no memory of what took place, if that’s what you’re worried about.”

“I think you should phone your husband, like you did before you came up to the room with me and Ciaran. Would you do that for me? Just...” He shrugged. “Just to put my mind at rest.”

Nicole smiled. “You’re a nice guy.” She wandered into the living room and found her bag.

“Please don’t tell me you’re leaving already,” John said from the couch.

She smiled at him, aware that his eyes were on her backside as she’d bent to take out her phone. “Oh no, the night’s still young.” It was actually past one in the morning. “I’m just going to phone Will a taxi, because he needs his beauty sleep.”

He’d already called one by the time she’d returned to the kitchen. “Ten minutes,” he said.

“Good. Thank you.” Nicole phoned Julian, who answered on the second ring. “Hi,” she said, her eyes locked on Will’s. “Were you asleep?”

“No, though I am in bed. How was your evening?”

“It’s been... entertaining.”

“Ah, that sounds promising.”

“Don’t get excited. Nothing like that’s happened.”

“Oh.”

“Yet.”

“Oh?” She heard a muffled rustling as Julian sat up in bed. “You mean something might happen?” he asked.

“Maybe. At the moment I’m standing in the kitchen with Will.”

“Will?”

“Yes, you remember me telling you about him?”

“Of course I do.”

“Yes, he did. And in my mouth.” Will’s eyes widened, and she smiled at her own wickedness.

Julian caught on quickly. “Ah. So he’s listening to this conversation?”

Nicole smiled. “Only my half of it.”

“I see. So is Will—?”

“Oh no, he’s just called a taxi to take him home to his gorgeous wife.”

“Right. What about Ciaran?”

“Gone home to change his clothes. I’ll explain when I get home, though I might have to book a plane ticket now.”

Julian was quiet for a few moments. “Is everything alright?”

“Yes, everything’s fine. That’s why I phoned you. Actually, it was Will who insisted I call you because he’s a little worried about me.”

“Why is he worried?”

“Well, once he’s gone, I’ll be alone in the house with four men.”

“Four men?”

“Hmm.”

“The engineers from the company?”

“That’s right, though they’re actually soon going to be members of the Board. And Will seems to think I’ve had too much to drink to make any rash decisions.”

“Decisions about what?”

“Apparently all four of them have been ogling me all night. Will was suggesting that they were actually lusting after me. He reckons they’ve been looking at my legs.”

“I see...”

“Do you think four at once would be too many?”

Julian was quiet for several seconds. Nicole wished she could see his expression.

“Erm...” His voice was a rasp. “Do *you* think it’d be too many?”

“I’m sure I could cope.”

“Yes, I’ve no doubt that you could.” From his voice, it sounded like he was smiling.

“There’s a problem, though.”

“Oh?”

“I’d imagined that if something sexy was going to happen tonight, it would have been in my room. So that’s where I’ve left the condoms.”

“The condoms are in your hotel?”

“Hmm.” She gazed into Will’s eyes. “So I’ll have to take all four guys bareback.” Julian went completely silent, but Nicole had no intention of letting Will know that. “Yes,” she went on, lowering her voice to a husky whisper. “That’ll be a lot of cum.”

Will’s expression was one of complete awe.

“So, you’re happy for me to do it?”

Julian’s ragged breathing was loud in her ear. “Yes, more than happy. Is it going to happen now?”

“No. Once Will’s left, I’ll go and join the others and have a drink. Maybe do a bit of flirting, flash a little stocking-top.”

“Call me beforehand.”

She was surprised by his request, but smiled. “Okay. Speak later.” She blew him a kiss and ended the call.

Will looked like he’d just got off a rollercoaster. “Jeez, I didn’t know couples like you existed outside of dirty films.”

She laughed, and just then someone shouted that a taxi had pulled up outside.

Will frowned at Nicole. “Give me your phone.”

She did so.

He keyed in a number, and then his own mobile rang. “There, we’ve now got each other’s number.” He handed her phone back, then sighed. “I wish I was staying.”

She hugged him close. “No you don’t. Go home and enjoy the best woman in your life.”

He nodded, then they walked out into the hall together. Nicole went into the living room and Will poked his head in through the doorway. “Guys, thanks for a great night. I’ll see you all on Monday.”

There were numerous farewell calls from the others.

“Can somebody make sure Nicole gets back to the Galmont for me?” he said.

John held up a hand. “You can count on us, boss.”

Will laughed. “Yeah, that’s what I’m worried about.” He turned to Nicole. “We’ll have a catch-up about the business. I’m sure Ciaran will phone you about the ferry but call me if there are any problems.”

Nicole flashed him a warm smile. After he’d left, she looked around at the men sitting on the 3-piece suite. “Is there room for a small one?”

John and Donal made space between them on the couch. Brian got up from his armchair to refill everyone’s glass with whisky, and Paul, in the other armchair, now stared blatantly at Nicole’s legs as she sat down. She gave him a smile. Brian handed her another glass of whisky, which she managed to sip without coughing at all.

She turned to John. “See, I can swallow.”

He gave a dirty laugh.

“Do you think I was too harsh on Ciaran?” she asked.

John stroked his chin. “I don’t know what it was about, but to be honest, I don’t really care. Anyone who slaps that twat is alright in my book, though it *was* my Malbec you threw at him.”

“Sorry, I’ll buy you a new bottle.” She looked over at Brian. “And I’ll buy you some carpet shampoo.”

They chatted for a few more minutes with Nicole enjoying the heat of the men on either side of her. She waited until Paul looked back at her legs, then slowly crossed them. The hem of her dress rode up, and she could feel the cool leather of the seat on the back of her bare thigh.

“I like your shoes,” Donal said.

“Thank you.” Nicole pointed her upper leg out in front of her, turning her ankle this way and that. “My husband calls them my fuck-me shoes.”

The men cast furtive glances at each other. “And does he know you’re wearing them tonight?” John asked.

“Oh yes.” She turned and looked up into his eyes. “It was his idea that I wear them tonight.”

This left him speechless, which made her giggle.

“Does he know you’re here now?” Donal asked.

“Yes, I phoned him earlier. At Will’s request.”

“Will suggested you phone your husband back in England in the early hours of the morning?”

She nodded. “Hmm.”

Donal looked bemused. “And what did he say?”

“Will?”

“No, your husband. What did he say about you being here in your fuck-me shoes?”

“He asked if I was wearing them with stockings.”

“And are you?”

Nicole turned to look at Paul, whose gaze hadn’t moved since she’d crossed her legs. “Ask Paul.”

Paul looked up at Donal, glanced at John, then looked back at her hem line. “She is. And suspenders.”

John closed his eyes. “Oh my fuck...”

“Don’t you like stockings, John?”

“I *love* stockings.”

“Good. Would you like to see them?”

The four men all glanced at each other again.

“Well I don’t know about these three,” Brian said, leaning forward in his chair, “but I would.”

Nicole smiled at him, then slowly stood up. She was drunk, but not *that* drunk. Her hands trembled as she put her drink down on the coffee

table, but that was more to do with her excitement than the alcohol. Her dress fastened under one arm, and after pulling the zipper down she swayed her hips and let the dress slide down and off her body. Stepping out of it, she stood in front of the four men in her basque, thong, suspender belt and stockings.

“Oh my fuck,” John said again.

“You like?” Nicole turned slowly through a full three-sixty.

John reached up and ran his hand slowly down Nicole’s leg. “God, I’ve not seen anything like this in...” He shook his head “Ever.”

She looked at Brian. “Is there anywhere that might be more comfortable?”

“The bedroom?”

Nicole looked around at them. “The bedroom sounds perfect...”

The men stood up as one.

“But first,” she went on, “I have to phone my husband.”

All four men stopped in their tracks, and she giggled. “Don’t worry, he just asked me to let him know when the fun was going to start.”

They exchanged shocked looks, and Nicole strode through to the kitchen to get her phone. She came back into the living room and looked at Brian. “I assume the bedroom’s upstairs?”

He nodded, and Nicole moved through the hall and started up the stairs. All four men quickly followed her.

“To the left,” Brian said, and Nicole pushed open the door. The huge room featured a king-sized bed under a single wall light. The curtains were already closed.

She stepped over to the far wall and turned round to look at the men, then called Julian. With the phone pressed to her ear, she gave them a confident smile.

“Hi,” she said when Julian picked up.

“Hello.” He sounded breathless already.

“You told me to call you back when things started to heat up.”

“And are they heating up now?”

Nicole looked around the room at the four men staring at her. “I’m hoping things are about to get pretty hot.” She saw John slip off his jacket

and drop it on the floor near the wall. Donal did the same.

“Are you still in the kitchen?” Julian asked.

“No, I’m in a bedroom.”

“Has Will gone home?”

“Mm-hmm.”

“But the other four are still there?”

“Yeah, they’re all here.”

“And what’s happened so far?”

“Nothing’s happened yet.” She looked down at herself. “Except that I decided to leave my dress downstairs.”

“So you’re in the bedroom with four men wearing just your underwear?”

“And my shoes.” She grinned at Donal. “Yes, the fuck-me ones.”

“I want to see you.”

“What?” Nicole was puzzled.

“I want to watch it. I’ll FaceTime you. Put your phone where it shows the action, or better still, let the men hold the phone.”

“Are you serious?”

“Very. I’ll call you using my iPad. End this call and I’ll call you. Then answer the phone, pass it to one of the men and get whoever isn’t involved at that time to film the action so I can watch it.”

Before Nicole could reply, he’d ended the call. She looked up at the men. “He wants to watch it on FaceTime.”

They all glanced at each other, then shrugged. When Nicole’s phone rang she jumped, then accepted the call.

The screen was blank, but Julian’s voice came over the loudspeaker. “Tap the screen, then choose the ‘Flip’ icon.”

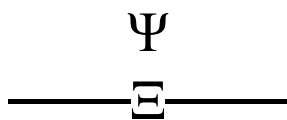
Nicole did as instructed, and the screen filled with the view from the camera lens on the back of the phone, as if shooting a normal video.

“Right,” said Julian, “now pass the phone to somebody else so I can see what you’re wearing.”

Nicole felt a little awkward, but Paul stepped forward and held out his hand. After she’d handed him the phone, he pointed it at her, slowly sweeping from her head down to her feet and then back up again.

“Wonderful,” Julian said. “Right, forget I’m here. Just enjoy yourselves and capture what you can.”





Chapter Ten

Nicole looked around at the men, momentarily knocked off her stride by Julian's inclusion. She studied their expressions, looking from one face to the next. Brian looked as nervous as she felt. John and Donal both stared hungrily at her. Paul's focus was fixed on the screen of the phone, his eyes wide.

Nicole slowly walked over to the bed. After turning to face the men, she sat on the edge, tucked her thumbs inside the waistband of her thong and peeled it down her legs. This time she'd put it on over the suspenders so it could be removed without unclipping her stockings. Once the thong was off, she sat upright, stared into the lens of the phone in Paul's hand, and slowly parted her legs. John let out a low sigh and Paul angled the phone lower, moving two fingers on the screen to no doubt zoom in on her exposed sex.

Nicole's head buzzed. She wasn't sure if it was due to the alcohol, her arousal, or nerves. During her first threesome, she'd had some sort of routine planned. By following her husband's prior instructions, she'd gotten over the awkward first hurdle by dropping to her knees and sucking Ciaran and Will in turn.

Nicole gave them a smile, then scooted around until she was lying on her back in the centre of the bed. The men gathered round, two on either side. Hands reached down towards her, and she closed her eyes.

Fingertips, probably Brian's, traced over the fine mesh of her left leg. Another hand, warm and calloused, slid over her bare right shoulder and down her arm. That'd be Donal. A heavy hand was placed on her bare tummy and slid up over the basque, cupping her breast through the material and circling the nipple. Undoubtedly John.

Brian's hand had started at her thigh and he'd moved it downwards over her knee, slipping around from the shin to feel the contours of her calf before cradling her foot and tracing the intricate straps of her shoe. Another

hand replicated the action on her other foot, which she surmised was Paul finally joining the action.

The hands on her feet moved upwards, caressing her ankles and calves. Nicole bent her legs and let her knees fall apart. The hand on her arm moved back over her shoulder and followed her collarbone down to the centre of her chest. It pushed further, forcing the soft material of the basque down. John stopped stroking her boob and helped Donal ease the basque lower.

She felt cool air on her taut nipples as her boobs were uncovered. One of the men uttered a low growl. Both breasts were caressed at the same time, one being squeezed and lifted, the other having the nipple pinched. The hands on her legs had moved up above her stocking-tops and were now on the soft flesh of her upper thighs. She could feel her juices seeping out, and as one man traced a finger through her sopping labia, Nicole let out a groan.

The finger slid inside her and she arched up, raising her crotch to meet it, to take it deeper. Warm wetness enveloped her left nipple, instantly followed by the same on her other. John and Donal were sucking her tits, and either Brian or Paul was fingering her. She let out another groan as teeth nipped at her nipples and another hand joined the first at her sex. As the first finger eased out of her sodden channel, another replaced it. This was Paul, she felt sure. He'd been on her right, and he fingered her like a piston—in and out, short and fast. After a few seconds, he removed his hand to let Brian back in. The older and younger men played finger-tag for a couple of minutes, and she was sure they both had a finger inside at the same time at least once.

The scent of her sex was strong in the air, and a hand—probably John's—moved slowly down her belly and over her mons. Brian and Paul both retreated, now moving their sticky fingers up to her hips and waist, and John cupped her sex for a moment before sending two thick fingers deep inside her. Nicole groaned again.

It felt good, and it felt dirty, but it never threatened to provoke an orgasm.

Finally, she opened her eyes and looked up at the faces surrounding her. “Okay, I think you all know what I want now.”

John's hand remained over her sex, a fingertip flicking through the slick folds. Paul still held her phone, and it was the lens of this that Nicole stared into when she spoke.

"I want your cocks." She remembered the night Julian had narrated his fantasy about him being one of several men waiting in line. "I want you to take turns fucking me, but you're not allowed to come yet." She looked from one man to the next, then back at the phone. "Just stay inside for a while, then let someone else have a go. Let your balls get wound up tight, but don't let them unload."

They all nodded. The men were now all stripped down to shirt and trousers. Brian and Paul still wore ties, though Paul's was undone and hanging down on either side.

Nicole looked around the men. "Okay, who's going first?"

Unsurprisingly, John unbuckled his belt. He moved to the foot of the bed and took out his cock. Paul swung the phone around to capture the thick pillar of flesh jutting from John's suit trousers. John crawled up the bed and Nicole stretched her legs out, straight and wide. She smiled up at him as he leaned over her. With a lunge of his hips, his cock slid into her sopping hole.

She let out a grateful moan and undulated her body beneath him, riding him from below.

John let out little grunts as he fucked her, but after less than a minute he pulled out and got off the bed. Brian took his place, a frown of concentration on his face as he looked down at her body.

Nicole stroked her hand down his arm, trying to dispel the fleeting thought that she was behaving like a whore on the bed he'd probably shared with his late wife. She rocked her hips and held onto his backside as he fucked her. "Mmm, that feels so... Yeah, give it to me."

Brian fucked her slowly, as if relishing every single thrust. But, like John, he pulled out after only a minute or so. Donal held his hand out for the phone, which Paul eagerly passed over before he dropped his trousers to mid-thigh. He clambered between Nicole's spread thighs and ran his hand over her sex again, slipping two fingers inside then holding them up to her mouth. Nicole parted her lips and raised her head, sucking his fingers seductively.

Paul grinned and rammed his cock home. His shyness completely gone, he fucked her hard and fast. Donal stepped back and swept the phone over their entire length, then moved close and held it overhead, filming Nicole's face over Paul's shoulder as he fucked her with a ferocity that seemed to verge on anger.

Nicole stared into the lens, her mouth hanging open and tiny yelps escaping her lips with each thrust. She slid her hands around Paul's back and raked her fingernails over his shirt, which spurred him on to fuck her harder.

John tapped Paul's shoulder gently. "Okay mate, take it easy. You'll drive her through the mattress."

Paul took a breath, then pulled out and nodded. "Sorry," he whispered to Nicole as he knelt up.

She shook her head. "Don't be. Fuck me like that when you get in again."

Donal handed the phone back to Paul. His shoulders bulged under his shirt. His chest was broad, his stomach probably not as flat as it had been during his younger days, but he was undoubtedly the most athletic man in the room. Probably the most powerfully built man Nicole had ever been with. He knelt on the bed and gave her a confident grin. Without bothering to unbuckle his belt, he unzipped and pulled out his cock. It was big. Thick and long, and an unusually dark shade of purple. The fat crown of his tip glistened with precum, and he wanked it slowly while looking into Nicole's eyes.

She took a breath, then licked her lips. "What are you waiting for?"

"Just savouring the moment." Then he leaned over her, supporting himself on one thick arm, and guided his cock to her slippery entrance.

Easing it in slowly, he showed a lot more consideration than Paul had a couple of minutes earlier. Nicole appreciated his concern. This was the biggest cock she'd ever taken. He was both longer and thicker than Ciaran. She felt herself stretching, was aware of her walls clinging tightly to the thick shaft. Maybe it was just her imagination, but she was sure she could feel the ridges of his veins. He pulled back a little, then pushed in again. On the next thrust he gave her even more. She felt crammed to the brim, then on his next stroke he filled her.

“Oh god!” she whispered as he moved slowly in and out. The tip bashed against the roof of her cunt with every in-stroke, and she feared she’d be pulled inside out with each retreat.

John reached down and gently turned Nicole’s head towards him, offering his cock in front of her face. Nicole parted her lips and watched his face as she took him into her mouth. She swirled her tongue around the head and licked the sensitive underside of his glans, then pushed her head further toward his side of the bed and took his entire length into her throat.

Gasps of surprise escaped from Brian and Paul. John didn’t appear to be able to say anything, and Donal pushed his cock as deep as it’d go. Nicole was now fully stretched, and all she felt was pleasure.

She bobbed her head, then John held up his hand. “Whoa! You’re going to have to stop there before I...”

She released his cock from her mouth and gave him a self-satisfied smile. Paul replaced John at that side of the bed and, holding the phone close to her face, fed his own cock into her mouth. Nicole stared into the lens and fellated Paul in what she hoped was a visually thrilling way. She slobbered down the side of his shaft, used a hand to wank the base, and wiped the wet tip over her lips before swallowing it again. She wanted her husband to be jerking off while watching at home. She hoped her actions made him come so hard he left a stain on their bedroom ceiling.

Paul pulled back and looked up at Brian. “You want some of that?”

“Too fucking right, I do.”

Nicole leaned over to the opposite side of the bed and took Brian’s cock into her mouth. The cocks were different sizes and shapes but all tasted of her juices.

“Donal,” John complained. “Stop hogging the main attraction.”

With a reluctant sigh, Donal withdrew and backed off the bed. Before anyone could take his place, Nicole released Brian and sat up.

“Time for a change around.” She turned so she was lying sideways across the bed, then rolled over onto her tummy and raised herself up onto all fours. “Let’s try two at a time, shall we? Brian, come here and put your dick back in my mouth.” She looked at the other guys. “And one of you fuck me from behind.”

As Brian held his cock in front of her face, Nicole felt a cock being lodged just inside her slit, then two hands gripped her hips and pulled her back to meet his thrust. Without turning round, she couldn't be sure if it was Paul or John. She closed her eyes and enjoyed being spit-roasted yet again, clenching on the cock invading her from behind while working her tongue on the one in her mouth.

After a couple of minutes, Brian pulled out of her mouth, shaking his head and laughing. "If we're not allowed to come, you're not allowed to use your tongue like that."

"Move over." Donal took his place, his monster cock pointing directly at Nicole.

She stuck out her tongue and licked all around the tip, then took the fat head into her mouth. Since it was impossible to take him any deeper, she used her tongue and the insides of her cheeks to stimulate his glans.

The man behind her withdrew. "Give me the phone." It had been John fucking her, and as he made his way around to the bottom of the bed, Paul took his place and entered Nicole again. She was starting to get sore.

John swept the phone over the scene. Paul was pounding her from behind with a woodpecker rhythm, and Donal was breathing heavily as Nicole sucked and licked the top half of his cock.

She released Donal and eased herself forward until Paul withdrew. "I think it's time for your release." Nicole lay back in the middle of the bed, the position she'd been in at the start. "Okay, now I want you to repeat what you did earlier." Julian had made several references to something over the past couple of months; she didn't know if it was actually a fantasy of his, but it had become one for her. "Take yourself all the way, but I want you to pull out and shoot it over me. I don't care where you come. Just make sure it lands somewhere on my body."

John pushed his way to the front of the queue and got on the bed. Without any preamble he entered with force, sending his cock balls-deep in a single stab. Holding himself up on straight arms, he jackhammered his hips. His eyes were closed, and his brow covered in a sheen of sweat. Eventually his breathing became short gasps. Then he opened his eyes, gave one final thrust and withdrew. A rope of creamy white arced from him and landed on Nicole's left breast. She writhed on the bed as he pumped his

cock, sending another dollop onto her chest and two more onto the rolled-down basque.

After Paul had handed the phone to Brian, he impatiently pulled John out of the way and took his place. He lifted Nicole's legs and rested them against his shoulders before pushing his cock inside and fucking her with the same brutal intensity he'd shown earlier. Paul lasted only a couple of minutes before pulling out and ejaculating on her chest and stomach, as John had.

Brian was next, and once again the older man seemed to savour each sensation, sliding his cock slowly in and out. On any other occasion this would have made Nicole come, but tonight she was too ramped up. This wasn't about reaching orgasm—this was about putting on a show of being used by four men, all while her husband watched.

Brian pulled out and held his cock flat against her mons. Nicole raised her head in time to see him come onto her bare belly below the basque. He let out a stifled grunt and kept his gaze on his cock. She brought her hands up and clamped his dick to her belly, wriggling beneath him as another gush covered her tummy. She continued to massage his cock with one hand as she rubbed his cum into her skin with the other. Paul brought the phone closer to capture the action.

Nicole and Brian shared a smile, and then Donal knelt on the bed, grinning down at her. She took a breath, glanced down at his cock, then swallowed. This was probably going to hurt, but that would be a fitting finale to the evening.

Donal entered her with ease. There was no pain, just the wonderful sensation of being filled. Nicole clenched, wriggled and rocked her hips. She looked up at the phone in Paul's hand, remembering the time Julian had described waiting in line while a guy with a big cock fucked her. In her head, this was it. This was the biggest cock she'd ever taken, and she was enjoying taking it all. Wanting her husband to see her pleasure, she gritted her teeth and rocked her body, trying her hardest to entice the spunk out of Donal's balls.

It seemed to work—he lasted no longer than any of the other guys. With a groan, he pulled out and aimed his cock at the opening of her sex. She felt the hot shower of cum hit the gap between her slit and her right leg.

The second eruption covered her outer lips and pubic hair. So did the third and fourth.

Donal rubbed his fat cockhead through the sticky mess and then pushed back inside her. Nicole cried out and, as he resumed fucking her, she finally tumbled into an orgasm. She wrapped her legs around his and moved on his cock. He held still as Nicole rode out the final tremors. He didn't manage to come again, and as the contractions of her orgasm abated, she felt his cock wither and slip out of her.

Once Donal had stood up, Nicole sunk into the mattress, limp and weary. She saw Paul walking slowly to the bottom of the bed and moving the phone closer to her cum-splattered sex. After a few seconds, he passed her the phone.

She smiled into the camera then blew her husband a kiss. "See you tomorrow." After ending the call, she looked up at the four men. They'd all tucked away their cocks and had fastened their trousers.

"I'll give these guys a final drink," Brian said. "The bathroom's the next door on the left, if you need it."

"Thank you."

After they'd trooped back downstairs, Nicole walked unsteadily to the bathroom and managed a basic clean-up. Even so, she'd need a bath when she got to the hotel. Back in the bedroom, she'd just pulled on her thong and rolled her basque back up when a knock on the door made her jump.

Brian was holding out her dress. "You left this downstairs."

"Thanks." Nicole put it back on, took one last look around the room and picked up her phone.

Downstairs, the other three men were standing in the hallway. "We've got a taxi coming in five, so we can drop you at The Galmont on the way."

"Thank you." Nicole gathered her bag and shawl, then waited in the hall with the others. When the taxi arrived, she gave each man a hug before leaving the house.

Donal held open the front door of the taxi for Nicole while John and Paul got into the back. "I'm just down the road, so I'll walk from here," he explained.

Nicole thanked the driver as he stopped outside the steps of her hotel. The men in the back refused her offer of money, so she got out and walked up the steps and into the hotel. Avoiding looking over at the reception desk, she headed straight to the lift and managed to get all the way to her room without meeting any of the other guests or staff.

Once inside, she slipped off her shoes and started to fill the bath, adding the whole complimentary bottle of relaxing bubbles. Then she returned to the bedroom and quickly stripped. She picked up her phone and tapped out a quick text to Julian.

*Am now back in my hotel room if you want to
chat. xNx*

She'd been soaking for a couple of minutes when her phone rang. She reached out to the side and grabbed it. "Hiya."

"Nicole?"

She sat up so suddenly that water sloshed over the side of the bath. "Ciaran?"

"Yes, I'm sorry to call so late. Did I wake you?"

"No, I've only recently got back to the hotel."

He was silent for a beat, then asked, "Are you alone?"

She snorted. "Yes, I'm alone. Though I've a good mind to tell you I'm enjoying a filthy threesome with Will and Meg."

Ciaran chuckled. "Well, I don't suppose I could blame you. Listen, about Will and Meg—"

"I'm sorry for my reaction earlier, but I was so angry at—"

"Yes, and you had every right to be. I was—"

"Yes, you were. I still think the slap was justified, but not throwing the wine. I've probably ruined Brian's carpet as well as your suit."

"They'll both clean, I'm sure. But the reason I called was to apologise, and to try and explain some things."

"I'm not sure even your smooth-talking could ever justify your actions." She heard another soft chuckle, and could imagine his handsome face looking half-sincere, and half-admonished.

“Well, I haven’t been thinking very clearly for quite some time, but I do know I want to clear the air. Before the journey home.”

She believed him, but his long pause suggested he didn’t know where to start. She decided to lay her own cards on the table and explain what had disturbed her so much. “Meg told me that you’d kept talking about me over Christmas, and she seemed to think we were still ‘seeing’ each other.”

“I’d hoped that, after you’d calmed down, we could maybe go back to what we had.”

“Ciaran, I got the impression that your continual mention of me was to force Will into convincing Meg to do a threesome.”

“No, that’s not—”

“Then why mention me at all? Was Meg your ulterior motive all along? Let Will have a bit of fun with me and then pressure him into getting Meg to do the same with you?”

“What? No, of course not. That was never... Look, I didn’t introduce Will to you as part of some complicated plan—I thought you’d say no.”

“What?” Nicole was confused.

“It never crossed my mind that you’d agree to a threesome with him. I expected you to refuse. I was *sure* you’d refuse, and that your refusal would prove that I meant something to you.”

Nicole closed her eyes and tried to think clearly. The residual fug of alcohol was still slowing her thought processes. “You thought I’d—?”

“I wanted you to see that I was more than just someone you had sex with. There was a real connection there. I felt it, and I was sure you felt it, too. The full night we spent in that hotel room together, that was more than just fucking. When you told me about the other guy you’d seen, I was upset and angry.” He let out a long sigh. “I didn’t stop talking about you because I couldn’t stop thinking about you.”

“Oh, Ciaran.”

He was silent for a moment, and when he spoke again, his voice was barely more than a whisper. “I wish I’d never invited Will along that night. I wish we were still meeting in my office or in a hotel, and I wish we were still—”

“I’m sorry. I have some lovely memories of our time together, but that time is over. What we had was a physical thing, nothing more. I was always honest about that, and I thought you accepted it for what it was.”

A beeping told her and Ciaran that someone else was trying to phone her.

“Is that Julian?” he asked.

“Probably.”

“Well, I’d better let you go. Can you be ready for 10.30 in the morning?”

“Yes, I’ll be ready.”

“Okay. Will says you and Julian are going to invest in the company, too.”

“Yes, if you’re still intending to sell.”

“My decision to sell now has nothing to do with anything that’s been said between me and Will.”

“Good. I’d hate to think that an indiscretion on my part had put the livelihood of all the employees at risk.”

“No, it’s simply about me trying to get into the stock market at a good time. Tell Julian you’ll be home before six tomorrow evening. I’ll see you in the morning. Goodnight, Nicole.”

“Bye.” Nicole ended the call and rang Julian, who picked up immediately.

“Hello?” He sounded worried.

“Hiya.”

“Were you on another call?”

“Yes, Ciaran phoned to confirm what time he was picking me up. So...” She lowered her voice. “Did you enjoy what you saw tonight?”

“Enjoy is far too mild a word. It was phenomenal.”

Nicole smiled. “Did it come out clearly? The lighting was quite low, and I didn’t know if—”

“It was all much clearer than I imagined it would be. Whoever held the phone had a steadier hand than I did. You can watch it tomorrow.”

“You recorded it?”

“Of course. Didn’t you want me to?”

“I hadn’t thought about... Yes, I’m glad. It’ll be nice to see it, I just didn’t realise you could record FaceTime chats.”

“I didn’t either until after you called me from the kitchen and told me your intention. But once I’d had the idea, I quickly researched how to do it.”

“What was your favourite part?”

“There were so many favourite parts, I couldn’t possibly choose just one.”

“Did it turn you on, seeing your wife being used by four men?”

“Immensely.”

“Good.”

“Did you enjoy being used like that?”

“Mm-hmm.”

“Did you come?”

“Yes, but not until the very end.”

“That’s what I thought.” He chuckled. “I actually came more times than you did.”

“You made yourself come watching it?”

“Twice. And once more after I watched it a second time.”

Nicole smiled. “I like that you came, and I’m glad you told me about it.”

“As you’ve told me on many occasions, what we’re doing now means that there’s no reason to be anything other than completely open and honest with each other.”

“That’s right.”

“One of the men was very big.”

“Mmm.”

He let out another sigh. “Well, I suppose I should let you get some well-deserved rest.”

“Okay. Ciaran’s picking me up from the hotel in...” She checked the time on her phone. “Seven hours. He said to tell you I’ll be home around six tomorrow evening.”

“I look forward to it.”

She smiled. “And what will you do to me when I get home?”

“I promise to exercise some patience and restraint.”

Memories of returning home after one particular date with Ciaran flickered through her mind—when she’d been caught in a rainstorm and arrived drenched and horny. Julian had taken her roughly in the hallway of their old house the moment she’d set foot inside.

“What if I don’t want patience or restraint?” she asked.

“Then I may well drag you straight to bed.”

“That might be showing too much patience.”

“In that case I’ll fuck you on the stairs.”

“I love that idea.”

“Me too. And what’s on the agenda after that?” he asked, his voice an intimate whisper.

She frowned, a little confused. “On what agenda?”

“I mean who will be the next person to enjoy the charms of my loaned wife?”

“Liz.”

“Liz alone?”

“Yes. After that, maybe Liz and Ed at the same time. And then, who knows?”

“I’ve had some thoughts about that.”

Nicole smiled. “Oh have you?”

“Hmm. When lockdown’s lifted, I’ll have to travel more with my new job. I was thinking that it’d be nice for you to join me on some of those trips.”

“I’d love that.”

“And while I’m busy working, you could go sightseeing. Budapest, Strasbourg and Paris are all on my list of places to go as soon as restrictions allow.”

“That sounds lovely.”

“And you could seduce a stranger in each city.”

Nicole felt a shiver run down her spine. She held her breath.

“Are you still there?” he asked after a few moment’s silence.

“Yes, I just... Are you serious?”

“Very. There’d be no pressure to do anything, but the option would be there if a man you found attractive made a pass at you.”

Nicole thought about wandering through Paris on a hot day, or sitting at a sidewalk café and catching the eye of a man at a nearby table, allowing him to join her for a drink, and then... “It’s a very sexy idea.”

“Hmm. And if your date with Liz is a success, you won’t need to limit your options to only men.”

“We’ll see.”

He let out a chuckle. “Well, it’s something to think about. I’ll see you tomorrow.”

“Night night.” She ended the call, got out of the bath and dried herself.

Nicole climbed into bed naked and lay in the dark, sated and content. She had a beautiful home, an incredible sex-life, and a wonderful husband who encouraged her to explore all her fantasies. Life as a loaned wife certainly suited her.

THE END



[Delores Swallows](#)

United Kingdom (2021)

About the Author



Delores Swallows has many dirty thoughts, and during his free time he writes them down in the form of stories. Born and bred in the northwest of England, he has a commoner's accent and a bit of a crush on his future queen (Kate, not Camilla!).

His stories often feature petite brunettes, high-heeled shoes and voyeurism. He claims he didn't realise these were obsessions until someone pointed out how often they appear in his work.

Find out more about Delores on his [web site](#), chat on [Twitter](#), or follow his new stories on [Amazon](#). And don't forget to sign up to his [mailing list](#) for a **free story**.

Don't forget your dirty story exclusively available to members of [Delores' mailing list](#).

Also by Delores Swallows



A Hotwife's Journey

Her key in the door made his heart race. He listened as she came up the stairs, then held his breath when she walked into the bedroom. He couldn't help staring. Her clothes were twisted, her makeup was smudged, and her hair was dishevelled.

She's fucked someone.

Karen walked to the foot of the bed and looked into his face. "I did it."

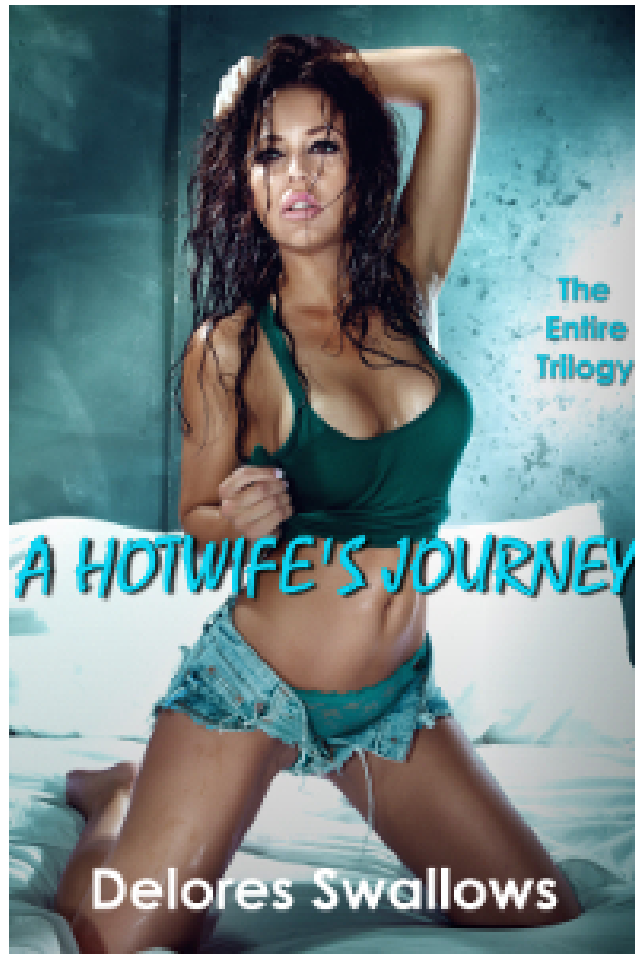
He swallowed.

She pulled her top over her head and dropped it on the floor, then pushed her skirt down over her hips and kicked it away. Slowly, she unclipped her bra at the front. As the cups came away, he saw a love bite on one of her breasts. Karen held his gaze as she pushed her thong down her legs and then bent to pick it up, holding it open so he could see the gooey mess soaked into the crotch.

It was another man's cum, and it'd dribbled out of her during the drive home. The guy had deposited it deep in her cunt, and she'd returned home to her pervert husband to show him the evidence.

Nigel ached for her.





After her husband's open invitation to become a hotwife, Karen enjoys a variety of surprises and adventures that are hotter than any wife could wish for.

This collection covers her entire journey.

Karen's Open Invitation

Nigel is a lucky man. He has everything a man could want: a successful and beautiful wife, a happy marriage, two wonderful daughters, a nice home and his own business.

So why risk it all just to satisfy his dirty fantasy?

When Karen's throwaway comment about a hot colleague in the Sweden office unlocks the door to his secret desires, he offers her the chance to have a little fun; to mix business with pleasure.

Nigel has fantasised about sharing his wife for a long time. And from the way Karen's been behaving lately, he suspects the idea appeals to her, too. But there's a big difference between fantasy and reality.

Will she take up his suggestion and have a passionate tryst with a virtual stranger while attending an overseas meeting? Neither know the answer when she leaves for the airport, but she doesn't have to make her decision straight away. She can see how the meeting pans out. After all, it's an open invitation...

Karen's Party Surprise

Nigel is amazed by how Karen's taken to her new role as a hotwife. Not only does she give herself freely to strangers, but she also thrills her husband by giving him all the juicy details he craves when she gets home.

Their sex-life is better than ever.

Nigel realises that an upcoming company get together will mean that they'll be staying in the same hotel as Sean, the first man he ever shared her with. He offers Karen the chance to enjoy another night of passion, and they hatch a plan that could work. But Sean comes up with a counteroffer that's just too good to refuse.

For a wife-sharing couple like Nigel and Karen, it's the ultimate party surprise...

Karen's Holiday Adventures

Life keeps getting better and better for Nigel. His long-held wife-sharing fantasy is now his reality, and he couldn't be happier.

Or at least that's what he thinks until his wife reveals her plans for a break.

Their daughters are going away with their cousin's family, so Karen books a holiday for the two of them—on a Caribbean island. What's more, she promises to make it a fun-filled week where nothing is off-limits.

Under the hot tropical sun of St Lucia, Nigel learns just how hot his hotwife can be.

He's shocked by the diversity of her sexual appetite, but then she did promise him an 'anything goes' holiday adventure...

[A Hotwife's Journey](#) is available from Amazon.



Extramarital Pursuits

Michelle climbed up off the lounge and turned to face Harry. Lucas's sunglasses still hid her eyes, and his cum still covered her chest and stomach.

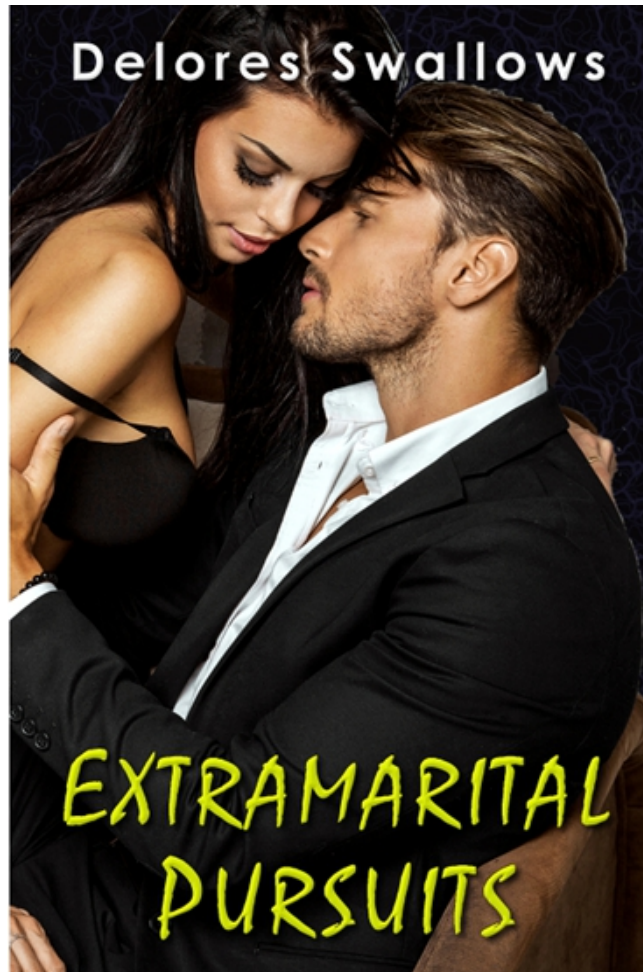
She tilted her head to one side and smiled. "Take my picture."

Harry did so, taking at least ten shots.

"And now shoot a video," she ordered.

Harry obeyed, selecting the correct option and pressing the red button.

Michelle smeared the cum all over her stomach and breasts while looking directly into the lens. "I have a confession—this isn't my husband's cum. My husband has just watched another man fuck me, and I know he enjoyed it almost as much as I did." She licked her lips. "And when we get home, my husband is going to use me for his pleasure, and then he's going to come all over me as well." Michelle gave her most beautiful smile. "I love my life."



The complete sordid trilogy...

Operation Cuckold

Harry's having problems rising to the occasion and discovers Michelle's been using porn to help take care of things herself. He suggests she lives out her fantasy of a one-night stand, but is shocked by how much he gets out of it. As they repeat the experience with other men, pretty soon neither can stand the idea of going back to what they had before, even though Michelle pushes Harry right out of his comfort zone.

A cuck and bull story about a very happy hotwife.

Stag Nights

Harry and Michelle are now fully entrenched in their new wife-sharing lifestyle. Michelle is proving to be one of the hottest hotwives around, with bulls waiting in line to take turns. Literally. As Michelle gets more of what

she craves, she pushes Harry further into the role of the cuckold and he's presented with situations he finds hard to accept. Things look like they might be going awry until a helpful bull called Ben explains that not all wife-sharing husbands need to be cucks...

Unleashing the Bull

When Josh's ex-girlfriend asks to meet for coffee, his hopes that they might get back together are crushed by news of her whirlwind romance and marriage. He offers his congratulations through gritted teeth, still besotted enough to agree to meet her again just days later. This time, Olivia's more provocative, more flirtatious, and she tells him exactly what part of him she misses the most. Caught up in a rush of emotions which steamroll over his morals, he goes back to her upmarket townhouse and indulges in what he's been missing. Her behaviour—coarser, sluttier—puzzles him, but that doesn't stop him going back for more. And then she tells him that her husband wants to meet him. Josh is stunned to find that her husband is a cuckold who actively encourages their liaisons. Hotwife Olivia, with her husband's help, convinces Josh that he has the physical attributes and stamina to service not just her, but several of her friends. Rising to the challenge, he becomes Ben the Bull, and loves every minute of it. As he explains to a friend, his life is full of dates with gorgeous women interested in having hot, dirty sex and nothing more.

Surely, no red-blooded man could want for anything more than that...?

[Extramarital Pursuits](#) is available from Amazon.



Take My Wife

After about fifteen minutes, Sophie leaned up on her elbow and started to kiss Joel, ready to continue with her night of passion. As she pushed the quilt down the bed with her foot, Jim saw that her hand was

gripping Joel's dick, slowly masturbating him. Joel was already hard. Evidently, he was ready for more, too. Jim wondered how long Sophie had been playing with him. Sophie climbed on top of him, feeding his thick dick inside her.

Jim knelt on the bed next to their legs and watched as his wife slowly made love to the other man. Her head was buried against Joel's shoulder, her long tousled hair a dark fan over the pillow, hiding both their faces. Their bodies moved together in a slow, sensual dance. From his position on the bed, Jim had a perfect view of their union. With each slow, upward movement of Sophie's hips he could see Joel's slippery hardness, partially exposed for a second or two before it disappeared again inside the dark pinkness. Joel was holding Sophie's hips in his hands, moving her on him. Jim stretched his hand out and gently stroked the back of Sophie's leg, aroused to feel her thigh muscles working as she rode his friend.

There was a layer of perspiration on Sophie's back, giving her a sultry, exotic look in the dim yellow light. Their lovemaking seemed to go on for a long time before Sophie reached her climax. She was very vocal as she came – muffled moans and sighs as the current built up, urgent grunts as the waves swelled inside her, then screams and shouts as the waves broke into an explosion of pleasure. Finally, she let out grateful cries and whimpers as she rode the final waves.



The epic saga of how a really dirty fantasy becomes a fantastically dirty reality. All three books under one sweaty cover.

Bon Voyeur

Another man in their bed? Madness! Sophie and Jim had never done it before—heck, it was only supposed to be a fantasy to get them in the mood for each other. What if Sophie likes it too much? What if Jim has second thoughts when he sees his beautiful wife taken by another man? What if she enjoys the other man more because he has more to offer?

When the perfect opportunity presents, though, they both jump at the chance.

Joel is tall, handsome, and so much bigger than even Sophie expected! Best of all, he's moving to the other side of the world, so they need never see him again. If Jim plays this right, Joel won't even suspect the stranger they're sharing is his loving wife.

Watching his beautiful Sophie—so vulnerable, so unprotected, so utterly owned—Jim experiences a powerful revelation. It's sure been fun having a gorgeous wife all to himself, but it's much more fun to share.

Abuse of Power

Jim's learning things about himself that he never knew. Surprising things. Like how much he enjoys watching his wife lose herself with another man. Sophie's learning as well, like how when it comes to

male attention, for her it's a case of the more the merrier.

And Sophie loves getting merry. You might say she's becoming addicted. Sometimes she needs it so bad she'll take the initiative herself, even when Jim is not around. For most men, that might be a problem, but Jim is not most men. Just knowing what his loving wife is doing without him, giving herself to those men, letting them have her in every way they can... Yes, he gets jealous, but if Sophie tells him everything, how she becomes so needy that she simply relinquishes her will, it can be almost as good as being there.

Drunk on the seemingly inexhaustible depth of his wife's libido, Jim oversteps at a swinging party and starts directing Sophie's lovers, telling them where they should finish. Finally, Sophie cracks. Sticky, degraded, angry, she strikes back and gives her cuckold husband a taste of his own medicine... or at least, her lovers' medicine.

Global Playground

Jim is a simple man with simple needs. He's lives in a nice house on a nice street, he's got a good job, and he plays tennis to wind down. And on weekends he kisses his wife Sophie goodbye when she goes off to swingers' parties to service her ever-escalating needs. Billionaires, porn stars, dancers—one at a time or all at once, it doesn't matter to Sophie. She'll take it every way she can get it and relay all the juicy details to Jim when she gets home.

Life is good. Too good, you might say. For a voyeur like Jim, his open marriage is damn near perfect. Little bit of wife-watching, little bit of playing around... what more could a man want? Well there's only one answer to the eternal question, and that's the eternal truth. He want's what he can't have—romantic dates, curling up in front of a fire, sweet togetherness—and while Sophie is off jet-setting with wealthy men to service her needs, Jim falls into a comfortable friendship with Naomi, a stunning older woman and self-described cougar.

For a man who's known nothing but chocolate-chip, where's the harm in trying vanilla for once? Just a little taste... maybe a scoop...

[Take My Wife](#) is available from Amazon

